
In the name of Allah — the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

The Clear Quran

An Optimal English Translation

Translated by

Dr. Mustafa Khattab

Scholar of Islamic Studies • Al-Azhar University, Egypt

English-only edition • No Arabic script • A5 Format

Generated from the [druvx13/Quran-data](#) repository

*“Indeed, We have sent it down as an Arabic Quran so
that you may understand.”*

— Quran 12:2

About This Translation

The Clear Quran: An Optimal Translation is an English translation of the meanings of the Holy Quran by Dr. Mustafa Khat-tab, a Canadian-Egyptian Muslim scholar who studied at Al-Azhar University in Egypt, one of the oldest institutions of Islamic learning in the world.

This translation aims to convey the meanings of the Quran in clear, contemporary English that is accessible to the modern reader, without compromising accuracy. Key features include:

- Clear, modern English that preserves the dignity and beauty of the original Arabic text.
- The use of gender-inclusive language where the original intends both men and women.
- Footnotes and bracketed additions [^{text}] clarifying implied meanings, represented here as ^{raised} markers or in-line context notes.

- The `⸱⸱` corner brackets are used throughout to enclose implied meanings that are in the original Arabic but need elaboration in English for clarity.

This document contains the English translation text only. For Arabic script, Unicode transliteration, or multi-language comparison, see the full `druvx13/Quran-data` repository.

Contents

About This Translation	iii
1 1. Al-Fātiḥah	1
2 2. Al-Baqarah	3
3 3. Āl-‘Imrān	61
4 4. An-Nisā’	95
5 5. Al-Mā’idah	131
6 6. Al-An‘ām	157
7 7. Al-A‘rāf	189
8 8. Al-Anfāl	223
9 9. At-Tawbah	237
10 10. Yūnus	263

11 11. Hūd	281
12 12. Yūsuf	301
13 13. Ar-Ra'd	319
14 14. Ibrāhīm	329
15 15. Al-Ḥijr	339
16 16. An-Naḥl	349
17 17. Al-Isrā'	369
18 18. Al-Kahf	387
19 19. Maryam	405
20 20. Ṭā Hā	417
21 21. Al-Anbiyā'	433
22 22. Al-Ḥajj	447
23 23. Al-Mu'minūn	461

24	24. An-Nūr	475
25	25. Al-Furqān	489
26	26. Ash-Shu‘arā’	501
27	27. An-Naml	519
28	28. Al-Qaṣaṣ	533
29	29. Al-‘Ankabūt	549
30	30. Ar-Rūm	561
31	31. Luqmān	571
32	32. As-Sajdah	577
33	33. Al-Aḥzāb	583
34	34. Saba’	597
35	35. Fāṭir	607
36	36. Yā Sīn	615

37 37. Aṣ-Ṣāffāt	625
38 38. Ṣād	639
39 39. Az-Zumar	649
40 40. Ghāfir	663
41 41. Fuṣṣilat	677
42 42. Ash-Shūrā	687
43 43. Az-Zukhruf	697
44 44. Ad-Dukhān	709
45 45. Al-Jāthiyah	715
46 46. Al-Aḥqāf	721
47 47. Muḥammad	729
48 48. Al-Fath	737
49 49. Al-Ḥujurāt	743

50	50. Qāf	747
51	51. Adh-Dhāriyāt	753
52	52. Aṭ-Ṭūr	759
53	53. An-Najm	765
54	54. Al-Qamar	771
55	55. Ar-Raḥmān	777
56	56. Al-Wāqī'ah	783
57	57. Al-Ḥadīd	789
58	58. Al-Mujādilah	795
59	59. Al-Ḥashr	801
60	60. Al-Mumtaḥanah	807
61	61. Aṣ-Ṣaff	811
62	62. Al-Jumu'ah	815

63 63. Al-Munāfiqūn	817
64 64. At-Taghābun	821
65 65. Aṭ-Ṭalāq	825
66 66. At-Taḥrīm	829
67 67. Al-Mulk	833
68 68. Al-Qalam	837
69 69. Al-Ḥāqqah	843
70 70. Al-Ma‘ārij	847
71 71. Nūḥ	851
72 72. Al-Jinn	855
73 73. Al-Muzzammil	859
74 74. Al-Muddaththir	863
75 75. Al-Qiyāmah	867

76	76. Al-Insān	871
77	77. Al-Mursalāt	875
78	78. An-Naba'	879
79	79. An-Nāzi'āt	883
80	80. 'Abasa	887
81	81. At-Takwīr	891
82	82. Al-Infīṭār	893
83	83. Al-Muṭaffifīn	895
84	84. Al-Inshiqāq	899
85	85. Al-Burūj	901
86	86. Aṭ-Ṭariq	903
87	87. Al-A'lā	905
88	88. Al-Ghāshiyah	907

89	89. Al-Fajr	909
90	90. Al-Balad	913
91	91. Ash-Shams	915
92	92. Al-Layl	917
93	93. Ad-Duḥā	919
94	94. Ash-Sharḥ	921
95	95. At-Tīn	923
96	96. Al-‘Alaq	925
97	97. Al-Qadr	927
98	98. Al-Bayyinah	929
99	99. Az-Zalzalah	931
100	100. Al-‘Ādiyāt	933
101	101. Al-Qāri‘ah	935

102102. At-Takāthur	937
103103. Al-‘Aşr	939
104104. Al-Humazah	941
105105. Al-Fīl	943
106106. Quraysh	945
107107. Al-Mā‘ūn	947
108108. Al-Kawthar	949
109109. Al-Kāfirūn	951
110110. An-Naşr	953
111111. Al-Masad	955
112112. Al-Ikhlāş	957
113113. Al-Falaq	959
114114. An-Nās	961

Al-Fātiḥah

The Opening • 7 verses

¹In the Name of Allah—the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

²All praise is for Allah—Lord of all worlds

³the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

⁴Master of the Day of Judgment

⁵You ‘alone’ we worship and You ‘alone’ we ask for help

⁶Guide us along the Straight Path

⁷the Path of those You have blessed—not those You are displeased with, or those who are astray

Al-Baqarah

The Cow • 286 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²This is the Book! There is no doubt about it—a guide for those mindful ‘of Allah’

³who believe in the unseen, establish prayer, and donate from what We have provided for them

⁴and who believe in what has been revealed to you ‘O Prophet’ and what was revealed before you, and have sure faith in the Hereafter

⁵It is they who are ‘truly’ guided by their Lord, and it is they who will be successful

⁶As for those who persist in disbelief, it is the same whether you warn them or not—they will never believe

⁷Allah has sealed their hearts and their hearing, and their sight is covered. They will suffer a tremendous punishment

⁸And there are some who say, “We believe in Allah and the Last Day,” yet they are not ‘true’ believers

⁹They seek to deceive Allah and the believers, yet they only deceive themselves, but they fail to perceive it

¹⁰There is sickness in their hearts, and Allah ‘only’ lets their sickness increase. They will suffer a painful punishment for their lies

¹¹When they are told, “Do not spread corruption in the land,” they reply, “We are only peace-makers!”

¹²Indeed, it is they who are the corruptors, but they fail to perceive it

¹³And when they are told, “Believe as others believe,” they reply, “Will we believe as the fools believe?” Indeed, it is they who are fools, but they do not know

¹⁴When they meet the believers they say, “We believe.” But when alone with their evil associates they say, “We are definitely with you; we were only mocking.”

¹⁵Allah will throw their mockery back at them, leaving them to continue wandering blindly in their defiance

¹⁶They are the ones who trade guidance for misguidance. But this trade is profitless, and they are not ‘rightly’ guided

¹⁷Their example is that of someone who kindles a fire, but when it lights up all around them, Allah takes away their light, leaving them in complete darkness—unable to see

¹⁸They are ‘wilfully’ deaf, dumb, and blind, so they will never return ‘to the Right Path’

¹⁹Or ‘those caught in’ a rainstorm from the sky with darkness, thunder, and lightning. They press their fingers into their ears at the sound of every thunder-clap for fear of death. And Allah encompasses the disbelievers ‘by His might’

²⁰It is as if the lightning were about to snatch away their sight. Whenever lightning strikes, they walk in its light, but when darkness covers them, they stand still. Had Allah willed, He could have taken away their hearing and sight. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

²¹O humanity! Worship your Lord, Who created you and those before you, so that you may become mindful ‘of Him’

²²‘He is the One’ Who has made the earth a place of settlement for you and the sky a canopy; and sends down rain from the sky, causing fruits to grow as a provision for you. So do not knowingly set up equals to Allah ‘in worship’

²³And if you are in doubt about what We have revealed to Our servant, then produce a sūrah like it and call your helpers other than Allah, if what you say is true

²⁴But if you are unable to do so—and you will never be able to do so—then fear the Fire fuelled with people and stones, which is prepared for the disbelievers

²⁵Give good news ‘O Prophet’ to those who believe and do good that they will have Gardens under which rivers flow. Whenever provided with fruit, they will say, “This is what we were given before,” for they will be served fruit that looks similar ‘but tastes different’. They will have pure spouses, and they will be there forever

²⁶Surely Allah does not shy away from using the parable of a mosquito or what is even smaller. As for the believers, they know that it is the truth from their Lord. And as for the disbelievers, they argue, “What does Allah mean by such a parable?” Through this ‘test’, He leaves many to stray, and guides many. And He leaves none to stray except the rebellious—

²⁷those who violate Allah’s covenant after it has been affirmed, break whatever ‘ties’ Allah has ordered to be maintained, and spread corruption in the land. It is they who are the ‘true’ losers

²⁸How can you deny Allah? You were lifeless and He gave you life, then He will cause you to die and again bring you to life, and then to Him you will 'all' be returned

²⁹He is the One Who created everything in the earth for you. Then He turned towards the heaven, forming it into seven heavens. And He has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

³⁰'Remember' when your Lord said to the angels, "I am going to place a successive 'human' authority on earth." They asked 'Allah', "Will You place in it someone who will spread corruption there and shed blood while we glorify Your praises and proclaim Your holiness?" Allah responded, "I know what you do not know."

³¹He taught Adam the names of all things, then He presented them to the angels and said, "Tell Me the names of these, if what you say is true?"

³²They replied, "Glory be to You! We have no knowledge except what You have taught us. You are truly the All-Knowing, All-Wise."

³³Allah said, "O Adam! Inform them of their names." Then when Adam did, Allah said, "Did I not tell you that I know the secrets of the heavens and the earth, and I know what you reveal and what you conceal?"

³⁴And ‘remember’ when We said to the angels, “Prostrate before Adam,” so they all did—but not Iblīs, who refused and acted arrogantly, becoming unfaithful

³⁵We cautioned, “O Adam! Live with your wife in Paradise and eat as freely as you please, but do not approach this tree, or else you will be wrongdoers.”

³⁶But Satan deceived them—leading to their fall from the ‘blissful’ state they were in, and We said, “Descend from the heavens ‘to the earth’ as enemies to each other. You will find in the earth a residence and provision for your appointed stay.”

³⁷Then Adam was inspired with words ‘of prayer’ by his Lord, so He accepted his repentance. Surely He is the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

³⁸We said, “Descend all of you! Then when guidance comes to you from Me, whoever follows it, there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

³⁹But those who disbelieve and deny Our signs will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever.”

⁴⁰O children of Israel! Remember My favours upon you. Fulfil your covenant and I will fulfil Mine, and stand in awe of Me ‘alone’

⁴¹Believe in My revelations which confirm your Scriptures. Do not be the first to deny them or trade them for a fleeting gain. And be mindful of Me

⁴²Do not mix truth with falsehood or hide the truth knowingly

⁴³Establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and bow down with those who bow down

⁴⁴Do you preach righteousness and fail to practice it yourselves, although you read the Scripture? Do you not understand

⁴⁵And seek help through patience and prayer. Indeed, it is a burden except for the humble—

⁴⁶those who are certain that they will meet their Lord and to Him they will return

⁴⁷O Children of Israel! Remember ‘all’ the favours I granted you and how I honoured you above the others

⁴⁸Guard yourselves against the Day on which no soul will be of help to another. No intercession will be accepted, no ransom taken, and no help will be given

⁴⁹‘Remember’ how We delivered you from the people of Pharaoh, who afflicted you with dreadful torment, slaughtering your

sons and keeping your women. That was a severe test from your Lord

⁵⁰And ‘remember’ when We parted the sea, rescued you, and drowned Pharaoh’s people before your very eyes

⁵¹And ‘remember’ when We appointed forty nights for Moses, then you worshipped the calf in his absence, acting wrongfully

⁵²Even then We ‘still’ forgave you so perhaps you would be grateful

⁵³And ‘remember’ when We gave Moses the Scripture—the standard ‘to distinguish between right and wrong’ that perhaps you would be ‘rightly’ guided

⁵⁴And ‘remember’ when Moses said to his people, “O my people! Surely you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf, so turn in repentance to your Creator and execute ‘the calf-worshippers among’ yourselves. That is best for you in the sight of your Creator.” Then He accepted your repentance. Surely He is the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

⁵⁵And ‘remember’ when you said, “O Moses! We will never believe you until we see Allah with our own eyes,” so a thunderbolt struck you while you were looking on

⁵⁶Then We brought you back to life after your death, so that perhaps you would be grateful

⁵⁷And ‘remember when’ We shaded you with clouds and sent down to you manna and quails, ‘saying’, “Eat from the good things We have provided for you.” The evildoers ‘certainly’ did not wrong Us, but wronged themselves

⁵⁸And ‘remember’ when We said, “Enter this city and eat freely from wherever you please; enter the gate with humility, saying, ‘Absolve us.’ We will forgive your sins and multiply the reward for the good-doers.”

⁵⁹But the wrongdoers changed the words they were commanded to say. So We sent down a punishment from the heavens upon them for their rebelliousness

⁶⁰And ‘remember’ when Moses prayed for water for his people, We said, “Strike the rock with your staff.” Then twelve springs gushed out, ‘and’ each tribe knew its drinking place. ‘We then said,’ “Eat and drink of Allah’s provisions, and do not go about spreading corruption in the land.”

⁶¹And ‘remember’ when you said, “O Moses! We cannot endure the same meal ‘every day’. So ‘just’ call upon your Lord on our behalf, He will bring forth for us some of what the earth produces of herbs, cucumbers, garlic, lentils, and onions.”

Moses scolded ‘them’, “Do you exchange what is better for what is worse? ‘You can’ go down to any village and you will find what you have asked for.” They were stricken with disgrace and misery, and they invited the displeasure of Allah for rejecting Allah’s signs and unjustly killing the prophets. This is ‘a fair reward’ for their disobedience and violations

⁶²Indeed, the believers, Jews, Christians, and Sabians—whoever ‘truly’ believes in Allah and the Last Day and does good will have their reward with their Lord. And there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

⁶³And ‘remember’ when We took a covenant from you and raised the mountain above you ‘saying’, “Hold firmly to that ‘Scripture’ which We have given you and observe its teachings so perhaps you will become mindful ‘of Allah’.”

⁶⁴Yet you turned away afterwards. Had it not been for Allah’s grace and mercy upon you, you would have certainly been of the losers

⁶⁵You are already aware of those of you who broke the Sabbath. We said to them, “Be disgraced apes!”

⁶⁶So We made their fate an example to present and future generations, and a lesson to the God-fearing

⁶⁷And ‘remember’ when Moses said to his people, “Allah commands you to sacrifice a cow.” They replied, “Are you mocking us?” Moses responded, “I seek refuge in Allah from acting foolishly!”

⁶⁸They said, “Call upon your Lord to clarify for us what type ‘of cow’ it should be!” He replied, “Allah says, ‘The cow should neither be old nor young but in between. So do as you are commanded!’”

⁶⁹They said, “Call upon your Lord to specify for us its colour.” He replied, “Allah says, ‘It should be a bright yellow cow—pleasant to see.’”

⁷⁰Again they said, “Call upon your Lord so that He may make clear to us which cow, for all cows look the same to us. Then, Allah willing, we will be guided ‘to the right one’.”

⁷¹He replied, “Allah says, ‘It should have been used neither to till the soil nor water the fields; wholesome and without blemish.’” They said, “Now you have come with the truth.” Yet they still slaughtered it hesitantly

⁷²‘This is’ when a man was killed and you disputed who the killer was, but Allah revealed what you concealed

⁷³So We instructed, “Strike the dead body with a piece of the cow.” This is how ‘easily’ Allah brings the dead to life, showing you His signs so that you may understand

⁷⁴Even then your hearts became hardened like a rock or even harder, for some rocks gush rivers; others split, spilling water; while others are humbled in awe of Allah. And Allah is never unaware of what you do

⁷⁵Do you ‘believers still’ expect them to be true to you, though a group of them would hear the word of Allah then knowingly corrupt it after understanding it

⁷⁶When they meet the believers they say, “We believe.” But in private they say ‘to each other’, “Will you disclose to the believers the knowledge Allah has revealed to you, so that they may use it against you before your Lord? Do you not understand?”

⁷⁷Do they not know that Allah is aware of what they conceal and what they reveal

⁷⁸And among them are the illiterate who know nothing about the Scripture except lies, and ‘so’ they ‘wishfully’ speculate

⁷⁹So woe to those who distort the Scripture with their own hands then say, “This is from Allah”—seeking a fleeting gain!

So woe to them for what their hands have written, and woe to them for what they have earned

⁸⁰Some of the Jews claim, “The Fire will not touch us except for a number of days.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Have you taken a pledge from Allah—for Allah never breaks His word—or are you ‘just’ saying about Allah what you do not know?”

⁸¹But no! Those who commit evil and are engrossed in sin will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

⁸²And those who believe and do good will be the residents of Paradise. They will be there forever

⁸³And ‘remember’ when We took a covenant from the children of Israel ‘stating’, “Worship none but Allah; be kind to parents, relatives, orphans and the needy; speak kindly to people; establish prayer; and pay alms-tax.” But you ‘Israelites’ turned away—except for a few of you—and were indifferent

⁸⁴And ‘remember’ when We took your covenant that you would neither shed each other’s blood nor expel each other from their homes, you gave your pledge and bore witness

⁸⁵But here you are, killing each other and expelling some of your people from their homes, aiding one another in sin and aggression; and when those ‘expelled’ come to you as

captives, you still ransom them—though expelling them was unlawful for you. Do you believe in some of the Scripture and reject the rest? Is there any reward for those who do so among you other than disgrace in this worldly life and being subjected to the harshest punishment on the Day of Judgment? For Allah is never unaware of what you do

⁸⁶These are the ones who trade the Hereafter for the life of this world. So their punishment will not be reduced, nor will they be helped

⁸⁷Indeed, We gave Moses the Book and sent after him successive messengers. And We gave Jesus, son of Mary, clear proofs and supported him with the holy spirit. Why is it that every time a messenger comes to you 'Israelites' with something you do not like, you become arrogant, rejecting some and killing others

⁸⁸They say, "Our hearts are unreceptive!" In fact, Allah has condemned them for their disbelief. They have but little faith

⁸⁹Although they used to pray for victory 'by means of the Prophet' over the polytheists, when there came to them a Book from Allah which they recognized, confirming the Scripture they had 'in their hands', they rejected it. So may Allah's condemnation be upon the disbelievers

⁹⁰Miserable is the price they have sold their souls for—denying Allah’s revelation and resenting Allah for granting His grace to whoever He wills of His servants! They have earned wrath upon wrath. And such disbelievers will suffer a humiliating punishment

⁹¹When it is said to them: “Believe in what Allah has revealed,” they reply, “We only believe in what was sent down to us,” and they deny what came afterwards, though it is the truth confirming their own Scriptures! Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Why then did you kill Allah’s prophets before, if you are ‘truly’ believers?”

⁹²Indeed, Moses came to you with clear proofs, then you worshipped the calf in his absence, acting wrongfully

⁹³And when We took your covenant and raised the mountain above you ‘saying’, “Hold firmly to that ‘Scripture’ which We have given you and obey,” they answered, “We hear and disobey.” The love of the calf was rooted in their hearts because of their disbelief. Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “How evil is what your ‘so-called’ belief prompts you to do, if you ‘actually’ believe ‘in the Torah’!”

⁹⁴Say, 'O Prophet, '“If the 'eternal' Home of the Hereafter with Allah is exclusively for you 'Israelites' out of all humanity, then wish for death if what you say is true!”

⁹⁵But they will never wish for that because of what their hands have done. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of the wrongdoers

⁹⁶You will surely find them clinging to life more eagerly than any other people, even more than polytheists. Each one of them wishes to live a thousand years. But even if they were to live that long, it would not save them from the punishment. And Allah is All-Seeing of what they do

⁹⁷Say, 'O Prophet, '“Whoever is an enemy of Gabriel should know that he revealed this 'Quran' to your heart by Allah's Will, confirming what came before it—a guide and good news for the believers.”

⁹⁸Whoever is an enemy of Allah, His angels, His messengers, Gabriel, and Michael, then 'let them know that' Allah is certainly the enemy of the disbelievers

⁹⁹Indeed, We have sent down to you 'O Prophet' clear revelations. 'But' none will deny them except the rebellious

100 Why is it that every time they make a covenant, a group of them casts it aside? In fact, most of them do not believe

101 Now, when a messenger from Allah has come to them—confirming their own Scriptures—some of the People of the Book cast the Book of Allah behind their backs as if they did not know

102 They ‘instead’ followed the magic promoted by the devils during the reign of Solomon. Never did Solomon disbelieve, rather the devils disbelieved. They taught magic to the people, along with what had been revealed to the two angels, Hârût and Mârût, in Babylon. The two angels never taught anyone without saying, “We are only a test ‘for you’, so do not abandon ‘your’ faith.” Yet people learned ‘magic’ that caused a rift ‘even’ between husband and wife; although their magic could not harm anyone except by Allah’s Will. They learned what harmed them and did not benefit them—although they already knew that whoever buys into magic would have no share in the Hereafter. Miserable indeed was the price for which they sold their souls, if only they knew

103 If only they were faithful and mindful ‘of Allah’, there would have been a better reward from Allah, if only they knew

104O believers! Do not say, “Râ’ina.” [Herd us!] But say, “Unẓurna,” [Tend to us!] and listen ‘attentively’. And the disbelievers will suffer a painful punishment

105The disbelievers from the People of the Book and the polytheists would not want you to receive any blessing from your Lord, but Allah selects whoever He wills for His mercy. And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

106If We ever abrogate a verse or cause it to be forgotten, We replace it with a better or similar one. Do you not know that Allah is Most Capable of everything

107Do you not know that the kingdom of the heavens and the earth belongs ‘only’ to Allah, and you have no guardian or helper besides Allah

108Or do you ‘believers’ intend to ask of your Messenger as Moses was asked before? But whoever trades belief for disbelief has truly strayed from the Right Way

109Many among the People of the Book wish they could turn you ‘believers’ back to disbelief because of their envy, after the truth has been made clear to them. Pardon and bear with them until Allah delivers His decision. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

110 Establish prayer, and pay alms-tax. Whatever good you send forth for yourselves, you will 'certainly' find 'its reward' with Allah. Surely Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

111 The Jews and Christians each claim that none will enter Paradise except those of their own faith. These are their desires. Reply, 'O Prophet,' "Show 'me' your proof if what you say is true."

112 But no! Whoever submits themselves to Allah and does good will have their reward with their Lord. And there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

113 The Jews say, "The Christians have nothing to stand on" and the Christians say, "The Jews have nothing to stand on," although both recite the Scriptures. And those 'pagans' who have no knowledge say the same 'about people of faith'. Surely Allah will judge between them on the Day of Judgment regarding their dispute

114 Who does more wrong than those who prevent Allah's Name from being mentioned in His places of worship and strive to destroy them? Such people have no right to enter these places except with fear. For them is disgrace in this world, and they will suffer a tremendous punishment in the Hereafter

115 To Allah belong the east and the west, so wherever you turn you are facing 'towards' Allah. Surely Allah is All-Encompassing, All-Knowing

116 They say, "Allah has offspring." Glory be to Him! In fact, to Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth—all are subject to His Will

117 'He is' the Originator of the heavens and the earth! When He decrees a matter, He simply tells it, "Be!" And it is

118 Those who have no knowledge say, "If only Allah would speak to us or a sign would come to us!" The same was said by those who came before. Their hearts are all alike. Indeed, We have made the signs clear for people of sure faith

119 We have surely sent you with the truth 'O Prophet' as a deliverer of good news and a warner. And you will not be accountable for the residents of the Hellfire

120 Never will the Jews or Christians be pleased with you, until you follow their faith. Say, "Allah's guidance is the only 'true' guidance." And if you were to follow their desires after 'all' the knowledge that has come to you, there would be none to protect or help you against Allah

¹²¹Those We have given the Book follow it as it should be followed. It is they who 'truly' believe in it. As for those who reject it, it is they who are the losers

¹²²O Children of Israel! Remember My favours upon you and how I honoured you above the others

¹²³And guard yourselves against the Day when no soul will be of any help to another. No ransom will be taken, no intercession accepted, and no help will be given

¹²⁴'Remember' when Abraham was tested by his Lord with 'certain' commandments, which he fulfilled. Allah said, "I will certainly make you into a role model for the people." Abraham asked, "What about my offspring?" Allah replied, "My covenant is not extended to the wrongdoers."

¹²⁵And 'remember' when We made the Sacred House a centre and a sanctuary for the people 'saying', "You may take the standing-place of Abraham as a site of prayer." And We entrusted Abraham and Ishmael to purify My House for those who circle it, who meditate in it, and who bow and prostrate themselves 'in prayer'

¹²⁶And 'remember' when Abraham said, "My Lord, make this city 'of Mecca' secure and provide fruits to its people—those among them who believe in Allah and the Last Day." He an-

swered, “As for those who disbelieve, I will let them enjoy themselves for a little while, then I will condemn them to the torment of the Fire. What an evil destination!”

127 And ‘remember’ when Abraham raised the foundation of the House with Ishmael, ‘both praying,’ “Our Lord! Accept ‘this’ from us. You are indeed the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

128 Our Lord! Make us both ‘fully’ submit to You and from our descendants a nation that will submit to you. Show us our rituals, and turn to us in grace. You are truly the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

129 Our Lord! Raise from among them a messenger who will recite to them Your revelations, teach them the Book and wisdom, and purify them. Indeed, You ‘alone’ are the Almighty, All-Wise.”

130 And who would reject the faith of Abraham except a fool! We certainly chose him in this life, and in the Hereafter he will surely be among the righteous

131 When his Lord ordered him, “Submit ‘to My Will’,” he responded, “I submit to the Lord of all worlds.”

¹³²This was the advice of Abraham—as well as Jacob—to his children, ‘saying’, “Indeed, Allah has chosen for you this faith; so do not die except in ‘a state of full’ submission.”

¹³³Or did you witness when death came to Jacob? He asked his children, “Who will you worship after my passing?” They replied, “We will ‘continue to’ worship your God, the God of your forefathers—Abraham, Ishmael, and Isaac—the One God. And to Him we ‘all’ submit.”

¹³⁴That was a community that had already gone before. For them is what they earned and for you is what you have earned. And you will not be accountable for what they have done

¹³⁵The Jews and Christians each say, “Follow our faith to be ‘rightly’ guided.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “No! We follow the faith of Abraham, the upright—who was not a polytheist.”

¹³⁶Say, ‘O believers,’ “We believe in Allah and what has been revealed to us; and what was revealed to Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, and his descendants; and what was given to Moses, Jesus, and other prophets from their Lord. We make no distinction between any of them. And to Allah we all submit.”

¹³⁷So if they believe in what you believe, then they will indeed be ‘rightly’ guided. But if they turn away, they are sim-

ply opposed 'to the truth'. But Allah will spare you their evil. For He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

138 This is the 'natural' Way of Allah. And who is better than Allah in ordaining a way? And we worship 'none but' Him

139 Say, "Would you dispute with us about Allah, while He is our Lord and your Lord? We are accountable for our deeds and you for yours. And we are devoted to Him 'alone'

140 Do you claim that Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, and his descendants were all Jews or Christians?" Say, "Who is more knowledgeable: you or Allah?" Who does more wrong than those who hide the testimony they received from Allah? And Allah is never unaware of what you do

141 That was a community that had already gone before. For them is what they earned and for you is what you have earned. And you will not be accountable for what they have done

142 The foolish among the people will ask, "Why did they turn away from the direction of prayer they used to face?" Say, 'O Prophet,' "The east and west belong 'only' to Allah. He guides whoever He wills to the Straight Path."

143 And so We have made you 'believers' an upright community so that you may be witnesses over humanity and that the

Messenger may be a witness over you. We assigned your former direction of prayer only to distinguish those who would remain faithful to the Messenger from those who would lose faith. It was certainly a difficult test except for those 'rightly' guided by Allah. And Allah would never discount your 'previous acts of' faith. Surely Allah is Ever Gracious and Most Merciful to humanity

¹⁴⁴Indeed, We see you 'O Prophet' turning your face towards heaven. Now We will make you turn towards a direction 'of prayer' that will please you. So turn your face towards the Sacred Mosque 'in Mecca'—wherever you are, turn your faces towards it. Those who were given the Scripture certainly know this to be the truth from their Lord. And Allah is never unaware of what they do

¹⁴⁵Even if you were to bring every proof to the People of the Book, they would not accept your direction 'of prayer', nor would you accept theirs; nor would any of them accept the direction 'of prayer' of another. And if you were to follow their desires after 'all' the knowledge that has come to you, then you would certainly be one of the wrongdoers

146 Those We have given the Scripture recognize this 'Prophet' as they recognize their own children. Yet a group of them hides the truth knowingly

147 'This is' the truth from your Lord, so do not ever be one of those who doubt

148 Everyone turns to their own direction 'of prayer'. So compete with one another in doing good. Wherever you are, Allah will bring you all together 'for judgment'. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

149 Wherever you are 'O Prophet', turn your face towards the Sacred Mosque. This is certainly the truth from your Lord. And Allah is never unaware of what you 'all' do

150 Wherever you are 'O Prophet', turn your face towards the Sacred Mosque. And wherever you 'believers' are, face towards it, so that people will have no argument against you, except the wrongdoers among them. Do not fear them; fear Me, so that I may 'continue to' perfect My favour upon you and so you may be 'rightly' guided

151 Since We have sent you a messenger from among yourselves—reciting to you Our revelations, purifying you, teaching you the Book and wisdom, and teaching you what you never knew—

¹⁵²remember Me; I will remember you. And thank Me, and never be ungrateful

¹⁵³O believers! Seek comfort in patience and prayer. Allah is truly with those who are patient

¹⁵⁴Never say that those martyred in the cause of Allah are dead—in fact, they are alive! But you do not perceive it

¹⁵⁵We will certainly test you with a touch of fear and famine and loss of property, life, and crops. Give good news to those who patiently endure—

¹⁵⁶who, when faced with a disaster, say, “Surely to Allah we belong and to Him we will ‘all’ return.”

¹⁵⁷They are the ones who will receive Allah’s blessings and mercy. And it is they who are ‘rightly’ guided

¹⁵⁸Indeed, ‘the hills of’ Şafa and Marwah are among the symbols of Allah. So whoever performs the pilgrimage or minor pilgrimage, let them walk between ‘the two hills’. And whoever does good willingly, Allah is truly Appreciative, All-Knowing

¹⁵⁹Those who hide the clear proofs and guidance that We have revealed—after We made it clear for humanity in the

Book—will be condemned by Allah and ‘all’ those who condemn

¹⁶⁰As for those who repent, mend their ways, and let the truth be known, they are the ones to whom I will turn ‘in forgiveness’, for I am the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

¹⁶¹Surely those who disbelieve and die as disbelievers are condemned by Allah, the angels, and all of humanity

¹⁶²They will be in Hell forever. Their punishment will not be lightened, nor will they be delayed ‘from it’

¹⁶³Your God is ‘only’ One God. There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

¹⁶⁴Indeed, in the creation of the heavens and the earth; the alternation of the day and the night; the ships that sail the sea for the benefit of humanity; the rain sent down by Allah from the skies, reviving the earth after its death; the scattering of all kinds of creatures throughout; the shifting of the winds; and the clouds drifting between the heavens and the earth—‘in all of this’ are surely signs for people of understanding

¹⁶⁵Still there are some who take others as Allah’s equal—they love them as they should love Allah—but the ‘true’ believers

love Allah even more. If only the wrongdoers could see the 'horrible' punishment 'awaiting them', they would certainly realize that all power belongs to Allah and that Allah is indeed severe in punishment

¹⁶⁶Consider the Day' when those who misled others will disown their followers—when they face the torment—and the bonds that united them will be cut off

¹⁶⁷The 'misled' followers will cry, "If only we could have a second chance, we would disown them as they disowned us." And so Allah will make them remorseful of their misdeeds. And they will never 'be able to' leave the Fire

¹⁶⁸O humanity! Eat from what is lawful and good on the earth and do not follow Satan's footsteps. He is truly your sworn enemy

¹⁶⁹He only incites you to commit evil and indecency, and to claim against Allah what you do not know

¹⁷⁰When it is said to them, "Follow what Allah has revealed," they reply, "No! We 'only' follow what we found our forefathers practicing." 'Would they still do so,' even if their forefathers had 'absolutely' no understanding or guidance

¹⁷¹The example of the disbelievers 'not responding to the Messenger's warning' is like a flock not comprehending the calls and cries of the shepherd. 'They are wilfully' deaf, dumb and blind so they have no understanding

¹⁷²O believers! Eat from the good things We have provided for you. And give thanks to Allah if you 'truly' worship Him 'alone'

¹⁷³He has only forbidden you 'to eat' carrion, blood, swine, and what is slaughtered in the name of any other than Allah. But if someone is compelled by necessity—neither driven by desire nor exceeding immediate need—they will not be sinful. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁷⁴Indeed, those who hide Allah's revelations, trading them for a fleeting gain consume nothing but fire into their bellies. Allah will neither speak to them on the Day of Judgment, nor will He purify them. And they will suffer a painful punishment

¹⁷⁵They are the ones who trade guidance for misguidance and forgiveness for punishment. How persistent are they in pursuit of the Fire

¹⁷⁶That is because Allah has revealed the Book in truth. And surely those who differ regarding it are totally engrossed in opposition

¹⁷⁷Righteousness is not in turning your faces towards the east or the west. Rather, the righteous are those who believe in Allah, the Last Day, the angels, the Books, and the prophets; who give charity out of their cherished wealth to relatives, orphans, the poor, 'needy' travellers, beggars, and for freeing captives; who establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and keep the pledges they make; and who are patient in times of suffering, adversity, and in 'the heat of' battle. It is they who are true 'in faith', and it is they who are mindful 'of Allah'

¹⁷⁸O believers! 'The law of' retaliation is set for you in cases of murder—a free man for a free man, a slave for a slave, and a female for a female. But if the offender is pardoned by the victim's guardian, then blood-money should be decided fairly and payment should be made courteously. This is a concession and a mercy from your Lord. But whoever transgresses after that will suffer a painful punishment

¹⁷⁹There is 'security of' life for you in 'the law of' retaliation, O people of reason, so that you may become mindful 'of Allah'

¹⁸⁰It is prescribed that when death approaches any of you—if they leave something of value—a will should be made in favour of parents and immediate family with fairness. 'This is' an obligation on those who are mindful 'of Allah'

¹⁸¹But whoever changes the will after hearing it, the blame will only be on those who made the change. Indeed, Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

¹⁸²Whoever suspects an error or an injustice in the will and brings about a 'fair' settlement among the parties will not be sinful. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁸³O believers! Fasting is prescribed for you—as it was for those before you—so perhaps you will become mindful 'of Allah'

¹⁸⁴'Fast a' prescribed number of days. But whoever of you is ill or on a journey, then 'let them fast' an equal number of days 'after Ramaḍân'. For those who can only fast with extreme difficulty, compensation can be made by feeding a needy person 'for every day not fasted'. But whoever volunteers to give more, it is better for them. And to fast is better for you, if only you knew

¹⁸⁵Ramaḍân is the month in which the Quran was revealed as a guide for humanity with clear proofs of guidance and the

standard 'to distinguish between right and wrong'. So whoever is present this month, let them fast. But whoever is ill or on a journey, then 'let them fast' an equal number of days 'after Ramaḍân'. Allah intends ease for you, not hardship, so that you may complete the prescribed period and proclaim the greatness of Allah for guiding you, and perhaps you will be grateful

¹⁸⁶When My servants ask you 'O Prophet' about Me: I am truly near. I respond to one's prayer when they call upon Me. So let them respond 'with obedience' to Me and believe in Me, perhaps they will be guided 'to the Right Way'

¹⁸⁷It has been made permissible for you to be intimate with your wives during the nights preceding the fast. Your spouses are a garment for you as you are for them. Allah knows that you were deceiving yourselves. So He has accepted your repentance and pardoned you. So now you may be intimate with them and seek what Allah has prescribed for you. 'You may' eat and drink until you see the light of dawn breaking the darkness of night, then complete the fast until nightfall. Do not be intimate with your spouses while you are meditating in the mosques. These are the limits set by Allah, so

do not exceed them. This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to people, so they may become mindful 'of Him'

188 Do not consume one another's wealth unjustly, nor deliberately bribe authorities in order to devour a portion of others' property, knowing that it is a sin

189 They ask you 'O Prophet' about the phases of the moon. Say, "They are a means for people to determine time and pilgrimage." Righteousness is not in entering your houses from the back doors. Rather, righteousness is to be mindful 'of Allah'. So enter your homes through their 'proper' doors, and be mindful of Allah so you may be successful

190 Fight in the cause of Allah 'only' against those who wage war against you, but do not exceed the limits. Allah does not like transgressors

191 Kill them wherever you come upon them and drive them out of the places from which they have driven you out. For persecution is far worse than killing. And do not fight them at the Sacred Mosque unless they attack you there. If they do so, then fight them—that is the reward of the disbelievers

192 But if they cease, then surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁹³Fight against them 'if they persecute you' until there is no more persecution, and 'your' devotion will be to Allah 'alone'. If they stop 'persecuting you', let there be no hostility except against the aggressors

¹⁹⁴There will be retaliation in 'a sacred month for 'an offence in' a sacred month, and all violations will bring about retaliation. So, if anyone attacks you, retaliate in the same manner. 'But' be mindful of Allah, and know that Allah is with those mindful 'of Him'

¹⁹⁵Spend in the cause of Allah and do not let your own hands throw you into destruction 'by withholding'. And do good, for Allah certainly loves the good-doers

¹⁹⁶Complete the pilgrimage and minor pilgrimage for Allah. But if prevented 'from proceeding', then 'offer' whatever sacrificial animals you can afford. And do not shave your heads until the sacrificial animal reaches its destination. But if any of you is ill or has a scalp ailment 'requiring shaving', then compensate either by fasting, charity, or a sacrificial offering. In times of peace, you may combine the pilgrimage and minor pilgrimage then make the sacrificial offering you can afford. Whoever cannot afford that 'offering', let them fast three days during pilgrimage and seven after returning 'home'—

completing ten. These offerings are for those who do not live near the Sacred House. And be mindful of Allah, and know that Allah is severe in punishment

¹⁹⁷Commitment to pilgrimage is made in appointed months. Whoever commits to performing pilgrimage, let them stay away from intimate relations, foul language, and arguments during pilgrimage. Whatever good you do, Allah fully knows of it. Take necessary provisions for the journey—surely the best provision is righteousness. And be mindful of Me, O people of reason

¹⁹⁸There is no blame on you for seeking the bounty of your Lord during this journey. When you return from Arafât, praise Allah near the sacred place and praise Him for having guided you, for surely before this guidance you were astray

¹⁹⁹Then go forth with the rest of the pilgrims. And seek Allah's forgiveness. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²⁰⁰When you have fulfilled your sacred rites, praise Allah as you used to praise your forefathers before Islam, or even more passionately. There are some who say, "Our Lord! Grant us Your bounties in this world," but they will have no share in the Hereafter

²⁰¹Yet there are others who say, “Our Lord! Grant us the good of this world and the Hereafter, and protect us from the torment of the Fire.”

²⁰²It is they who will receive a ‘heavenly’ reward for the good they have done. Surely Allah is swift in reckoning

²⁰³And remember Allah during ‘these’ appointed days. Whoever departs swiftly on the second day is not sinful, neither are those who stay behind ‘till the third—seeking additional reward’, so long as they are mindful ‘of their Lord’. And be mindful of Allah, and know that to Him you will ‘all’ be gathered

²⁰⁴There are some ‘hypocrites’ who impress you with their views regarding worldly affairs and openly call upon Allah to witness what is in their hearts, yet they are your worst adversaries

²⁰⁵And when they leave ‘you’, they strive throughout the land to spread mischief in it and destroy crops and cattle. Allah does not like mischief

²⁰⁶When it is said to them, “Fear Allah,” pride carries them off to sin. Hell will be their proper place. What an evil place to rest

207 And there are those who would dedicate their lives to Allah's pleasure. And Allah is Ever Gracious to 'His' servants

208 O believers! Enter into Islam wholeheartedly and do not follow Satan's footsteps. Surely he is your sworn enemy

209 If you falter after receiving the clear proofs, then know that Allah is indeed Almighty, All-Wise

210 Are they waiting for Allah 'Himself' to come to them in the shade of clouds, along with the angels? 'If He did', then the matter would be settled 'at once'. And to Allah 'all' matters will be returned 'for judgment'

211 Ask the Children of Israel how many clear signs We have given them. And whoever trades Allah's favour—after receiving it—'for disbelief' should know that Allah is indeed severe in punishment

212 The life of this world has been made appealing to the disbelievers, and they mock the believers. Those who are mindful 'of Allah' will rank above them on the Day of Judgment. And Allah provides for whoever He wills without limit

213 Humanity had once been one community 'of believers before they lost faith'. Then Allah raised prophets as deliverers of good news and as warners, and revealed to them the

Scriptures in truth to judge among people regarding their disputes. And no one disputed the Scriptures except the very people who received them after clear proofs had come to them—out of jealousy. Then Allah, by His grace, has guided the believers to the truth regarding those disputes. And Allah guides whoever He wills to the Straight Path

²¹⁴Do you think you will be admitted into Paradise without being tested like those before you? They were afflicted with suffering and adversity and were so ‘violently’ shaken that ‘even’ the Messenger and the believers with him cried out, “When will Allah’s help come?” Indeed, Allah’s help is ‘always’ near

²¹⁵They ask you ‘O Prophet in’ what ‘way’ they should donate. Say, “Whatever donations you give are for parents, relatives, orphans, the poor, and ‘needy’ travellers. Whatever good you do is certainly well known to Allah.”

²¹⁶Fighting has been made obligatory upon you ‘believers’, though you dislike it. Perhaps you dislike something which is good for you and like something which is bad for you. Allah knows and you do not know

²¹⁷They ask you ‘O Prophet’ about fighting in the sacred months. Say, “Fighting during these months is a great sin. But hin-

dering ‘others’ from the Path of Allah, rejecting Him, and expelling the worshippers from the Sacred Mosque is ‘a’ greater ‘sin’ in the sight of Allah. For persecution is far worse than killing. And they will not stop fighting you until they turn you away from your faith—if they can. And whoever among you renounces their own faith and dies a disbeliever, their deeds will become void in this life and in the Hereafter. It is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever.”

218 Surely those who have believed, emigrated, and struggled in the Way of Allah—they can hope for Allah’s mercy. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

219 They ask you ‘O Prophet’ about intoxicants and gambling. Say, “There is great evil in both, as well as some benefit for people—but the evil outweighs the benefit.” They ‘also’ ask you ‘O Prophet’ what they should donate. Say, “Whatever you can spare.” This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you ‘believers’, so perhaps you may reflect

220 upon this world and the Hereafter. And they ask you ‘O Prophet’ concerning orphans. Say, “Improving their condition is best. And if you partner with them, they are bonded with you ‘in faith’. And Allah knows who intends harm and

who intends good. Had Allah willed, He could have made it difficult for you. Surely Allah is Almighty, All-Wise.”

²²¹Do not marry polytheistic women until they believe; for a believing slave-woman is better than a free polytheist, even though she may look pleasant to you. And do not marry your women to polytheistic men until they believe, for a believing slave-man is better than a free polytheist, even though he may look pleasant to you. They invite ‘you’ to the Fire while Allah invites ‘you’ to Paradise and forgiveness by His grace. He makes His revelations clear to the people so perhaps they will be mindful

²²²They ask you ‘O Prophet’ about menstruation. Say, “Beware of its harm! So keep away, and do not have intercourse with your wives during their monthly cycles until they are purified. When they purify themselves, then you may approach them in the manner specified by Allah. Surely Allah loves those who always turn to Him in repentance and those who purify themselves.”

²²³Your wives are like farmland for you, so approach them ‘consensually’ as you please. And send forth something good for yourselves. Be mindful of Allah, and know that you will meet Him. And give good news to the believers

²²⁴Do not use Allah's Name in your oaths as an excuse for not doing good, not guarding against evil, or not making peace between people. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²²⁵Allah will not hold you accountable for unintentional oaths, but for what you intended in your hearts. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Forbearing

²²⁶Those who swear not to have intercourse with their wives must wait for four months. If they change their mind, then Allah is certainly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²²⁷But if they settle on divorce, then Allah is indeed All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²²⁸Divorced women must wait three monthly cycles 'before they can re-marry'. It is not lawful for them to conceal what Allah has created in their wombs, if they 'truly' believe in Allah and the Last Day. And their husbands reserve the right to take them back within that period if they desire reconciliation. Women have rights similar to those of men equitably, although men have a degree 'of responsibility' above them. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

²²⁹Divorce may be retracted twice, then the husband must retain 'his wife' with honour or separate 'from her' with grace. It is not lawful for husbands to take back anything of the

dowry given to their wives, unless the couple fears not being able to keep within the limits of Allah. So if you fear they will not be able to keep within the limits of Allah, there is no blame if the wife compensates the husband to obtain divorce. These are the limits set by Allah, so do not transgress them. And whoever transgresses the limits of Allah, they are the 'true' wrongdoers

²³⁰ So if a husband divorces his wife 'three times', then it is not lawful for him to remarry her until after she has married another man and then is divorced. Then it is permissible for them to reunite, as long as they feel they are able to maintain the limits of Allah. These are the limits set by Allah, which He makes clear for people of knowledge

²³¹ When you divorce women and they have 'almost' reached the end of their waiting period, either retain them honourably or let them go honourably. But do not retain them 'only' to harm them 'or' to take advantage 'of them'. Whoever does that surely wrongs his own soul. Do not take Allah's revelations lightly. Remember Allah's favours upon you as well as the Book and wisdom He has sent down for your guidance. Be mindful of Allah, and know that Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

232 When you have divorced women and they have reached the end of their waiting period, do not prevent them from re-marrying their ex-husbands if they come to an honourable agreement. This is enjoined on whoever has faith in Allah and the Last Day. This is purer and more dignifying for you. Allah knows and you do not know

233 ‘Divorced’ mothers will breastfeed their offspring for two whole years, for those who wish to complete the nursing ‘of their child’. The child’s father will provide reasonable maintenance and clothing for the mother ‘during that period’. No one will be charged with more than they can bear. No mother or father should be made to suffer for their child. The ‘father’s’ heirs are under the same obligation. But if both sides decide—after mutual consultation and consent—to wean a child, then there is no blame on them. If you decide to have your children nursed by a wet-nurse, it is permissible as long as you pay fairly. Be mindful of Allah, and know that Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

234 As for those of you who die and leave widows behind, let them observe a waiting period of four months and ten days. When they have reached the end of this period, then you are

not accountable for what they decide for themselves in a reasonable manner. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

²³⁵There is no blame on you for subtly showing interest in ‘divorced or widowed’ women or for hiding ‘the intention’ in your hearts. Allah knows that you are considering them ‘for marriage’. But do not make a secret commitment with them—you can only show interest in them appropriately. Do not commit to the bond of marriage until the waiting period expires. Know that Allah is aware of what is in your hearts, so beware of Him. And know that Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Forbearing

²³⁶There is no blame if you divorce women before the marriage is consummated or the dowry is settled. But give them a ‘suitable’ compensation—the rich according to his means and the poor according to his. A reasonable compensation is an obligation on the good-doers

²³⁷And if you divorce them before consummating the marriage but after deciding on a dowry, pay half of the dowry, unless the wife graciously waives it or the husband graciously pays in full. Graciousness is closer to righteousness. And do not forget kindness among yourselves. Surely Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

238 Observe the 'five obligatory' prayers—especially the middle prayer—and stand in true devotion to Allah

239 If you are in danger, pray on foot or while riding. But when you are safe, 'take time to' remember Allah for teaching you what you did not know

240 Those of you who die leaving widows should bequeath for them a year's maintenance without forcing them out. But if they choose to leave, you are not accountable for what they reasonably decide for themselves. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

241 Reasonable provisions must be made for divorced women—a duty on those mindful 'of Allah'

242 This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you, so perhaps you will understand

243 Have you 'O Prophet' not seen those who fled their homes in the thousands for fear of death? Allah said to them, "Die!" then He gave them life. Surely Allah is ever Bountiful to humanity, but most people are ungrateful

244 Fight in the cause of Allah, and know that Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²⁴⁵Who will lend to Allah a good loan which Allah will multiply many times over? It is Allah 'alone' who decreases and increases 'wealth'. And to Him you will 'all' be returned

²⁴⁶Have you not seen those chiefs of the Children of Israel after Moses? They said to one of their prophets, "Appoint for us a king, 'and' we will fight in the cause of Allah." He said, "Are you not going to cower if ordered to fight?" They replied, "How could we refuse to fight in the cause of Allah, while we were driven out of our homes and 'separated from' our children?" But when they were ordered to fight, they fled, except for a few of them. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of the wrongdoers

²⁴⁷Their prophet told them, "Allah has appointed Saul to be your king." They protested, "How can he be our king when some of us are more deserving of kingship than he, and he has not been blessed with vast riches?" He replied, "Allah has chosen him over you and blessed him with knowledge and stature. Allah grants kingship to whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing."

²⁴⁸Their prophet further told them, "The sign of Saul's kingship is that the Ark will come to you—containing reassurance from your Lord and relics of the family of Moses and the fam-

ily of Aaron, which will be carried by the angels. Surely in this is a sign for you, if you 'truly' believe."

249 When Saul marched forth with his army, he cautioned: "Allah will test you with a river. So whoever drinks 'his fill' from it is not with me, and whoever does not taste it—except a sip from the hollow of his hands—is definitely with me." They all drank 'their fill' except for a few! When he and the 'remaining' faithful with him crossed the river, they said, "Now we are no match for Goliath and his warriors." But those 'believers' who were certain they would meet Allah reasoned, "How many times has a small force vanquished a mighty army by the Will of Allah! And Allah is 'always' with the steadfast."

250 When they advanced to face Goliath and his warriors, they prayed, "Our Lord! Shower us with perseverance, make our steps firm, and give us victory over the disbelieving people."

251 So they defeated them by Allah's Will, and David killed Goliath. And Allah blessed David with kingship and wisdom and taught him what He willed. Had Allah not repelled a group of people by 'the might of' another, corruption would have dominated the earth, but Allah is Gracious to all

²⁵²These are Allah's revelations which We recite to you 'O Prophet' in truth. And you are truly one of the messengers

²⁵³We have chosen some of those messengers above others. Allah spoke directly to some, and raised some high in rank. To Jesus, son of Mary, We gave clear proofs and supported him with the holy spirit. If Allah had willed, succeeding generations would not have fought 'among themselves' after receiving the clear proofs. But they differed—some believed while others disbelieved. Yet if Allah had willed, they would not have fought one another. But Allah does what He wills

²⁵⁴O believers! Donate from what We have provided for you before the arrival of a Day when there will be no bargaining, friendship, or intercession. Those who disbelieve are 'truly' the wrongdoers

²⁵⁵Allah! There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him, the Ever-Living, All-Sustaining. Neither drowsiness nor sleep overtakes Him. To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Who could possibly intercede with Him without His permission? He 'fully' knows what is ahead of them and what is behind them, but no one can grasp any of His knowledge—except what He wills 'to reveal'. His Seat encompasses the heavens and the earth, and the preser-

vation of both does not tire Him. For He is the Most High, the Greatest

²⁵⁶Let there be no compulsion in religion, for the truth stands out clearly from falsehood. So whoever renounces false gods and believes in Allah has certainly grasped the firmest, un-failing hand-hold. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²⁵⁷Allah is the Guardian of the believers—He brings them out of darkness and into light. As for the disbelievers, their guardians are false gods who lead them out of light and into darkness. It is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

²⁵⁸Are you 'O Prophet' not aware of the one who argued with Abraham about his Lord because Allah had granted him kingship? 'Remember' when Abraham said, "My Lord is the One Who has power to give life and cause death." He argued, "I too have the power to give life and cause death." Abraham challenged 'him', "Allah causes the sun to rise from the east. So make it rise from the west." And so the disbeliever was dumbstruck. And Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

²⁵⁹Or 'are you not aware of' the one who passed by a city which was in ruins. He wondered, "How could Allah bring

this back to life after its destruction?” So Allah caused him to die for a hundred years then brought him back to life. Allah asked, “How long have you remained ‘in this state’?” He replied, “Perhaps a day or part of a day.” Allah said, “No! You have remained here for a hundred years! Just look at your food and drink—they have not spoiled. ‘But now’ look at ‘the remains of’ your donkey! And ‘so’ We have made you into a sign for humanity. And look at the bones ‘of the donkey’, how We bring them together then clothe them with flesh!” When this was made clear to him, he declared, “‘Now’ I know that Allah is Most Capable of everything.”

²⁶⁰ And ‘remember’ when Abraham said, “My Lord! Show me how you give life to the dead.” Allah responded, “Do you not believe?” Abraham replied, “Yes I do, but just so my heart can be reassured.” Allah said, “Then bring four birds, train them to come to you, ‘then cut them into pieces,’ and scatter them on different hilltops. Then call them back, they will fly to you in haste. And ‘so you will’ know that Allah is Almighty, All-Wise.”

²⁶¹ The example of those who spend their wealth in the cause of Allah is that of a grain that sprouts into seven ears, each bearing one hundred grains. And Allah multiplies ‘the re-

ward even more' to whoever He wills. For Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing

²⁶²Those who spend their wealth in the cause of Allah and do not follow their charity with reminders of their generosity or hurtful words—they will get their reward from their Lord, and there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

²⁶³Kind words and forgiveness are better than charity followed by injury. And Allah is Self-Sufficient, Most Forbearing

²⁶⁴O believers! Do not waste your charity with reminders 'of your generosity' or hurtful words, like those who donate their wealth just to show off and do not believe in Allah or the Last Day. Their example is that of a hard barren rock covered with a thin layer of soil hit by a strong rain—leaving it just a bare stone. Such people are unable to preserve the reward of their charity. Allah does not guide 'such' disbelieving people

²⁶⁵And the example of those who donate their wealth, seeking Allah's pleasure and believing the reward is certain, is that of a garden on a fertile hill: when heavy rain falls, it yields up twice its normal produce. If no heavy rain falls, a drizzle is sufficient. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

²⁶⁶Would any of you wish to have a garden with palm trees, grapevines, and all kinds of fruits with rivers flowing under-

neath and as they grow very old with dependent children, a fiery whirlwind hits the garden, burning it all up? This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you, so perhaps you will reflect

²⁶⁷O believers! Donate from the best of what you have earned and of what We have produced for you from the earth. Do not pick out worthless things for donation, which you yourselves would only accept with closed eyes. And know that Allah is Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

²⁶⁸The Devil threatens you with 'the prospect of' poverty and bids you to the shameful deed 'of stinginess', while Allah promises you forgiveness and 'great' bounties from Him. And Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing

²⁶⁹Allah grants wisdom to whoever He wills. And whoever is granted wisdom is certainly blessed with a great privilege. But none will be mindful 'of this' except people of reason

²⁷⁰Whatever charities you give or vows you make are surely known to Allah. And the wrongdoers will have no helpers

²⁷¹To give charity publicly is good, but to give to the poor privately is better for you, and will absolve you of your sins. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

²⁷²You are not responsible for people's guidance 'O Prophet'—it is Allah Who guides whoever He wills. Whatever you 'believers' spend in charity, it is for your own good—as long as you do so seeking the pleasure of Allah. Whatever you donate will be paid back to you in full, and you will not be wronged

²⁷³'Charity is' for the needy who are too engaged in the cause of Allah to move about in the land 'for work'. Those unfamiliar with their situation will think they are not in need 'of charity' because they do not beg. You can recognize them by their appearance. They do not beg people persistently. Whatever you give in charity is certainly well known to Allah

²⁷⁴Those who spend their wealth in charity day and night, secretly and openly—their reward is with their Lord, and there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

²⁷⁵Those who consume interest will stand 'on Judgment Day' like those driven to madness by Satan's touch. That is because they say, "Trade is no different than interest." But Allah has permitted trading and forbidden interest. Whoever refrains—after having received warning from their Lord—may keep their previous gains, and their case is left to Allah.

As for those who persist, it is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

²⁷⁶Allah has made interest fruitless and charity fruitful. And Allah does not like any ungrateful evildoer

²⁷⁷Indeed, those who believe, do good, establish prayer, and pay alms-tax will receive their reward from their Lord, and there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

²⁷⁸O believers! Fear Allah, and give up outstanding interest if you are 'true' believers

²⁷⁹If you do not, then beware of a war with Allah and His Messenger! But if you repent, you may retain your principal—neither inflicting nor suffering harm

²⁸⁰If it is difficult for someone to repay a debt, postpone it until a time of ease. And if you waive it as an act of charity, it will be better for you, if only you knew

²⁸¹Be mindful of the Day when you will 'all' be returned to Allah, then every soul will be paid in full for what it has done, and none will be wronged

²⁸²O believers! When you contract a loan for a fixed period of time, commit it to writing. Let the scribe maintain justice between the parties. The scribe should not refuse to write as Al-

lah has taught them to write. They will write what the debtor dictates, bearing Allah in mind and not defrauding the debt. If the debtor is incompetent, weak, or unable to dictate, let their guardian dictate for them with justice. Call upon two of your men to witness. If two men cannot be found, then one man and two women of your choice will witness—so if one of the women forgets the other may remind her. The witnesses must not refuse when they are summoned. You must not be against writing ‘contracts’ for a fixed period—whether the sum is small or great. This is more just ‘for you’ in the sight of Allah, and more convenient to establish evidence and remove doubts. However, if you conduct an immediate transaction among yourselves, then there is no need for you to record it, but call upon witnesses when a deal is finalized. Let no harm come to the scribe or witnesses. If you do, then you have gravely exceeded ‘your limits’. Be mindful of Allah, for Allah ‘is the One Who’ teaches you. And Allah has ‘perfect’ knowledge of all things

²⁸³ If you are on a journey and a scribe cannot be found, then a security can be taken. If you trust one another, then ‘there is no need for a security, but’ the debtor should honour this trust ‘by repaying the debt’—and let them fear Allah, their

Lord. And do not conceal the testimony, for whoever conceals it, their hearts are indeed sinful. And Allah 'fully' knows what you do

²⁸⁴To Allah 'alone' belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Whether you reveal what is in your hearts or conceal it, Allah will call you to account for it. He forgives whoever He wills, and punishes whoever He wills. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

²⁸⁵The Messenger 'firmly' believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, and so do the believers. They 'all' believe in Allah, His angels, His Books, and His messengers. 'They proclaim,' "We make no distinction between any of His messengers." And they say, "We hear and obey. 'We seek' Your forgiveness, our Lord! And to You 'alone' is the final return."

²⁸⁶Allah does not require of any soul more than what it can afford. All good will be for its own benefit, and all evil will be to its own loss. 'The believers pray,' "Our Lord! Do not punish us if we forget or make a mistake. Our Lord! Do not place a burden on us like the one you placed on those before us. Our Lord! Do not burden us with what we cannot bear. Par-

don us, forgive us, and have mercy on us. You are our 'only' Guardian. So grant us victory over the disbelieving people.”

Āl-‘Imrān

The Family of Imrān • 200 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²Allah! There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—the Ever-Living, All-Sustaining

³He has revealed to you ‘O Prophet’ the Book in truth, confirming what came before it, as He revealed the Torah and the Gospel

⁴previously, as a guide for people, and ‘also’ revealed the Standard ‘to distinguish between right and wrong’. Surely those who reject Allah’s revelations will suffer a severe torment. For Allah is Almighty, capable of punishment

⁵Surely nothing on earth or in the heavens is hidden from Allah

⁶He is the One Who shapes you in the wombs of your mothers as He wills. There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—the Almighty, All-Wise

⁷He is the One Who has revealed to you 'O Prophet' the Book, of which some verses are precise—they are the foundation of the Book—while others are elusive. Those with deviant hearts follow the elusive verses seeking 'to spread' doubt through their 'false' interpretations—but none grasps their 'full' meaning except Allah. As for those well-grounded in knowledge, they say, "We believe in this 'Quran'—it is all from our Lord." But none will be mindful 'of this' except people of reason

⁸'They say,' "Our Lord! Do not let our hearts deviate after you have guided us. Grant us Your mercy. You are indeed the Giver 'of all bounties'

⁹Our Lord! You will certainly gather all humanity for the 'promised' Day—about which there is no doubt. Surely Allah does not break His promise."

¹⁰Indeed, neither the wealth nor children of the disbelievers will be of any benefit to them against Allah—and they will be the fuel for the Fire

¹¹Their fate will be like that of the people of Pharaoh and those before them—they all rejected Our signs, so Allah seized them for their sins. And Allah is severe in punishment

¹²'O Prophet!' Tell the disbelievers, "Soon you will be overpowered and driven to Hell—what an evil place to rest!"

¹³Indeed, there was a sign for you in the two armies that met in battle—one fighting for the cause of Allah and the other in denial. The believers saw their enemy twice their number. But Allah supports with His victory whoever He wills. Surely in this is a lesson for people of insight

¹⁴The enjoyment of ‘worldly’ desires—women, children, treasures of gold and silver, fine horses, cattle, and fertile land—has been made appealing to people. These are the pleasures of this worldly life, but with Allah is the finest destination

¹⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Shall I inform you of what is better than ‘all of’ this? Those mindful ‘of Allah’ will have Gardens with their Lord under which rivers flow, to stay there forever, and pure spouses, along with Allah’s pleasure.” And Allah is All-Seeing of ‘His’ servants

¹⁶who pray, “Our Lord! We have believed, so forgive our sins and protect us from the torment of the Fire.”

¹⁷‘It is they’ who are patient, sincere, obedient, and charitable, and who pray for forgiveness before dawn

¹⁸Allah ‘Himself’ is a Witness that there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—and so are the angels and people of knowledge. He is the Maintainer of justice. There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—the Almighty, All-Wise

¹⁹Certainly, Allah's only Way is Islam. Those who were given the Scripture did not dispute 'among themselves' out of mutual envy until knowledge came to them. Whoever denies Allah's signs, then surely Allah is swift in reckoning

²⁰So if they argue with you 'O Prophet', say, "I have submitted myself to Allah, and so have my followers." And ask those who were given the Scripture and the illiterate 'people', "Have you submitted yourselves 'to Allah'?" If they submit, they will be 'rightly' guided. But if they turn away, then your duty is only to deliver 'the message'. And Allah is All-Seeing of 'His' servants

²¹Indeed, those who deny Allah's signs, kill the prophets unjustly, and kill people who stand up for justice—give them good news of a painful punishment

²²They are the ones whose deeds are wasted in this world and the Hereafter. And they will have no helpers

²³Have you not seen those who were given a portion of the Scriptures? Yet when they are invited to the Book of Allah to settle their disputes, some of them turn away heedlessly

²⁴This is because they say, "The Fire will not touch us except for a few days." They have been deceived in their faith by their wishful lying

²⁵But how ‘horrible’ will it be when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt—when every soul will be paid in full for what it has done, and none will be wronged

²⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “O Allah! Lord over all authorities! You give authority to whoever You please and remove it from who You please; You honour whoever You please and disgrace who You please—all good is in Your Hands. Surely You ‘alone’ are Most Capable of everything

²⁷You cause the night to pass into the day and the day into the night. You bring forth the living from the dead and the dead from the living. And You provide for whoever You will without limit.”

²⁸Believers should not take disbelievers as guardians instead of the believers—and whoever does so will have nothing to hope for from Allah—unless it is a precaution against their tyranny. And Allah warns you about Himself. And to Allah is the final return

²⁹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Whether you conceal what is in your hearts or reveal it, it is known to Allah. For He knows whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And Allah is Most Capable of everything.”

30“Watch for” the Day when every soul will be presented with whatever good it has done. And it will wish that its misdeeds were far off. And Allah warns you about Himself. And Allah is Ever Gracious to ‘His’ servants

31Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “If you ‘sincerely’ love Allah, then follow me; Allah will love you and forgive your sins. For Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.”

32Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Obey Allah and His Messenger.” If they still turn away, then truly Allah does not like the disbelievers

33Indeed, Allah chose Adam, Noah, the family of Abraham, and the family of ‘Imrân above all people ‘of their time’

34They are descendants of one another. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

35“Remember” when the wife of ‘Imrân said, “My Lord! I dedicate what is in my womb entirely to Your service, so accept it from me. You ‘alone’ are truly the All-Hearing, All-Knowing.”

36When she delivered, she said, “My Lord! I have given birth to a girl,”—and Allah fully knew what she had delivered—“and the male is not like the female. I have named her Mary, and I seek Your protection for her and her offspring from Satan, the accursed.”

³⁷So her Lord accepted her graciously and blessed her with a pleasant upbringing—entrusting her to the care of Zachariah. Whenever Zachariah visited her in the sanctuary, he found her supplied with provisions. He exclaimed, “O Mary! Where did this come from?” She replied, “It is from Allah. Surely Allah provides for whoever He wills without limit.”

³⁸Then and there Zachariah prayed to his Lord, saying, “My Lord! Grant me—by your grace—righteous offspring. You are certainly the Hearer of ‘all’ prayers.”

³⁹So the angels called out to him while he stood praying in the sanctuary, “Allah gives you good news of ‘the birth of’ John who will confirm the Word of Allah and will be a great leader, chaste, and a prophet among the righteous.”

⁴⁰Zachariah exclaimed, “My Lord! How can I have a son when I am very old and my wife is barren?” He replied, “So will it be. Allah does what He wills.”

⁴¹Zachariah said, “My Lord! Grant me a sign.” He said, “Your sign is that you will not ‘be able to’ speak to people for three days except through gestures. Remember your Lord often and glorify ‘Him’ morning and evening.”

⁴²And ‘remember’ when the angels said, “O Mary! Surely Allah has selected you, purified you, and chosen you over all women of the world

⁴³O Mary! Be devout to your Lord, prostrate yourself ‘in prayer’ and bow along with those who bow down.”

⁴⁴This is news of the unseen that We reveal to you ‘O Prophet’. You were not with them when they cast lots to decide who would be Mary’s guardian, nor were you there when they argued ‘about it’

⁴⁵‘Remember’ when the angels proclaimed, “O Mary! Allah gives you good news of a Word from Him, his name will be the Messiah, Jesus, son of Mary; honoured in this world and the Hereafter, and he will be one of those nearest ‘to Allah’

⁴⁶And he will speak to people in ‘his’ infancy and adulthood and will be one of the righteous.”

⁴⁷Mary wondered, “My Lord! How can I have a child when no man has ever touched me?” An angel replied, “So will it be. Allah creates what He wills. When He decrees a matter, He simply tells it, ‘Be!’ And it is

⁴⁸And Allah will teach him writing and wisdom, the Torah and the Gospel

⁴⁹and ‘make him’ a messenger to the Children of Israel ‘to proclaim,’ ‘I have come to you with a sign from your Lord: I will make for you a bird from clay, breathe into it, and it will become a ‘real’ bird—by Allah’s Will. I will heal the blind and the leper and raise the dead to life—by Allah’s Will. And I will prophesize what you eat and store in your houses. Surely in this is a sign for you if you ‘truly’ believe

⁵⁰And I will confirm the Torah revealed before me and legalize some of what had been forbidden to you. I have come to you with a sign from your Lord, so be mindful of Allah and obey me

⁵¹Surely Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him ‘alone’. This is the Straight Path.”

⁵²When Jesus sensed disbelief from his people, he asked, “Who will stand up with me for Allah?” The disciples replied, “We will stand up for Allah. We believe in Allah, so bear witness that we have submitted.”

⁵³‘They prayed to Allah,’ “Our Lord! We believe in Your revelations and follow the messenger, so count us among those who bear witness.”

⁵⁴And the disbelievers made a plan ‘against Jesus’, but Allah also planned—and Allah is the best of planners

⁵⁵Remember when Allah said, “O Jesus! I will take you and raise you up to Myself. I will deliver you from those who disbelieve, and elevate your followers above the disbelievers until the Day of Judgment. Then to Me you will ‘all’ return, and I will settle all your disputes

⁵⁶As for those who disbelieve, I will subject them to a severe punishment in this life and the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers

⁵⁷And as for those who believe and do good, they will be rewarded in full. And Allah does not like the wrongdoers.”

⁵⁸We recite ‘all’ this to you ‘O Prophet’ as one of the signs and ‘as’ a wise reminder

⁵⁹Indeed, the example of Jesus in the sight of Allah is like that of Adam. He created him from dust, then said to him, “Be!” And he was

⁶⁰This is the truth from your Lord, so do not be one of those who doubt

⁶¹Now, whoever disputes with you ‘O Prophet’ concerning Jesus after full knowledge has come to you, say, “Come! Let us gather our children and your children, our women and

your women, ourselves and yourselves—then let us sincerely invoke Allah’s curse upon the liars.”

⁶²Certainly, this is the true narrative, and there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Allah. And indeed, Allah ‘alone’ is the Almighty, All-Wise

⁶³If they turn away, then surely Allah has ‘perfect’ knowledge of the corruptors

⁶⁴Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “O People of the Book! Let us come to common terms: that we will worship none but Allah, associate none with Him, nor take one another as lords instead of Allah.” But if they turn away, then say, “Bear witness that we have submitted ‘to Allah alone’.”

⁶⁵O People of the Book! Why do you argue about Abraham, while the Torah and the Gospel were not revealed until long after him? Do you not understand

⁶⁶Here you are! You disputed about what you have ‘little’ knowledge of, but why do you now argue about what you have no knowledge of? Allah knows and you do not know

⁶⁷Abraham was neither a Jew nor a Christian; he submitted in all uprightness and was not a polytheist

⁶⁸Indeed, those who have the best claim to Abraham are his followers, this Prophet, and the believers. And Allah is the Guardian of those who believe

⁶⁹Some of the People of the Book wish to mislead you 'believers'. They mislead none but themselves, yet they fail to perceive it

⁷⁰O People of the Book! Why do you reject the signs of Allah while you bear witness 'to their truth'

⁷¹O People of the Book! Why do you mix the truth with falsehood and hide the truth knowingly

⁷²A group among the People of the Book said 'to one another', "Believe in what has been revealed to the believers in the morning and reject it in the evening, so they may abandon their faith

⁷³And only believe those who follow your religion." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Surely, 'the only' true guidance is Allah's guidance." They also said,' "Do not believe that someone will receive 'revealed' knowledge similar to yours or argue against you before your Lord." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Indeed, all bounty is in the Hands of Allah—He grants it to whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing."

⁷⁴He chooses whoever He wills to receive His mercy. And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

⁷⁵There are some among the People of the Book who, if entrusted with a stack of gold, will readily return it. Yet there are others who, if entrusted with a single coin, will not repay it unless you constantly demand it. This is because they say, “We are not accountable for ‘exploiting’ the Gentiles.” And ‘so’ they attribute lies to Allah knowingly

⁷⁶Absolutely! Those who honour their trusts and shun evil—surely Allah loves those who are mindful ‘of Him’

⁷⁷Indeed, those who trade Allah’s covenant and their oaths for a fleeting gain will have no share in the Hereafter. Allah will neither speak to them, nor look at them, nor purify them on the Day of Judgment. And they will suffer a painful punishment

⁷⁸There are some among them who distort the Book with their tongues to make you think this ‘distortion’ is from the Book—but it is not what the Book says. They say, “It is from Allah”—but it is not from Allah. And ‘so’ they attribute lies to Allah knowingly

⁷⁹It is not appropriate for someone who Allah has blessed with the Scripture, wisdom, and prophethood to say to peo-

ple, “Worship me instead of Allah.” Rather, he would say, “Be devoted to the worship of your Lord ‘alone’”—in accordance with what these prophets read in the Scripture and what they taught

⁸⁰And he would never ask you to take angels and prophets as lords. Would he ask you to disbelieve after you have submitted

⁸¹‘Remember’ when Allah made a covenant with the prophets, ‘saying,’ “Now that I have given you the Book and wisdom, if there comes to you a messenger confirming what you have, you must believe in him and support him.” He added, “Do you affirm this covenant and accept this commitment?” They said, “Yes, we do.” Allah said, “Then bear witness, and I too am a Witness.”

⁸²Whoever turns back after this, they will be the rebellious

⁸³Do they desire a way other than Allah’s—knowing that all those in the heavens and the earth submit to His Will, willingly or unwillingly, and to Him they will ‘all’ be returned

⁸⁴Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “We believe in Allah and what has been revealed to us and what was revealed to Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, and his descendants; and what was given to Moses, Jesus, and other prophets from their Lord—we make

no distinction between any of them, and to Him we ‘fully’ submit.”

⁸⁵Whoever seeks a way other than Islam, it will never be accepted from them, and in the Hereafter they will be among the losers

⁸⁶How will Allah guide a people who chose to disbelieve after they had believed, acknowledged the Messenger to be true, and received clear proofs? For Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

⁸⁷Their reward is that they will be condemned by Allah, the angels, and all of humanity

⁸⁸They will be in Hell forever. Their punishment will not be lightened, nor will they be delayed ‘from it’

⁸⁹As for those who repent afterwards and mend their ways, then surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁹⁰Indeed, those who disbelieve after having believed then increase in disbelief, their repentance will never be accepted. It is they who are astray

⁹¹Indeed, if each of those who disbelieve then die as disbelievers were to offer a ransom of enough gold to fill the whole

world, it would never be accepted from them. It is they who will suffer a painful punishment, and they will have no helpers

⁹²You will never achieve righteousness until you donate some of what you cherish. And whatever you give is certainly well known to Allah

⁹³All food was lawful for the children of Israel, except what Israel made unlawful for himself before the Torah was revealed. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Bring the Torah and read it, if your claims are true."

⁹⁴Then whoever still fabricates lies about Allah, they will be the 'true' wrongdoers

⁹⁵Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah has declared the truth. So follow the Way of Abraham, the upright—who was not a polytheist."

⁹⁶Surely the first House 'of worship' established for humanity is the one at Bakkah—a blessed sanctuary and a guide for 'all' people

⁹⁷In it are clear signs and the standing-place of Abraham. Whoever enters it should be safe. Pilgrimage to this House is an obligation by Allah upon whoever is able among the people. And whoever disbelieves, then surely Allah is not in need of 'any of His' creation

⁹⁸Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “O People of the Book! Why do you deny the revelations of Allah, when Allah is a Witness to what you do?”

⁹⁹Say, “O People of the Book! Why do you turn the believers away from the Way of Allah—striving to make it ‘appear’ crooked, while you are witnesses ‘to its truth’? And Allah is never unaware of what you do.”

¹⁰⁰O believers! If you were to yield to a group of those who were given the Scripture, they would turn you back from belief to disbelief

¹⁰¹How can you disbelieve when Allah’s revelations are recited to you and His Messenger is in your midst? Whoever holds firmly to Allah is surely guided to the Straight Path

¹⁰²O believers! Be mindful of Allah in the way He deserves, and do not die except in ‘a state of full’ submission ‘to Him’

¹⁰³And hold firmly to the rope of Allah and do not be divided. Remember Allah’s favour upon you when you were enemies, then He united your hearts, so you—by His grace—became brothers. And you were at the brink of a fiery pit and He saved you from it. This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you, so that you may be ‘rightly’ guided

104 Let there be a group among you who call ‘others’ to goodness, encourage what is good, and forbid what is evil—it is they who will be successful

105 And do not be like those who split ‘into sects’ and differed after clear proofs had come to them. It is they who will suffer a tremendous punishment

106 On that Day some faces will be bright while others gloomy. To the gloomy-faced it will be said, “Did you disbelieve after having believed? So taste the punishment for your disbelief.”

107 As for the bright-faced, they will be in Allah’s mercy, where they will remain forever

108 These are Allah’s revelations We recite to you ‘O Prophet’ in truth. And Allah desires no injustice to ‘His’ creation

109 To Allah ‘alone’ belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And to Allah ‘all’ matters will be returned ‘for judgment’

110 You are the best community ever raised for humanity—you encourage good, forbid evil, and believe in Allah. Had the People of the Book believed, it would have been better for them. Some of them are faithful, but most are rebellious

111 They can never inflict harm on you, except a little annoyance. But if they meet you in battle, they will flee and they will have no helpers

112 They will be stricken with disgrace wherever they go, unless they are protected by a covenant with Allah or a treaty with the people. They have invited the displeasure of Allah and have been branded with misery for rejecting Allah's revelations and murdering 'His' prophets unjustly. This is 'a fair reward' for their disobedience and violations

113 Yet they are not all alike: there are some among the People of the Book who are upright, who recite Allah's revelations throughout the night, prostrating 'in prayer'

114 They believe in Allah and the Last Day, encourage good and forbid evil, and race with one another in doing good. They are 'truly' among the righteous

115 They will never be denied the reward for any good they have done. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of those mindful 'of Him'

116 Indeed, neither the wealth nor children of the disbelievers will be of any benefit to them against Allah. It is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

117 The good they do in this worldly life is like the harvest of an evil people struck by a bitter wind, destroying it 'completely'. Allah never wronged them, but they wronged themselves

118 O believers! Do not associate closely with others who would not miss a chance to harm you. Their only desire is to see you suffer. Their prejudice has become evident from what they say—and what their hearts hide is far worse. We have made Our revelations clear to you, if only you understood

119 Here you are! You love them but they do not love you, and you believe in all Scriptures. When they meet you they say, "We believe." But when alone, they bite their fingertips in rage. Say, 'O Prophet,' "May you' die of your rage!" Surely Allah knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

120 When you 'believers' are touched with good, they grieve; but when you are afflicted with evil, they rejoice. 'Yet,' if you are patient and mindful 'of Allah', their schemes will not harm you in the least. Surely Allah is Fully Aware of what they do

121 Remember, O Prophet,' when you left your home in the early morning to position the believers in the battlefield. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

¹²²Remember when two groups among you 'believers' were about to cower, then Allah reassured them. So in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹²³Indeed, Allah made you victorious at Badr when you were 'vastly' outnumbered. So be mindful of Allah, perhaps you will be grateful

¹²⁴Remember, O Prophet, when you said to the believers, "Is it not enough that your Lord will send down a reinforcement of three thousand angels for your aid?"

¹²⁵Most certainly, if you 'believers' are firm and mindful 'of Allah' and the enemy launches a sudden attack on you, Allah will reinforce you with five thousand angels designated 'for battle'

¹²⁶Allah ordained this 'reinforcement' only as good news for you and reassurance for your hearts. And victory comes only from Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise—

¹²⁷to destroy a group of the disbelievers and humble the rest, causing them to withdraw in disappointment

¹²⁸You 'O Prophet' have no say in the matter. It is up to Allah to turn to them in mercy or punish them, for indeed they are wrongdoers

129 To Allah 'alone' belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. He forgives whoever He wills, and punishes whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

130 O believers! Do not consume interest, multiplying it many times over. And be mindful of Allah, so you may prosper

131 Guard yourselves against the Fire prepared for the disbelievers

132 Obey Allah and the Messenger, so you may be shown mercy

133 And hasten towards forgiveness from your Lord and a Paradise as vast as the heavens and the earth, prepared for those mindful 'of Allah'

134 'They are' those who donate in prosperity and adversity, control their anger, and pardon others. And Allah loves the good-doers

135 'They are' those who, upon committing an evil deed or wronging themselves, remember Allah and seek forgiveness and do not knowingly persist in sin—and who forgives sins except Allah

¹³⁶Their reward is forgiveness from their Lord and Gardens under which rivers flow, staying there forever. How excellent is the reward for those who work ‘righteousness’

¹³⁷Similar situations came to pass before you, so travel throughout the land and see the fate of the deniers

¹³⁸This is an insight to humanity—a guide and a lesson to the God-fearing

¹³⁹Do not falter or grieve, for you will have the upper hand, if you are ‘true’ believers

¹⁴⁰If you have suffered injuries ‘at Uḥud’, they suffered similarly ‘at Badr’. We alternate these days ‘of victory and defeat’ among people so that Allah may reveal the ‘true’ believers, choose martyrs from among you—and Allah does not like the wrongdoers—

¹⁴¹and distinguish the ‘true’ believers and destroy the disbelievers

¹⁴²Do you think you will enter Paradise without Allah proving which of you ‘truly’ struggled ‘for His cause’ and patiently endured

¹⁴³You certainly wished 'for the opportunity' for martyrdom before encountering it, now you have seen it with your own eyes

¹⁴⁴Muḥammad is no more than a messenger; other messengers have gone before him. If he were to die or to be killed, would you regress into disbelief? Those who do so will not harm Allah whatsoever. And Allah will reward those who are grateful

¹⁴⁵No soul can ever die without Allah's Will at the destined time. Those who desire worldly gain, We will let them have it, and those who desire heavenly reward, We will grant it to them. And We will reward those who are grateful

¹⁴⁶'Imagine' how many devotees fought along with their prophets and never faltered despite whatever 'losses' they suffered in the cause of Allah, nor did they weaken or give in! Allah loves those who persevere

¹⁴⁷And all they said was, "Our Lord! Forgive our sins and excesses, make our steps firm, and grant us victory over the disbelieving people."

¹⁴⁸So Allah gave them the reward of this world and the excellent reward of the Hereafter. For Allah loves the good-doers

¹⁴⁹O believers! If you yield to the disbelievers, they will drag you back to disbelief—and you will become losers

¹⁵⁰But no! Allah is your Guardian, and He is the best Helper

¹⁵¹We will cast horror into the hearts of the disbelievers for associating ‘false gods’ with Allah—a practice He has never authorized. The Fire will be their home—what an evil place for the wrongdoers to stay

¹⁵²Indeed, Allah fulfilled His promise to you when you ‘initially’ swept them away by His Will, then your courage weakened and you disputed about the command and disobeyed, after Allah had brought victory within your reach. Some of you were after worldly gain while others desired a heavenly reward. He denied you victory over them as a test, yet He has pardoned you. And Allah is Gracious to the believers

¹⁵³‘Remember’ when you were running far away ‘in panic’—not looking at anyone—while the Messenger was calling to you from behind! So Allah rewarded your disobedience with distress upon distress. Now, do not grieve over the victory you were denied or the injury you suffered. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹⁵⁴Then after distress, He sent down serenity in the form of drowsiness overcoming some of you, while others were dis-

turbed by evil thoughts about Allah—the thoughts of ‘pre-Islamic’ ignorance. They ask, “Do we have a say in the matter?” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “All matters are destined by Allah.” They conceal in their hearts what they do not reveal to you. They say ‘to themselves’, “If we had any say in the matter, none of us would have come to die here.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Even if you were to remain in your homes, those among you who were destined to be killed would have met the same fate.” Through this, Allah tests what is within you and purifies what is in your hearts. And Allah knows best what is ‘hidden’ in the heart

¹⁵⁵Indeed, those ‘believers’ who fled on the day when the two armies met were made to slip by Satan because of their misdeeds. But Allah has pardoned them. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Forbearing

¹⁵⁶O believers! Do not be like the unfaithful who say about their brothers who travel throughout the land or engage in battle, “If they had stayed with us, they would not have died or been killed.” Allah makes such thinking a cause of agony in their hearts. It is Allah who gives life and causes death. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

¹⁵⁷Should you be martyred or die in the cause of Allah, then His forgiveness and mercy are far better than whatever 'wealth' those 'who stay behind' accumulate

¹⁵⁸Whether you die or are martyred—all of you will be gathered before Allah

¹⁵⁹It is out of Allah's mercy that you 'O Prophet' have been lenient with them. Had you been cruel or hard-hearted, they would have certainly abandoned you. So pardon them, ask Allah's forgiveness for them, and consult with them in 'conducting' matters. Once you make a decision, put your trust in Allah. Surely Allah loves those who trust in Him

¹⁶⁰If Allah helps you, none can defeat you. But if He denies you help, then who else can help you? So in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹⁶¹It is not appropriate for a prophet to illegally withhold spoils of war. And whoever does so, it will be held against them on the Day of Judgment. Then every soul will be paid in full for what it has done, and none will be wronged

¹⁶²Are those who seek Allah's pleasure like those who deserve Allah's wrath? Hell is their home. What an evil destination

¹⁶³They 'each' have varying degrees in the sight of Allah. And Allah is All-Seeing of what they do

¹⁶⁴Indeed, Allah has done the believers a 'great' favour by raising a messenger from among them—reciting to them His revelations, purifying them, and teaching them the Book and wisdom. For indeed they had previously been clearly astray

¹⁶⁵Why is it when you suffered casualties 'at Uḥud'—although you had made your enemy suffer twice as much 'at Badr'—you protested, "How could this be?"? Say, 'O Prophet,' "It is because of your disobedience." Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

¹⁶⁶So what you suffered on the day the two armies met was by Allah's Will, so that He might distinguish the 'true' believers

¹⁶⁷and expose the hypocrites. When it was said to them, "Come fight in the cause of Allah or 'at least' defend yourselves," they replied, "If we had known there was fighting, we would have definitely gone with you." They were closer to disbelief than to belief on that day—for saying with their mouths what was not in their hearts. Allah is All-Knowing of what they hide

¹⁶⁸Those who sat at home, saying about their brothers, “Had they listened to us, they would not have been killed.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Try not to die if what you say is true!”

¹⁶⁹Never think of those martyred in the cause of Allah as dead. In fact, they are alive with their Lord, well provided for—

¹⁷⁰rejoicing in Allah’s bounties and being delighted for those yet to join them. There will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

¹⁷¹They are joyful for receiving Allah’s grace and bounty, and that Allah does not deny the reward of the believers

¹⁷²‘As for’ those who responded to the call of Allah and His Messenger after their injury, those of them who did good and were mindful ‘of Allah’ will have a great reward

¹⁷³Those who were warned, “Your enemies have mobilized their forces against you, so fear them,” the warning only made them grow stronger in faith and they replied, “Allah ‘alone’ is sufficient ‘as an aid’ for us and ‘He’ is the best Protector.”

¹⁷⁴So they returned with Allah’s favours and grace, suffering no harm. For they sought to please Allah. And surely Allah is ‘the’ Lord of infinite bounty

¹⁷⁵That 'warning' was only 'from' Satan, trying to prompt you to fear his followers. So do not fear them; fear Me if you are 'true' believers

¹⁷⁶'O Prophet!' Do not grieve for those who race to disbelieve—surely they will not harm Allah in the least. It is Allah's Will to disallow them a share in the Hereafter, and they will suffer a tremendous punishment

¹⁷⁷Those who trade belief for disbelief will never harm Allah in the least, and they will suffer a painful punishment

¹⁷⁸Those who disbelieve should not think that living longer is good for them. They are only given more time to increase in sin, and they will suffer a humiliating punishment

¹⁷⁹Allah would not leave the believers in the condition you were in, until He distinguished the good from the evil 'among you'. Nor would Allah 'directly' reveal to you the unseen, but He chooses whoever He wills as a messenger. So believe in Allah and His messengers. And if you are faithful and mindful 'of Allah', you will receive a great reward

¹⁸⁰And do not let those who 'greedily' withhold Allah's bounties think it is good for them—in fact, it is bad for them! They will be leashed 'by their necks' on the Day of Judgment with whatever 'wealth' they used to withhold. And Allah is the

‘sole’ inheritor of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹⁸¹Indeed, Allah has heard those ‘among the Jews’ who said, “Allah is poor; we are rich!” We have certainly recorded their slurs and their killing of prophets unjustly. Then We will say, “Taste the torment of burning

¹⁸²This is ‘the reward’ for what your hands have done. And Allah is never unjust to ‘His’ creation.”

¹⁸³Those ‘are the same people’ who say, “Allah has commanded us not to believe in any messenger unless he brings us an offering to be consumed by fire ‘from the sky’.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Other prophets did in fact come to you before me with clear proofs and ‘even’ what you demanded—why then did you kill them, if what you say is true?”

¹⁸⁴If you are rejected by them, so too were messengers before you who came with clear proofs, divine Books, and enlightening Scriptures

¹⁸⁵Every soul will taste death. And you will only receive your full reward on the Day of Judgment. Whoever is spared from the Fire and is admitted into Paradise will ‘indeed’ triumph, whereas the life of this world is no more than the delusion of enjoyment

186 You ‘believers’ will surely be tested in your wealth and yourselves, and you will certainly hear many hurtful words from those who were given the Scripture before you and ‘from’ the polytheists. But if you are patient and mindful ‘of Allah’—surely this is a resolve to aspire to

187 ‘Remember, O Prophet,’ when Allah took the covenant of those who were given the Scripture to make it known to people and not hide it, yet they cast it behind their backs and traded it for a fleeting gain. What a miserable profit

188 Do not let those who rejoice in their misdeeds and love to take credit for what they have not done think they will escape torment. They will suffer a painful punishment

189 To Allah ‘alone’ belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

190 Indeed, in the creation of the heavens and the earth and the alternation of the day and night there are signs for people of reason

191 ‘They are’ those who remember Allah while standing, sitting, and lying on their sides, and reflect on the creation of the heavens and the earth ‘and pray’, “Our Lord! You have not created ‘all of’ this without purpose. Glory be to You! Protect us from the torment of the Fire

¹⁹²Our Lord! Indeed, those You commit to the Fire will be ‘completely’ disgraced! And the wrongdoers will have no helpers

¹⁹³Our Lord! We have heard the caller to ‘true’ belief, ‘proclaiming,’ ‘Believe in your Lord ‘alone’,’ so we believed. Our Lord! Forgive our sins, absolve us of our misdeeds, and allow us ‘each’ to die as one of the virtuous

¹⁹⁴Our Lord! Grant us what You have promised us through Your messengers and do not put us to shame on Judgment Day—for certainly You never fail in Your promise.”

¹⁹⁵So their Lord responded to them: “I will never deny any of you—male or female—the reward of your deeds. Both are equal in reward. Those who migrated or were expelled from their homes, and were persecuted for My sake and fought and ‘some’ were martyred—I will certainly forgive their sins and admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow, as a reward from Allah. And with Allah is the finest reward!”

¹⁹⁶Do not be deceived by the prosperity of the disbelievers throughout the land

¹⁹⁷It is only a brief enjoyment. Then Hell will be their home—what an evil place to rest

198 But those who are mindful of their Lord will be in Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever—as an accommodation from Allah. And what is with Allah is best for the virtuous

199 Indeed, there are some among the People of the Book who truly believe in Allah and what has been revealed to you ‘believers’ and what was revealed to them. They humble themselves before Allah—never trading Allah’s revelations for a fleeting gain. Their reward is with their Lord. Surely Allah is swift in reckoning

200 O believers! Patiently endure, persevere, stand on guard, and be mindful of Allah, so you may be successful

An-Nisā'

The Women • 176 verses

¹O humanity! Be mindful of your Lord Who created you from a single soul, and from it He created its mate, and through both He spread countless men and women. And be mindful of Allah—in Whose Name you appeal to one another—and 'honour' family ties. Surely Allah is ever Watchful over you

²Give orphans their wealth 'when they reach maturity', and do not exchange your worthless possessions for their valuables, nor cheat them by mixing their wealth with your own. For this would indeed be a great sin

³If you fear you might fail to give orphan women their 'due' rights 'if you were to marry them', then marry other women of your choice—two, three, or four. But if you are afraid you will fail to maintain justice, then 'content yourselves with' one or those 'bondwomen' in your possession. This way you are less likely to commit injustice

⁴Give women 'you wed' their due dowries graciously. But if they waive some of it willingly, then you may enjoy it freely with a clear conscience

⁵Do not entrust the incapable 'among your dependants' with your wealth which Allah has made a means of support for you—but feed and clothe them from it, and speak to them kindly

⁶Test 'the competence of' the orphans until they reach a marriageable age. Then if you feel they are capable of sound judgment, return their wealth to them. And do not consume it wastefully and hastily before they grow up 'to demand it'. If the guardian is well-off, they should not take compensation; but if the guardian is poor, let them take a reasonable provision. When you give orphans back their property, call in witnesses. And sufficient is Allah as a 'vigilant' Reckoner

⁷For men there is a share in what their parents and close relatives leave, and for women there is a share in what their parents and close relatives leave—whether it is little or much. 'These are' obligatory shares

⁸If 'non-inheriting' relatives, orphans, or the needy are present at the time of distribution, offer them a 'small' provision from it and speak to them kindly

⁹Let the guardians be as concerned 'for the orphans' as they would if they were to 'die and' leave 'their own' helpless children behind. So let them be mindful of Allah and speak equitably

¹⁰Indeed, those who unjustly consume orphans' wealth 'in fact' consume nothing but fire into their bellies. And they will be burned in a blazing Hell

¹¹Allah commands you regarding your children: the share of the male will be twice that of the female. If you leave only two 'or more' females, their share is two-thirds of the estate. But if there is only one female, her share will be one-half. Each parent is entitled to one-sixth if you leave offspring. But if you are childless and your parents are the only heirs, then your mother will receive one-third. But if you leave siblings, then your mother will receive one-sixth—after the fulfilment of bequests and debts. 'Be fair to' your parents and children, as you do not 'fully' know who is more beneficial to you. 'This is' an obligation from Allah. Surely Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹²You will inherit half of what your wives leave if they are childless. But if they have children, then 'your share is' one-fourth of the estate—after the fulfilment of bequests and debts.

And your wives will inherit one-fourth of what you leave if you are childless. But if you have children, then your wives will receive one-eighth of your estate—after the fulfilment of bequests and debts. And if a man or a woman leaves neither parents nor children but only a brother or a sister ^ᾑfrom their mother’s side^ᾑ, they will each inherit one-sixth, but if they are more than one, they ^ᾑall^ᾑ will share one-third of the estate—after the fulfilment of bequests and debts without harm ^ᾑto the heirs^ᾑ. ^ᾑThis is^ᾑ a commandment from Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, Most Forbearing

¹³These ^ᾑentitlements^ᾑ are the limits set by Allah. Whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger will be admitted into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever. That is the ultimate triumph

¹⁴But whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger and exceeds their limits will be cast into Hell, to stay there forever. And they will suffer a humiliating punishment

¹⁵^ᾑAs for^ᾑ those of your women who commit illegal intercourse—call four witnesses from among yourselves. If they testify, confine the offenders to their homes until they die or Allah ordains a ^ᾑdifferent^ᾑ way for them

¹⁶And the two among you who commit this sin—discipline them. If they repent and mend their ways, relieve them. Surely Allah is ever Accepting of Repentance, Most Merciful

¹⁷Allah only accepts the repentance of those who commit evil ignorantly 'or recklessly' then repent soon after—Allah will pardon them. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹⁸However, repentance is not accepted from those who knowingly persist in sin until they start dying, and then cry, "Now I repent!" nor those who die as disbelievers. For them We have prepared a painful punishment

¹⁹O believers! It is not permissible for you to inherit women against their will or mistreat them to make them return some of the dowry 'as a ransom for divorce'—unless they are found guilty of adultery. Treat them fairly. If you happen to dislike them, you may hate something which Allah turns into a great blessing

²⁰If you desire to replace a wife with another and you have given the former 'even' a stack of gold 'as a dowry', do not take any of it back. Would you 'still' take it unjustly and very sinfully

²¹And how could you take it back after having enjoyed each other intimately and she has taken from you a firm commitment

²²Do not marry former wives of your fathers—except what was done previously. It was indeed a shameful, despicable, and evil practice

²³Also forbidden to you for marriage are your mothers, your daughters, your sisters, your paternal and maternal aunts, your brother's daughters, your sister's daughters, your foster-mothers, your foster-sisters, your mothers-in-law, your step-daughters under your guardianship if you have consummated marriage with their mothers—but if you have not, then you can marry them—nor the wives of your own sons, nor two sisters together at the same time—except what was done previously. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²⁴Also forbidden are married women—except female captives in your possession. This is Allah's commandment to you. Lawful to you are all beyond these—as long as you seek them with your wealth in a legal marriage, not in fornication. Give those you have consummated marriage with their due dowries. It is permissible to be mutually gracious regarding the set dowry. Surely Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

²⁵But if any of you cannot afford to marry a free believing woman, then 'let him marry' a believing bondwoman possessed by one of you. Allah knows best 'the state of' your faith 'and theirs'. You are from one another. So marry them with the permission of their owners, giving them their dowry in fairness, if they are chaste, neither promiscuous nor having secret affairs. If they commit indecency after marriage, they receive half the punishment of free women. This is for those of you who fear falling into sin. But if you are patient, it is better for you. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²⁶It is Allah's Will to make things clear to you, guide you to the 'noble' ways of those before you, and turn to you in mercy. For Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

²⁷And it is Allah's Will to turn to you in grace, but those who follow their desires wish to see you deviate entirely 'from Allah's Way'

²⁸And it is Allah's Will to lighten your burdens, for humankind was created weak

²⁹O believers! Do not devour one another's wealth illegally, but rather trade by mutual consent. And do not kill 'each other or' yourselves. Surely Allah is ever Merciful to you

30 And whoever does this sinfully and unjustly, We will burn them in the Fire. That is easy for Allah

31 If you avoid the major sins forbidden to you, We will absolve you of your 'lesser' misdeeds and admit you into a place of honour

32 And do not crave what Allah has given some of you over others. Men will be rewarded according to their deeds and women 'equally' according to theirs. Rather, ask Allah for His bounties. Surely Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

33 And We have appointed heirs to what has been left by parents and next of kin. As for those you have made a pledge to, give them their share. Surely Allah is a Witness over all things

34 Men are the caretakers of women, as men have been provisioned by Allah over women and tasked with supporting them financially. And righteous women are devoutly obedient and, when alone, protective of what Allah has entrusted them with. And if you sense ill-conduct from your women, advise them 'first', 'if they persist,' do not share their beds, 'but if they still persist,' then discipline them 'gently'. But if they change their ways, do not be unjust to them. Surely Allah is Most High, All-Great

³⁵If you anticipate a split between them, appoint a mediator from his family and another from hers. If they desire reconciliation, Allah will restore harmony between them. Surely Allah is All-Knowing, All-Aware

³⁶Worship Allah 'alone' and associate none with Him. And be kind to parents, relatives, orphans, the poor, near and distant neighbours, close friends, 'needy' travellers, and those 'bondspeople' in your possession. Surely Allah does not like whoever is arrogant, boastful—

³⁷those who are stingy, promote stinginess among people, and withhold Allah's bounties. We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating punishment

³⁸Likewise for those who spend their wealth to show off and do not believe in Allah or the Last Day. And whoever takes Satan as an associate—what an evil associate they have

³⁹What harm could have come to them if they had believed in Allah and the Last Day and donated from what Allah has provided for them? And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of them

⁴⁰Indeed, Allah never wrongs 'anyone'—even by an atom's weight. And if it is a good deed, He will multiply it many times over and will give a great reward out of His grace

⁴¹So how will it be when We bring a witness from every faith-community and bring you 'O Prophet' as a witness against yours

⁴²On that Day, those who denied 'Allah' and disobeyed the Messenger will wish they were reduced to dust. And they will never be able to hide anything from Allah

⁴³O believers! Do not approach prayer while intoxicated until you are aware of what you say, nor in a state of 'full' impurity—unless you merely pass through 'the mosque'—until you have bathed. But if you are ill, on a journey, or have relieved yourselves, or been intimate with your wives and cannot find water, then purify yourselves with clean earth, wiping your faces and hands. And Allah is Ever-Pardoning, All-Forgiving

⁴⁴Have you 'O Prophet' not seen those who were given a portion of the Scriptures yet trade it for misguidance and wish to see you deviate from the 'Right' Path

⁴⁵Allah knows best who your enemies are! And Allah is sufficient as a Guardian, and He is sufficient as a Helper

⁴⁶Some Jews take words out of context and say, "We listen and we disobey," "Hear! May you never hear," and "Râ'ina!" [Herd us!]
—playing with words and discrediting the faith. Had they said 'courteously', "We hear and obey," "Listen to

us,” and “Unẓurna,” [Tend to us!] it would have been better for them and more proper. Allah has condemned them for their disbelief, so they do not believe except for a few

⁴⁷O you who were given the Book! Believe in what We have revealed—confirming your own Scriptures—before We wipe out ‘your’ faces, turning them backwards, or We condemn the defiant as We did to the Sabbath-breakers. And Allah’s command is always executed

⁴⁸Indeed, Allah does not forgive associating others with Him ‘in worship’, but forgives anything else of whoever He wills. And whoever associates others with Allah has indeed committed a grave sin

⁴⁹Have you ‘O Prophet’ not seen those who ‘falsely’ elevate themselves? It is Allah who elevates whoever He wills. And none will be wronged ‘even by the width of’ the thread of a date stone

⁵⁰See how they fabricate lies against Allah—this alone is a blatant sin

⁵¹Have you ‘O Prophet’ not seen those who were given a portion of the Scriptures yet believe in idols and false gods and reassure the disbelievers that they are better guided than the believers

⁵²It is they who have been condemned by Allah. And whoever is condemned by Allah will have no helper

⁵³Do they have control over shares of the kingdom? If so, they would not have given anyone so much as the speck on a date stone

⁵⁴Or do they envy the people for Allah's bounties? Indeed, We have given the descendants of Abraham the Book and wisdom, along with great authority

⁵⁵Yet some believed in him while others turned away from him. Hell is sufficient as a torment

⁵⁶Surely those who reject Our signs, We will cast them into the Fire. Whenever their skin is burnt completely, We will replace it so they will 'constantly' taste the punishment. Indeed, Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁵⁷As for those who believe and do good, We will admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. There they will have pure spouses, and We will place them under a vast shade

⁵⁸Indeed, Allah commands you to return trusts to their rightful owners; and when you judge between people, judge with

fairness. What a noble commandment from Allah to you! Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing

⁵⁹O believers! Obey Allah and obey the Messenger and those in authority among you. Should you disagree on anything, then refer it to Allah and His Messenger, if you 'truly' believe in Allah and the Last Day. This is the best and fairest resolution

⁶⁰Have you 'O Prophet' not seen those who claim they believe in what has been revealed to you and what was revealed before you? They seek the judgment of false judges, which they were commanded to reject. And Satan 'only' desires to lead them farther away

⁶¹When it is said to them, "Come to Allah's revelations and to the Messenger," you see the hypocrites turn away from you stubbornly

⁶²How 'horrible' will it be if a disaster strikes them because of what their hands have done, then they come to you swearing by Allah, "We intended nothing but goodwill and reconciliation."

⁶³'Only' Allah knows what is in their hearts. So turn away from them, caution them, and give them advice that will shake their very souls

⁶⁴We only sent messengers to be obeyed by Allah's Will. If only those 'hypocrites' came to you 'O Prophet'—after wronging themselves—seeking Allah's forgiveness and the Messenger prayed for their forgiveness, they would have certainly found Allah ever Accepting of Repentance, Most Merciful

⁶⁵But no! By your Lord, they will never be 'true' believers until they accept you 'O Prophet' as the judge in their disputes, and find no resistance within themselves against your decision and submit wholeheartedly

⁶⁶If We had commanded them to sacrifice themselves or abandon their homes, none would have obeyed except for a few. Had they done what they were advised to do, it would have certainly been far better for them and more reassuring

⁶⁷and We would have granted them a great reward by Our grace

⁶⁸and guided them to the Straight Path

⁶⁹And whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger will be in the company of those blessed by Allah: the prophets, the people of truth, the martyrs, and the righteous—what honourable company

⁷⁰This is Allah's favour, and Allah fully knows 'who deserves it'

⁷¹O believers! Take your precautions and go forth either in groups or together

⁷²There will be some among you who will lag behind so that if you face a disaster, they will say, "Allah has blessed us for not being there among them."

⁷³But if you return with Allah's bounties, they will say—as if there had been no bond between you—"We wish we had been there with them to share the great gain!"

⁷⁴Let those who would sacrifice this life for the Hereafter fight in the cause of Allah. And whoever fights in Allah's cause—whether they achieve martyrdom or victory—We will honour them with a great reward

⁷⁵And what is it with you? You do not fight in the cause of Allah and for oppressed men, women, and children who cry out, "Our Lord! Deliver us from this land of oppressors! Appoint for us a saviour; appoint for us a helper—all by Your grace."

⁷⁶Believers fight for the cause of Allah, whereas disbelievers fight for the cause of the Devil. So fight against Satan's 'evil' forces. Indeed, Satan's schemes are ever weak

⁷⁷Have you 'O Prophet' not seen those who had been told, "Do not fight! Rather, establish prayer and pay alms-tax."? Then once the order came to fight, a group of them feared those 'hostile' people as Allah should be feared—or even more. They said, "Our Lord! Why have You ordered us to fight? If only You had delayed 'the order for' us for a little while!" Say, 'O Prophet,' "The enjoyment of this world is so little, whereas the Hereafter is far better for those mindful 'of Allah'. And none of you will be wronged 'even by the width of' the thread of a date stone

⁷⁸Wherever you may be, death will overcome you—even if you were in fortified towers." When something good befalls them, they say, "This is from Allah," but when something evil befalls them, they say, "This is from you." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Both have been destined by Allah." So what is the matter with these people? They can hardly comprehend anything

⁷⁹Whatever good befalls you is from Allah and whatever evil befalls you is from yourself. We have sent you 'O Prophet'

as a messenger to 'all' people. And Allah is sufficient as a Witness

⁸⁰Whoever obeys the Messenger has truly obeyed Allah. But whoever turns away, then 'know that' We have not sent you 'O Prophet' as a keeper over them

⁸¹And they say, "We obey," but when they leave you, a group of them would spend the night contradicting what they said. Allah records all their schemes. So turn away from them, and put your trust in Allah. And Allah is sufficient as a Trustee of Affairs

⁸²Do they not then reflect on the Quran? Had it been from anyone other than Allah, they would have certainly found in it many inconsistencies

⁸³And when they hear news of security or fear, they publicize it. Had they referred it to the Messenger or their authorities, those with sound judgment among them would have validated it. Had it not been for Allah's grace and mercy, you would have followed Satan—except for a few

⁸⁴So fight in the cause of Allah 'O Prophet'. You are accountable for none but yourself. And motivate the believers 'to fight', so perhaps Allah will curb the disbelievers' might. And Allah is far superior in might and in punishment

⁸⁵Whoever intercedes for a good cause will have a share in the reward, and whoever intercedes for an evil cause will have a share in the burden. And Allah is Watchful over all things

⁸⁶And when you are greeted, respond with a better greeting or at least similarly. Surely Allah is a 'vigilant' Reckoner of all things

⁸⁷Allah, there is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. He will certainly gather 'all of' you together on the Day of Judgment—about which there is no doubt. And whose word is more truthful than Allah's

⁸⁸Why are you 'believers' divided into two groups regarding the hypocrites while Allah allowed them to regress 'to disbelief' because of their misdeeds? Do you wish to guide those left by Allah to stray? And whoever Allah leaves to stray, you will never find for them a way

⁸⁹They wish you would disbelieve as they have disbelieved, so you may all be alike. So do not take them as allies unless they emigrate in the cause of Allah. But if they turn away, then seize them and kill them wherever you find them, and do not take any of them as allies or helpers

⁹⁰except those who are allies of a people you are bound with in a treaty or those wholeheartedly opposed to fighting either you or their own people. If Allah had willed, He would have empowered them to fight you. So if they refrain from fighting you and offer you peace, then Allah does not permit you to harm them

⁹¹You will find others who wish to be safe from you and their own people. Yet they cannot resist the temptation 'of disbelief or hostility'. If they do not keep away, offer you peace, or refrain from attacking you, then seize them and kill them wherever you find them. We have given you full permission over such people

⁹²It is not lawful for a believer to kill another except by mistake. And whoever kills a believer unintentionally must free a believing slave and pay blood-money to the victim's family—unless they waive it charitably. But if the victim is a believer from a hostile people, then a believing slave must be freed. And if the victim is from a people bound with you in a treaty, then blood-money must be paid to the family along with freeing a believing slave. Those who are unable, let them fast two consecutive months—as a means of repentance to Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁹³And whoever kills a believer intentionally, their reward will be Hell—where they will stay indefinitely. Allah will be displeased with them, condemn them, and will prepare for them a tremendous punishment

⁹⁴O believers! When you struggle in the cause of Allah, be sure of who you fight. And do not say to those who offer you 'greetings of' peace, "You are no believer!"—seeking a fleeting worldly gain. Instead, Allah has infinite bounties 'in store'. You were initially like them then Allah blessed you 'with Islam'. So be sure! Indeed, Allah is All-Aware of what you do

⁹⁵Those who stay at home—except those with valid excuses—are not equal to those who strive in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives. Allah has elevated in rank those who strive with their wealth and their lives above those who stay behind 'with valid excuses'. Allah has promised each a fine reward, but those who strive will receive a far better reward than others—

⁹⁶far superior ranks, forgiveness, and mercy from Him. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁹⁷When the angels seize the souls of those who have wronged themselves—scolding them, "What do you think you were

doing?" they will reply, "We were oppressed in the land." The angels will respond, "Was Allah's earth not spacious enough for you to emigrate?" It is they who will have Hell as their home—what an evil destination

⁹⁸Except helpless men, women, and children who cannot afford a way out—

⁹⁹it is right to hope that Allah will pardon them. For Allah is Ever-Pardoning, All-Forgiving

¹⁰⁰Whoever emigrates in the cause of Allah will find many safe havens and bountiful resources throughout the earth. Those who leave their homes and die while emigrating to Allah and His Messenger—their reward has already been secured with Allah. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁰¹When you travel through the land, it is permissible for you to shorten the prayer—"especially" if you fear an attack by the disbelievers. Indeed, the disbelievers are your sworn enemies

¹⁰²When you 'O Prophet' are 'campaigning' with them and you lead them in prayer, let one group of them pray with you—while armed. When they prostrate themselves, let the other group stand guard behind them. Then the group that has not yet prayed will then join you in prayer—and let them

be vigilant and armed. The disbelievers would wish to see you neglect your weapons and belongings, so they could launch a sweeping assault on you. But there is no blame if you lay aside your weapons when overcome by heavy rain or illness—but take precaution. Indeed, Allah has prepared a humiliating punishment for the disbelievers

103 When the prayers are over, remember Allah—whether you are standing, sitting, or lying down. But when you are secure, establish regular prayers. Indeed, performing prayers is a duty on the believers at the appointed times

104 Do not falter in pursuit of the enemy—if you are suffering, they too are suffering. But you can hope to receive from Allah what they can never hope for. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

105 Indeed, We have sent down the Book to you ‘O Prophet’ in truth to judge between people by means of what Allah has shown you. So do not be an advocate for the deceitful

106 And seek Allah’s forgiveness—indeed, Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

107 Do not advocate for those who wrong themselves. Surely Allah does not like those who are deceitful, sinful

108 They try to hide 'their deception' from people, but they can never hide it from Allah—in Whose presence they plot by night what is displeasing to Him. And Allah is Fully Aware of what they do

109 Here you are! You 'believers' are advocating for them in this life, but who will 'dare to' advocate for them before Allah on the Day of Judgment? Or who will come to their defence

110 Whoever commits evil or wrongs themselves then seeks Allah's forgiveness will certainly find Allah All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

111 And whoever commits a sin—it is only to their own loss. Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

112 And whoever commits an evil or sinful deed then blames it on an innocent person, they will definitely bear the guilt of slander and blatant sin

113 Had it not been for Allah's grace and mercy, a group of them would have sought to deceive you 'O Prophet'. Yet they would deceive none but themselves, nor can they harm you in the least. Allah has revealed to you the Book and wisdom and taught you what you never knew. Great 'indeed' is Allah's favour upon you

114 There is no good in most of their secret talks—except those encouraging charity, kindness, or reconciliation between people. And whoever does this seeking Allah’s pleasure, We will grant them a great reward

115 And whoever defies the Messenger after guidance has become clear to them and follows a path other than that of the believers, We will let them pursue what they have chosen, then burn them in Hell—what an evil end

116 Surely Allah does not forgive associating ‘others’ with Him ‘in worship’, but forgives anything else of whoever He wills. Indeed, whoever associates ‘others’ with Allah has clearly gone far astray

117 Instead of Allah, they only invoke female gods and they ‘actually’ invoke none but a rebellious Satan—

118 cursed by Allah—who said, “I will surely take hold of a certain number of Your servants

119 I will certainly mislead them and delude them with empty hopes. Also, I will order them and they will slit the ears of cattle and alter Allah’s creation.” And whoever takes Satan as a guardian instead of Allah has certainly suffered a tremendous loss

¹²⁰Satan only makes them 'false' promises and deludes them with 'empty' hopes. Truly Satan promises them nothing but delusion

¹²¹It is they who will have Hell as their home, and they will find no escape from it

¹²²And those who believe and do good, We will soon admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. Allah's promise is 'always' true. And whose word is more truthful than Allah's

¹²³'Divine grace is' neither by your wishes nor those of the People of the Book! Whoever commits evil will be rewarded accordingly, and they will find no protector or helper besides Allah

¹²⁴But those who do good—whether male or female—and have faith will enter Paradise and will never be wronged 'even as much as' the speck on a date stone

¹²⁵And who is better in faith than those who 'fully' submit themselves to Allah, do good, and follow the Way of Abraham, the upright? Allah chose Abraham as a close friend

126To Allah 'alone' belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And Allah is Fully Aware of everything

127They ask you 'O Prophet' regarding women. Say, "It is Allah Who instructs you regarding them. Instruction has 'already' been revealed in the Book concerning the orphan women you deprive of their due rights but still wish to marry, also helpless children, as well as standing up for orphans' rights. And whatever good you do is certainly well known to Allah."

128If a woman fears indifference or neglect from her husband, there is no blame on either of them if they seek 'fair' settlement, which is best. Humans are ever inclined to selfishness. But if you are gracious and mindful 'of Allah', surely Allah is All-Aware of what you do

129You will never be able to maintain 'emotional' justice between your wives—no matter how keen you are. So do not totally incline towards one leaving the other in suspense. And if you do what is right and are mindful 'of Allah', surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

130But if they choose to separate, Allah will enrich both of them from His bounties. And Allah is Ever-Bountiful, All-Wise

131To Allah 'alone' belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Indeed, We have commanded those given the Scripture before you, as well as you, to be mindful of Allah. But if you disobey, then 'know that' to Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

132To Allah 'alone' belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And Allah is sufficient as a Trustee of Affairs

133If it is His Will, He can remove you altogether, O humanity, and replace you with others. And Allah is Most Capable to do so

134Whoever desires the reward of this world, then 'let them know that' with Allah are the rewards of this world and the Hereafter. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing

135O believers! Stand firm for justice as witnesses for Allah even if it is against yourselves, your parents, or close relatives. Be they rich or poor, Allah is best to ensure their interests. So do not let your desires cause you to deviate 'from justice'. If you distort the testimony or refuse to give it, then 'know that' Allah is certainly All-Aware of what you do

136O believers! Have faith in Allah, His Messenger, the Book He has revealed to His Messenger, and the Scriptures He revealed before. Indeed, whoever denies Allah, His angels, His Books, His messengers, and the Last Day has clearly gone far astray

137Indeed, those who believed then disbelieved, then believed and again disbelieved—‘only’ increasing in disbelief—Allah will neither forgive them nor guide them to the ‘Right’ Way

138Give good news of a painful punishment to hypocrites

139who choose disbelievers as allies instead of the believers. Do they seek honour and power through that company? Surely all honour and power belongs to Allah

140He has already revealed to you in the Book that when you hear Allah’s revelations being denied or ridiculed, then do not sit in that company unless they engage in a different topic, or else you will be like them. Surely Allah will gather the hypocrites and disbelievers all together in Hell

141‘The hypocrites are’ those who wait to see what happens to you. So if Allah grants you victory, they say ‘to you’, “Were we not on your side?” But if the disbelievers have a share ‘of victory’, they say ‘to them’, “Did we not have the advantage over you, yet we protected you from the believers?” Allah

will judge between 'all of' you on the Day of Judgment. And Allah will never grant the disbelievers a way over the believers

¹⁴²Surely the hypocrites seek to deceive Allah, but He outwits them. When they stand up for prayer, they do it halfheartedly only to be seen by people—hardly remembering Allah at all

¹⁴³Torn between belief and disbelief—belonging neither to these 'believers' nor those 'disbelievers'. And whoever Allah leaves to stray, you will never find for them a way

¹⁴⁴O believers! Do not take disbelievers as allies instead of the believers. Would you like to give Allah solid proof against yourselves

¹⁴⁵Surely the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire—and you will never find for them any helper—

¹⁴⁶except those who repent, mend their ways, hold fast to Allah, and are sincere in their devotion to Allah; they will be with the believers. And Allah will grant the believers a great reward

¹⁴⁷Why should Allah punish you if you are grateful and faithful? Allah is ever Appreciative, All-Knowing

¹⁴⁸Allah does not like negative thoughts to be voiced—except by those who have been wronged. Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

¹⁴⁹Whether you reveal or conceal a good or pardon an evil—surely Allah is Ever-Pardoning, Most Capable

¹⁵⁰Surely those who deny Allah and His messengers and wish to make a distinction between Allah and His messengers, saying, “We believe in some and disbelieve in others,” desiring to forge a compromise

¹⁵¹they are indeed the true disbelievers. And We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating punishment

¹⁵²As for those who believe in Allah and His messengers—accepting all; rejecting none—He will surely give them their rewards. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁵³The People of the Book demand that you ‘O Prophet’ bring down for them a revelation in writing from heaven. They demanded what is even greater than this from Moses, saying, “Make Allah visible to us!” So a thunderbolt struck them for their wrongdoing. Then they took the calf for worship after receiving clear signs. Still We forgave them for that ‘after their repentance’ and gave Moses compelling proof

¹⁵⁴We raised the Mount over them 'as a warning' for 'breaking' their covenant and said, "Enter the gate 'of Jerusalem' with humility." We also warned them, "Do not break the Sabbath," and took from them a firm covenant

¹⁵⁵They were condemned' for breaking their covenant, rejecting Allah's signs, killing the prophets unjustly, and for saying, "Our hearts are unreceptive!"—it is Allah Who has sealed their hearts for their disbelief, so they do not believe except for a few—

¹⁵⁶and for their denial and outrageous accusation against Mary

¹⁵⁷and for boasting, "We killed the Messiah, Jesus, son of Mary, the messenger of Allah." But they neither killed nor crucified him—it was only made to appear so. Even those who argue for this 'crucifixion' are in doubt. They have no knowledge whatsoever—only making assumptions. They certainly did not kill him

¹⁵⁸Rather, Allah raised him up to Himself. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

¹⁵⁹Every one of the People of the Book will definitely believe in him before his death. And on the Day of Judgment Jesus will be a witness against them

160 We forbade the Jews certain foods that had been lawful to them for their wrongdoing, and for hindering many from the Way of Allah

161 taking interest despite its prohibition, and consuming people's wealth unjustly. We have prepared for the disbelievers among them a painful punishment

162 But those of them well-grounded in knowledge, the faithful 'who' believe in what has been revealed to you 'O Prophet' and what was revealed before you—'especially' those who establish prayer—and those who pay alms-tax and believe in Allah and the Last Day, to these 'people' We will grant a great reward

163 Indeed, We have sent revelation to you 'O Prophet' as We sent revelation to Noah and the prophets after him. We also sent revelation to Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, and his descendants, 'as well as' Jesus, Job, Jonah, Aaron, and Solomon. And to David We gave the Psalms

164 There are messengers whose stories We have told you already and others We have not. And to Moses Allah spoke directly

¹⁶⁵‘All were’ messengers delivering good news and warnings so humanity should have no excuse before Allah after ‘the coming of’ the messengers. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

¹⁶⁶Yet ‘if you are denied, O Prophet,’ Allah bears witness to what He has sent down to you—He has sent it with His knowledge. The angels too bear witness. And Allah ‘alone’ is sufficient as a Witness

¹⁶⁷Those who disbelieve and hinder ‘others’ from the Way of Allah have certainly strayed far away

¹⁶⁸Those who disbelieve and wrong themselves—surely Allah will neither forgive them nor guide them to any path

¹⁶⁹except that of Hell, to stay there for ever and ever. And that is easy for Allah

¹⁷⁰O humanity! The Messenger has certainly come to you with the truth from your Lord, so believe for your own good. But if you disbelieve, then ‘know that’ to Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹⁷¹O People of the Book! Do not go to extremes regarding your faith; say nothing about Allah except the truth. The Messiah, Jesus, son of Mary, was no more than a messenger

of Allah and the fulfilment of His Word through Mary and a spirit 'created by a command' from Him. So believe in Allah and His messengers and do not say, "Trinity." Stop!—for your own good. Allah is only One God. Glory be to Him! He is far above having a son! To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And Allah is sufficient as a Trustee of Affairs

¹⁷²The Messiah would never be too proud to be a servant of Allah, nor would the angels nearest to Allah. Those who are too proud and arrogant to worship Him will be brought before Him all together

¹⁷³As for those who believe and do good, He will reward them in full and increase them out of His grace. But those who are too proud and arrogant, He will subject them to a painful punishment. And besides Allah they will find no protector or helper

¹⁷⁴O humanity! There has come to you conclusive evidence from your Lord. And We have sent down to you a brilliant light

¹⁷⁵As for those who believe in Allah and hold fast to Him, He will admit them into His mercy and grace and guide them to Himself through the Straight Path

¹⁷⁶They ask you 'for a ruling, O Prophet'. Say, "Allah gives you a ruling regarding those who die without children or parents." If a man dies childless and leaves behind a sister, she will inherit one-half of his estate, whereas her brother will inherit all of her estate if she dies childless. If this person leaves behind two sisters, they together will inherit two-thirds of the estate. But if the deceased leaves male and female siblings, a male's share will be equal to that of two females. Allah makes 'this' clear to you so you do not go astray. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

Al-Mā'idah

The Spread Table • 120 verses

¹O believers! Honour your obligations. All grazing livestock has been made lawful to you—except what is hereby announced to you and hunting while on pilgrimage. Indeed, Allah commands what He wills

²O believers! Do not violate Allah's rituals 'of pilgrimage', the sacred months, the sacrificial animals, the 'offerings decorated with' garlands, nor those 'pilgrims' on their way to the Sacred House seeking their Lord's bounty and pleasure. When pilgrimage has ended, you are allowed to hunt. Do not let the hatred of a people who once barred you from the Sacred Mosque provoke you to transgress. Cooperate with one another in goodness and righteousness, and do not cooperate in sin and transgression. And be mindful of Allah. Surely Allah is severe in punishment

³Forbidden to you are carrion, blood, and swine; what is slaughtered in the name of any other than Allah; what is killed by

strangling, beating, a fall, or by being gored to death; what is partly eaten by a predator unless you slaughter it; and what is sacrificed on altars. You are also forbidden to draw lots for decisions. This is all evil. Today the disbelievers have given up all hope of 'undermining' your faith. So do not fear them; fear Me! Today I have perfected your faith for you, completed My favour upon you, and chosen Islam as your way. But whoever is compelled by extreme hunger—not intending to sin—then surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁴They ask you, 'O Prophet,' what is permissible for them 'to eat'. Say, "What is good and lawful. Also what is caught by your hunting animals and birds of prey which you have trained as instructed by Allah. So eat what they catch for you, but mention the Name of Allah over it 'first'." And be mindful of Allah. Surely Allah is swift in reckoning

⁵Today all good, pure foods have been made lawful for you. Similarly, the food of the People of the Book is permissible for you and yours is permissible for them. And 'permissible for you in marriage' are chaste believing women as well as chaste women of those given the Scripture before you—as long as you pay them their dowries in wedlock, neither for-

nicating nor taking them as mistresses. And whoever rejects the faith, all their good deeds will be void 'in this life' and in the Hereafter they will be among the losers

⁶O believers! When you rise up for prayer, wash your faces and your hands up to the elbows, wipe your heads, and wash your feet to the ankles. And if you are in a state of 'full' impurity, then take a full bath. But if you are ill, on a journey, or have relieved yourselves, or have been intimate with your wives and cannot find water, then purify yourselves with clean earth by wiping your faces and hands. It is not Allah's Will to burden you, but to purify you and complete His favour upon you, so perhaps you will be grateful

⁷Remember Allah's favour upon you and the covenant He made with you when you said, "We hear and obey." And be mindful of Allah. Surely Allah knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁸O believers! Stand firm for Allah and bear true testimony. Do not let the hatred of a people lead you to injustice. Be just! That is closer to righteousness. And be mindful of Allah. Surely Allah is All-Aware of what you do

⁹Allah has promised those who believe and do good 'His' forgiveness and a great reward

¹⁰As for those who disbelieve and deny Our signs, they are the residents of the Hellfire

¹¹O believers! Remember Allah's favour upon you: when a people sought to harm you, but He held their hands back from you. Be mindful of Allah. And in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹²Allah made a covenant with the Children of Israel and appointed twelve leaders from among them and 'then' said, "I am truly with you. If you establish prayer, pay alms-tax, believe in My messengers, support them, and lend to Allah a good loan, I will certainly forgive your sins and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow. And whoever among you disbelieves afterwards has truly strayed from the Right Way."

¹³But for breaking their covenant We condemned them and hardened their hearts. They distorted the words of the Scripture and neglected a portion of what they had been commanded to uphold. You 'O Prophet' will always find deceit on their part, except for a few. But pardon them and bear with them. Indeed, Allah loves the good-doers

¹⁴And from those who say, "We are Christians," We took their covenant, but they neglected a portion of what they had been

commanded to uphold. So We let hostility and enmity arise between them until the Day of Judgment, and soon Allah will inform them of all they have done

¹⁵O People of the Book! Now Our Messenger has come to you, revealing much of what you have hidden of the Scriptures and disregarding much. There certainly has come to you from Allah a light and a clear Book

¹⁶through which Allah guides those who seek His pleasure to the ways of peace, brings them out of darkness and into light by His Will, and guides them to the Straight Path

¹⁷Indeed, those who say, "Allah is the Messiah, son of Mary," have fallen into disbelief. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Who has the power to prevent Allah if He chose to destroy the Messiah, son of Mary, his mother, and everyone in the world all together?" To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth and everything in between. He creates whatever He wills. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

¹⁸The Jews and the Christians each say, "We are the children of Allah and His most beloved!" Say, 'O Prophet,' "Why then does He punish you for your sins? No! You are only humans like others of His Own making. He forgives whoever He wills and punishes whoever He wills. To Allah 'alone' belongs the

kingdom of the heavens and the earth and everything in between. And to Him is the final return.”

¹⁹O People of the Book! Our Messenger has indeed come to you, making things clear to you after an interval between the messengers so you do not say, “There has never come to us a deliverer of good news or a warner.” Now there has come to you a deliverer of good news and a warner. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

²⁰And ‘remember’ when Moses said to his people, “O my people! Remember Allah’s favours upon you when He raised prophets from among you, made you sovereign, and gave you what He had never given anyone in the world

²¹O my people! Enter the Holy Land which Allah has destined for you ‘to enter’. And do not turn back or else you will become losers.”

²²They replied, “O Moses! There is an enormously powerful people there, so we will never ‘be able to’ enter it until they leave. If they do, then we will enter!”

²³Two God-fearing men—who had been blessed by Allah—said, “Surprise them through the gate. If you do, you will certainly prevail. Put your trust in Allah if you are ‘truly’ believers.”

²⁴Yet they said, "O Moses! 'Still' we will never enter as long as they remain there. So go—both you and your Lord—and fight; we are staying right here!"

²⁵Moses pleaded, "My Lord! I have no control over anyone except myself and my brother. So set us apart from the rebellious people."

²⁶Allah replied, "Then this land is forbidden to them for forty years, during which they will wander through the land. So do not grieve for the rebellious people."

²⁷Relate to them in truth 'O Prophet' the story of Adam's two sons—how each offered a sacrifice: Abel's offering was accepted while Cain's was not. So Cain threatened, "I will kill you!" His brother replied, "Allah only accepts 'the offering' of the sincerely devout

²⁸If you raise your hand to kill me, I will not raise mine to kill you, because I fear Allah—the Lord of all worlds

²⁹I want to let you bear your sin against me along with your other sins, then you will be one of those destined to the Fire. And that is the reward of the wrongdoers."

³⁰Yet Cain convinced himself to kill his brother, so he killed him—becoming a loser

³¹Then Allah sent a crow digging 'a grave' in the ground 'for a dead crow', in order to show him how to bury the corpse of his brother. He cried, "Alas! Have I 'even' failed to be like this crow and bury the corpse of my brother?" So he became regretful

³²That is why We ordained for the Children of Israel that whoever takes a life—unless as a punishment for murder or mischief in the land—it will be as if they killed all of humanity; and whoever saves a life, it will be as if they saved all of humanity. 'Although' Our messengers already came to them with clear proofs, many of them still transgressed afterwards through the land

³³Indeed, the penalty for those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and spread mischief in the land is death, crucifixion, cutting off their hands and feet on opposite sides, or exile from the land. This 'penalty' is a disgrace for them in this world, and they will suffer a tremendous punishment in the Hereafter

³⁴As for those who repent before you seize them, then know that Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

³⁵O believers! Be mindful of Allah and seek what brings you closer to Him and struggle in His Way, so you may be successful

³⁶As for the disbelievers, even if they were to possess everything in the world twice over and offer it all to ransom themselves from the punishment of the Day of Judgment, it would never be accepted from them. And they will suffer a painful punishment

³⁷They will be desperate to get out of the Fire but they will never be able to. And they will suffer an everlasting punishment

³⁸As for male and female thieves, cut off their hands for what they have done—a deterrent from Allah. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

³⁹But whoever repents after their wrongdoing and mends their ways, Allah will surely turn to them in forgiveness. Indeed, Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁴⁰Do you not know that the kingdom of the heavens and the earth belongs to Allah alone? He punishes whoever He wills and forgives whoever He wills. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁴¹O Messenger! Do not grieve for those who race to disbelieve—those who say, “We believe” with their tongues, but their hearts are in disbelief. Nor those among the Jews who eagerly listen to lies, attentive to those who are too arrogant to come to you. They distort the Scripture, taking rulings out of context, then say, “If this is the ruling you get ‘from Muḥammad’, accept it. If not, beware!” Whoever Allah allows to be deluded, you can never be of any help to them against Allah. It is not Allah’s Will to purify their hearts. For them is disgrace in this world, and they will suffer a tremendous punishment in the Hereafter

⁴²They eagerly listen to falsehood and consume forbidden gain. So if they come to you ‘O Prophet’, either judge between them or turn away from them. If you turn away from them, they cannot harm you whatsoever. But if you judge between them, then do so with justice. Surely Allah loves those who are just

⁴³But why do they come to you for judgment when they ‘already’ have the Torah containing Allah’s judgment, then they turn away after all? They are not ‘true’ believers

⁴⁴Indeed, We revealed the Torah, containing guidance and light, by which the prophets, who submitted themselves to

Allah, made judgments for Jews. So too did the rabbis and scholars judge according to Allah's Book, with which they were entrusted and of which they were made keepers. So do not fear the people; fear Me! Nor trade my revelations for a fleeting gain. And those who do not judge by what Allah has revealed are 'truly' the disbelievers

⁴⁵We ordained for them in the Torah, "A life for a life, an eye for an eye, a nose for a nose, an ear for an ear, a tooth for a tooth—and for wounds equal retaliation." But whoever waives it charitably, it will be atonement for them. And those who do not judge by what Allah has revealed are 'truly' the wrongdoers

⁴⁶Then in the footsteps of the prophets, We sent Jesus, son of Mary, confirming the Torah revealed before him. And We gave him the Gospel containing guidance and light and confirming what was revealed in the Torah—a guide and a lesson to the God-fearing

⁴⁷So let the people of the Gospel judge by what Allah has revealed in it. And those who do not judge by what Allah has revealed are 'truly' the rebellious

⁴⁸We have revealed to you 'O Prophet' this Book with the truth, as a confirmation of previous Scriptures and a supreme

authority on them. So judge between them by what Allah has revealed, and do not follow their desires over the truth that has come to you. To each of you We have ordained a code of law and a way of life. If Allah had willed, He would have made you one community, but His Will is to test you with what He has given 'each of' you. So compete with one another in doing good. To Allah you will all return, then He will inform you 'of the truth' regarding your differences

⁴⁹And judge between them 'O Prophet' by what Allah has revealed, and do not follow their desires. And beware, so they do not lure you away from some of what Allah has revealed to you. If they turn away 'from Allah's judgment', then know that it is Allah's Will to repay them for some of their sins, and that many people are indeed rebellious

⁵⁰Is it the judgment of 'pre-Islamic' ignorance they seek? Who could be a better judge than Allah for people of sure faith

⁵¹O believers! Take neither Jews nor Christians as guardians—they are guardians of each other. Whoever does so will be counted as one of them. Surely Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

⁵²You see those with sickness in their hearts racing for their guardianship, saying 'in justification', "We fear a turn of for-

tune will strike us.” But perhaps Allah will bring about ‘your’ victory or another favour by His command, and they will regret what they have hidden in their hearts

⁵³‘Only then,’ the believers will ask ‘one another’, “Are these the ones who swore solemn oaths by Allah that they were with you?” Their deeds have been in vain, so they have become losers

⁵⁴O believers! Whoever among you abandons their faith, Allah will replace them with others who love Him and are loved by Him. They will be humble with the believers but firm towards the disbelievers, struggling in the Way of Allah; fearing no blame from anyone. This is the favour of Allah. He grants it to whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing

⁵⁵Your only guardians are Allah, His Messenger, and fellow believers—who establish prayer and pay alms-tax with humility

⁵⁶Whoever allies themselves with Allah, His Messenger, and fellow believers, then it is certainly Allah’s party that will prevail

⁵⁷O believers! Do not seek the guardianship of those given the Scripture before you and the disbelievers who have made

your faith a mockery and amusement. And be mindful of Allah if you are 'truly' believers

⁵⁸When you call to prayer, they mock it in amusement. This is because they are a people without understanding

⁵⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "O People of the Book! Do you resent us only because we believe in Allah and what has been revealed to us and what was revealed before—while most of you are rebellious?"

⁶⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "Shall I inform you of those who deserve a worse punishment from Allah 'than the rebellious'? It is those who earned Allah's condemnation and displeasure—some being reduced to apes and pigs and worshippers of false gods. These are far worse in rank and farther astray from the Right Way."

⁶¹When they come to you 'believers' they say, "We believe." But they are committed to disbelief when they enter and when they leave. And Allah knows what they hide

⁶²You see many of them racing towards sin, transgression, and consumption of forbidden gain. Evil indeed are their actions

⁶³Why do their rabbis and scholars not forbid them from saying what is sinful and consuming what is unlawful? Evil indeed is their inaction

⁶⁴‘Some among’ the Jews said, “Allah is tight-fisted.” May their fists be tied and they be condemned for what they said. Rather, He is open-handed, giving freely as He pleases. That which has been revealed to you ‘O Prophet’ from your Lord will only cause many of them to increase in wickedness and disbelief. We have stirred among them hostility and hatred until the Day of Judgment. Whenever they kindle the fire of war, Allah puts it out. And they strive to spread corruption in the land. And Allah does not like corruptors

⁶⁵Had the People of the Book only been faithful and mindful ‘of Allah’, We would have certainly absolved them of their sins and admitted them into the Gardens of Bliss

⁶⁶And had they observed the Torah, the Gospel, and what has been revealed to them from their Lord, they would have been overwhelmed with provisions from above and below. Some among them are upright, yet many do nothing but evil

⁶⁷O Messenger! Convey everything revealed to you from your Lord. If you do not, then you have not delivered His message.

Allah will ‘certainly’ protect you from the people. Indeed, Allah does not guide the people who disbelieve

⁶⁸Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “O People of the Book! You have nothing to stand on unless you observe the Torah, the Gospel, and what has been revealed to you from your Lord.” And your Lord’s revelation to you ‘O Prophet’ will only cause many of them to increase in wickedness and disbelief. So do not grieve for the people who disbelieve

⁶⁹Indeed, the believers, Jews, Sabians and Christians—whoever ‘truly’ believes in Allah and the Last Day and does good, there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

⁷⁰Indeed, We took a covenant from the Children of Israel and sent them messengers. Whenever a messenger came to them with what they did not desire, they denied some and killed others

⁷¹They thought there would be no consequences, so they turned a blind eye and a deaf ear. Yet Allah turned to them in forgiveness ‘after their repentance’, but again many became blind and deaf. And Allah is All-Seeing of what they do

⁷²Those who say, “Allah is the Messiah, son of Mary,” have certainly fallen into disbelief. The Messiah ‘himself’ said, “O Children of Israel! Worship Allah—my Lord and your Lord.”

Whoever associates others with Allah 'in worship' will surely be forbidden Paradise by Allah. Their home will be the Fire. And the wrongdoers will have no helpers

⁷³Those who say, "Allah is one in a Trinity," have certainly fallen into disbelief. There is only One God. If they do not stop saying this, those who disbelieve among them will be afflicted with a painful punishment

⁷⁴Will they not turn to Allah in repentance and seek His forgiveness? And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁷⁵The Messiah, son of Mary, was no more than a messenger. 'Many' messengers had 'come and' gone before him. His mother was a woman of truth. They both ate food. See how We make the signs clear to them, yet see how they are deluded 'from the truth'

⁷⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "How can you worship besides Allah those who can neither harm nor benefit you? And Allah 'alone' is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing."

⁷⁷Say, "O People of the Book! Do not go to extremes in your faith beyond the truth, nor follow the vain desires of those who went astray before 'you'. They misled many and strayed from the Right Way."

⁷⁸The disbelievers among the Children of Israel were condemned in the revelations of David and Jesus, son of Mary. That was for their disobedience and violations

⁷⁹They did not forbid one another from doing evil. Evil indeed was what they did

⁸⁰You see many of them taking the disbelievers as allies. Truly wicked are their misdeeds, which have earned them Allah's wrath. And they will be in everlasting torment

⁸¹Had they believed in Allah, the Prophet, and what has been revealed to him, they would have never taken those 'pagans' as allies. But most of them are rebellious

⁸²You will surely find the most bitter towards the believers to be the Jews and polytheists and the most gracious to be those who call themselves Christian. That is because there are priests and monks among them and because they are not arrogant

⁸³When they listen to what has been revealed to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears for recognizing the truth. They say, "Our Lord! We believe, so count us among the witnesses

⁸⁴Why should we not believe in Allah and the truth that has come to us? And we long for our Lord to include us in the company of the righteous.”

⁸⁵So Allah will reward them for what they said with Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever. And that is the reward of the good-doers

⁸⁶As for those who disbelieve and reject Our signs, they will be the residents of the Hellfire

⁸⁷O believers! Do not forbid the good things which Allah has made lawful for you, and do not transgress. Indeed, Allah does not like transgressors

⁸⁸Eat of the good, lawful things provided to you by Allah. And be mindful of Allah in Whom you believe

⁸⁹Allah will not call you to account for your thoughtless oaths, but He will hold you accountable for deliberate oaths. The penalty for a broken oath is to feed ten poor people from what you normally feed your own family, or to clothe them, or to free a bondsperson. But if none of this is affordable, then you must fast three days. This is the penalty for breaking your oaths. So be mindful of your oaths. This is how Allah makes things clear to you, so perhaps you will be grateful

⁹⁰O believers! Intoxicants, gambling, idols, and drawing lots for decisions are all evil of Satan's handiwork. So shun them so you may be successful

⁹¹Satan's plan is to stir up hostility and hatred between you with intoxicants and gambling and to prevent you from remembering Allah and praying. Will you not then abstain

⁹²Obey Allah and obey the Messenger and beware! But if you turn away, then know that Our Messenger's duty is only to deliver 'the message' clearly

⁹³There is no blame on those who believe and do good for what they had consumed before 'the prohibition', as long as they fear Allah, have faith, and do what is good; then they believe and act virtuously, then become fully mindful 'of Allah' and do righteous deeds. For Allah loves the good-doers

⁹⁴O believers! Allah will surely test you with game within the reach of your hands and spears to distinguish those who fear Him in secret. Whoever transgresses from now on will suffer a painful punishment

⁹⁵O believers! Do not kill game while on pilgrimage. Whoever kills game intentionally must compensate by offering its equivalence—as judged by two just men among you—to be offered at the Sacred House, or by feeding the needy, or

by fasting so that they may taste the consequences of their violations. Allah has forgiven what has been done. But those who persist will be punished by Allah. And Allah is Almighty, capable of punishment

⁹⁶It is lawful for you to hunt and eat seafood, as a provision for you and for travellers. But hunting on land is forbidden to you while on pilgrimage. Be mindful of Allah to Whom you all will be gathered

⁹⁷Allah has made the Ka'bah—the Sacred House—a sanctuary of well-being for all people, along with the sacred months, the sacrificial animals, and the 'offerings decorated with' garlands. All this so you may know that Allah knows whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth, and that He has 'perfect' knowledge of everything

⁹⁸Know that Allah is severe in punishment and that He is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁹⁹The Messenger's duty is only to deliver 'the message'. And Allah 'fully' knows what you reveal and what you conceal

¹⁰⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "Good and evil are not equal, though you may be dazzled by the abundance of evil. So be mindful of Allah, O people of reason, so you may be successful."

101O believers! Do not ask about any matter which, if made clear to you, may disturb you. But if you inquire about what is being revealed in the Quran, it will be made clear to you. Allah has forgiven what was done 'in the past'. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Forbearing

102Some people before you asked such questions then denied their answers

103Allah has never ordained the 'so-called' baḥîrah, sâ'ibah, waṣîlah, and ḥâm camels. But the disbelievers just fabricate lies about Allah, and most of them lack understanding

104When it is said to them, "Come to Allah's revelations and to the Messenger," they reply, "What we found our forefathers practicing is good enough for us." 'Would they still do so,' even if their forefathers had absolutely no knowledge or guidance

105O believers! You are accountable only for yourselves. It will not harm you if someone chooses to deviate—as long as you are 'rightly' guided. To Allah you will all return, and He will inform you of what you used to do

106O believers! When death approaches any of you, call upon two just Muslim men to witness as you make a bequest; otherwise, two non-Muslims if you are afflicted with death while

on a journey. If you doubt 'their testimony', keep them after prayer and let them testify under oath 'saying', "By Allah! We would never sell our testimony for any price, even in favour of a close relative, nor withhold the testimony of Allah. Otherwise, we would surely be sinful."

¹⁰⁷If they are found guilty 'of false testimony', let the deceased's two closest heirs affected by the bequest replace the witnesses and testify under oath 'saying', "By Allah! Our testimony is truer than theirs. We have not transgressed. Otherwise, we would surely be wrongdoers."

¹⁰⁸In this way it is more likely that witnesses will give true testimony or else fear that their oaths could be refuted by those of the heirs. Be mindful of Allah and obey. For Allah does not guide the rebellious people

¹⁰⁹"Consider' the Day Allah will gather the messengers and say, "What response did you receive?" They will reply, "We have no knowledge 'compared to You'! You 'alone' are indeed the Knower of all unseen."

¹¹⁰And 'on Judgment Day' Allah will say, "O Jesus, son of Mary! Remember My favour upon you and your mother: how I supported you with the holy spirit so you spoke to people in 'your' infancy and adulthood. How I taught you writing, wisdom,

the Torah, and the Gospel. How you moulded a bird from clay—by My Will—and breathed into it and it became a ‘real’ bird—by My Will. How you healed the blind and the lepers—by My Will. How you brought the dead to life—by My Will. How I prevented the Children of Israel from harming you when you came to them with clear proofs and the disbelievers among them said, “This is nothing but pure magic.”

111 And how I inspired the disciples, “Believe in Me and My messenger!” They declared, “We believe and bear witness that we fully submit ‘to Allah’.”

112 ‘Remember’ when the disciples asked, “O Jesus, son of Mary! Would your Lord be willing to send down to us a table spread with food from heaven?” Jesus answered, “Fear Allah if you are ‘truly’ believers.”

113 They said, “We ‘only’ wish to eat from it to reassure our hearts, to verify you are indeed truthful to us, and to become its witnesses.”

114 Jesus, son of Mary, prayed, “O Allah, our Lord! Send us from heaven a table spread with food as a feast for us—the first and last of us—and as a sign from You. Provide for us! You are indeed the Best Provider.”

115 Allah answered, "I am sending it down to you. But whoever among you denies afterwards will be subjected to a torment I have never inflicted on anyone of My creation."

116 And 'on Judgment Day' Allah will say, "O Jesus, son of Mary! Did you ever ask the people to worship you and your mother as gods besides Allah?" He will answer, "Glory be to You! How could I ever say what I had no right to say? If I had said such a thing, you would have certainly known it. You know what is 'hidden' within me, but I do not know what is within You. Indeed, You 'alone' are the Knower of all unseen

117 I never told them anything except what You ordered me to say: "Worship Allah—my Lord and your Lord!" And I was witness over them as long as I remained among them. But when You took me, You were the Witness over them—and You are a Witness over all things

118 If You punish them, they belong to You after all. But if You forgive them, You are surely the Almighty, All-Wise."

119 Allah will declare, "This is the Day when 'only' the faithful will benefit from their faithfulness. Theirs are Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. Allah is pleased with them and they are pleased with Him. That is the ultimate triumph."

120To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth and everything within. And He is Most Capable of everything

Al-An‘ām

The Cattle • 165 verses

¹All praise is for Allah Who created the heavens and the earth and made darkness and light. Yet the disbelievers set up equals to their Lord ‘in worship’

²He is the One Who created you from clay, then appointed a term ‘for your death’ and another known only to Him ‘for your resurrection’—yet you continue to doubt

³He is the Only True God in the heavens and the earth. He knows whatever you conceal and whatever you reveal, and knows whatever you do

⁴Whenever a sign comes to them from their Lord, they turn away from it

⁵They have indeed rejected the truth when it came to them, so they will soon face the consequences of their ridicule

⁶Have they not seen how many ‘disbelieving’ peoples We destroyed before them? We had made them more established

in the land than you. We sent down abundant rain for them and made rivers flow at their feet. Then We destroyed them for their sins and replaced them with other peoples

⁷Had We sent down to you 'O Prophet' a revelation in writing and they were to touch it with their own hands, the disbelievers would still have said, "This is nothing but pure magic!"

⁸They say, "Why has no 'visible' angel come with him?" Had We sent down an angel, the matter would have certainly been settled 'at once', and they would have never been given more time 'to repent'

⁹And if We had sent an angel, We would have certainly made it 'assume the form of' a man—leaving them more confused than they already are

¹⁰'Other' messengers had already been ridiculed before you 'O Prophet', but those who mocked them were overtaken by what they used to ridicule

¹¹Say, "Travel throughout the land and see the fate of the deniers."

¹²Ask 'them, O Prophet', "To whom belongs everything in the heavens and the earth?" Say, "To Allah!" He has taken upon Himself to be Merciful. He will certainly gather 'all of' you

together for the Day of Judgment—about which there is no doubt. But those who have ruined themselves will never believe

¹³To Him belongs whatever exists in the day and night. And He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

¹⁴Say, 'O Prophet,' "Will I take any guardian other than Allah, the Originator of the heavens and the earth, Who provides for all and is not in need of provision?" Say, "I have been commanded to be the first to submit and not be one of the polytheists."

¹⁵Say, "I truly fear—if I were to disobey my Lord—the torment of a tremendous Day."

¹⁶Whoever is spared the torment of that Day will have certainly been shown Allah's mercy. And that is the absolute triumph

¹⁷If Allah touches you with harm, none can undo it except Him. And if He touches you with a blessing, He is Most Capable of everything

¹⁸He reigns supreme over His creation. And He is the All-Wise, All-Aware

¹⁹Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Who is the best witness?” Say, “Allah is! He is a Witness between me and you. And this Quran has been revealed to me so that, with it, I may warn you and whoever it reaches. Do you ‘pagans’ testify that there are other gods besides Allah?” ‘Then’ say, “I will never testify ‘to this!’” ‘And’ say, “There is only One God. And I totally reject whatever ‘idols’ you associate with Him.”

²⁰Those to whom We gave the Scripture recognize him ‘to be a true prophet’ as they recognize their own children. Those who have ruined themselves will never believe

²¹Who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah or deny His signs? Indeed, the wrongdoers will never succeed

²²‘Consider’ the Day We will gather them all together then ask those who associated others ‘with Allah in worship’, “Where are those gods you used to claim?”

²³Their only argument will be: “By Allah, our Lord! We were never polytheists.”

²⁴See how they will lie about themselves and how those ‘gods’ they fabricated will fail them

²⁵There are some of them who 'pretend to' listen to your recitation 'of the Quran', but We have cast veils over their hearts—leaving them unable to comprehend it—and deafness in their ears. Even if they were to see every sign, they still would not believe in them. The disbelievers would 'even' come to argue with you, saying, "This 'Quran' is nothing but ancient fables!"

²⁶They turn others away from the Prophet and distance themselves as well. They ruin none but themselves, yet they fail to perceive it

²⁷If only you could see when they will be detained before the Fire! They will cry, "Oh! If only we could be sent back, we would never deny the signs of our Lord and we would 'surely' be of the believers."

²⁸But no! 'They only say this' because the truth they used to hide will become all too clear to them. Even if they were to be sent back, they would certainly revert to what they were forbidden. Indeed they are liars

²⁹They insisted, "There is nothing beyond this worldly life and we will never be resurrected."

³⁰But if only you could see when they will be detained before their Lord! He will ask 'them', "Is this 'Hereafter' not

the truth?” They will cry, “Absolutely, by our Lord!” He will say, “Then taste the punishment for your disbelief.”

³¹Losers indeed are those who deny the meeting with Allah until the Hour takes them by surprise, then they will cry, “Woe to us for having ignored this!” They will bear ‘the burden of’ their sins on their backs. Evil indeed is their burden

³²This worldly life is no more than play and amusement, but far better is the ‘eternal’ Home of the Hereafter for those mindful ‘of Allah’. Will you not then understand

³³We certainly know that what they say grieves you ‘O Prophet’. It is not your honesty they question—it is Allah’s signs that the wrongdoers deny

³⁴Indeed, messengers before you were rejected but patiently endured rejection and persecution until Our help came to them. And Allah’s promise ‘to help’ is never broken. And you have already received some of the narratives of these messengers

³⁵If you find their denial unbearable, then build—if you can—a tunnel through the earth or stairs to the sky to bring them a ‘more compelling’ sign. Had Allah so willed, He could have guided them all. So do not be one of those ignorant ‘of this fact’

³⁶Only the attentive will respond 'to your call'. As for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will 'all' be returned

³⁷They ask, "Why has no 'other' sign been sent down to him from his Lord?" Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah certainly has the power to send down a sign"—though most of them do not know

³⁸All living beings roaming the earth and winged birds soaring in the sky are communities like yourselves. We have left nothing out of the Record. Then to their Lord they will be gathered all together

³⁹Those who deny Our signs are 'wilfully' deaf and dumb—lost in darkness. Allah leaves whoever He wills to stray and guides whoever He wills to the Straight Way

⁴⁰Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Imagine if you were overwhelmed by Allah's torment or the Hour—would you call upon any other than Allah 'for help'? 'Answer me' if your claims are true

⁴¹No! He is the only One you would call. And if He willed, He could remove the affliction that made you invoke Him. Only then will you forget whatever you associate with Him 'in worship'."

⁴²Indeed, We have sent messengers before you 'O Prophet' to other people who We put through suffering and adversity 'for their denial', so perhaps they would be humbled

⁴³Why did they not humble themselves when We made them suffer? Instead, their hearts were hardened, and Satan made their misdeeds appealing to them

⁴⁴When they became oblivious to warnings, We showered them with everything they desired. But just as they became prideful of what they were given, We seized them by surprise, then they instantly fell into despair

⁴⁵So the wrongdoers were utterly uprooted. And all praise is for Allah—Lord of all worlds

⁴⁶Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Imagine if Allah were to take away your hearing or sight, or seal your hearts—who else other than Allah could restore it?" See 'O Prophet' how We vary the signs, yet they still turn away

⁴⁷Ask, "Imagine if Allah's punishment were to overwhelm you with or without warning—who would be destroyed other than the wrongdoers?"

⁴⁸We have sent messengers only as deliverers of good news and as warners. Whoever believes and does good, there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

⁴⁹But those who deny Our signs will be afflicted with punishment for their rebelliousness

⁵⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "I do not say to you that I possess Allah's treasures or know the unseen, nor do I claim to be an angel. I only follow what is revealed to me." Say, "Are those blind 'to the truth' equal to those who can see? Will you not then reflect?"

⁵¹Warn with this 'Quran' those who are awed by the prospect of being gathered before their Lord—when they will have no protector or intercessor besides Him—so perhaps they will be mindful 'of Him'

⁵²'O Prophet!' Do not dismiss those 'poor believers' who invoke their Lord morning and evening, seeking His pleasure. You are not accountable for them whatsoever, nor are they accountable for you. So do not dismiss them, or you will be one of the wrongdoers

⁵³In this way We have tested some by means of others, so those 'disbelievers' may say, "Has Allah favoured these 'poor

believers' out of all of us?" Does Allah not best recognize the grateful

⁵⁴When the believers in Our revelations come to you, say, "Peace be upon you! Your Lord has taken upon Himself to be Merciful. Whoever among you commits evil ignorantly 'or recklessly' then repents afterwards and mends their ways, then Allah is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

⁵⁵This is how We make Our signs clear, so the way of the wicked may become distinct

⁵⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "I have been forbidden to worship those you invoke besides Allah." Say, "I will not follow your desires, for I then would certainly be astray and not one of those 'rightly' guided."

⁵⁷Say, 'O Prophet,' "Indeed, I stand on a clear proof from my Lord—yet you have denied it. That 'torment' you seek to hasten is not within my power. It is only Allah Who decides 'its time'. He declares the truth. And He is the Best of Judges."

⁵⁸Say 'also', "If what you seek to hasten were within my power, the matter between us would have already been settled. But Allah knows the wrongdoers best."

⁵⁹With Him are the keys of the unseen—no one knows them except Him. And He knows what is in the land and sea. Not even a leaf falls without His knowledge, nor a grain in the darkness of the earth or anything—green or dry—but is ‘written’ in a perfect Record

⁶⁰He is the One Who calls back your souls by night and knows what you do by day, then revives you daily to complete your appointed term. To Him is your ‘ultimate’ return, then He will inform you of what you used to do

⁶¹He reigns supreme over all of His creation, and sends recording-angels, watching over you. When death comes to any of you, Our angels take their soul, never neglecting this duty

⁶²Then they are ‘all’ returned to Allah—their True Master. Judgment is His ‘alone’. And He is the Swiftest Reckoner

⁶³Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Who rescues you from the darkest times on land and at sea? He ‘alone’ you call upon with humility, openly and secretly: “If You rescue us from this, we will be ever grateful.”

⁶⁴Say, “‘Only’ Allah rescues you from this and any other distress, yet you associate others with Him ‘in worship’.”

⁶⁵Say, “He ‘alone’ has the power to unleash upon you a torment from above or below you or split you into ‘conflicting’ factions and make you taste the violence of one another.” See how We vary the signs, so perhaps they will comprehend

⁶⁶Still your people ‘O Prophet’ have rejected this ‘Quran’, although it is the truth. Say, “I am not a keeper over you.”

⁶⁷Every ‘destined’ matter has a ‘set’ time to transpire. And you will soon come to know

⁶⁸And when you come across those who ridicule Our revelations, do not sit with them unless they engage in a different topic. Should Satan make you forget, then once you remember, do not ‘continue to’ sit with the wrongdoing people

⁶⁹Those mindful ‘of Allah’ will not be accountable for those ‘who ridicule it’ whatsoever—their duty is to advise, so perhaps the ridiculers will abstain

⁷⁰And leave those who take this faith ‘of Islam’ as mere play and amusement and are deluded by ‘their’ worldly life. Yet remind them by this ‘Quran’, so no one should be ruined for their misdeeds. They will have no protector or intercessor other than Allah. Even if they were to offer every ‘possible’ ransom, none will be accepted from them. Those are the ones

who will be ruined for their misdeeds. They will have a boiling drink and painful punishment for their disbelief

⁷¹Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Should we invoke, other than Allah, those 'idols' which cannot benefit or harm us, and turn back to disbelief after Allah has guided us? 'If we do so, we will be' like those disoriented by devils in the wilderness, while their companions call them to guidance, 'saying', 'Come to us!' Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah's guidance is the 'only' true guidance. And we are commanded to submit to the Lord of all worlds

⁷²establish prayer, and be mindful of Him. To Him you will all be gathered together

⁷³He is the One Who created the heavens and the earth in truth. On the Day 'of Judgment' He will say, 'Be!' And there will be! His command is truth. All authority is His 'alone' on the Day the Trumpet will be blown. He is the Knower of all—seen or unseen. And He is the All-Wise, All-Aware."

⁷⁴And 'remember' when Abraham said to his father, Âzar, "Do you take idols as gods? It is clear to me that you and your people are entirely misguided."

⁷⁵We also showed Abraham the wonders of the heavens and the earth, so he would be sure in faith

⁷⁶When the night grew dark upon him, he saw a star and said, “This is my Lord!” But when it set, he said, “I do not love things that set.”

⁷⁷Then when he saw the moon rising, he said, “This one is my Lord!” But when it disappeared, he said, “If my Lord does not guide me, I will certainly be one of the misguided people.”

⁷⁸Then when he saw the sun shining, he said, “This must be my Lord—it is the greatest!” But again when it set, he declared, “O my people! I totally reject whatever you associate ‘with Allah in worship’

⁷⁹I have turned my face towards the One Who has originated the heavens and the earth—being upright—and I am not one of the polytheists.”

⁸⁰And his people argued with him. He responded, “Are you arguing with me about Allah, while He has guided me? I am not afraid of whatever ‘idols’ you associate with Him—‘none can harm me,’ unless my Lord so wills. My Lord encompasses everything in ‘His’ knowledge. Will you not be mindful

⁸¹And how should I fear your associate-gods, while you have no fear in associating ‘others’ with Allah—a practice He has

never authorized? Which side has more right to security? 'Tell me' if you really know!"

⁸²It is 'only' those who are faithful and do not tarnish their faith with falsehood who are guaranteed security and are 'rightly' guided

⁸³This was the argument We gave Abraham against his people. We elevate in rank whoever We please. Surely your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing

⁸⁴And We blessed him with Isaac and Jacob. We guided them all as We previously guided Noah and those among his descendants: David, Solomon, Job, Joseph, Moses, and Aaron. This is how We reward the good-doers

⁸⁵Likewise, 'We guided' Zachariah, John, Jesus, and Elias, who were all of the righteous

⁸⁶'We also guided' Ishmael, Elisha, Jonah, and Lot, favouring each over other people 'of their time'

⁸⁷And 'We favoured' some of their forefathers, their descendants, and their brothers. We chose them and guided them to the Straight Path

⁸⁸This is Allah's guidance with which He guides whoever He wills of His servants. Had they associated others with Him 'in worship', their 'good' deeds would have been wasted

⁸⁹Those were the ones to whom We gave the Scripture, wisdom, and prophethood. But if these 'pagans' disbelieve in this 'message', then We have already entrusted it to a people who will never disbelieve in it

⁹⁰These 'prophets' were 'rightly' guided by Allah, so follow their guidance. Say, "I ask no reward of you for this 'Quran'—it is a reminder to the whole world."

⁹¹And they have not shown Allah His proper reverence when they said, "Allah has revealed nothing to any human being." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Who then revealed the Book brought forth by Moses as a light and guidance for people, which you split into separate sheets—revealing some and hiding much? You have been taught 'through this Quran' what neither you nor your forefathers knew." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah 'revealed it'!" Then leave them to amuse themselves with falsehood

⁹²This is a blessed Book which We have revealed—confirming what came before it—so you may warn the Mother of Cities and everyone around it. Those who believe in the Hereafter 'truly' believe in it and guard their prayers

⁹³Who does more wrong than the one who fabricates lies against Allah or claims, “I have received revelations!”—although nothing was revealed to them—or the one who says, “I can reveal the like of Allah’s revelations!”? If you ‘O Prophet’ could only see the wrongdoers in the throes of death while the angels are stretching out their hands ‘saying’, “Give up your souls! Today you will be rewarded with the torment of disgrace for telling lies about Allah and for being arrogant towards His revelations!”

⁹⁴“Today’ you have come back to Us all alone as We created you the first time—leaving behind everything We have provided you with. We do not see your intercessors with you—those you claimed were Allah’s partners ‘in worship’. All your ties have been broken and all your claims have let you down.”

⁹⁵Indeed, Allah is the One Who causes seeds and fruit stones to sprout. He brings forth the living from the dead and the dead from the living. That is Allah! How can you then be deluded ‘from the truth’

⁹⁶He causes the dawn to break, and has made the night for rest and ‘made’ the sun and the moon ‘to travel’ with precision. That is the design of the Almighty, All-Knowing

⁹⁷And He is the One Who has made the stars as your guide through the darkness of land and sea. We have already made the signs clear for people who know

⁹⁸And He is the One Who originated you all from a single soul, then assigned you a place to live and another to 'be laid to' rest. We have already made the signs clear for people who comprehend

⁹⁹And He is the One Who sends down rain from the sky—causing all kinds of plants to grow—producing green stalks from which We bring forth clustered grain. And from palm trees come clusters of dates hanging within reach. 'There are' also gardens of grapevines, olives, and pomegranates, similar 'in shape' but dissimilar 'in taste'. Look at their fruit as it yields and ripens! Indeed, in these are signs for people who believe

¹⁰⁰Yet they associate the jinn with Allah 'in worship', even though He created them, and they falsely attribute to Him sons and daughters out of ignorance. Glorified and Exalted is He above what they claim

¹⁰¹'He is' the Originator of the heavens and earth. How could He have children when He has no mate? He created all things and has 'perfect' knowledge of everything

102That is Allah—your Lord! There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him. ‘He is’ the Creator of all things, so worship Him ‘alone’. And He is the Maintainer of everything

103No vision can encompass Him, but He encompasses all vision. For He is the Most Subtle, All-Aware

104Indeed, there have come to you insights from your Lord. So whoever chooses to see, it is for their own good. But whoever chooses to be blind, it is to their own loss. And I am not a keeper over you

105And so We vary our signs to the extent that they will say, “You have studied ‘previous scriptures’,” and We make this ‘Quran’ clear for people who know

106‘O Prophet!’ Follow what is revealed to you from your Lord—there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him—and turn away from the polytheists

107Had Allah willed, they would not have been polytheists. We have not appointed you as their keeper, nor are you their maintainer

108‘O believers!’ Do not insult what they invoke besides Allah or they will insult Allah spitefully out of ignorance. This is how We have made each people’s deeds appealing to them.

Then to their Lord is their return, and He will inform them of what they used to do

109 They swear by Allah their most solemn oaths that if a sign were to come to them, they would certainly believe in it. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Signs are only with Allah." What will make you 'believers' realize that even if a sign were to come to them, they still would not believe

110 We turn their hearts and eyes away 'from the truth' as they refused to believe at first, leaving them to wander blindly in their defiance

111 Even if We had sent them the angels, made the dead speak to them, and assembled before their own eyes every sign 'they demanded', they still would not have believed—unless Allah so willed. But most of them are ignorant 'of this'

112 And so We have made for every prophet enemies—devilish humans and jinn—whispering to one another with elegant words of deception. Had it been your Lord's Will, they would not have done such a thing. So leave them and their deceit

113 so that the hearts of those who disbelieve in the Hereafter may be receptive to it, be pleased with it, and be persistent in their evil pursuits

114 Say, O Prophet, "Should I seek a judge other than Allah while He is the One Who has revealed for you the Book with the truth perfectly explained?" Those who were given the Scripture know that it has been revealed to you from your Lord in truth. So do not be one of those who doubt

115 The Word of your Lord has been perfected in truth and justice. None can change His Words. And He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

116 O Prophet! If you were to obey most of those on earth, they would lead you away from Allah's Way. They follow nothing but assumptions and do nothing but lie

117 Indeed, your Lord knows best who has strayed from His Way and who is rightly guided

118 So eat only of what is slaughtered in Allah's Name if you truly believe in His revelations

119 Why should you not eat of what is slaughtered in Allah's Name when He has already explained to you what He has forbidden to you—except when compelled by necessity? Many deviants certainly mislead others by their whims out of ignorance. Surely your Lord knows the transgressors best

¹²⁰Shun all sin—open and secret. Indeed, those who commit sin will be punished for what they earn

¹²¹Do not eat of what is not slaughtered in Allah's Name. For that would certainly be 'an act of' disobedience. Surely the devils whisper to their 'human' associates to argue with you. If you were to obey them, then you 'too' would be polytheists

¹²²Can those who had been dead, to whom We gave life and a light with which they can walk among people, be compared to those in complete darkness from which they can never emerge? That is how the misdeeds of the disbelievers have been made appealing to them

¹²³And so We have placed in every society the most wicked to conspire in it. Yet they plot only against themselves, but they fail to perceive it

¹²⁴Whenever a sign comes to them, they say, "We will never believe until we receive what Allah's messengers received." Allah knows best where to place His message. The wicked will soon be overwhelmed by humiliation from Allah and a severe punishment for their evil plots

¹²⁵Whoever Allah wills to guide, He opens their heart to Islam. But whoever He wills to leave astray, He makes their

chest tight and constricted as if they were climbing up into the sky. This is how Allah dooms those who disbelieve

¹²⁶That is your Lord's Path—perfectly straight. We have already made the signs clear to those who are mindful

¹²⁷They will have the Home of Peace with their Lord, Who will be their Guardian because of what they used to do

¹²⁸Consider the Day He will gather them 'all' together and say, "O assembly of jinn! You misled humans in great numbers." And their human associates will say, "Our Lord! We benefited from each other's company, but now we have reached the term which You appointed for us." Then He will say, "The Fire is your home, yours to stay in forever, except whoever Allah wills to spare." Surely your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing

¹²⁹This is how We make the wrongdoers 'destructive' allies of one another because of their misdeeds

¹³⁰Allah will ask, "O assembly of jinn and humans! Did messengers not come from among you, proclaiming My revelations and warning you of the coming of this Day of yours?" They will say, "We confess against ourselves!" For they have been deluded by 'their' worldly life. And they will testify against themselves that they were disbelievers

131 This 'sending of the messengers' is because your Lord would never destroy a society for their wrongdoing while its people are unaware 'of the truth'

132 They will each be assigned ranks according to their deeds. And your Lord is not unaware of what they do

133 Your Lord is the Self-Sufficient, Full of Mercy. If He wills, He can do away with you and replace you with whoever He wills, just as He produced you from the offspring of other people

134 Indeed, what you have been promised will certainly come to pass. And you will have no escape

135 Say, 'O Prophet,' "O my people! Persist in your ways, for I 'too' will persist in mine. You will soon know who will fare best in the end. Indeed, the wrongdoers will never succeed."

136 The pagans set aside for Allah a share of the crops and cattle He created, saying, "This 'portion' is for Allah," so they claim, "and this 'one' for our associate-gods." Yet the portion of their associate-gods is not shared with Allah while Allah's portion is shared with their associate-gods. What unfair judgment

¹³⁷ Likewise, the pagans' evil associates have made it appealing to them to kill their own children—only leading to their destruction as well as confusion in their faith. Had it been Allah's Will, they would not have done such a thing. So leave them and their falsehood

¹³⁸ They say, "These cattle and crops are reserved—none may eat them except those we permit," so they claim. Some other cattle are exempted from labour and others are not slaughtered in Allah's Name—falsely attributing lies to Him. He will repay them for their lies

¹³⁹ They 'also' say, "The offspring of this cattle is reserved for our males and forbidden to our females; but if it is stillborn, they may all share it." He will repay them for their falsehood. Surely He is All-Wise, All-Knowing

¹⁴⁰ Lost indeed are those who have murdered their own children foolishly out of ignorance and have forbidden what Allah has provided for them—falsely attributing lies to Allah. They have certainly strayed and are not 'rightly' guided

¹⁴¹ He is the One Who produces gardens—both cultivated and wild—and palm trees, crops of different flavours, olives, and pomegranates—similar 'in shape', but dissimilar 'in taste'.

Eat of the fruit they bear and pay the dues at harvest, but do not waste. Surely He does not like the wasteful

¹⁴²Some cattle are fit for labour, others are too small. Eat of what Allah has provided for you and do not follow Satan's footsteps. Certainly, he is your sworn enemy

¹⁴³‘Allah has created’ four pairs: a pair of sheep and a pair of goats—ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Has He forbidden ‘to you’ the two males or the two females or what is in the wombs of the two females? Tell me with knowledge, if what you say is true.”—

¹⁴⁴and a pair of camels and a pair of oxen. Ask ‘them’, “Has He forbidden ‘to you’ the two males or the two females or what is in the wombs of the two females? Or were you present when Allah gave you this commandment?” Who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah to mislead others without ‘any’ knowledge? Surely Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

¹⁴⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I do not find in what has been revealed to me anything forbidden to eat except carrion, running blood, swine—which is impure—or a sinful offering in the name of any other than Allah. But if someone is compelled by necessity—

neither driven by desire nor exceeding immediate need—then surely your Lord is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.”

¹⁴⁶For those who are Jewish, We forbade every animal with undivided hoofs and the fat of oxen and sheep except what is joined to their backs or intestines or mixed with bone. In this way We rewarded them for their violations. And We are certainly truthful

¹⁴⁷But if they deny you ‘O Prophet’, say, “Your Lord is infinite in mercy, yet His punishment will not be averted from the wicked people.”

¹⁴⁸The polytheists will argue, “Had it been Allah’s Will, neither we nor our forefathers would have associated others with Him ‘in worship’ or made anything unlawful.” Likewise, those before them rejected the truth until they tasted Our punishment. Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Do you have any knowledge that you can produce for us? Surely you follow nothing but ‘false’ assumptions and you do nothing but lie.”

¹⁴⁹Say, “Allah has the most conclusive argument. Had it been His Will, He would have easily imposed guidance upon all of you.”

¹⁵⁰Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Bring your witnesses who can testify that Allah has forbidden this.” If they ‘falsely’ testify, do not tes-

tify with them. And do not follow the desires of those who deny Our proofs, disbelieve in the Hereafter, and set up equals with their Lord

¹⁵¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Come! Let me recite to you what your Lord has forbidden to you: do not associate others with Him 'in worship'. 'Do not fail to' honour your parents. Do not kill your children for fear of poverty. We provide for you and for them. Do not come near indecencies, openly or secretly. Do not take a 'human' life—made sacred by Allah—except with 'legal' right. This is what He has commanded you, so perhaps you will understand

¹⁵²And do not come near the wealth of the orphan—unless intending to enhance it—until they attain maturity. Give full measure and weigh with justice. We never require of any soul more than what it can afford. Whenever you speak, maintain justice—even regarding a close relative. And fulfil your covenant with Allah. This is what He has commanded you, so perhaps you will be mindful

¹⁵³Indeed, that is My Path—perfectly straight. So follow it and do not follow other ways, for they will lead you away from His Way. This is what He has commanded you, so perhaps you will be conscious 'of Allah'."

¹⁵⁴ Additionally, We gave Moses the Scripture, completing the favour upon those who do good, detailing everything, and as a guide and a mercy, so perhaps they would be certain of the meeting with their Lord

¹⁵⁵ This is a blessed Book We have revealed. So follow it and be mindful 'of Allah', so you may be shown mercy

¹⁵⁶ You 'pagans' can no longer say, "Scriptures were only revealed to two groups before us and we were unaware of their teachings."

¹⁵⁷ Nor can you say, "If only the Scriptures had been revealed to us, we would have been better guided than they." Now there has come to you from your Lord a clear proof—a guide and mercy. Who then does more wrong than those who deny Allah's revelations and turn away from them? We will reward those who turn away from Our revelations with a dreadful punishment for turning away

¹⁵⁸ Are they awaiting the coming of the angels, or your Lord 'Himself', or some of your Lord's 'major' signs? On the Day your Lord's signs arrive, belief will not benefit those who did not believe earlier or those who did no good through their faith. Say, "Keep waiting! We too are waiting."

¹⁵⁹Indeed, you 'O Prophet' are not responsible whatsoever for those who have divided their faith and split into sects. Their judgment rests only with Allah. And He will inform them of what they used to do

¹⁶⁰Whoever comes with a good deed will be rewarded tenfold. But whoever comes with a bad deed will be punished for only one. None will be wronged

¹⁶¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Surely my Lord has guided me to the Straight Path, a perfect way, the faith of Abraham, the upright, who was not one of the polytheists."

¹⁶²Say, "Surely my prayer, my worship, my life, and my death are all for Allah—Lord of all worlds

¹⁶³He has no partner. So I am commanded, and so I am the first to submit."

¹⁶⁴Say, 'O Prophet,' "Should I seek a lord other than Allah while He is the Lord of everything?" No one will reap except what they sow. No soul burdened with sin will bear the burden of another. Then to your Lord is your return, and He will inform you of your differences

¹⁶⁵He is the One Who has placed you as successors on earth and elevated some of you in rank over others, so He may test

you with what He has given you. Surely your Lord is swift in punishment, but He is certainly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

Al-A'rāf

The Heights • 206 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm-Ṣād

²“This is” a Book sent down to you “O Prophet”—do not let anxiety into your heart regarding it—so with it you may warn “the disbelievers”, and as a reminder to the believers

³Follow what has been sent down to you from your Lord, and do not take others as guardians besides Him. How seldom are you mindful

⁴“Imagine” how many societies We have destroyed! Our torment took them by surprise “while sleeping” at night or mid-day

⁵Their only cry—when overwhelmed by Our torment—was, “We have indeed been wrongdoers.”

⁶We will surely question those who received messengers and We will question the messengers “themselves”

⁷Then We will give them a full account with sure knowledge—for We were never absent

⁸The weighing on that Day will be just. As for those whose scale will be heavy ‘with good deeds’, ‘only’ they will be successful

⁹But those whose scale is light, they have doomed themselves for wrongfully denying Our signs

¹⁰We have indeed established you on earth and provided you with a means of livelihood. ‘Yet’ you seldom give any thanks

¹¹Surely We created you, then shaped you, then said to the angels, “Prostrate before Adam,” so they all did—but not Iblīs, who refused to prostrate with the others

¹²Allah asked, “What prevented you from prostrating when I commanded you?” He replied, “I am better than he is: You created me from fire and him from clay.”

¹³Allah said, “Then get down from Paradise! It is not for you to be arrogant here. So get out! You are truly one of the disgraced.”

¹⁴He appealed, “Then delay my end until the Day of their resurrection.”

¹⁵Allah said, “You are delayed ‘until the appointed Day’.”

¹⁶He said, “For leaving me to stray I will lie in ambush for them on Your Straight Path

¹⁷I will approach them from their front, their back, their right, their left, and then You will find most of them ungrateful.”

¹⁸Allah said, “Get out of Paradise! You are disgraced and rejected! I will certainly fill up Hell with you and your followers all together.”

¹⁹Allah said, “O Adam! Live with your wife in Paradise and eat from wherever you please, but do not approach this tree, or else you will be wrongdoers.”

²⁰Then Satan tempted them in order to expose what was hidden of their nakedness. He said, “Your Lord has forbidden this tree to you only to prevent you from becoming angels or immortals.”

²¹And he swore to them, “I am truly your sincere advisor.”

²²So he brought about their fall through deception. And when they tasted of the tree, their nakedness was exposed to them, prompting them to cover themselves with leaves from Paradise. Then their Lord called out to them, “Did I not forbid you from that tree and ‘did I not’ tell you that Satan is your sworn enemy?”

²³They replied, “Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You do not forgive us and have mercy on us, we will certainly be losers.”

²⁴Allah said, “Descend as enemies to each other. You will find in the earth a residence and provision for your appointed stay.”

²⁵He added, “There you will live, there you will die, and from there you will be resurrected.”

²⁶O children of Adam! We have provided for you clothing to cover your nakedness and as an adornment. However, the best clothing is righteousness. This is one of Allah’s bounties, so perhaps you will be mindful

²⁷O children of Adam! Do not let Satan deceive you as he tempted your parents out of Paradise and caused their cover to be removed in order to expose their nakedness. Surely he and his soldiers watch you from where you cannot see them. We have made the devils allies of those who disbelieve

²⁸Whenever they commit a shameful deed, they say, “We found our forefathers doing it and Allah has commanded us to do it.” Say, “No! Allah never commands what is shameful. How can you attribute to Allah what you do not know?”

²⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "My Lord has commanded uprightness and dedication 'to Him alone' in worship, calling upon Him with sincere devotion. Just as He first brought you into being, you will be brought to life again."

³⁰He has guided some, while others are destined to stray. They have taken devils as their masters instead of Allah—thinking they are 'rightly' guided

³¹O Children of Adam! Dress properly whenever you are at worship. Eat and drink, but do not waste. Surely He does not like the wasteful

³²Ask, 'O Prophet,' "Who has forbidden the adornments and lawful provisions Allah has brought forth for His servants?" Say, "They are for the enjoyment of the believers in this worldly life, but they will be exclusively theirs on the Day of Judgment. This is how We make Our revelations clear for people of knowledge."

³³Say, "My Lord has only forbidden open and secret indecencies, sinfulness, unjust aggression, associating 'others' with Allah 'in worship'—a practice He has never authorized—and attributing to Allah what you do not know."

³⁴For each community there is an appointed term. When their time arrives, they can neither delay it for a moment, nor could they advance it

³⁵O children of Adam! When messengers from among yourselves come to you reciting My revelations—whoever shuns evil and mends their ways, there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

³⁶But those who receive Our revelations with denial and arrogance will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

³⁷Who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah or deny His revelations? They will receive what is destined for them, until Our messenger-angels arrive to take their souls, asking them, “Where are those ‘false gods’ you used to invoke besides Allah?” They will cry, “They have failed us,” and they will confess against themselves that they were indeed disbelievers

³⁸Allah will say, “Enter the Fire along with the ‘evil’ groups of jinn and humans that preceded you.” Whenever a group enters Hell, it will curse the preceding one until they are all gathered inside, the followers will say about their leaders, “Our Lord! They have misled us, so multiply their torment

in the Fire.” He will answer, “It has already been multiplied for all, but you do not know.”

³⁹Then the leaders will say to their followers, “You were no better than us! So taste the torment for what you used to commit.”

⁴⁰Surely those who receive our revelations with denial and arrogance, the gates of heaven will not be opened for them, nor will they enter Paradise until a camel passes through the eye of a needle. This is how We reward the wicked

⁴¹Hell will be their bed; flames will be their cover. This is how We reward the wrongdoers

⁴²As for those who believe and do good—We never require of any soul more than what it can afford—it is they who will be the residents of Paradise. They will be there forever

⁴³We will remove whatever bitterness they had in their hearts. Rivers will flow under their feet. And they will say, “Praise be to Allah for guiding us to this. We would have never been guided if Allah had not guided us. The messengers of our Lord had certainly come with the truth.” It will be announced to them, “This is Paradise awarded to you for what you used to do.”

⁴⁴The residents of Paradise will call out to the residents of the Fire, “We have certainly found our Lord’s promise to be true. Have you too found your Lord’s promise to be true?” They will reply, “Yes, we have!” Then a caller will announce to both, “May Allah’s condemnation be upon the wrongdoers

⁴⁵those who hindered ‘others’ from Allah’s Way, strived to make it ‘appear’ crooked, and disbelieved in the Hereafter.”

⁴⁶There will be a barrier between Paradise and Hell. And on the heights ‘of that barrier’ will be people who will recognize ‘the residents of’ both by their appearance. They will call out to the residents of Paradise, “Peace be upon you!” They will have not yet entered Paradise, but eagerly hope to

⁴⁷When their eyes will turn towards the residents of Hell, they will pray, “Our Lord! Do not join us with the wrongdoing people.”

⁴⁸Those on the heights will call out to some ‘tyrants in the Fire’, who they will recognize by their appearance, saying, “Your large numbers and arrogance are of no use ‘today’

⁴⁹Are these ‘humble believers’ the ones you swore would never be shown Allah’s mercy?” ‘Finally, those on the heights will be told:’ “Enter Paradise! There will be no fear for you, nor will you grieve.”

⁵⁰The residents of the Fire will then cry out to the residents of Paradise, "Aid us with some water or any provision Allah has granted you." They will reply, "Allah has forbidden both to the disbelievers

⁵¹those who took this faith 'of Islam' as mere amusement and play and were deluded by 'their' worldly life." 'Allah will say,' "Today We will ignore them just as they ignored the coming of this Day of theirs and for rejecting Our revelations."

⁵²We have certainly brought them a Book which We explained with knowledge—a guide and mercy for those who believe

⁵³Do they only await the fulfilment 'of its warning'? The Day it will be fulfilled, those who ignored it before will say, "The messengers of our Lord certainly came with the truth. Are there any intercessors who can plead on our behalf? Or can we be sent back so we may do 'good,' unlike what we used to do?" They will have certainly ruined themselves, and whatever 'gods' they fabricated will fail them

⁵⁴Indeed your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days, then established Himself on the Throne. He makes the day and night overlap in rapid succession. He created the sun, the moon, and the stars—all subjected by

His command. The creation and the command belong to Him 'alone'. Blessed is Allah—Lord of all worlds

⁵⁵Call upon your Lord humbly and secretly. Surely He does not like the transgressors

⁵⁶Do not spread corruption in the land after it has been set in order. And call upon Him with hope and fear. Indeed, Allah's mercy is always close to the good-doers

⁵⁷He is the One Who sends the winds ushering in His mercy. When they bear heavy clouds, We drive them to a lifeless land and then cause rain to fall, producing every type of fruit. Similarly, We will bring the dead to life, so perhaps you will be mindful

⁵⁸The fertile land produces abundantly by the Will of its Lord, whereas the infertile land hardly produces anything. This is how We vary 'Our' lessons to those who are thankful

⁵⁹Indeed, We sent Noah to his people. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah—you have no other god except Him. I truly fear for you the torment of a tremendous Day."

⁶⁰But the chiefs of his people said, "We surely see that you are clearly misguided."

⁶¹He replied, "O my people! I am not misguided! But I am a messenger from the Lord of all worlds

⁶²conveying to you my Lord's messages and giving you 'sincere' advice. And I know from Allah what you do not know

⁶³Do you find it astonishing that a reminder should come to you from your Lord through one of your own, warning you, so you may beware and perhaps be shown mercy?"

⁶⁴But they rejected him, so We saved him and those with him in the Ark, and drowned those who rejected Our signs. They were certainly a blind people

⁶⁵And to the people of 'Âd We sent their brother Hûd. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah—you have no other god except Him. Will you not then fear Him?"

⁶⁶The disbelieving chiefs of his people responded, "We surely see you as a fool, and we certainly think you are a liar."

⁶⁷Hûd replied, "O my people! I am no fool! But I am a messenger from the Lord of all worlds

⁶⁸conveying to you my Lord's messages. And I am your sincere advisor

⁶⁹Do you find it astonishing that a reminder should come to you from your Lord through one of your own so he may warn

you? Remember that He made you successors after the people of Noah and increased you greatly in stature. So remember Allah's favours, so you may be successful."

⁷⁰They said, "Have you come to us so that we would worship Allah alone and abandon what our forefathers used to worship? Then bring us what you threaten us with, if what you say is true!"

⁷¹He said, "You will certainly be subjected to your Lord's torment and wrath. Do you dispute with me regarding the so-called gods which you and your forefathers have made up—a practice Allah has never authorized? Then wait! I too am waiting with you."

⁷²So We saved him and those with him by Our mercy and uprooted those who denied Our signs. They were not believers

⁷³And to the people of Thamûd We sent their brother Şâliḥ. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah—you have no other god except Him. A clear proof has come to you from your Lord: this is Allah's she-camel as a sign to you. So leave her to graze 'freely' on Allah's land and do not harm her, or else you will be overcome by a painful punishment

⁷⁴Remember when He made you successors after 'Âd and established you in the land—"and" you built palaces on its

plains and carved homes into mountains. So remember Allah's favours, and do not go about spreading corruption in the land."

⁷⁵The arrogant chiefs of his people asked the lowly who believed among them, "Are you certain that Şâliḥ has been sent by his Lord?" They replied, "We certainly believe in what he has been sent with."

⁷⁶The arrogant said, "We surely reject what you believe in."

⁷⁷Then they killed the she-camel—defying their Lord's command—and challenged 'Şâliḥ', "Bring us what you threaten us with, if you are 'truly' one of the messengers."

⁷⁸Then an 'overwhelming' earthquake struck them, and they fell lifeless in their homes

⁷⁹So he turned away from them, saying, "O my people! Surely I conveyed to you my Lord's message and gave you 'sincere' advice, but you do not like 'sincere' advisors."

⁸⁰And 'remember' when Lot scolded 'the men of' his people, 'saying,' "Do you commit a shameful deed that no man has ever done before

⁸¹You lust after men instead of women! You are certainly transgressors."

⁸²But his people's only response was to say, "Expel them from your land! They are a people who wish to remain chaste!"

⁸³So We saved him and his family except his wife, who was one of the doomed

⁸⁴We poured upon them a rain 'of brimstone'. See what was the end of the wicked

⁸⁵And to the people of Midian We sent their brother Shu'aib. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah—you have no other god except Him. A clear proof has already come to you from your Lord. So give just measure and weight, do not defraud people of their property, nor spread corruption in the land after it has been set in order. This is for your own good, if you are 'truly' believers

⁸⁶And do not lie in ambush on every road—threatening and hindering those who believe in Allah from His Path and striving to make it 'appear' crooked. Remember when you were few, then He increased you in number. And consider the fate of the corruptors

⁸⁷If some of you do believe in what I have been sent with while others do not, then be patient until Allah judges between us. He is the Best of Judges."

⁸⁸The arrogant chiefs of his people threatened, “O Shu’aib! We will certainly expel you and your fellow believers from our land, unless you return to our faith.” He replied, “Even if we hate it

⁸⁹We would surely be fabricating a lie against Allah if we were to return to your faith after Allah has saved us from it. It does not befit us to return to it unless it is the Will of Allah, our Lord. Our Lord has encompassed everything in ‘His’ knowledge. In Allah we trust. Our Lord! Judge between us and our people with truth. You are the best of those who judge.”

⁹⁰The disbelieving chiefs of his people threatened, “If you follow Shu’aib, you will surely be losers!”

⁹¹Then an ‘overwhelming’ earthquake struck them and they fell lifeless in their homes

⁹²Those who rejected Shu’aib were ‘wiped out’ as if they had never lived there. Those who rejected Shu’aib were the true losers

⁹³He turned away from them, saying, “O my people! Indeed, I have delivered to you the messages of my Lord and gave you ‘sincere’ advice. How can I then grieve for those who chose to disbelieve?”

⁹⁴Whenever We sent a prophet to a society, We afflicted its ‘disbelieving’ people with suffering and adversity, so perhaps they would be humbled

⁹⁵Then We changed their adversity to prosperity until they flourished and argued ‘falsely’, “Our forefathers ‘too’ had been visited by adversity and prosperity.” So We seized them by surprise, while they were unaware

⁹⁶Had the people of those societies been faithful and mindful ‘of Allah’, We would have overwhelmed them with blessings from heaven and earth. But they disbelieved, so We seized them for what they used to commit

⁹⁷Did the people of those societies feel secure that Our punishment would not come upon them by night while they were asleep

⁹⁸Or did they feel secure that Our punishment would not come upon them by day while they were at play

⁹⁹Did they feel secure against Allah’s planning? None would feel secure from Allah’s planning except the losers

¹⁰⁰Is it not clear to those who take over the land after ‘the destruction of’ its former residents that—if We will—We can

punish them 'too' for their sins and seal their hearts so they will not hear 'the truth'

¹⁰¹We have narrated to you 'O Prophet' some of the stories of those societies. Surely, their messengers came to them with clear proofs, but still they would not believe in what they had already denied. This is how Allah seals the hearts of the disbelievers

¹⁰²We did not find most of them true to their covenant. Rather, We found most of them truly rebellious

¹⁰³Then after them We sent Moses with Our signs to Pharaoh and his chiefs, but they wrongfully rejected them. See what was the end of the corruptors

¹⁰⁴And Moses said, "O Pharaoh! I am truly a messenger from the Lord of all worlds

¹⁰⁵obliged to say nothing about Allah except the truth. Indeed, I have come to you with clear proof from your Lord, so let the children of Israel go with me."

¹⁰⁶Pharaoh said, "If you have come with a sign, then bring it if what you say is true."

¹⁰⁷So Moses threw down his staff and—behold!—it became a real snake

108 Then he drew his hand 'out of his collar' and it was 'shining' white for all to see

109 The chiefs of Pharaoh's people said, "He is indeed a skilled magician

110 who seeks to drive you from your land." 'So Pharaoh asked,' "What do you propose?"

111 They replied, "Let him and his brother wait and send mobilizers to all cities

112 to bring you every clever magician."

113 The magicians came to Pharaoh, saying, "Shall we receive a 'suitable' reward if we prevail?"

114 He replied, "Yes, and you will certainly be among those closest to me."

115 They asked, "O Moses! Will you cast, or shall we be the first to cast?"

116 Moses said, "You first." So when they did, they deceived the eyes of the people, stunned them, and made a great display of magic

117 Then We inspired Moses, "Throw down your staff," and—behold!—it devoured the objects of their illusion

118 So the truth prevailed and their illusions failed

¹¹⁹So Pharaoh and his people were defeated right there and put to shame

¹²⁰And the magicians fell down, prostrating

¹²¹They declared, “We ‘now’ believe in the Lord of all worlds—

¹²²the Lord of Moses and Aaron.”

¹²³Pharaoh threatened, “How dare you believe in him before I give you permission? This must be a conspiracy you devised in the city to drive out its people, but soon you will see

¹²⁴I will certainly cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, then crucify you all.”

¹²⁵They responded, “Surely to our Lord we will ‘all’ return

¹²⁶Your rage towards us is only because we believed in the signs of our Lord when they came to us. Our Lord! Shower us with perseverance, and let us die while submitting ‘to You’.”

¹²⁷The chiefs of Pharaoh’s people protested, “Are you going to leave Moses and his people free to spread corruption in the land and abandon you and your gods?” He responded, “We will kill their sons and keep their women. We will completely dominate them.”

128 Moses reassured his people, “Seek Allah’s help and be patient. Indeed, the earth belongs to Allah ‘alone’. He grants it to whoever He chooses of His servants. The ultimate outcome belongs ‘only’ to the righteous.”

129 They complained, “We have always been oppressed—before and after you came to us ‘with the message’.” He replied, “Perhaps your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors in the land to see what you will do.”

130 Indeed, We afflicted Pharaoh’s people with famine and shortage of crops so they might come back ‘to their senses’

131 In times of prosperity, they said, “This is what we deserve,” but in adversity, they blamed it on Moses and those with him. Surely all is destined by Allah. Yet most of them did not know

132 They said, “No matter what sign you may bring to deceive us, we will never believe in you.”

133 So We plagued them with floods, locusts, lice, frogs, and blood—all as clear signs, but they persisted in arrogance and were a wicked people

134 When tormented, they pleaded, “O Moses! Pray to your Lord on our behalf, by virtue of the covenant He made with you. If you help remove this torment from us, we will cer-

tainly believe in you and let the Children of Israel go with you.”

135 But as soon as We removed the torment from them—until they met their inevitable fate—they broke their promise

136 So We inflicted punishment upon them, drowning them in the sea for denying Our signs and being heedless of them

137 And ‘so’ We made the oppressed people successors of the eastern and western lands, which We had showered with blessings. ‘In this way’ the noble Word of your Lord was fulfilled for the Children of Israel for what they had endured. And We destroyed what Pharaoh and his people constructed and what they established

138 We brought the Children of Israel across the sea and they came upon a people devoted to idols. They demanded, “O Moses! Make for us a god like their gods.” He replied, “Indeed, you are a people acting ignorantly

139 What they follow is certainly doomed to destruction and their deeds are in vain.”

140 He added, “Shall I seek for you a god other than Allah, while He has honoured you above the others?”

¹⁴¹And ‘remember’ when We rescued you from the people of Pharaoh, who afflicted you with dreadful torment—killing your sons and keeping your women. That was a severe test from your Lord

¹⁴²We appointed for Moses thirty nights then added another ten—completing his Lord’s term of forty nights. Moses commanded his brother Aaron, “Take my place among my people, do what is right, and do not follow the way of the corruptors.”

¹⁴³When Moses came at the appointed time and his Lord spoke to him, he asked, “My Lord! Reveal Yourself to me so I may see You.” Allah answered, “You cannot see Me! But look at the mountain. If it remains firm in its place, only then will you see Me.” When his Lord appeared to the mountain, He levelled it to dust and Moses collapsed unconscious. When he recovered, he cried, “Glory be to You! I turn to You in repentance and I am the first of the believers.”

¹⁴⁴Allah said, “O Moses! I have ‘already’ elevated you above all others by My messages and speech. So hold firmly to what I have given you and be grateful.”

¹⁴⁵We wrote for him on the Tablets ‘the fundamentals’ of everything; commandments and explanations of all things. ‘We

commanded, '“Hold to this firmly and ask your people to take the best of it. I will soon show 'all of' you the home of the rebellious

¹⁴⁶I will turn away from My signs those who act unjustly with arrogance in the land. And even if they were to see every sign, they still would not believe in them. If they see the Right Path, they will not take it. But if they see a crooked path, they will follow it. This is because they denied Our signs and were heedless of them

¹⁴⁷The deeds of those who deny Our signs and the meeting 'with Allah' in the Hereafter will be in vain. Will they be rewarded except for what they have done?”

¹⁴⁸In the absence of Moses, his people made from their 'golden' jewellery an idol of a calf that made a lowing sound. Did they not see that it could neither speak to them nor guide them to the 'Right' Path? Still they took it as a god and were wrongdoers

¹⁴⁹Later, when they were filled with remorse and realized they had gone astray, they cried, “If our Lord does not have mercy on us and forgive us, we will certainly be losers.”

¹⁵⁰Upon Moses' return to his people, 'totally' furious and sorrowful, he said, “What an evil thing you committed in my ab-

sence! Did you want to hasten your Lord's torment?" Then he threw down the Tablets and grabbed his brother by the hair, dragging him closer. Aaron pleaded, "O son of my mother! The people overpowered me and were about to kill me. So do not 'humiliate me and' make my enemies rejoice, nor count me among the wrongdoing people."

¹⁵¹Moses prayed, "My Lord! Forgive me and my brother! And admit us into Your mercy. You are the Most Merciful of the merciful."

¹⁵²Those who worshipped the calf will certainly be afflicted with Allah's wrath as well as disgrace in the life of this world. This is how We reward those who invent falsehood

¹⁵³But those who commit evil, then repent and become 'true' believers, your Lord will certainly be All-Forgiving, Most-Merciful

¹⁵⁴When Moses' anger subsided, he took up the Tablets whose text contained guidance and mercy for those who stand in awe of their Lord

¹⁵⁵Moses chose seventy men from among his people for Our appointment and, when they were seized by an earthquake, he cried, "My Lord! Had You willed, You could have destroyed them long ago, and me as well. Will You destroy us for what the foolish among us have done? This is only a test from

You—by which You allow whoever you will to stray and guide whoever You will. You are our Guardian. So forgive us and have mercy on us. You are the best forgiver

¹⁵⁶Ordain for us what is good in this life and the next. Indeed, we have turned to You 'in repentance'." Allah replied, "I will inflict My torment on whoever I will. But My mercy encompasses everything. I will ordain mercy for those who shun evil, pay alms-tax, and believe in Our revelations

¹⁵⁷"“They are' the ones who follow the Messenger, the unlettered Prophet, whose description they find in their Torah and the Gospel. He commands them to do good and forbids them from evil, permits for them what is lawful and forbids to them what is impure, and relieves them from their burdens and the shackles that bound them. 'Only' those who believe in him, honour and support him, and follow the light sent down to him will be successful.”

¹⁵⁸Say, 'O Prophet,' "O humanity! I am Allah's Messenger to you all. To Him 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. He gives life and causes death." So believe in Allah and His Messenger, the unlettered Prophet, who believes in Allah

and His revelations. And follow him, so you may be 'rightly' guided

159 There are some among the people of Moses who guide with the truth and establish justice accordingly

160 We divided them into twelve tribes—each as a community. And We revealed to Moses, when his people asked for water, “Strike the rock with your staff.” Then twelve springs gushed out. Each tribe knew its drinking place. We shaded them with clouds and sent down to them manna and quails, 'saying', “Eat from the good things We have provided for you.” They 'certainly' did not wrong Us, but wronged themselves

161 And 'remember' when it was said to them, “Enter this city 'of Jerusalem' and eat from wherever you please. Say, ‘Absolve us,’ and enter the gate with humility. We will forgive your sins, 'and' We will multiply the reward for the good-doers.”

162 But the wrongdoers among them changed the words they were commanded to say. So We sent down a punishment from the heavens upon them for their wrongdoing

163 Ask them 'O Prophet' about 'the people of' the town which was by the sea, who broke the Sabbath. During the Sabbath, 'abundant' fish would come to them clearly visible, but on

other days the fish were never seen. In this way We tested them for their rebelliousness

¹⁶⁴When some of 'the righteous among' them questioned 'their fellow Sabbath-keepers', "Why do you 'bother to' warn those 'Sabbath-breakers' who will either be destroyed or severely punished by Allah?" They replied, "Just to be free from your Lord's blame, and so perhaps they may abstain."

¹⁶⁵When they ignored the warning they were given, We rescued those who used to warn against evil and overtook the wrongdoers with a dreadful punishment for their rebelliousness

¹⁶⁶But when they stubbornly persisted in violation, We said to them, "Be disgraced apes!"

¹⁶⁷And 'remember, O Prophet,' when your Lord declared that He would send against them others who would make them suffer terribly until the Day of Judgment. Indeed, your Lord is swift in punishment, but He is certainly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁶⁸We dispersed them through the land in groups—some were righteous, others were less so. We tested them with prosperity and adversity, so perhaps they would return 'to the Right Path'

169 Then they were succeeded by other generations who inherited the Scripture. They indulged in unlawful gains, claiming, “We will be forgiven ‘after all’.” And if similar gain came their way, they would seize it. Was a covenant not taken from them in the Scripture that they would not say anything about Allah except the truth? And they were already well-versed in its teachings. But the ‘eternal’ Home of the Hereafter is far better for those mindful ‘of Allah’. Will you not then understand

170 As for those who firmly abide by the Scripture and establish prayer—surely We never discount the reward of those acting righteously

171 And ‘remember’ when We raised the mountain over them as if it were a cloud and they thought it would fall on them. ‘We said,’ “Hold firmly to that ‘Scripture’ which We have given you and observe its teachings so perhaps you will become mindful ‘of Allah’.”

172 And ‘remember’ when your Lord brought forth from the loins of the children of Adam their descendants and had them testify regarding themselves. ‘Allah asked,’ “Am I not your Lord?” They replied, “Yes, You are! We testify.” ‘He cau-

tioned,' "Now you have no right to say on Judgment Day, 'We were not aware of this.'

¹⁷³Nor say, 'It was our forefathers who had associated others 'with Allah in worship' and we, as their descendants, followed in their footsteps. Will you then destroy us for the falsehood they invented?'"

¹⁷⁴This is how We make our signs clear, so perhaps they will return 'to the Right Path'

¹⁷⁵And relate to them 'O Prophet' the story of the one to whom We gave Our signs, but he abandoned them, so Satan took hold of him, and he became a deviant

¹⁷⁶If We had willed, We would have elevated him with Our signs, but he clung to this life—following his evil desires. His example is that of a dog: if you chase it away, it pants, and if you leave it, it 'still' pants. This is the example of the people who deny Our signs. So narrate 'to them' stories 'of the past', so perhaps they will reflect

¹⁷⁷What an evil example of those who denied Our signs! They 'only' wronged their own souls

¹⁷⁸Whoever Allah guides is truly guided. And whoever He leaves to stray, they are the 'true' losers

¹⁷⁹Indeed, We have destined many jinn and humans for Hell. They have hearts they do not understand with, eyes they do not see with, and ears they do not hear with. They are like cattle. In fact, they are even less guided! Such 'people' are 'entirely' heedless

¹⁸⁰Allah has the Most Beautiful Names. So call upon Him by them, and keep away from those who abuse His Names. They will be punished for what they used to do

¹⁸¹And among those We created is a group that guides with the truth and establishes justice accordingly

¹⁸²As for those who deny Our signs, We will gradually draw them to destruction in ways they cannot comprehend

¹⁸³I 'only' delay their end for a while, but My planning is flawless

¹⁸⁴Have they not ever given it a thought? Their fellow man is not insane. He is only sent with a clear warning

¹⁸⁵Have they ever reflected on the wonders of the heavens and the earth, and everything Allah has created, and that perhaps their end is near? So what message after this 'Quran' would they believe in

¹⁸⁶Whoever Allah allows to stray, none can guide, leaving them to wander blindly in their defiance

¹⁸⁷They ask you 'O Prophet' regarding the Hour, "When will it be?" Say, "That knowledge is only with my Lord. He alone will reveal it when the time comes. It is too tremendous for the heavens and the earth and will only take you by surprise." They ask you as if you had full knowledge of it. Say, "That knowledge is only with Allah, but most people do not know."

¹⁸⁸Say, "I have no power to benefit or protect myself, except by the Will of Allah. If I had known the unknown, I would have benefited myself enormously, and no harm would have ever touched me. I am only a warner and deliverer of good news for those who believe."

¹⁸⁹He is the One Who created you from a single soul, then from it made its spouse so he may find comfort in her. After he had been united with her, she carried a light burden that developed gradually. When it grew heavy, they prayed to Allah, their Lord, "If you grant us good offspring, we will certainly be grateful."

¹⁹⁰But when He granted their descendants good offspring, they associated false gods in what He has given them. Exalted is Allah above what they associate 'with Him'

¹⁹¹Do they associate 'with Allah' those 'idols' which cannot create anything, but are in fact created

¹⁹²which cannot help them, or even help themselves

¹⁹³And if you 'idolaters' call upon them for guidance, they cannot respond to you. It is all the same whether you call them or remain silent

¹⁹⁴Those 'idols' you invoke besides Allah are created beings like yourselves. So call upon them and see if they will answer you, if your claims are true

¹⁹⁵Do they have feet to walk with? Or hands to hold with? Or eyes to see with? Or ears to hear with? Say, 'O Prophet,' "Call upon your associate-gods and conspire against me without delay

¹⁹⁶"Indeed, my Protector is Allah Who has revealed this Book. For He 'alone' protects the righteous

¹⁹⁷But those 'false gods' you call besides Him can neither help you nor even themselves."

¹⁹⁸If you 'idolaters' call them to guidance, they cannot hear. And you 'O Prophet' may see them facing towards you, but they cannot see

¹⁹⁹Be gracious, enjoin what is right, and turn away from those who act ignorantly

²⁰⁰If you are tempted by Satan, then seek refuge with Allah. Surely He is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²⁰¹Indeed, when Satan whispers to those mindful 'of Allah', they remember 'their Lord' then they start to see 'things' clearly

²⁰²But the devils persistently plunge their 'human' associates deeper into wickedness, sparing no effort

²⁰³If you 'O Prophet' do not bring them a sign 'which they demanded', they ask, "Why do you not make it yourself?" Say, "I only follow what is revealed to me from my Lord. This 'Quran' is an insight from your Lord—a guide and a mercy for those who believe."

²⁰⁴When the Quran is recited, listen to it attentively and be silent, so you may be shown mercy

²⁰⁵Remember your Lord inwardly with humility and reverence and in a moderate tone of voice, both morning and evening. And do not be one of the heedless

²⁰⁶Surely those 'angels' nearest to your Lord are not too proud to worship Him. They glorify Him. And to Him they prostrate

Al-Anfāl

The Spoils of War • 75 verses

¹They ask you 'O Prophet' regarding the spoils of war. Say, "Their distribution is decided by Allah and His Messenger. So be mindful of Allah, settle your affairs, and obey Allah and His Messenger if you are 'true' believers."

²The 'true' believers are only those whose hearts tremble at the remembrance of Allah, whose faith increases when His revelations are recited to them, and who put their trust in their Lord

³'They are' those who establish prayer and donate from what We have provided for them

⁴It is they who are the true believers. They will have elevated ranks, forgiveness, and an honourable provision from their Lord

⁵Similarly, when your Lord brought you ‘O Prophet’ out of your home for a just cause, a group of believers was totally against it

⁶They disputed with you about the truth after it had been made clear, as if they were being driven to death with their eyes wide open

⁷‘Remember, O believers,’ when Allah promised ‘to give’ you the upper hand over either target, you wished to capture the unarmed party. But it was Allah’s Will to establish the truth by His Words and uproot the disbelievers

⁸to firmly establish the truth and wipe out falsehood—even to the dismay of the wicked

⁹‘Remember’ when you cried out to your Lord for help, He answered, “I will reinforce you with a thousand angels—followed by many others.”

¹⁰And Allah made this a sign of victory and reassurance to your hearts. Victory comes only from Allah. Surely Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

¹¹‘Remember’ when He caused drowsiness to overcome you, giving you serenity. And He sent down rain from the sky to

purify you, free you from Satan's whispers, strengthen your hearts, and make 'your' steps firm

¹²'Remember, O Prophet,' when your Lord revealed to the angels, "I am with you. So make the believers stand firm. I will cast horror into the hearts of the disbelievers. So strike their necks and strike their fingertips."

¹³This is because they defied Allah and His Messenger. And whoever defies Allah and His Messenger, then 'know that' Allah is surely severe in punishment

¹⁴That 'worldly punishment' is yours, so taste it! Then the disbelievers will suffer the torment of the Fire

¹⁵O believers! When you face the disbelievers in battle, never turn your backs to them

¹⁶And whoever does so on such an occasion—unless it is a manoeuvre or to join their own troops—will earn the displeasure of Allah, and their home will be Hell. What an evil destination

¹⁷It was not you 'believers' who killed them, but it was Allah Who did so. Nor was it you 'O Prophet' who threw 'a handful of sand at the disbelievers', but it was Allah Who did so,

rendering the believers a great favour. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

¹⁸As such, Allah frustrates the evil plans of the disbelievers

¹⁹If you 'Meccans' sought judgment, now it has come to you. And if you cease, it will be for your own good. But if you persist, We will persist. And your forces—no matter how numerous they might be—will not benefit you whatsoever. For Allah is certainly with the believers

²⁰O believers! Obey Allah and His Messenger and do not turn away from him while you hear 'his call'

²¹Do not be like those who say, "We hear," but in fact they are not listening

²²Indeed, the worst of all beings in the sight of Allah are the 'wilfully' deaf and dumb, who do not understand

²³Had Allah known any goodness in them, He would have certainly made them hear. 'But' even if He had made them hear, they would have surely turned away heedlessly

²⁴O believers! Respond to Allah and His Messenger when he calls you to that which gives you life. And know that Allah stands between a person and their heart, and that to Him you will all be gathered

²⁵Beware of a trial that will not only affect the wrongdoers among you. And know that Allah is severe in punishment

²⁶Remember when you had been vastly outnumbered and oppressed in the land, constantly in fear of attacks by your enemy, then He sheltered you, strengthened you with His help, and provided you with good things so perhaps you would be thankful

²⁷O believers! Do not betray Allah and the Messenger, nor betray your trusts knowingly

²⁸And know that your wealth and your children are only a test and that with Allah is a great reward

²⁹O believers! If you are mindful of Allah, He will grant you a standard 'to distinguish between right and wrong', absolve you of your sins, and forgive you. And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

³⁰And 'remember, O Prophet,' when the disbelievers conspired to capture, kill, or exile you. They planned, but Allah also planned. And Allah is the best of planners

³¹Whenever Our revelations are recited to them, they challenge 'you', "We have already heard 'the recitation'. If we

wanted, we could have easily produced something similar. This 'Quran' is nothing but ancient fables!"

³²And 'remember' when they prayed, "O Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain down stones upon us from the sky or overcome us with a painful punishment."

³³But Allah would never punish them while you 'O Prophet' were in their midst. Nor would He ever punish them if they prayed for forgiveness

³⁴And why should Allah not punish them while they hinder pilgrims from the Sacred Mosque, claiming to be its rightful guardians? None has the right to guardianship except those mindful 'of Allah', but most pagans do not know

³⁵Their prayer at the Sacred House was nothing but whistling and clapping. So taste the punishment for your disbelief

³⁶Surely the disbelievers spend their wealth to hinder others from the Path of Allah. They will continue to spend to the point of regret. Then they will be defeated and the disbelievers will be driven into Hell

³⁷so Allah may separate the evil from the good. He will pile up the evil ones all together and then cast them into Hell. They are the 'true' losers

³⁸Tell the disbelievers that if they desist, their past will be forgiven. But if they persist, then they have an example in those destroyed before them

³⁹Fight against them until there is no more persecution—and ‘your’ devotion will be entirely to Allah. But if they desist, then surely Allah is All-Seeing of what they do

⁴⁰And if they do not comply, then know that Allah is your Protector. What an excellent Protector, and what an excellent Helper

⁴¹Know that whatever spoils you take, one-fifth is for Allah and the Messenger, his close relatives, orphans, the poor, and ‘needy’ travellers, if you ‘truly’ believe in Allah and what We revealed to Our servant on that decisive day when the two armies met ‘at Badr’. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁴²‘Remember’ when you were on the near side of the valley, your enemy on the far side, and the caravan was below you. Even if the two armies had made an appointment ‘to meet’, both would have certainly missed it. Still it transpired so Allah may establish what He had destined—that those who were to perish and those who were to survive might do so after the truth had been made clear to both. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁴³Remember, O Prophet, when Allah showed them in your dream as few in number. Had He shown them to you as many, you 'believers' would have certainly faltered and disputed in the matter. But Allah spared you 'from that'. Surely He knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁴⁴Then when your armies met, Allah made them appear as few in your eyes, and made you appear as few in theirs, so Allah may establish what He had destined. And to Allah 'all' matters will be returned 'for judgment'

⁴⁵O believers! When you face an enemy, stand firm and remember Allah often so you may triumph

⁴⁶Obey Allah and His Messenger and do not dispute with one another, or you would be discouraged and weakened. Persevere! Surely Allah is with those who persevere

⁴⁷Do not be like those 'pagans' who left their homes arrogantly, only to be seen by people and to hinder others from Allah's Path. And Allah is Fully Aware of what they do

⁴⁸And 'remember' when Satan made their 'evil' deeds appealing to them, and said, "No one can overcome you today. I am surely by your side." But when the two forces faced off, he cowered and said, "I have absolutely nothing to do with

you. I certainly see what you do not see. I truly fear Allah, for Allah is severe in punishment.”

⁴⁹‘Remember’ when the hypocrites and those with sickness in their hearts said, “These ‘believers’ are deluded by their faith.” But whoever puts their trust in Allah, surely Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁵⁰If only you could see when the angels take the souls of the disbelievers, beating their faces and backs, ‘saying,’ “Taste the torment of burning

⁵¹This is ‘the reward’ for what your hands have done. And Allah is never unjust to ‘His’ creation.”

⁵²Their fate is that of the people of Pharaoh and those before them—they all disbelieved in Allah’s signs, so Allah seized them for their sins. Indeed, Allah is All-Powerful, severe in punishment

⁵³This is because Allah would never discontinue His favour to a people until they discontinue their faith. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁵⁴That was the case with Pharaoh’s people and those before them—they all rejected the signs of their Lord, so We de-

stroyed them for their sins and drowned Pharaoh's people.
They were all wrongdoers

⁵⁵Indeed, the worst of all beings in the sight of Allah are those
who persist in disbelief, never to have faith—

⁵⁶'namely' those with whom you 'O Prophet' have entered
into treaties, but they violate them every time, not fearing
the consequences

⁵⁷If you ever encounter them in battle, make a fearsome ex-
ample of them, so perhaps those who would follow them may
be deterred

⁵⁸And if you 'O Prophet' see signs of betrayal by a people,
respond by openly terminating your treaty with them. Surely
Allah does not like those who betray

⁵⁹Do not let those disbelievers think they are not within reach.
They will have no escape

⁶⁰Prepare against them what you 'believers' can of 'military'
power and cavalry to deter Allah's enemies and your ene-
mies as well as other enemies unknown to you but known to
Allah. Whatever you spend in the cause of Allah will be paid
to you in full and you will not be wronged

⁶¹If the enemy is inclined towards peace, make peace with them. And put your trust in Allah. Indeed, He 'alone' is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁶²But if their intention is only to deceive you, then Allah is certainly sufficient for you. He is the One Who has supported you with His help and with the believers

⁶³He brought their hearts together. Had you spent all the riches in the earth, you could not have united their hearts. But Allah has united them. Indeed, He is Almighty, All-Wise

⁶⁴O Prophet! Allah is sufficient for you and for the believers who follow you

⁶⁵O Prophet! Motivate the believers to fight. If there are twenty steadfast among you, they will overcome two hundred. And if there are one hundred of you, they will overcome one thousand of the disbelievers, for they are a people who do not comprehend

⁶⁶Now Allah has lightened your burden, for He knows that there is weakness in you. So if there are a hundred steadfast among you, they will overcome two hundred. And if there be one thousand, they will overcome two thousand, by Allah's Will. And Allah is with the steadfast

⁶⁷It is not fit for a prophet that he should take captives until he has thoroughly subdued the land. You 'believers' settled with the fleeting gains of this world, while Allah's aim 'for you' is the Hereafter. Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁶⁸Had it not been for a prior decree from Allah, you would have certainly been disciplined with a tremendous punishment for whatever 'ransom' you have taken

⁶⁹Now enjoy what you have taken, for it is lawful and good. And be mindful of Allah. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁷⁰O Prophet! Tell the captives in your custody, "If Allah finds goodness in your hearts, He will give you better than what has been taken from you, and forgive you. For Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

⁷¹But if their intention is only to betray you 'O Prophet', they sought to betray Allah before. But He gave you power over them. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁷²Those who believed, emigrated, and strived with their wealth and lives in the cause of Allah, as well as those who gave them shelter and help—they are truly guardians of one another. As for those who believed but did not emigrate, you have no obligations to them until they emigrate. But if they seek your

help 'against persecution' in faith, it is your obligation to help them, except against people bound with you in a treaty. Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

⁷³As for the disbelievers, they are guardians of one another. And unless you 'believers' act likewise, there will be great oppression and corruption in the land

⁷⁴Those who believed, migrated, and struggled in the cause of Allah, and those who gave 'them' shelter and help, they are the true believers. They will have forgiveness and an honourable provision

⁷⁵And those who later believed, migrated, and struggled alongside you, they are also with you. But only blood relatives are now entitled to inherit from one another, as ordained by Allah. Surely Allah has 'full' knowledge of everything

At-Tawbah

The Repentance • 129 verses

¹‘This is’ a discharge from all obligations, by Allah and His Messenger, to the polytheists you ‘believers’ have entered into treaties with

²“You ‘polytheists’ may travel freely through the land for four months, but know that you will have no escape from Allah, and that Allah will disgrace the disbelievers.”

³A declaration from Allah and His Messenger ‘is made’ to all people on the day of the greater pilgrimage that Allah and His Messenger are free of the polytheists. So if you ‘pagans’ repent, it will be better for you. But if you turn away, then know that you will have no escape from Allah. And give good news ‘O Prophet’ to the disbelievers of a painful punishment

⁴As for the polytheists who have honoured every term of their treaty with you and have not supported an enemy against you, honour your treaty with them until the end of its term. Surely Allah loves those who are mindful ‘of Him’

⁵But once the Sacred Months have passed, kill the polytheists 'who violated their treaties' wherever you find them, capture them, besiege them, and lie in wait for them on every way. But if they repent, perform prayers, and pay alms-tax, then set them free. Indeed, Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶And if anyone from the polytheists asks for your protection 'O Prophet', grant it to them so they may hear the Word of Allah, then escort them to a place of safety, for they are a people who have no knowledge

⁷How can such polytheists have a treaty with Allah and His Messenger, except those you have made a treaty with at the Sacred Mosque? So, as long as they are true to you, be true to them. Indeed Allah loves those who are mindful 'of Him'

⁸How 'can they have a treaty'? If they were to have the upper hand over you, they would have no respect for kinship or treaty. They only flatter you with their tongues, but their hearts are in denial, and most of them are rebellious

⁹They chose a fleeting gain over Allah's revelations, hindering 'others' from His Way. Evil indeed is what they have done

¹⁰They do not honour the bonds of kinship or treaties with the believers. It is they who are the transgressors

¹¹But if they repent, perform prayer, and pay alms-tax, then they are your brothers in faith. This is how We make the revelations clear for people of knowledge

¹²But if they break their oaths after making a pledge and attack your faith, then fight the champions of disbelief—who never honour their oaths—so perhaps they will desist

¹³Will you not fight those who have broken their oaths, conspired to expel the Messenger 'from Mecca', and attacked you first? Do you fear them? Allah is more deserving of your fear, if you are 'true' believers

¹⁴'So' fight them and Allah will punish them at your hands, put them to shame, help you overcome them, and soothe the hearts of the believers—

¹⁵removing rage from their hearts. And Allah pardons whoever He wills. For Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹⁶Do you 'believers' think that you will be left without Allah proving who among you 'truly' struggles 'in His cause' and never takes trusted allies other than Allah, His Messenger, or the believers? And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹⁷It is not for the polytheists to maintain the mosques of Allah while they openly profess disbelief. Their deeds are void, and they will be in the Fire forever

¹⁸The mosques of Allah should only be maintained by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and fear none but Allah. It is right to hope that they will be among the 'truly' guided

¹⁹Do you 'pagans' consider providing the pilgrims with water and maintaining the Sacred Mosque as equal to believing in Allah and the Last Day and struggling in the cause of Allah? They are not equal in Allah's sight. And Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

²⁰Those who have believed, emigrated, and strived in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives are greater in rank in the sight of Allah. It is they who will triumph

²¹Their Lord gives them good news of His mercy, pleasure, and Gardens with everlasting bliss

²²to stay there for ever and ever. Surely with Allah is a great reward

²³O believers! Do not take your parents and siblings as trusted allies if they choose disbelief over belief. And whoever of you does so, they are the 'true' wrongdoers

²⁴Say, 'O Prophet,' "If your parents and children and siblings and spouses and extended family and the wealth you have acquired and the trade you fear will decline and the homes you cherish—"if all these" are more beloved to you than Allah and His Messenger and struggling in His Way, then wait until Allah brings about His Will. Allah does not guide the rebellious people."

²⁵Indeed Allah has given you 'believers' victory on many battlefields, even at the Battle of Ḥunain when you took pride in your great numbers, but they proved of no advantage to you. The earth, despite its vastness, seemed to close in on you, then you turned back in retreat

²⁶Then Allah sent down His reassurance upon His Messenger and the believers, and sent down forces you could not see, and punished those who disbelieved. Such was the reward of the disbelievers

²⁷Then afterwards Allah will turn in grace to whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

28O believers! Indeed, the polytheists are 'spiritually' impure, so they should not approach the Sacred Mosque after this year. If you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you out of His bounty, if He wills. Surely, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

29Fight those who do not believe in Allah and the Last Day, nor comply with what Allah and His Messenger have forbidden, nor embrace the religion of truth from among those who were given the Scripture, until they pay the tax, willingly submitting, fully humbled

30The Jews say, "Ezra is the son of Allah," while the Christians say, "The Messiah is the son of Allah." Such are their baseless assertions, only parroting the words of earlier disbelievers. May Allah condemn them! How can they be deluded 'from the truth'

31They have taken their rabbis and monks as well as the Messiah, son of Mary, as lords besides Allah, even though they were commanded to worship none but One God. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. Glorified is He above what they associate 'with Him'

32They wish to extinguish Allah's light with their mouths, but Allah will only allow His light to be perfected, even to the dismay of the disbelievers

³³He is the One Who has sent His Messenger with ‘true’ guidance and the religion of truth, making it prevail over all others, even to the dismay of the polytheists

³⁴O believers! Indeed, many rabbis and monks consume people’s wealth wrongfully and hinder ‘others’ from the Way of Allah. Give good news of a painful torment to those who hoard gold and silver and do not spend it in Allah’s cause

³⁵The Day ‘will come’ when their treasure will be heated up in the Fire of Hell, and their foreheads, sides, and backs branded with it. ‘It will be said to them,’ “This is the treasure you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste what you hoarded!”

³⁶Indeed, the number of months ordained by Allah is twelve—in Allah’s Record since the day He created the heavens and the earth—of which four are sacred. That is the Right Way. So do not wrong one another during these months. And together fight the polytheists as they fight against you together. And know that Allah is with those mindful ‘of Him’

³⁷Reallocating the sanctity of ‘these’ months is an increase in disbelief, by which the disbelievers are led ‘far’ astray. They adjust the sanctity one year and uphold it in another, only to maintain the number of months sanctified by Allah, violating the very months Allah has made sacred. Their evil deeds

have been made appealing to them. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people

³⁸O believers! What is the matter with you that when you are asked to march forth in the cause of Allah, you cling firmly to 'your' land? Do you prefer the life of this world over the Hereafter? The enjoyment of this worldly life is insignificant compared to that of the Hereafter

³⁹If you do not march forth, He will afflict you with a painful torment and replace you with other people. You are not harming Him in the least. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁴⁰'It does not matter' if you 'believers' do not support him, for Allah did in fact support him when the disbelievers drove him out 'of Mecca' and he was only one of two. While they both were in the cave, he reassured his companion, "Do not worry; Allah is certainly with us." So Allah sent down His serenity upon the Prophet, supported him with forces you 'believers' did not see, and made the word of the disbelievers lowest, while the Word of Allah is supreme. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁴¹'O believers!' March forth whether it is easy or difficult for you, and strive with your wealth and your lives in the cause of Allah. That is best for you, if only you knew

⁴²Had the gain been within reach and the journey shorter, they would have followed you, but the distance seemed too long for them. And they will swear by Allah, “Had we been able, we would have certainly joined you.” They are ruining themselves. And Allah knows that they are surely lying

⁴³May Allah pardon you ‘O Prophet’! Why did you give them permission ‘to stay behind’ before those who told the truth were distinguished from those who were lying

⁴⁴Those who believe in Allah and the Last Day do not ask for exemption from striving with their wealth and their lives. And Allah has perfect knowledge of those who are mindful ‘of Him’

⁴⁵No one would ask for exemption except those who have no faith in Allah or the Last Day, and whose hearts are in doubt, so they are torn by their doubts

⁴⁶Had they ‘really’ intended to march forth, they would have made preparations for it. But Allah disliked that they should go, so He let them lag behind, and it was said ‘to them’, “Stay with those ‘helpless’ who remain behind.”

⁴⁷Had they gone forth with you ‘believers’, they would have been nothing but trouble for you, and would have scrambled around, seeking to spread discord in your midst. And some

of you would have eagerly listened to them. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of the wrongdoers

⁴⁸They had already sought to spread discord before and devised every 'possible' plot against you 'O Prophet', until the truth came and Allah's Will prevailed—much to their dismay

⁴⁹There are some of them who say, "Exempt me and do not expose me to temptation." They have already fallen into temptation. And Hell will surely engulf the disbelievers

⁵⁰If a blessing befalls you 'O Prophet', they grieve, but if a disaster befalls you, they say, "We took our precaution in advance," and turn away, rejoicing

⁵¹Say, "Nothing will ever befall us except what Allah has destined for us. He is our Protector." So in Allah let the believers put their trust

⁵²Say, "Are you awaiting anything to befall us except one of the two best things: 'victory or martyrdom'? But We are awaiting Allah to afflict you with torment either from Him or at our hands. So keep waiting! We too are waiting with you."

⁵³Say, 'O Prophet, '“Whether you' donate willingly or unwillingly, it will never be accepted from you, for you have been a rebellious people.”

⁵⁴And what prevented their donations from being accepted is that they have lost faith in Allah and His Messenger, they never come to prayer except half-heartedly, and they never donate except resentfully

⁵⁵So let neither their wealth nor children impress you 'O Prophet'. Allah only intends to torment them through these things in this worldly life, then their souls will depart while they are disbelievers

⁵⁶They swear by Allah that they are part of you, but they are not. They only say so out of fear

⁵⁷If only they could find a refuge, or a cave, or any hiding-place, they would rush headlong towards it

⁵⁸There are some of them who are critical of your distribution of alms 'O Prophet'. If they are given some of it they are pleased, but if not they are enraged

⁵⁹If only they had been content with what Allah and His Messenger had given them and said, “Allah is sufficient for us!

Allah will grant us out of His bounty, and so will His Messenger. To Allah 'alone' we turn with hope."

⁶⁰Alms-tax is only for the poor and the needy, for those employed to administer it, for those whose hearts are attracted 'to the faith', for 'freeing' slaves, for those in debt, for Allah's cause, and for 'needy' travellers. 'This is' an obligation from Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁶¹And there are others who hurt the Prophet by saying, "He listens to anyone." Say, 'O Prophet,' "He listens to what is best for you. He believes in Allah, has faith in the believers, and is a mercy for those who believe among you." Those who hurt Allah's Messenger will suffer a painful punishment

⁶²They swear by Allah to you 'believers' in order to please you, while it is the pleasure of Allah and His Messenger they should seek, if they are 'true' believers

⁶³Do they not know that whoever opposes Allah and His Messenger will be in the Fire of Hell forever? That is the ultimate disgrace

⁶⁴The hypocrites fear that a sûrah should be revealed about them, exposing what is in their hearts. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Keep mocking! Allah will definitely bring to light what you fear."

⁶⁵If you question them, they will certainly say, “We were only talking idly and joking around.” Say, “Was it Allah, His revelations, and His Messenger that you ridiculed?”

⁶⁶Make no excuses! You have lost faith after your belief. If We pardon a group of you, We will punish others for their wickedness

⁶⁷The hypocrites, both men and women, are all alike: they encourage what is evil, forbid what is good, and withhold ‘what is in’ their hands. They neglected Allah, so He neglected them. Surely the hypocrites are the rebellious

⁶⁸Allah has promised the hypocrites, both men and women, and the disbelievers an everlasting stay in the Fire of Hell—it is sufficient for them. Allah has condemned them, and they will suffer a never-ending punishment

⁶⁹‘You hypocrites are’ like those ‘disbelievers’ before you. They were far superior to you in might and more abundant in wealth and children. They enjoyed their share in this life. You have enjoyed your share, just as they did. And you have engaged in idle talk, just as they did. Their deeds have become void in this world and the Hereafter. And it is they who are the ‘true’ losers

⁷⁰Have they not received the stories of those ‘destroyed’ before them: the people of Noah, ‘Âd, and Thamûd, the people of Abraham, the residents of Midian, and the overturned cities ‘of Lot’? Their messengers came to them with clear proofs. Allah would have never wronged them, but it was they who wronged themselves

⁷¹The believers, both men and women, are guardians of one another. They encourage good and forbid evil, establish prayer and pay alms-tax, and obey Allah and His Messenger. It is they who will be shown Allah’s mercy. Surely Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁷²Allah has promised the believers, both men and women, Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever, and splendid homes in the Gardens of Eternity, and—above all—the pleasure of Allah. That is ‘truly’ the ultimate triumph

⁷³O Prophet! Struggle against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be firm with them. Hell will be their home. What an evil destination

⁷⁴They swear by Allah that they never said anything ‘blasphemous’, while they did in fact utter a blasphemy, lost faith after accepting Islam, and plotted what they could not carry out. It is only through resentment that they pay Allah and

His Messenger back for enriching them out of His bounty! If they repent, it will be better for them. But if they turn away, Allah will torment them with a painful punishment in this world and the Hereafter, and they will have no one on earth to protect or help them

⁷⁵And there are some who had made a vow to Allah: "If He gives us from His bounty, we will surely spend in charity and be of the righteous."

⁷⁶But when He gave them out of His bounty, they withheld it and turned away indifferently

⁷⁷So He caused hypocrisy to plague their hearts until the Day they will meet Him, for breaking their promise to Allah and for their lies

⁷⁸Do they not know that Allah 'fully' knows their 'evil' thoughts and secret talks, and that Allah is the Knower of all unseen

⁷⁹'There are' those who slander 'some of' the believers for donating liberally and mock others for giving only the little they can afford. Allah will throw their mockery back at them, and they will suffer a painful punishment

⁸⁰'It does not matter' whether you 'O Prophet' pray for them to be forgiven or not. Even if you pray for their forgiveness

seventy times, Allah will never forgive them. That is because they have lost faith in Allah and His Messenger. And Allah does not guide the rebellious people

⁸¹Those 'hypocrites' who remained behind rejoiced for doing so in defiance of the Messenger of Allah and hated 'the prospect of' striving with their wealth and their lives in the cause of Allah. They said 'to one another', "Do not march forth in the heat." Say, 'O Prophet,' "The Fire of Hell is far hotter!" If only they could comprehend

⁸²So let them laugh a little—they will weep much as a reward for what they have committed

⁸³If Allah returns you 'O Prophet' to a group of them and they ask to go forth with you, say, "You will not ever go forth or fight an enemy along with me. You preferred to stay behind the first time, so stay with those 'helpless' who remain behind."

⁸⁴And do not ever offer 'funeral' prayers for any of their dead, nor stand by their grave 'at burial', for they have lost faith in Allah and His Messenger and died rebellious

⁸⁵And let neither their wealth nor children impress you 'O Prophet'. Allah only intends to torment them through these

things in this world, and 'then' their souls will depart while they are disbelievers

⁸⁶Whenever a sûrah is revealed stating, "Believe in Allah and struggle along with His Messenger," the rich among them would ask to be exempt, saying, "Leave us with those who remain behind."

⁸⁷They preferred to stay behind with the helpless, and their hearts have been sealed so they do not comprehend

⁸⁸But the Messenger and the believers with him strived with their wealth and their lives. They will have all the best, and it is they who will be successful

⁸⁹Allah has prepared for them Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever. That is the ultimate triumph

⁹⁰Some nomadic Arabs 'also' came with excuses, seeking exemption. And those who were untrue to Allah and His Messenger remained behind 'with no excuse'. The unfaithful among them will be afflicted with a painful punishment

⁹¹There is no blame on the weak, the sick, or those lacking the means 'if they stay behind', as long as they are true to Allah and His Messenger. There is no blame on the good-doers. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁹²Nor 'is there any blame on' those who came to you 'O Prophet' for mounts, then when you said, "I can find no mounts for you," they left with eyes overflowing with tears out of grief that they had nothing to contribute

⁹³Blame is only on those who seek exemption from you although they have the means. They preferred to stay behind with the helpless, and Allah has sealed their hearts so they do not realize 'the consequences'

⁹⁴They will make excuses to you 'believers' when you return to them. Say, "Make no excuses, 'for' we will not believe you. Allah has already informed us about your 'true' state 'of faith'. Your 'future' deeds will be observed by Allah and His Messenger as well. And you will be returned to the Knower of the seen and unseen, then He will inform you of what you used to do."

⁹⁵When you return, they will swear to you by Allah so that you may leave them alone. So leave them alone—they are truly evil. Hell will be their home as a reward for what they have committed

⁹⁶They will swear to you in order to please you. And even if you are pleased with them, Allah will never be pleased with the rebellious people

⁹⁷The nomadic Arabs 'around Medina' are far worse in disbelief and hypocrisy, and less likely to know the laws revealed by Allah to His Messenger. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁹⁸And among the nomads are those who consider what they donate to be a loss and await your misfortune. May ill-fortune befall them! And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁹⁹However, among the nomadic Arabs are those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, and consider what they donate as a means of coming closer to Allah and 'receiving' the prayers of the Messenger. It will certainly bring them closer. Allah will admit them into His mercy. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁰⁰As for the foremost—the first of the Emigrants and the Helpers—and those who follow them in goodness, Allah is pleased with them and they are pleased with Him. And He has prepared for them Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. That is the ultimate triumph

¹⁰¹Some of the nomads around you 'believers' are hypocrites, as are some of the people of Medina. They have mastered hypocrisy. They are not known to you 'O Prophet'; they are known to Us. We will punish them twice 'in this world', then

they will be brought back 'to their Lord' for a tremendous punishment

102 Some others have confessed their wrongdoing: they have mixed goodness with evil. It is right to hope that Allah will turn to them in mercy. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

103 Take from their wealth 'O Prophet' charity to purify and bless them, and pray for them—surely your prayer is a source of comfort for them. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

104 Do they not know that Allah alone accepts the repentance of His servants and receives 'their' charity, and that Allah alone is the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

105 Tell 'them, O Prophet', "Do as you will. Your deeds will be observed by Allah, His Messenger, and the believers. And you will be returned to the Knower of the seen and unseen, then He will inform you of what you used to do."

106 And some others are left for Allah's decision, either to punish them or turn to them in mercy. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

107 There are also those 'hypocrites' who set up a mosque 'only' to cause harm, promote disbelief, divide the believers, and

as a base for those who had previously fought against Allah and His Messenger. They will definitely swear, “We intended nothing but good,” but Allah bears witness that they are surely liars

108Do not ‘O Prophet’ ever pray in it. Certainly, a mosque founded on righteousness from the first day is more worthy of your prayers. In it are men who love to be purified. And Allah loves those who purify themselves

109Which is better: those who laid the foundation of their building on the fear and pleasure of Allah, or those who did so on the edge of a crumbling cliff that tumbled down with them into the Fire of Hell? And Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

110The building which they erected will never cease to fuel hypocrisy in their hearts until their hearts are torn apart. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

111Allah has indeed purchased from the believers their lives and wealth in exchange for Paradise. They fight in the cause of Allah and kill or are killed. This is a true promise binding on Him in the Torah, the Gospel, and the Quran. And whose promise is truer than Allah’s? So rejoice in the exchange you have made with Him. That is ‘truly’ the ultimate triumph

112It is the believers' who repent, who are devoted to worship, who praise 'their Lord', who fast, who bow down and prostrate themselves, who encourage good and forbid evil, and who observe the limits set by Allah. And give good news to the believers

113It is not 'proper' for the Prophet and the believers to seek forgiveness for the polytheists, even if they were close relatives, after it has become clear to the believers that they are bound for the Hellfire

114As for Abraham's prayer for his father's forgiveness, it was only in fulfilment of a promise he had made to him. But when it became clear to Abraham that his father was an enemy of Allah, he broke ties with him. Abraham was truly tender-hearted, forbearing

115Allah would never consider a people deviant after He has guided them, until He makes clear to them what they must avoid. Surely Allah has 'full' knowledge of everything

116Indeed, to Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He gives life and causes death. And besides Allah you have no guardian or helper

117Allah has certainly turned in mercy to the Prophet as well as the Emigrants and the Helpers who stood by him in the

time of hardship, after the hearts of a group of them had almost faltered. He then accepted their repentance. Surely He is Ever Gracious and Most Merciful to them

118 And ʾAllah has also turned in mercy toʾ the three who had remained behind, ʾwhose guilt distressed themʾ until the earth, despite its vastness, seemed to close in on them, and their souls were torn in anguish. They knew there was no refuge from Allah except in Him. Then He turned to them in mercy so that they might repent. Surely Allah ʾaloneʾ is the Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

119 O believers! Be mindful of Allah and be with the truthful

120 It was not ʾproperʾ for the people of Medina and the nomadic Arabs around them to avoid marching with the Messenger of Allah or to prefer their own lives above his. That is because whenever they suffer from thirst, fatigue, or hunger in the cause of Allah; or tread on a territory, unnerving the disbelievers; or inflict any loss on an enemy—it is written to their credit as a good deed. Surely Allah never discounts the reward of the good-doers

121 And whenever they make a donation, small or large, or cross a valley ʾin Allahʾs causeʾ—it is written to their credit,

so that Allah may grant them the best reward for what they used to do

¹²²‘However,’ it is not necessary for the believers to march forth all at once. Only a party from each group should march forth, leaving the rest to gain religious knowledge then enlighten their people when they return to them, so that they ‘too’ may beware ‘of evil’

¹²³O believers! Fight the disbelievers around you and let them find firmness in you. And know that Allah is with those mindful ‘of Him’

¹²⁴Whenever a sûrah is revealed, some of them ask ‘mockingly’, “Which of you has this increased in faith?” As for the believers, it has increased them in faith and they rejoice

¹²⁵But as for those with sickness in their hearts, it has increased them only in wickedness upon their wickedness, and they die as disbelievers

¹²⁶Do they not see that they are tried once or twice every year? Yet they neither repent nor do they learn a lesson

¹²⁷Whenever a sûrah is revealed, they look at one another, ‘saying,’ “Is anyone watching you?” Then they slip away. ‘It

is Allah 'Who' has turned their hearts away because they are a people who do not comprehend

128 There certainly has come to you a messenger from among yourselves. He is concerned by your suffering, anxious for your well-being, and gracious and merciful to the believers

129 But if they turn away, then say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah is sufficient for me. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. In Him I put my trust. And He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne."

Yūnus

Jonah • 109 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Ra. These are the verses of the Book, rich in wisdom

²Is it astonishing to people that We have sent revelation to a man from among themselves, 'instructing him,' "Warn humanity and give good news to the believers that they will have an honourable status with their Lord." Yet the disbelievers said, "Indeed, this 'man' is clearly a magician!"

³Surely your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days, then established Himself on the Throne, conducting every affair. None can intercede except by His permission. That is Allah—your Lord, so worship Him 'alone'. Will you not then be mindful

⁴To Him is your return all together. Allah's promise is 'always' true. Indeed, He originates the creation then resurrects it so that He may justly reward those who believe and

do good. But those who disbelieve will have a boiling drink and a painful punishment for their disbelief

⁵He is the One Who made the sun a radiant source and the moon a reflected light, with precisely ordained phases, so that you may know the number of years and calculation 'of time'. Allah did not create all this except for a purpose. He makes the signs clear for people of knowledge

⁶Surely in the alternation of the day and the night, and in all that Allah has created in the heavens and the earth, there are truly signs for those mindful 'of Him'

⁷Indeed, those who do not expect to meet Us, being pleased and content with this worldly life, and who are heedless of Our signs

⁸they will have the Fire as a home because of what they have committed

⁹Surely those who believe and do good, their Lord will guide them 'to Paradise' through their faith, rivers will flow under their feet in the Gardens of Bliss

¹⁰in which their prayer will be, "Glory be to You, O Allah!" and their greeting will be, "Peace!" and their closing prayer will be, "All praise is for Allah—Lord of all worlds!"

¹¹If Allah were to hasten evil for people as they wish to hasten good, they would have certainly been doomed. But We leave those who do not expect to meet Us to wander blindly in their defiance

¹²Whenever someone is touched by hardship, they cry out to Us, whether lying on their side, sitting, or standing. But when We relieve their hardship, they return to their old ways as if they had never cried to Us to remove any hardship! This is how the misdeeds of the transgressors have been made appealing to them

¹³We surely destroyed 'other' peoples before you when they did wrong, and their messengers came to them with clear proofs but they would not believe! This is how We reward the wicked people

¹⁴Then We made you their successors in the land to see how you would act

¹⁵When Our clear revelations are recited to them, those who do not expect to meet Us say 'to the Prophet', "Bring us a different Quran or make some changes in it." Say 'to them', "It is not for me to change it on my own. I only follow what is revealed to me. I fear, if I were to disobey my Lord, the punishment of a tremendous Day."

¹⁶Say, “Had Allah willed, I would not have recited it to you, nor would He have made it known to you. I had lived my whole life among you before this ‘revelation’. Do you not understand?”

¹⁷Who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah or deny His revelations? Indeed, the wicked will never succeed

¹⁸They worship besides Allah others who can neither harm nor benefit them, and say, “These are our intercessors with Allah.” Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Are you informing Allah of something He does not know in the heavens or the earth? Glorified and Exalted is He above what they associate ‘with Him’!”

¹⁹Humanity was once nothing but a single community ‘of believers’, but then they differed. Had it not been for a prior decree from your Lord, their differences would have been settled ‘at once’

²⁰They ask, “Why has no ‘other’ sign been sent down to him from his Lord?” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “‘The knowledge of’ the unseen is with Allah alone. So wait! I too am waiting with you.”

²¹When We give people a taste of mercy after being afflicted with a hardship, they swiftly devise plots against Our rev-

elations! Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah is swifter in devising 'punishment'. Surely Our messenger-angels record whatever you devise."

²²He is the One Who enables you to travel through land and sea. And it so happens that you are on ships, sailing with a favourable wind, to the passengers' delight. Suddenly, the ships are overcome by a gale wind and those on board are overwhelmed by waves from every side, and they assume they are doomed. They cry out to Allah 'alone' in sincere devotion, "If You save us from this, we will certainly be grateful."

²³But as soon as He rescues them, they transgress in the land unjustly. O humanity! Your transgression is only against your own souls. 'There is only' brief enjoyment in this worldly life, then to Us is your return, and then We will inform you of what you used to do

²⁴The life of this world is just like rain We send down from the sky, producing a mixture of plants which humans and animals consume. Then just as the earth looks its best, perfectly beautified, and its people think they have full control over it, there comes to it Our command by night or by day, so

We mow it down as if it never flourished yesterday! This is how We make the signs clear for people who reflect

²⁵And Allah invites ‘all’ to the Home of Peace and guides whoever He wills to the Straight Path

²⁶Those who do good will have the finest reward and ‘even’ more. Neither gloom nor disgrace will cover their faces. It is they who will be the residents of Paradise. They will be there forever

²⁷As for those who commit evil, the reward of an evil deed is its equivalent. Humiliation will cover them—with no one to protect them from Allah—as if their faces were covered with patches of the night’s deep darkness. It is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

²⁸‘Consider’ the Day We will gather them all together then say to those who associated others ‘with Allah in worship’, “Stay in your places—you and your associate-gods.” We will separate them from each other, and their associate-gods will say, “It was not us that you worshipped

²⁹Allah is sufficient as a Witness between each of us that we were totally unaware of your worship.”

³⁰Then and there every soul will face 'the consequences of' what it had done. They all will be returned to Allah—their True Master. And whatever 'gods' they fabricated will fail them

³¹Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Who provides for you from heaven and earth? Who owns 'your' hearing and sight? Who brings forth the living from the dead and the dead from the living? And who conducts every affair?" They will 'surely' say, "Allah." Say, "Will you not then fear 'Him'?"

³²That is Allah—your True Lord. So what is beyond the truth except falsehood? How can you then be turned away?"

³³And so your Lord's decree has been proven true against the rebellious—that they will never believe

³⁴Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Can any of your associate-gods originate creation and then resurrect it?" Say, "'Only' Allah originates creation and then resurrects it. How can you then be deluded 'from the truth'?"

³⁵Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Can any of your associate-gods guide to the truth?" Say, "'Only' Allah guides to the truth." Who then is more worthy to be followed: the One Who guides to the truth or those who cannot find the way unless guided? What is the matter with you? How do you judge

³⁶Most of them follow nothing but 'inherited' assumptions. 'And' surely assumptions can in no way replace the truth. Allah is indeed All-Knowing of what they do

³⁷It is not 'possible' for this Quran to have been produced by anyone other than Allah. In fact, it is a confirmation of what came before, and an explanation of the Scripture. It is, without a doubt, from the Lord of all worlds

³⁸Or do they claim, "He made it up!"? Tell them 'O Prophet', "Produce one sûrah like it then, and seek help from whoever you can—other than Allah—if what you say is true!"

³⁹In fact, they 'hastily' rejected the Book without comprehending it and before the fulfilment of its warnings. Similarly, those before them were in denial. See then what was the end of the wrongdoers

⁴⁰Some of them will 'eventually' believe in it; others will not. And your Lord knows best the corruptors

⁴¹If they deny you, then say, "My deeds are mine and your deeds are yours. You are free of what I do and I am free of what you do!"

⁴²Some of them listen to what you say, but can you make the deaf hear even though they do not understand

⁴³And some of them look at you, but can you guide the blind even though they cannot see

⁴⁴Indeed, Allah does not wrong people in the least, but it is people who wrong themselves

⁴⁵On the Day He will gather them, it will be as if they had not stayed 'in the world' except for an hour of a day, 'as though they were only' getting to know one another. Lost indeed will be those who denied the meeting with Allah, and were not 'rightly' guided

⁴⁶Whether We show you 'O Prophet' some of what We threaten them with, or cause you to die 'before that', to Us is their return and Allah is a Witness over what they do

⁴⁷And for every community there is a messenger. After their messenger has come, judgment is passed on them in all fairness, and they are not wronged

⁴⁸They ask 'the believers', "When will this threat come to pass if what you say is true?"

⁴⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "I have no power to benefit or protect myself, except by the Will of Allah." For each community there is an appointed term. When their time arrives, they cannot delay it for a moment, nor could they advance it

⁵⁰Tell them 'O Prophet', "Imagine if His torment were to overtake you by night or day—do the wicked realize what they are 'really' asking Him to hasten

⁵¹Will you believe in it only after it has overtaken you? Now? But you always wanted to hasten it!"

⁵²Then the wrongdoers will be told, "Taste the torment of eternity! Are you not rewarded except for what you used to commit?"

⁵³They ask you 'O Prophet', "Is this true?" Say, "Yes, by my Lord! Most certainly it is true! And you will have no escape."

⁵⁴If every wrongdoer were to possess everything in the world, they would surely ransom themselves with it. They will hide 'their' remorse when they see the torment. And they will be judged in all fairness, and none will be wronged

⁵⁵Surely to Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. Surely Allah's promise is 'always' true, but most of them do not know

⁵⁶He 'is the One Who' gives life and causes death, and to Him you will 'all' be returned

⁵⁷O humanity! Indeed, there has come to you a warning from your Lord, a cure for what is in the hearts, a guide, and a mercy for the believers

⁵⁸Say, 'O Prophet,' "In Allah's grace and mercy let them rejoice. That is far better than whatever 'wealth' they amass."

⁵⁹Ask 'the pagans, O Prophet', "Have you seen that which Allah has sent down for you as a provision, of which you have made some lawful and some unlawful?" Say, "Has Allah given you authorization, or are you fabricating lies against Allah?"

⁶⁰What do those who fabricate lies against Allah expect on Judgment Day? Surely Allah is ever Bountiful to humanity, but most of them are ungrateful

⁶¹There is no activity you may be engaged in 'O Prophet' or portion of the Quran you may be reciting, nor any deed you 'all' may be doing except that We are a Witness over you while doing it. Not 'even' an atom's weight is hidden from your Lord on earth or in heaven; nor anything smaller or larger than that, but is 'written' in a perfect Record

⁶²There will certainly be no fear for the close servants of Allah, nor will they grieve

⁶³“They are” those who are faithful and are mindful “of Him”

⁶⁴For them is good news in this worldly life and the Hereafter. There is no change in the promise of Allah. That is “truly” the ultimate triumph

⁶⁵Do not let their words grieve you “O Prophet”. Surely all honour and power belongs to Allah. He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁶⁶Certainly to Allah “alone” belong all those in the heavens and all those on the earth. And what do those who associate others with Allah really follow? They follow nothing but assumptions and do nothing but lie

⁶⁷He is the One Who has made the night for you to rest in and the day bright. Surely in this are signs for people who listen

⁶⁸They say, “Allah has offspring.” Glory be to Him! He is the Self-Sufficient. To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. You have no proof of this! Do you say about Allah what you do not know

⁶⁹Say, “O Prophet,” “Indeed, those who fabricate lies against Allah will never succeed.”

⁷⁰It is only a brief enjoyment in this world, then to Us is their return, then We will make them taste the severe punishment for their disbelief

⁷¹Relate to them 'O Prophet' the story of Noah when he said to his people, "O my People! If my presence and my reminders to you of Allah's signs are unbearable to you, then 'know that' I have put my trust in Allah. So devise a plot along with your associate-gods—and you do not have to be secretive about your plot—then carry it out against me without delay

⁷²And if you turn away, 'remember' I have never demanded a reward from you 'for delivering the message'. My reward is only from Allah. And I have been commanded to be one of those who submit 'to Allah'."

⁷³But they still rejected him, so We saved him and those with him in the Ark and made them successors, and drowned those who rejected Our signs. See then what was the end of those who had been warned

⁷⁴Then after him We sent 'other' messengers to their 'own' people and they came to them with clear proofs. But they would not believe in what they had rejected before. This is how We seal the hearts of the transgressors

⁷⁵Then after these 'messengers' We sent Moses and Aaron to Pharaoh and his chiefs with Our signs. But they behaved arrogantly and were a wicked people

⁷⁶When the truth came to them from Us, they said, "This is certainly pure magic!"

⁷⁷Moses responded, "Is this what you say about the truth when it has come to you? Is this magic? Magicians will never succeed."

⁷⁸They argued, "Have you come to turn us away from the faith of our forefathers so that the two of you may become supreme in the land? We will never believe in you!"

⁷⁹Pharaoh demanded, "Bring me every skilled magician."

⁸⁰When the magicians came, Moses said to them, "Cast whatever you wish to cast!"

⁸¹When they did, Moses said, "What you have produced is mere magic, Allah will surely make it useless, for Allah certainly does not set right the work of the corruptors

⁸²And Allah establishes the truth by His Words—even to the dismay of the wicked."

⁸³But no one believed in Moses except a few youths of his people, while fearing that Pharaoh and their own chiefs might

persecute them. And certainly Pharaoh was a tyrant in the land, and he was truly a transgressor

⁸⁴Moses said, “O my people! If you do believe in Allah and submit ‘to His Will’, then put your trust in Him.”

⁸⁵They replied, “In Allah we trust. Our Lord! Do not subject us to the persecution of the oppressive people

⁸⁶and deliver us by Your mercy from the disbelieving people.”

⁸⁷We revealed to Moses and his brother, “Appoint houses for your people in Egypt. Turn these houses into places of worship, establish prayer, and give good news to the believers!”

⁸⁸Moses prayed, “Our Lord! You have granted Pharaoh and his chiefs luxuries and riches in this worldly life, ‘which they abused’ to lead people astray from Your Way! Our Lord, destroy their riches and harden their hearts so that they will not believe until they see the painful punishment.”

⁸⁹Allah responded ‘to Moses and Aaron’, “Your prayer is answered! So be steadfast and do not follow the way of those who do not know.”

⁹⁰We brought the Children of Israel across the sea. Then Pharaoh and his soldiers pursued them unjustly and oppressively. But

as Pharaoh was drowning, he cried out, “I believe that there is no god except that in whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am ‘now’ one of those who submit.”

⁹¹“He was told, ‘Now ‘you believe’? But you always disobeyed and were one of the corruptors

⁹²Today We will preserve your corpse so that you may become an example for those who come after you. And surely most people are heedless of Our examples!”

⁹³Indeed, We settled the Children of Israel in a blessed land, and granted them good, lawful provisions. They did not differ until knowledge came to them. Surely your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Judgment regarding their differences

⁹⁴If you ‘O Prophet’ are in doubt about ‘these stories’ that We have revealed to you, then ask those who read the Scripture before you. The truth has certainly come to you from your Lord, so do not be one of those who doubt

⁹⁵and do not be one of those who deny Allah’s signs or you will be one of the losers

⁹⁶Indeed, those against whom Allah’s decree ‘of torment’ is justified will not believe—

⁹⁷even if every sign were to come to them—until they see the painful punishment

⁹⁸If only there had been a society which believed ‘before seeing the torment’ and, therefore, benefited from its belief, like the people of Jonah. When they believed, We lifted from them the torment of disgrace in this world and allowed them enjoyment for a while

⁹⁹Had your Lord so willed ‘O Prophet’, all ‘people’ on earth would have certainly believed, every single one of them! Would you then force people to become believers

¹⁰⁰It is not for any soul to believe except by Allah’s leave, and He will bring His wrath upon those who are unmindful

¹⁰¹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Consider all that is in the heavens and the earth!” Yet neither signs nor warners are of any benefit to those who refuse to believe

¹⁰²Are they waiting for ‘anything’ except the same torments that befell those before them? Say, “Keep waiting then! I too am waiting with you.”

¹⁰³Then We saved Our messengers and those who believed. For it is Our duty to save the believers

104 Say, 'O Prophet,' "O humanity! If you are in doubt of my faith, then 'know that' I do not worship those 'idols' you worship instead of Allah. But I worship Allah, Who has the power to cause your death. And I have been commanded, 'Be one of the believers,'

105 and, 'Be steadfast in faith in all uprightness, and do not be one of the polytheists,'

106 and 'Do not invoke, instead of Allah, what can neither benefit nor harm you—for if you do, then you will certainly be one of the wrongdoers,'

107 and 'If Allah touches you with harm, none can undo it except Him. And if He intends good for you, none can withhold His bounty. He grants it to whoever He wills of His servants. And He is the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.'"

108 Say, 'O Prophet,' "O humanity! The truth has surely come to you from your Lord. So whoever chooses to be guided, it is only for their own good. And whoever chooses to stray, it is only to their own loss. And I am not a keeper over you."

109 And follow what is revealed to you, and be patient until Allah passes His judgment. For He is the Best of Judges

Hūd

Hud • 123 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Ra. 'This is' a Book whose verses are well perfected and then fully explained. 'It is' from the One 'Who is' All-Wise, All-Aware

²Tell them, O Prophet, 'Worship none but Allah. Surely I am a warner and deliverer of good news to you from Him

³And seek your Lord's forgiveness and turn to Him in repentance. He will grant you a good provision for an appointed term and graciously reward the doers of good. But if you turn away, then I truly fear for you the torment of a formidable Day

⁴To Allah is your return. And He is Most Capable of everything."

⁵Indeed, they enfold 'what is in' their hearts, 'trying' to hide it from Him! But even when they cover themselves with their

clothes, He knows what they conceal and what they reveal. Surely He knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁶There is no moving creature on earth whose provision is not guaranteed by Allah. And He knows where it lives and where it is laid to rest. All is 'written' in a perfect Record

⁷He is the One Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days—and His Throne was upon the waters—in order to test which of you is best in deeds. And if you 'O Prophet' say, "Surely you will 'all' be raised up after death," the disbelievers will certainly say, "That is nothing but pure magic!"

⁸And if We delay their punishment until an appointed time, they will definitely say, "What is holding it back?" Indeed, on the Day it overtakes them, it will not be averted from them, and they will be overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

⁹If We give people a taste of Our mercy then take it away from them, they become utterly desperate, ungrateful

¹⁰But if We give them a taste of prosperity after being touched with adversity, they say, "My ills are gone," and become totally prideful and boastful

¹¹except those who patiently endure and do good. It is they who will have forgiveness and a mighty reward

¹²Perhaps you ‘O Prophet’ may wish to give up some of what is revealed to you and may be distressed by it because they say, “If only a treasure had been sent down to him, or an angel had come with him!” You are only a warner, and Allah is the Trustee of All Affairs

¹³Or do they say, “He has fabricated this ‘Quran’!”? Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Produce ten fabricated sūrahs like it and seek help from whoever you can—other than Allah—if what you say is true!”

¹⁴But if your helpers fail you, then know that it has been revealed with the knowledge of Allah, and that there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him! Will you ‘not’ then submit ‘to Allah’

¹⁵Whoever desires ‘only’ this worldly life and its luxuries, We will pay them in full for their deeds in this life—nothing will be left out

¹⁶It is they who will have nothing in the Hereafter except the Fire. Their efforts in this life will be fruitless and their deeds will be useless

¹⁷“Can these people be compared to’ those ‘believers’ who stand on clear proof from their Lord, backed by ‘the Quran as’ a witness from Him, and preceded by the Book of Moses

‘which was revealed’ as a guide and mercy? It is those ‘believers’ who have faith in it. But whoever from the ‘disbelieving’ groups rejects it, the Fire will be their destiny. So do not be in doubt of it. It is certainly the truth from your Lord, but most people do not believe

¹⁸Who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah? They will be brought before their Lord, and the witnesses will say, “These are the ones who lied against their Lord.” Surely Allah’s condemnation is upon the wrongdoers

¹⁹who hinder ‘others’ from Allah’s Path, striving to make it ‘appear’ crooked, and disbelieve in the Hereafter

²⁰They will never frustrate Allah on earth, and they will have no protector besides Allah. Their punishment will be multiplied, for they failed to hear or see ‘the truth’

²¹It is they who have ruined themselves, and whatever ‘gods’ they fabricated will fail them

²²Without a doubt, they will be the worst losers in the Hereafter

²³Surely those who believe, do good, and humble themselves before their Lord will be the residents of Paradise. They will be there forever

²⁴The example of these two parties is that of the blind and the deaf, compared to the seeing and the hearing. Can the two be equal? Will you not then be mindful

²⁵Surely We sent Noah to his people. 'He said,' "Indeed, I am sent to you with a clear warning

²⁶that you should worship none but Allah. I truly fear for you the torment of a painful Day."

²⁷The disbelieving chiefs of his people said, "We see you only as a human being like ourselves, and we see that no one follows you except the lowliest among us, who do so 'hastily' without thinking. We do not see anything that makes 'all of' you any better than us. In fact, we think you are liars."

²⁸He said, "O my people! Consider if I stand on a clear proof from my Lord and He has blessed me with a mercy from Himself, which you fail to see. Should we 'then' force it on you against your will

²⁹O my people! I do not ask you for a payment for this 'message'. My reward is only from Allah. And I will never dismiss the believers, for they will surely meet their Lord. But I can see that you are a people acting ignorantly

³⁰O my people! Who would protect me from Allah if I were to dismiss them? Will you not then be mindful

³¹I do not say to you that I possess Allah's treasures or know the unseen, nor do I claim to be an angel, nor do I say that Allah will never grant goodness to those you look down upon. Allah knows best what is 'hidden' within them. 'If I did,' then I would truly be one of the wrongdoers."

³²They protested, "O Noah! You have argued with us far too much, so bring upon us what you threaten us with, if what you say is true."

³³He responded, "It is Allah Who can bring it upon you if He wills, and then you will have no escape

³⁴My advice will not benefit you—no matter how hard I try—if Allah wills 'for' you to stray. He is your Lord, and to Him you will 'all' be returned."

³⁵Or do they say, "He has fabricated this 'Quran'!"? Say, 'O Prophet,' "If I have done so, then I bear the burden of that sin! But I am free from your sinful accusation."

³⁶And it was revealed to Noah, "None of your people will believe except those who already have. So do not be distressed by what they have been doing

³⁷And build the Ark under Our ‘watchful’ Eyes and directions, and do not plead with Me for those who have done wrong, for they will surely be drowned.”

³⁸So he began to build the Ark, and whenever some of the chiefs of his people passed by, they mocked him. He said, “If you laugh at us, we will ‘soon’ laugh at you similarly

³⁹You will soon come to know who will be visited by a humiliating torment ‘in this life’ and overwhelmed by an everlasting punishment ‘in the next’.”

⁴⁰And when Our command came and the oven burst ‘with water’, We said ‘to Noah’, “Take into the Ark a pair from every species along with your family—except those against whom the decree ‘to drown’ has already been passed—and those who believe.” But none believed with him except for a few

⁴¹And he said, “Board it! In the Name of Allah it will sail and cast anchor. Surely my Lord is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.”

⁴²And ‘so’ the Ark sailed with them through waves like mountains. Noah called out to his son, who stood apart, “O my dear son! Come aboard with us and do not be with the disbelievers.”

⁴³He replied, "I will take refuge on a mountain, which will protect me from the water." Noah cried, "Today no one is protected from Allah's decree except those to whom He shows mercy!" And the waves came between them, and his son was among the drowned

⁴⁴And it was said, "O earth! Swallow up your water. And O sky! Withhold 'your rain'." The floodwater receded and the decree was carried out. The Ark rested on Mount Judi, and it was said, "Away with the wrongdoing people!"

⁴⁵Noah called out to his Lord, saying, "My Lord! Certainly my son is 'also' of my family, Your promise is surely true, and You are the most just of all judges!"

⁴⁶Allah replied, "O Noah! He is certainly not of your family—he was entirely of unrighteous conduct. So do not ask Me about what you have no knowledge of! I warn you so you do not fall into ignorance."

⁴⁷Noah pleaded, "My Lord, I seek refuge in You from asking You about what I have no knowledge of, and unless You forgive me and have mercy on me, I will be one of the losers."

⁴⁸It was said, "O Noah! Disembark with Our peace and blessings on you and some of the descendants of those with you. As for the others, We will allow them 'a brief' enjoyment,

then they will be touched with a painful punishment from Us.”

⁴⁹This is one of the stories of the unseen, which we reveal to you ‘O Prophet’. Neither you nor your people knew it before this. So be patient! Surely the ultimate outcome belongs ‘only’ to the righteous

⁵⁰And to the people of ‘Âd We sent their brother Hûd. He said, “O my people! Worship Allah. You have no god other than Him. You do nothing but fabricate lies ‘against Allah’

⁵¹O my people! I do not ask you for any reward for this ‘message’. My reward is only from the One Who created me. Will you not then understand

⁵²And O my people! Seek your Lord’s forgiveness and turn to Him in repentance. He will shower you with rain in abundance, and add strength to your strength. So do not turn away, persisting in wickedness.”

⁵³They argued, “O Hûd! You have not given us any clear proof, and we will never abandon our gods upon your word, nor will we believe in you

⁵⁴All we can say is that some of our gods have possessed you with evil.” He said, “I call Allah to witness, and you too bear witness, that I ‘totally’ reject whatever you associate

⁵⁵with Him ‘in worship’. So let all of you plot against me without delay

⁵⁶I have put my trust in Allah—my Lord and your Lord. There is no living creature that is not completely under His control. Surely my Lord’s Way is perfect justice

⁵⁷But if you turn away, I have already delivered to you what I have been sent with. My Lord will replace you with others. You are not harming Him in the least. Indeed, my Lord is a ‘vigilant’ Keeper over all things.”

⁵⁸When Our command came, We rescued Hûd and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us, saving them from a harsh torment

⁵⁹That was ‘Âd. They denied the signs of their Lord, disobeyed His messengers, and followed the command of every stubborn tyrant

⁶⁰They were followed by a curse in this world, as they will be on the Day of Judgment. Surely ‘Âd denied their Lord. So away with ‘Âd, the people of Hûd

⁶¹And to the people of Thamûd We sent their brother Şâlih. He said, “O my people! Worship Allah. You have no god other than Him. He ‘is the One Who’ produced you from the earth and settled you on it. So seek His forgiveness and turn to Him in repentance. Surely my Lord is Ever Near, All-Responsive ‘to prayers’.”

⁶²They argued, “O Şâlih! We truly had high hopes in you before this. How dare you forbid us to worship what our forefathers had worshipped? We are certainly in alarming doubt about what you are inviting us to.”

⁶³He responded, “O my people! Consider if I stand on a clear proof from my Lord and He has blessed me with a mercy from Him. Who could help me against Allah if I were to disobey Him? You would only contribute to my doom

⁶⁴And O my people! This she-camel of Allah is a sign for you. So leave her to graze ‘freely’ on Allah’s earth and do her no harm, or a swift punishment will overtake you!”

⁶⁵But they killed her, so he warned ‘them’, “You have ‘only’ three ‘more’ days to enjoy life in your homes—this is an un-failing promise!”

⁶⁶When Our command came, We saved Şâlih and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us and spared them the

disgrace of that Day. Surely your Lord 'alone' is the All-Powerful, Almighty

⁶⁷And the 'mighty' blast overtook the wrongdoers, so they fell lifeless in their homes

⁶⁸as if they had never lived there. Surely Thamûd denied their Lord, so away with Thamûd

⁶⁹And surely Our messenger-angels came to Abraham with good news 'of a son'. They greeted 'him with', "Peace!" And he replied, "Peace 'be upon you'!" Then it was not long before he brought 'them' a 'fat,' roasted calf

⁷⁰And when he saw that their hands did not reach for the food, he became suspicious and fearful of them. They reassured 'him', "Do not be afraid! We are 'angels' sent 'only' against the people of Lot."

⁷¹And his wife was standing by, so she laughed, then We gave her good news of 'the birth of' Isaac, and, after him, Jacob

⁷²She wondered, "Oh, my! How can I have a child in this old age, and my husband here is an old man? This is truly an astonishing thing!"

⁷³They responded, “Are you astonished by Allah’s decree? May Allah’s mercy and blessings be upon you, O people of this house. Indeed, He is Praiseworthy, All-Glorious.”

⁷⁴Then after the fear had left Abraham, and the good news had reached him, he began to plead with Us for the people of Lot

⁷⁵Truly, Abraham was forbearing, tender-hearted, and ever turning ‘to his Lord’

⁷⁶The angels said, ‘O Abraham! Plead no more! Your Lord’s decree has already come, and they will certainly be afflicted with a punishment that cannot be averted!’

⁷⁷When Our messenger-angels came to Lot, he was distressed and worried by their arrival. He said, “This is a terrible day.”

⁷⁸And ‘the men of’ his people—who were used to shameful deeds—came to him rushing. He pleaded, “O my people! Here are my daughters ‘for marriage’—they are pure for you. So fear Allah, and do not humiliate me by disrespecting my guests. Is there not ‘even’ a single right-minded man among you?”

⁷⁹They argued, “You certainly know that we have no need for your daughters. You already know what we desire!”

⁸⁰He responded, "If only I had the strength 'to resist you' or could rely on a strong supporter."

⁸¹The angels said, "O Lot! We are the messengers of your Lord. They will never reach you. So travel with your family in the dark of night, and do not let any of you look back, except your wife. She will certainly suffer the fate of the others. Their appointed time is the morning. Is the morning not near?"

⁸²When Our command came, We turned the cities upside down and rained down on them clustered stones of baked clay

⁸³marked by your Lord 'O Prophet'. And these stones are not far from the 'pagan' wrongdoers

⁸⁴And to the people of Midian We sent their brother Shu'aib. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah. You have no god other than Him. And do not give short measure and weight. I do see you in prosperity now, but I truly fear for you the torment of an overwhelming Day

⁸⁵O my people! Give full measure and weigh with justice. Do not defraud people of their property, nor go about spreading corruption in the land

⁸⁶What is left 'as a lawful gain' by Allah is far better for you if you are 'truly' believers. And I am not a keeper over you."

⁸⁷They asked 'sarcastically', "O Shu'aib! Does your prayer command you that we should abandon what our forefathers worshipped or give up managing our wealth as we please? Indeed, you are such a tolerant, sensible man!"

⁸⁸He said, "O my people! Consider if I stand on a clear proof from my Lord and He has blessed me with a good provision from Him. I do not want to do what I am forbidding you from. I only intend reform to the best of my ability. My success comes only through Allah. In Him I trust and to Him I turn

⁸⁹O my people! Do not let your opposition to me lead you to a fate similar to that of the people of Noah, or Hūd, or Šâliḥ. And the people of Lot are not far from you

⁹⁰So seek your Lord's forgiveness and turn to Him in repentance. Surely my Lord is Most Merciful, All-Loving."

⁹¹They threatened, "O Shu'aib! We do not comprehend much of what you say, and surely we see you powerless among us. Were it not for your clan, we would have certainly stoned you, for you are nothing to us."

⁹²He said, "O my people! Do you have more regard for my clan than for Allah, turning your back on Him entirely? Surely my Lord is Fully Aware of what you do

⁹³O my people! Persist in your ways, for I 'too' will persist in mine. You will soon come to know who will be visited by a humiliating torment and is a liar! And watch! I too am watching with you!"

⁹⁴When Our command came, We saved Shu'aib and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us. And the 'mighty' blast overtook the wrongdoers, so they fell lifeless in their homes

⁹⁵as if they had never lived there. So away with Midian as it was with Thamûd

⁹⁶Indeed, We sent Moses with Our signs and compelling proof

⁹⁷to Pharaoh and his chiefs, but they followed the command of Pharaoh, and Pharaoh's command was not well guided

⁹⁸He will be before his people on the Day of Judgment and will lead them into the Fire. What an evil place to be led into

⁹⁹They were followed by a curse in this 'life' and 'will receive another' on the Day of Judgment. What an evil gift to receive

100 These are accounts, We relate to you 'O Prophet', of the 'destroyed' cities. Some are still standing 'barren', while others have been mowed down

101 We did not wrong them, rather they wronged themselves. The gods they invoked beside Allah were of no help at all when the command of your Lord came, and only contributed to their ruin

102 Such is the 'crushing' grip of your Lord when He seizes the societies entrenched in wrongdoing. Indeed, His grip is 'terribly' painful and severe

103 Surely in this is a sign for those who fear the torment of the Hereafter. That is a Day for which humanity will be gathered and a Day 'that will be' witnessed 'by all'

104 We only delay it for a fixed term

105 When that Day arrives, no one will dare speak except with His permission. Some of them will be miserable, others joyful

106 As for those bound for misery, they will be in the Fire, where they will be sighing and gasping

107 staying there forever, as long as the heavens and the earth will endure, except what your Lord wills. Surely your Lord does what He intends

108 And as for those destined to joy, they will be in Paradise, staying there forever, as long as the heavens and the earth will endure, except what your Lord wills—a 'generous' giving, without end

109 So do not be in doubt 'O Prophet' about what those 'pagans' worship. They worship nothing except what their forefathers worshipped before 'them'. And We will certainly give them their share 'of punishment' in full, without any reduction

110 Indeed, We had given Moses the Scripture, but differences arose regarding it. Had it not been for a prior decree from your Lord, their differences would have been settled 'at once'. They are truly in alarming doubt about it

111 And surely your Lord will fully pay all for their deeds. He is certainly All-Aware of what they do

112 So be steadfast as you are commanded 'O Prophet', along with those who turn 'in submission to Allah' with you. And do not transgress. Surely He is All-Seeing of what you 'believers' do

113 And do not be inclined to the wrongdoers or you will be touched by the Fire. For then you would have no protectors other than Allah, nor would you be helped

¹¹⁴Establish prayer ‘O Prophet’ at both ends of the day and in the early part of the night. Surely good deeds wipe out evil deeds. That is a reminder for the mindful

¹¹⁵And be patient! Certainly Allah does not discount the reward of the good-doers

¹¹⁶If only there had been among the ‘destroyed’ peoples before you, ‘O believers,’ virtuous individuals who forbade corruption in the land—other than the few We had saved ‘from the torment’. But the wrongdoers ‘only’ pursued their ‘worldly’ pleasures, becoming wicked

¹¹⁷And your Lord ‘O Prophet’ would never destroy a society unjustly while its people were acting rightly

¹¹⁸Had your Lord so willed, He would have certainly made humanity one single community ‘of believers’, but they will always ‘choose to’ differ—

¹¹⁹except those shown mercy by your Lord—and so He created them ‘to choose freely’. And so the Word of your Lord will be fulfilled: “I will surely fill up Hell with jinn and humans all together.”

¹²⁰And We relate to you ‘O Prophet’ the stories of the messengers to reassure your heart. And there has come to you

in this 'sûrah' the truth, a warning 'to the disbelievers', and a reminder to the believers

¹²¹ Say to those who disbelieve, "Persist in your ways; we will certainly persist in ours

¹²² And wait! Surely we 'too' are waiting."

¹²³ To Allah 'alone' belongs the knowledge of what is hidden in the heavens and the earth. And to Him all matters are returned. So worship Him and put your trust in Him. And your Lord is never unaware of what you do

Yūsuf

Joseph • 111 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Ra. These are the verses of the clear Book

²Indeed, We have sent it down as an Arabic Quran so that you may understand

³We relate to you ‘O Prophet’ the best of stories through Our revelation of this Quran, though before this you were totally unaware ‘of them’

⁴‘Remember’ when Joseph said to his father, “O my dear father! Indeed I dreamt of eleven stars, and the sun, and the moon—I saw them prostrating to me!”

⁵He replied, “O my dear son! Do not relate your vision to your brothers, or they will devise a plot against you. Surely Satan is a sworn enemy to humankind

⁶And so will your Lord choose you ‘O Joseph’, and teach you the interpretation of dreams, and perfect His favour upon you and the descendants of Jacob—‘just’ as He once perfected

it upon your forefathers, Abraham and Isaac. Surely your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise.”

⁷Indeed, in the story of Joseph and his brothers there are lessons for all who ask

⁸‘Remember’ when they said ‘to one another’, “Surely Joseph and his brother ‘Benjamin’ are more beloved to our father than we, even though we are a group of so many. Indeed, our father is clearly mistaken

⁹Kill Joseph or cast him out to some ‘distant’ land so that our father’s attention will be only ours, then after that you may ‘repent and’ become righteous people!”

¹⁰One of them said, “Do not kill Joseph. But if you must do something, throw him into the bottom of a well so perhaps he may be picked up by some travellers.”

¹¹They said, “O our father! Why do you not trust us with Joseph, although we truly wish him well

¹²Send him out with us tomorrow so that he may enjoy himself and play. And we will really watch over him.”

¹³He responded, “It would truly sadden me if you took him away with you, and I fear that a wolf may devour him while you are negligent of him.”

¹⁴They said, “If a wolf were to devour him, despite our strong group, then we would certainly be losers!”

¹⁵And so, when they took him away and decided to throw him into the bottom of the well, We inspired him: “‘One day’ you will remind them of this deed of theirs while they are unaware ‘of who you are’.”

¹⁶Then they returned to their father in the evening, weeping

¹⁷They cried, “Our father! We went racing and left Joseph with our belongings, and a wolf devoured him! But you will not believe us, no matter how truthful we are.”

¹⁸And they brought his shirt, stained with false blood. He responded, “No! Your souls must have tempted you to do something ‘evil’. So ‘I can only endure with’ beautiful patience! It is Allah’s help that I seek to bear your claims.”

¹⁹And there came some travellers, and they sent their water-boy who let down his bucket into the well. He cried out, “Oh, what a great find! Here is a boy!” And they took him secretly ‘to be sold’ as merchandise, but Allah is All-Knowing of what they did

²⁰They ‘later’ sold him for a cheap price, just a few silver coins—only wanting to get rid of him

²¹The man from Egypt who bought him said to his wife, "Take good care of him, perhaps he may be useful to us or we may adopt him as a son." This is how We established Joseph in the land, so that We might teach him the interpretation of dreams. Allah's Will always prevails, but most people do not know

²²And when he reached maturity, We gave him wisdom and knowledge. This is how We reward the good-doers

²³And the lady, in whose house he lived, tried to seduce him. She locked the doors 'firmly' and said, "Come to me!" He replied, "Allah is my refuge! It is 'not right to betray' my master, who has taken good care of me. Indeed, the wrongdoers never succeed."

²⁴She advanced towards him, and he would have done likewise, had he not seen a sign from his Lord. This is how We kept evil and indecency away from him, for he was truly one of Our chosen servants

²⁵They raced for the door and she tore his shirt from the back, only to find her husband at the door. She cried, "What is the penalty for someone who tried to violate your wife, except imprisonment or a painful punishment?"

²⁶Joseph responded, “It was she who tried to seduce me.” And a witness from her own family testified: “If his shirt is torn from the front, then she has told the truth and he is a liar

²⁷But if it is torn from the back, then she has lied and he is truthful.”

²⁸So when her husband saw that Joseph’s shirt was torn from the back, he said ‘to her’, “This must be ‘an example’ of the cunning of you ‘women’! Indeed, your cunning is so shrewd

²⁹O Joseph! Forget about this. And you ‘O wife’! Seek forgiveness for your sin. It certainly has been your fault.”

³⁰Some women of the city gossiped, “The Chief Minister’s wife is trying to seduce her slave-boy. Love for him has plagued her heart. Indeed, we see that she is clearly mistaken.”

³¹When she heard about their gossip, she invited them and set a banquet for them. She gave each one a knife, then said ‘to Joseph’, “Come out before them.” When they saw him, they were so stunned ‘by his beauty’ that they cut their hands, and exclaimed, “Good God! This cannot be human; this must be a noble angel!”

³²She said, “This is the one for whose love you criticized me! I did try to seduce him but he ‘firmly’ refused. And if he does not do what I order him to, he will certainly be imprisoned and ‘fully’ disgraced.”

³³Joseph prayed, “My Lord! I would rather be in jail than do what they invite me to. And if You do not turn their cunning away from me, I might yield to them and fall into ignorance.”

³⁴So his Lord responded to him, turning their cunning away from him. Surely He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

³⁵And so it occurred to those in charge, despite seeing all the proofs ‘of his innocence’, that he should be imprisoned for a while

³⁶And two other servants went to jail with Joseph. One of them said, “I dreamt I was pressing wine.” The other said, “I dreamt I was carrying ‘some’ bread on my head, from which birds were eating.” ‘Then both said,’ “Tell us their interpretation, for we surely see you as one of the good-doers.”

³⁷Joseph replied, “I can even tell you what kind of meal you will be served before you receive it. This ‘knowledge’ is from what my Lord has taught me. I have shunned the faith of a people who disbelieve in Allah and deny the Hereafter

³⁸I follow the faith of my fathers: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. It is not ‘right’ for us to associate anything with Allah ‘in worship’. This is part of Allah’s grace upon us and humanity, but most people are not grateful

³⁹O my fellow-prisoners! Which is far better: many different lords or Allah—the One, the Supreme

⁴⁰Whatever ‘idols’ you worship instead of Him are mere names which you and your forefathers have made up—a practice Allah has never authorized. It is only Allah Who decides. He has commanded that you worship none but Him. That is the upright faith, but most people do not know

⁴¹“O my fellow-prisoners! ‘The first’ one of you will serve wine to his master, and the other will be crucified and the birds will eat from his head. The matter about which you inquired has been decided.”

⁴²Then he said to the one he knew would survive, “Mention me in the presence of your master.” But Satan made him forget to mention Joseph to his master, so he remained in prison for several years

⁴³And ‘one day’ the King said, “I dreamt of seven fat cows eaten up by seven skinny ones; and seven green ears of grain

and 'seven' others dry. O chiefs! Tell me the meaning of my dream if you can interpret dreams."

⁴⁴They replied, "These are confused visions and we do not know the interpretation of such dreams."

⁴⁵"Finally," the surviving ex-prisoner remembered 'Joseph' after a long time and said, "I will tell you its interpretation, so send me forth 'to Joseph'."

⁴⁶"He said," "Joseph, O man of truth! Interpret for us 'the dream of' seven fat cows eaten up by seven skinny ones; and seven green ears of grain and 'seven' others dry, so that I may return to the people and let them know."

⁴⁷Joseph replied, "You will plant 'grain' for seven consecutive years, leaving in the ear whatever you will harvest, except for the little you will eat

⁴⁸Then after that will come seven years of great hardship which will consume whatever you have saved, except the little you will store 'for seed'

⁴⁹Then after that will come a year in which people will receive abundant rain and they will press 'oil and wine'."

⁵⁰The King 'then' said, "Bring him to me." When the messenger came to him, Joseph said, "Go back to your master and

ask him about the case of the women who cut their hands. Surely my Lord has 'full' knowledge of their cunning."

⁵¹The King asked 'the women', "What did you get when you tried to seduce Joseph?" They replied, "Allah forbid! We know nothing indecent about him." Then the Chief Minister's wife admitted, "Now the truth has come to light. It was I who tried to seduce him, and he is surely truthful

⁵²From this, Joseph should know that I did not speak dishonestly about him in his absence, for Allah certainly does not guide the scheming of the dishonest

⁵³And I do not seek to free myself from blame, for indeed the soul is ever inclined to evil, except those shown mercy by my Lord. Surely my Lord is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

⁵⁴The King said, "Bring him to me. I will employ him exclusively in my service." And when Joseph spoke to him, the King said, "Today you are highly esteemed and fully trusted by us."

⁵⁵Joseph proposed, "Put me in charge of the store-houses of the land, for I am truly reliable and adept."

⁵⁶This is how We established Joseph in the land to settle wherever he pleased. We shower Our mercy on whoever We will, and We never discount the reward of the good-doers

⁵⁷And the reward of the Hereafter is far better for those who are faithful and are mindful 'of Allah'

⁵⁸And Joseph's brothers came and entered his presence. He recognized them but they were unaware of who he really was

⁵⁹When he had provided them with their supplies, he demanded, "Bring me your brother on your father's side. Do you not see that I give full measure and I am the best of hosts

⁶⁰But if you do not bring him to me 'next time', I will have no grain for you, nor will you ever come close to me again."

⁶¹They promised, "We will try to convince his father to let him come. We will certainly do 'our best'."

⁶²Joseph ordered his servants to put his brothers' money back into their saddlebags so that they would find it when they returned to their family and perhaps they would come back

⁶³When Joseph's brothers returned to their father, they pleaded, "O our father! We have been denied 'further' supplies. So

send our brother with us so that we may receive our measure, and we will definitely watch over him.”

⁶⁴He responded, “Should I trust you with him as I once trusted you with his brother ‘Joseph’? But ‘only’ Allah is the best Protector, and He is the Most Merciful of the merciful.”

⁶⁵When they opened their bags, they discovered that their money had been returned to them. They argued, “O our father! What more can we ask for? Here is our money, fully returned to us. Now we can buy more food for our family. We will watch over our brother, and obtain an extra camel-load of grain. That load can be easily secured.”

⁶⁶Jacob insisted, “I will not send him with you until you give me a solemn oath by Allah that you will certainly bring him back to me, unless you are totally overpowered.” Then after they had given him their oaths, he concluded, “Allah is a Witness to what we have said.”

⁶⁷He then instructed ‘them’, “O my sons! Do not enter ‘the city’ all through one gate, but through separate gates. I cannot help you against ‘what is destined by’ Allah in the least. It is only Allah Who decides. In Him I put my trust. And in Him let the faithful put their trust.”

⁶⁸Then when they entered as their father had instructed them, this did not help them against 'the Will of' Allah whatsoever. It was just a desire in Jacob's heart which he satisfied. He was truly blessed with 'great' knowledge because of what We had taught him, but most people have no knowledge

⁶⁹When they entered Joseph's presence, he called his brother 'Benjamin' aside, and confided 'to him', "I am indeed your brother 'Joseph'! So do not feel distressed about what they have been doing."

⁷⁰When Joseph had provided them with supplies, he slipped the royal cup into his brother's bag. Then a herald cried, "O people of the caravan! You must be thieves!"

⁷¹They asked, turning back, "What have you lost?"

⁷²The herald 'along with the guards' replied, "We have lost the King's measuring cup. And whoever brings it will be awarded a camel-load 'of grain'. I guarantee it."

⁷³Joseph's brothers replied, "By Allah! You know well that we did not come to cause trouble in the land, nor are we thieves."

⁷⁴Joseph's men asked, "What should be the price for theft, if you are lying?"

⁷⁵Joseph's brothers responded, "The price will be 'the enslavement of' the one in whose bag the cup is found. That is how we punish the wrongdoers."

⁷⁶Joseph began searching their bags before that of his brother 'Benjamin', then brought it out of Benjamin's bag. This is how We inspired Joseph to plan. He could not have taken his brother under the King's law, but Allah had so willed. We elevate in rank whoever We will. But above those ranking in knowledge is the One All-Knowing

⁷⁷"To distance themselves,' Joseph's brothers argued, "If he has stolen, so did his 'full' brother before." But Joseph suppressed his outrage—revealing nothing to them—and said 'to himself', "You are in such an evil position, and Allah knows best 'the truth of' what you claim."

⁷⁸They appealed, "O Chief Minister! He has a very old father, so take one of us instead. We surely see you as one of the good-doers."

⁷⁹Joseph responded, "Allah forbid that we should take other than the one with whom we found our property. Otherwise, we would surely be unjust."

⁸⁰When they lost all hope in him, they spoke privately. The eldest of them said, "Do you not know that your father had

taken a solemn oath by Allah from you, nor how you failed him regarding Joseph before? So I am not leaving this land until my father allows me to, or Allah decides for me. For He is the Best of Judges

81Return to your father and say, ‘O our father! Your son committed theft. We testify only to what we know. We could not guard against the unforeseen

82Ask ‘the people of’ the land where we were and the caravan we travelled with. We are certainly telling the truth.”

83He cried, “No! Your souls must have tempted you to do something ‘evil’. So ‘I am left with nothing but’ beautiful patience! I trust Allah will return them all to me. Surely He ‘alone’ is the All-Knowing, All-Wise.”

84He turned away from them, lamenting, “Alas, poor Joseph!” And his eyes turned white out of the grief he suppressed

85They said, “By Allah! You will not cease to remember Joseph until you lose your health or ‘even’ your life.”

86He replied, “I complain of my anguish and sorrow only to Allah, and I know from Allah what you do not know

⁸⁷O my sons! Go and search 'diligently' for Joseph and his brother. And do not lose hope in the mercy of Allah, for no one loses hope in Allah's mercy except those with no faith."

⁸⁸When they entered Joseph's presence, they pleaded, "O Chief Minister! We and our family have been touched with hardship, and we have brought only a few worthless coins, but 'please' give us our supplies in full and be charitable to us. Indeed, Allah rewards the charitable."

⁸⁹He asked, "Do you remember what you did to Joseph and his brother in your ignorance?"

⁹⁰They replied 'in shock', "Are you really Joseph?" He said, "I am Joseph, and here is my brother 'Benjamin'! Allah has truly been gracious to us. Surely whoever is mindful 'of Allah' and patient, then certainly Allah never discounts the reward of the good-doers."

⁹¹They admitted, "By Allah! Allah has truly preferred you over us, and we have surely been sinful."

⁹²Joseph said, "There is no blame on you today. May Allah forgive you! He is the Most Merciful of the merciful

⁹³Go with this shirt of mine and cast it over my father's face, and he will regain his sight. Then come back to me with your whole family."

⁹⁴When the caravan departed 'from Egypt', their father said 'to those around him', "You may think I am senile, but I certainly sense the smell of Joseph."

⁹⁵They replied, "By Allah! You are definitely still in your old delusion."

⁹⁶But when the bearer of the good news arrived, he cast the shirt over Jacob's face, so he regained his sight. Jacob then said 'to his children', "Did I not tell you that I truly know from Allah what you do not know?"

⁹⁷They begged, "O our father! Pray for the forgiveness of our sins. We have certainly been sinful."

⁹⁸He said, "I will pray to my Lord for your forgiveness. He 'alone' is indeed the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

⁹⁹When they entered Joseph's presence, he received his parents 'graciously' and said, "Enter Egypt, Allah willing, in security."

¹⁰⁰Then he raised his parents to the throne, and they all fell down in prostration to Joseph, who then said, "O my dear

father! This is the interpretation of my old dream. My Lord has made it come true. He was truly kind to me when He freed me from prison, and brought you all from the desert after Satan had ignited rivalry between me and my siblings. Indeed my Lord is subtle in fulfilling what He wills. Surely He 'alone' is the All-Knowing, All-Wise."

¹⁰¹"My Lord! You have surely granted me authority and taught me the interpretation of dreams. 'O' Originator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Guardian in this world and the Hereafter. Allow me to die as one who submits and join me with the righteous."

¹⁰²That is from the stories of the unseen which We reveal to you 'O Prophet'. You were not present when they 'all' made up their minds, and when they plotted 'against Joseph'

¹⁰³And most people will not believe—no matter how keen you are—

¹⁰⁴even though you are not asking them for a reward for this 'Quran'. It is only a reminder to the whole world

¹⁰⁵How many signs in the heavens and the earth do they pass by with indifference

106 And most of them do not believe in Allah without associating others with Him 'in worship'

107 Do they feel secure that an overwhelming torment from Allah will not overtake them, or that the Hour will not take them by surprise when they least expect 'it'

108 Say, 'O Prophet,' "This is my way. I invite to Allah with insight—I and those who follow me. Glory be to Allah, and I am not one of the polytheists."

109 We only sent before you 'O Prophet' men inspired by Us from among the people of each society. Have the deniers not travelled through the land to see what was the end of those 'destroyed' before them? And surely the 'eternal' Home of the Hereafter is far better for those mindful 'of Allah'. Will you not then understand

110 And when the messengers despaired and their people thought the messengers had been denied help, Our help came to them 'at last'. We then saved whoever We willed, and Our punishment is never averted from the wicked people

111 In their stories there is truly a lesson for people of reason. This message cannot be a fabrication, rather 'it is' a confirmation of previous revelation, a detailed explanation of all things, a guide, and a mercy for people of faith

Ar-Ra'd

The Thunder • 43 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm-Ra. These are the verses of the Book. What has been revealed to you 'O Prophet' from your Lord is the truth, but most people do not believe

²It is Allah Who has raised the heavens without pillars—as you can see—then established Himself on the Throne. He has subjected the sun and the moon, each orbiting for an appointed term. He conducts the whole affair. He makes the signs clear so that you may be certain of the meeting with your Lord

³And He is the One Who spread out the earth and placed firm mountains and rivers upon it, and created fruits of every kind in pairs. He covers the day with night. Surely in this are signs for those who reflect

⁴And on the earth there are 'different' neighbouring tracts, gardens of grapevines, 'various' crops, palm trees—some stemming from the same root, others standing alone. They are all

irrigated with the same water, yet We make some taste better than others. Surely in this are signs for those who understand

⁵“Now,” if anything should amaze you ‘O Prophet’, then it is their question: “When we are reduced to dust, will we really be raised as a new creation?” It is they who have disbelieved in their Lord. It is they who will have shackles around their necks. And it is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

⁶They ask you ‘O Prophet’ to hasten the torment rather than grace, though there have ‘already’ been ‘many’ torments before them. Surely your Lord is full of forgiveness for people, despite their wrongdoing, and your Lord is truly severe in punishment

⁷The disbelievers say, “If only a sign could be sent down to him from his Lord.” You ‘O Prophet’ are only a warner. And every people had a guide

⁸Allah knows what every female bears and what increases and decreases in the wombs. And with Him everything is determined with precision

⁹“He is the” Knower of the seen and the unseen—the All-Great, Most Exalted

¹⁰It is the same 'to Him' whether any of you speaks secretly or openly, whether one hides in the darkness of night or goes about in broad daylight

¹¹For each one there are successive angels before and behind, protecting them by Allah's command. Indeed, Allah would never change a people's state 'of favour' until they change their own state 'of faith'. And if it is Allah's Will to torment a people, it can never be averted, nor can they find a protector other than Him

¹²He is the One Who shows you lightning, inspiring 'you with' hope and fear, and produces heavy clouds

¹³The thunder glorifies His praises, as do the angels in awe of Him. He sends thunderbolts, striking with them whoever He wills. Yet they dispute about Allah. And He is tremendous in might

¹⁴Calling upon Him 'alone' is the truth. But those 'idols' the pagans invoke besides Him 'can' never respond to them in any way. 'It is' just like someone who stretches out their hands to water, 'asking it' to reach their mouths, but it can never do so. The calls of the disbelievers are only in vain

¹⁵To Allah ‘alone’ bow down ‘in submission’ all those in the heavens and the earth—willingly or unwillingly—as do their shadows, morning and evening

¹⁶Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Who is the Lord of the heavens and the earth?” Say, “Allah!” Ask ‘them’, “Why ‘then’ have you taken besides Him lords who cannot even benefit or protect themselves?” Say, “Can the blind and the sighted be equal? Or can darkness and light be equal?” Or have they associated with Allah partners who ‘supposedly’ produced a creation like His, leaving them confused between the two creations? Say, “Allah is the Creator of all things, and He is the One, the Supreme.”

¹⁷He sends down rain from the sky, causing the valleys to flow, each according to its capacity. The currents then carry along rising foam, similar to the slag produced from metal that people melt in the fire for ornaments or tools. This is how Allah compares truth to falsehood. The ‘worthless’ residue is then cast away, but what benefits people remains on the earth. This is how Allah sets forth parables

¹⁸Those who respond to ‘the call of’ their Lord will have the finest reward. As for those who do not respond to Him, even if they were to possess everything in the world twice over,

they would certainly offer it to ransom themselves. They will face strict judgment, and Hell will be their home. What an evil place to rest

¹⁹Can the one who knows that your Lord's revelation to you 'O Prophet' is the truth be like the one who is blind? None will be mindful 'of this' except people of reason

²⁰'They are' those who honour Allah's covenant, never breaking the pledge

²¹and those who maintain whatever 'ties' Allah has ordered to be maintained, stand in awe of their Lord, and fear strict judgment

²²And 'they are' those who endure patiently, seeking their Lord's pleasure, establish prayer, donate from what We have provided for them—secretly and openly—and respond to evil with good. It is they who will have the ultimate abode

²³the Gardens of Eternity, which they will enter along with the righteous among their parents, spouses, and descendants. And the angels will enter upon them from every gate, 'saying,'

²⁴"Peace be upon you for your perseverance. How excellent is the ultimate abode!"

²⁵And those who violate Allah's covenant after it has been affirmed, break whatever 'ties' Allah has ordered to be maintained, and spread corruption in the land—it is they who will be condemned and will have the worst abode

²⁶Allah gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills. And the disbelievers become prideful of 'the pleasures of' this worldly life. But the life of this world, compared to the Hereafter, is nothing but a fleeting enjoyment

²⁷The disbelievers say, "If only a sign could be sent down to him from his Lord." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Indeed, Allah leaves to stray whoever He wills, and guides to Himself whoever turns to Him—

²⁸those who believe and whose hearts find comfort in the remembrance of Allah. Surely in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find comfort

²⁹Those who believe and do good, for them will be bliss and an honourable destination."

³⁰And so We have sent you 'O Prophet' to a community, like 'We did with' earlier communities, so that you may recite to them what We have revealed to you. Yet they deny the Most Compassionate. Say, "He is my Lord! There is no god 'worthy

of worship' except Him. In Him I put my trust, and to Him I turn 'in repentance'."

³¹If there were a recitation that could cause mountains to move, or the earth to split, or the dead to speak, 'it would have been this Quran'. But all matters are by Allah's Will. Have the believers not yet realized that had Allah willed, He could have guided all of humanity? And disasters will continue to afflict the disbelievers or strike close to their homes for their misdeeds, until Allah's promise comes to pass. Surely Allah never fails in His promise

³²Other messengers had already been ridiculed before you, but I delayed the disbelievers 'for a while' then seized them. And how 'horrible' was My punishment

³³Is 'there any equal to' the Vigilant One Who knows what every soul commits? Yet the pagans have associated others with Allah 'in worship'. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Name them! Or do you 'mean to' inform Him of something He does not know on the earth? Or are these 'gods' just empty words?" In fact, the disbelievers' falsehood has been made so appealing to them that they have been turned away from the Path. And whoever Allah leaves to stray will be left with no guide

³⁴For them is punishment in this worldly life, but the punishment of the Hereafter is truly far worse. And none can shield them from Allah

³⁵The description of the Paradise promised to the righteous is that under it rivers flow; eternal is its fruit as well as its shade. That is the 'ultimate' outcome for the righteous. But the outcome for the disbelievers is the Fire

³⁶"The believers among' those who were given the Scripture rejoice at what has been revealed to you 'O Prophet', while some 'disbelieving' factions deny a portion of it. Say, "I have only been commanded to worship Allah, associating none with Him 'in worship'. To Him I invite 'all', and to Him is my return."

³⁷And so We have revealed it as an authority in Arabic. And if you were to follow their desires after 'all' the knowledge that has come to you, there would be none to protect or shield you from Allah

³⁸We have certainly sent messengers before you 'O Prophet' and blessed them with wives and offspring. It was not for any messenger to bring a sign without Allah's permission. Every destined matter has a 'set' time

³⁹Allah eliminates and confirms what He wills, and with Him is the Master Record

⁴⁰Whether We show you 'O Prophet' some of what We threaten them with, or cause you to die 'before that', your duty is only to deliver 'the message'. Judgment is for Us

⁴¹Do they not see that We gradually reduce their land from its borders? Allah decides—none can reverse His decision. And He is swift in reckoning

⁴²Those 'disbelievers' before them 'secretly' planned, but Allah has the ultimate plan. He knows what every soul commits. And the disbelievers will soon know who will have the ultimate outcome

⁴³The disbelievers say, "You 'Muḥammad' are no messenger." Say, 'O Prophet,' "Allah is sufficient as a Witness between me and you, as is whoever has knowledge of the Scripture."

Ibrāhīm

Abraham • 52 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Ra. 'This is' a Book which We have revealed to you 'O Prophet' so that you may lead people out of darkness and into light, by the Will of their Lord, to the Path of the Almighty, the Praiseworthy—

²Allah, to Whom belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And woe to the disbelievers because of a severe torment

³'They are' the ones who favour the life of this world over the Hereafter and hinder 'others' from the Way of Allah, striving to make it 'appear' crooked. It is they who have gone far astray

⁴We have not sent a messenger except in the language of his people to clarify 'the message' for them. Then Allah leaves whoever He wills to stray and guides whoever He wills. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

⁵Indeed, We sent Moses with Our signs, 'ordering him,' "Lead your people out of darkness and into light, and remind them of Allah's days 'of favour'." Surely in this are signs for whoever is steadfast, grateful

⁶'Consider' when Moses said to his people, "Remember Allah's favour upon you when He rescued you from the people of Pharaoh, who afflicted you with dreadful torment—slaughtering your sons and keeping your women. That was a severe test from your Lord

⁷And 'remember' when your Lord proclaimed, 'If you are grateful, I will certainly give you more. But if you are ungrateful, surely My punishment is severe.'"

⁸Moses added, "If you along with everyone on earth were to be ungrateful, then 'know that' Allah is indeed Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy."

⁹Have you not 'already' received the stories of those who were before you: the people of Noah, 'Âd, Thamûd, and those after them? Only Allah knows how many they were. Their messengers came to them with clear proofs, but they put their hands over their mouths and said, "We totally reject what you have been sent with, and we are certainly in alarming doubt about what you are inviting us to."

¹⁰Their messengers asked 'them', "Is there any doubt about Allah, the Originator of the heavens and the earth? He is inviting you in order to forgive your sins, and delay your end until your appointed term." They argued, "You are no more than humans like us! You 'only' wish to turn us away from what our forefathers worshipped. So bring us some compelling proof."

¹¹Their messengers said to them, "We are 'indeed' only humans like you, but Allah favours whoever He chooses of His servants. It is not for us to bring you any proof without Allah's permission. And in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹²Why should we not put our trust in Allah, when He has truly guided us to 'the very best of' ways? Indeed, we will patiently endure whatever harm you may cause us. And in Allah let the faithful put their trust."

¹³The disbelievers then threatened their messengers, "We will certainly expel you from our land, unless you return to our faith." So their Lord revealed to them, "We will surely destroy the wrongdoers

¹⁴and make you reside in the land after them. This is for whoever is in awe of standing before Me and fears My warning."

¹⁵And both sides called for judgment, so every stubborn tyrant was doomed

¹⁶Awaiting them is Hell, and they will be left to drink oozing pus

¹⁷which they will sip with difficulty, and can hardly swallow. Death will overwhelm them from every side, yet they will not 'be able to' die. Awaiting them still is harsher torment

¹⁸The parable of the deeds of those who disbelieve in their Lord is that of ashes fiercely blown away by wind on a stormy day. They will gain nothing from what they have earned. That is 'truly' the farthest one can stray

¹⁹Have you not seen that Allah created the heavens and the earth for a reason? If He wills, He can eliminate you and produce a new creation

²⁰And that is not difficult for Allah 'at all'

²¹They will all appear before Allah, and the lowly 'followers' will appeal to the arrogant 'leaders', "We were your 'dedicated' followers, so will you 'then' protect us from Allah's torment in any way?" They will reply, "Had Allah guided us, we would have guided you. 'Now' it is all the same for

us whether we suffer patiently or impatiently, there is no escape for us.”

²²And Satan will say ‘to his followers’ after the judgment has been passed, “Indeed, Allah has made you a true promise. I too made you a promise, but I failed you. I did not have any authority over you. I only called you, and you responded to me. So do not blame me; blame yourselves. I cannot save you, nor can you save me. Indeed, I denounce your previous association of me with Allah ‘in loyalty’. Surely the wrongdoers will suffer a painful punishment.”

²³Those who believe and do good will be admitted into Gardens, under which rivers flow—to stay there forever by the Will of their Lord—where they will be greeted with “Peace!”

²⁴Do you not see how Allah compares a good word to a good tree? Its root is firm and its branches reach the sky

²⁵‘always’ yielding its fruit in every season by the Will of its Lord. This is how Allah sets forth parables for the people, so perhaps they will be mindful

²⁶And the parable of an evil word is that of an evil tree, uprooted from the earth, having no stability

²⁷Allah makes the believers steadfast with the firm Word 'of faith' in this worldly life and the Hereafter. And Allah leaves the wrongdoers to stray. For Allah does what He wills

²⁸Have you not seen those 'disbelievers' who meet Allah's favours with ingratitude and lead their own people to their doom

²⁹In Hell they will burn. What an evil place for settlement

³⁰They set up equals to Allah to mislead 'others' from His Way. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Enjoy yourselves! Surely your destination is the Fire."

³¹Tell My believing servants to establish prayer and donate from what We have provided for them—openly and secretly—before the arrival of a Day in which there will be no ransom or friendly connections

³²It is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth and sends down rain from the sky, causing fruits to grow as a provision for you. He has subjected the ships for your service, sailing through the sea by His command, and has subjected the rivers for you

³³He has 'also' subjected for you the sun and the moon, both constantly orbiting, and has subjected the day and night for you

³⁴And He has granted you all that you asked Him for. If you tried to count Allah's blessings, you would never be able to number them. Indeed humankind is truly unfair, 'totally' ungrateful

³⁵'Remember' when Abraham prayed, "My Lord! Make this city 'of Mecca' secure, and keep me and my children away from the worship of idols

³⁶My Lord! They have caused many people to go astray. So whoever follows me is with me, and whoever disobeys me—then surely You are 'still' All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

³⁷Our Lord! I have settled some of my offspring in a barren valley, near Your Sacred House, our Lord, so that they may establish prayer. So make the hearts of 'believing' people incline towards them and provide them with fruits, so perhaps they will be thankful

³⁸Our Lord! You certainly know what we conceal and what we reveal. Nothing on earth or in heaven is hidden from Allah

³⁹All praise is for Allah who has blessed me with Ishmael and Isaac in my old age. My Lord is indeed the Hearer of 'all' prayers

⁴⁰My Lord! Make me and those 'believers' of my descendants keep up prayer. Our Lord! Accept my prayers

⁴¹Our Lord! Forgive me, my parents, and the believers on the Day when the judgment will come to pass.”

⁴²Do not think 'O Prophet' that Allah is unaware of what the wrongdoers do. He only delays them until a Day when 'their' eyes will stare in horror—

⁴³rushing forth, heads raised, never blinking, hearts void

⁴⁴And warn the people of the Day when the punishment will overtake 'the wicked among' them, and the wrongdoers will cry, “Our Lord! Delay us for a little while. We will respond to Your call and follow the messengers!” 'It will be said,' “Did you not swear before that you would never be removed 'to the next life'?”

⁴⁵You passed by the ruins of those 'destroyed peoples' who had wronged themselves. It was made clear to you how We dealt with them, and We gave you 'many' examples

⁴⁶They devised every plot, which was fully known to Allah, but their plotting was not enough to ‘even’ overpower mountains ‘let alone Allah’

⁴⁷So do not think ‘O Prophet’ that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His messengers. Allah is indeed Almighty, capable of punishment

⁴⁸‘Watch for’ the Day ‘when’ the earth will be changed into a different earth and the heavens as well, and all will appear before Allah—the One, the Supreme

⁴⁹On that Day you will see the wicked bound together in chains

⁵⁰with garments of tar, and their faces covered with flames

⁵¹As such, Allah will reward every soul for what it has committed. Surely Allah is swift in reckoning

⁵²This ‘Quran’ is a ‘sufficient’ message for humanity so that they may take it as a warning and know that there is only One God, and so that people of reason may be mindful

Al-Ḥijr

The Rocky Highlands • 99 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Ra. These are the verses of the Book; the clear Quran

²“The day will come when the disbelievers will certainly wish they had submitted to Allah”

³“So let them eat and enjoy themselves and be diverted by false hope, for they will soon know

⁴We have never destroyed a society without a destined term

⁵No people can advance their doom, nor can they delay it

⁶They say, “O you to whom the Reminder is revealed! You must be insane

⁷Why do you not bring us the angels, if what you say is true?”

⁸We do not send the angels down except for a just cause, and then the end of the disbelievers will not be delayed

⁹It is certainly We Who have revealed the Reminder, and it is certainly We Who will preserve it

¹⁰Indeed, We sent messengers before you 'O Prophet' among the groups of early peoples

¹¹but no messenger ever came to them without being mocked

¹²This is how We allow disbelief 'to steep' into the hearts of the wicked

¹³They would not believe in this 'Quran' despite the 'many' examples of those 'destroyed' before

¹⁴And even if We opened for them a gate to heaven, through which they continued to ascend

¹⁵still they would say, "Our eyes have truly been dazzled! In fact, we must have been bewitched."

¹⁶Indeed, We have placed constellations in the sky, and adorned it for all to see

¹⁷And We protected it from every accursed devil

¹⁸except the one eavesdropping, who is then pursued by a visible flare

¹⁹As for the earth, We spread it out and placed upon it firm mountains, and caused everything to grow there in perfect balance

²⁰And We made in it means of sustenance for you and others, who you do not provide for

²¹There is not any means 'of sustenance' whose reserves We do not hold, only bringing it forth in precise measure

²²We send fertilizing winds, and bring down rain from the sky for you to drink. It is not you who hold its reserves

²³Surely it is We Who give life and cause death. And We are the 'Eternal' Successor

²⁴We certainly know those who have gone before you and those who will come after 'you'

²⁵Surely your Lord 'alone' will gather them together 'for judgment'. He is truly All-Wise, All-Knowing

²⁶Indeed, We created man from sounding clay moulded from black mud

²⁷As for the jinn, We created them earlier from smokeless fire

²⁸'Remember, O Prophet' when your Lord said to the angels, "I am going to create a human being from sounding clay moulded from black mud

²⁹So when I have fashioned him and had a spirit of My Own 'creation' breathed into him, fall down in prostration to him."

³⁰So the angels prostrated all together—

³¹but not Iblīs, who refused to prostrate with the others

³²Allah asked, “O Iblîs! What is the matter with you that you did not join others in prostration?”

³³He replied, “It is not for me to prostrate to a human You created from sounding clay moulded from black mud.”

³⁴Allah commanded, “Then get out of Paradise, for you are truly cursed

³⁵And surely upon you is condemnation until the Day of Judgment.”

³⁶Satan appealed, “My Lord! Then delay my end until the Day of their resurrection.”

³⁷Allah said, “You will be delayed

³⁸until the appointed Day.”

³⁹Satan responded, “My Lord! For allowing me to stray I will surely tempt them on earth and mislead them all together

⁴⁰except Your chosen servants among them.”

⁴¹Allah said, “This is the Way, binding on Me

⁴²you will certainly have no authority over My servants, except the deviant who follow you

⁴³and surely Hell is their destined place, all together

⁴⁴It has seven gates, to each a group of them is designated.”

⁴⁵Indeed, the righteous will be amid Gardens and springs

⁴⁶It will be said to them, 'Enter in peace and security.'

⁴⁷We will remove whatever bitterness they had in their hearts. In a friendly manner, they will be on thrones, facing one another

⁴⁸No fatigue will touch them there, nor will they ever be asked to leave

⁴⁹Inform My servants 'O Prophet' that I am truly the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁵⁰and that My torment is indeed the most painful

⁵¹And inform them 'O Prophet' about Abraham's guests

⁵²who entered upon him and greeted 'him with', "Peace!" He 'later' said, "Surely we are afraid of you."

⁵³They reassured 'him', "Do not be afraid! Surely we give you good news of a knowledgeable son."

⁵⁴He wondered, "Do you give me good news despite my old age? What unlikely news!"

⁵⁵They responded, "We give you good news in all truth, so do not be one of those who despair."

⁵⁶He exclaimed, "Who would despair of the mercy of their Lord except the misguided?"

⁵⁷He 'then' added, "What is your mission, O messenger-angels?"

⁵⁸They replied, “We have actually been sent to a wicked people

⁵⁹As for the family of Lot, we will certainly deliver them all

⁶⁰except his wife. We have determined that she will be one of the doomed.”

⁶¹So when the messengers came to the family of Lot

⁶²he said, “You are surely an unfamiliar people!”

⁶³They responded, “We have come to you with that ‘torment’ which they have doubted

⁶⁴We come to you with the truth, and we are certainly truthful

⁶⁵So travel with your family in the dark of night, and follow ‘closely’ behind them. Do not let any of you look back, and go where you are commanded.”

⁶⁶We revealed to him this decree: “Those ‘sinners’ will be uprooted in the morning.”

⁶⁷And there came the men of the city, rejoicing

⁶⁸Lot pleaded, “Indeed, these are my guests, so do not embarrass me

⁶⁹Fear Allah and do not humiliate me.”

⁷⁰They responded, “Have we not forbidden you from protecting anyone?”

⁷¹He said, “O my people! Here are my daughters ‘so marry them’ if you wish to do so.”

⁷²By your life ‘O Prophet’, they certainly wandered blindly, intoxicated ‘by lust’

⁷³So the ‘mighty’ blast overtook them at sunrise

⁷⁴And We turned the cities ‘of Sodom and Gomorrah’ upside down and rained upon them stones of baked clay

⁷⁵Surely in this are signs for those who contemplate

⁷⁶Their ruins still lie along a known route

⁷⁷Surely in this is a sign for those who believe

⁷⁸And the residents of the Forest were truly wrongdoers

⁷⁹so We inflicted punishment upon them. The ruins of both nations still lie on a well-known road

⁸⁰Indeed, the residents of the Stone Valley also denied the messengers

⁸¹We gave them Our signs, but they turned away from them

⁸²They carved their homes in the mountains, feeling secure

⁸³But the ‘mighty’ blast overtook them in the morning

⁸⁴and all they achieved was of no help to them

⁸⁵We have not created the heavens and the earth and everything in between except for a purpose. And the Hour is certain to come, so forgive graciously

⁸⁶Surely your Lord is the Master Creator, All-Knowing

⁸⁷We have certainly granted you the seven often-repeated verses and the great Quran

⁸⁸Do not let your eyes crave the 'fleeting' pleasures We have provided for some of the disbelievers, nor grieve for them. And be gracious to the believers

⁸⁹And say, "I am truly sent with a clear warning"—

⁹⁰'a warning' similar to what We sent to those who divided 'the Scriptures'

⁹¹who 'now' accept parts of the Quran, rejecting others

⁹²So by your Lord! We will certainly question them all

⁹³about what they used to do

⁹⁴So proclaim what you have been commanded, and turn away from the polytheists

⁹⁵Surely We will be sufficient for you against the mockers

⁹⁶who set up 'other' gods with Allah. They will soon come to know

⁹⁷We certainly know that your heart is truly distressed by what they say

⁹⁸So glorify the praises of your Lord and be one of those who 'always' pray

⁹⁹and worship your Lord until the inevitable comes your way

An-Naḥl

The Bees • 128 verses

¹The command of Allah is at hand, so do not hasten it. Glorified and Exalted is He above what they associate 'with Him in worship'

²He sends down the angels with revelation by His command to whoever He wills of His servants, 'stating:' "Warn 'humanity' that there is no god 'worthy of worship' except Me, so be mindful of Me 'alone'."

³He created the heavens and the earth for a purpose. Exalted is He above what they associate with Him 'in worship'

⁴He created humans from a sperm-drop, then—behold!—they openly challenge 'Him'

⁵And He created the cattle for you as a source of warmth, food, and 'many other' benefits

⁶They are also pleasing to you when you bring them home and when you take them out to graze

⁷And they carry your loads to 'distant' lands which you could not otherwise reach without great hardship. Surely your Lord is Ever Gracious, Most Merciful

⁸'He also created' horses, mules, and donkeys for your transportation and adornment. And He creates what you do not know

⁹It is upon Allah 'alone' to 'clearly' show the Straight Way. Other ways are deviant. Had He willed, He would have easily imposed guidance upon all of you

¹⁰He is the One Who sends down rain from the sky, from which you drink and by which plants grow for your cattle to graze

¹¹With it He produces for you 'various' crops, olives, palm trees, grapevines, and every type of fruit. Surely in this is a sign for those who reflect

¹²And He has subjected for your benefit the day and the night, the sun and the moon. And the stars have been subjected by His command. Surely in this are signs for those who understand

¹³And 'He subjected' for you whatever He has created on earth of varying colours. Surely in this is a sign for those who are mindful

¹⁴And He is the One Who has subjected the sea, so from it you may eat tender seafood and extract ornaments to wear. And you see the ships ploughing their way through it, so you may seek His bounty and give thanks 'to Him'

¹⁵He has placed into the earth firm mountains, so it does not shake with you, as well as rivers, and pathways so you may find your way

¹⁶Also by landmarks and stars do people find their way

¹⁷Can the One Who creates be equal to those who do not? Will you not then be mindful

¹⁸If you tried to count Allah's blessings, you would never be able to number them. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁹And Allah knows what you conceal and what you reveal

²⁰But those 'idols' they invoke besides Allah cannot create anything—they themselves are created

²¹They are dead, not alive—not even knowing when their followers will be resurrected

²²Your God is 'only' One God. As for those who do not believe in the Hereafter, their hearts are in denial, and they are too proud

²³Without a doubt, Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal. He certainly does not like those who are too proud

²⁴And when it is said to them, "What has your Lord revealed?" They say, "Ancient fables!"

²⁵Let them bear their burdens in full on the Day of Judgment as well as some of the burdens of those they mislead without knowledge. Evil indeed is what they will bear

²⁶Indeed, those before them had plotted, but Allah struck at the 'very' foundation of their structure, so the roof collapsed on top of them, and the torment came upon them from where they did not expect

²⁷Then on the Day of Judgment He will humiliate them and say, "Where are My 'so-called' associate-gods for whose sake you used to oppose 'the believers'?" Those gifted with knowledge will say, "Surely disgrace and misery today are upon the disbelievers."

²⁸Those whose souls the angels seize while they wrong themselves will then offer 'full' submission 'and say falsely,' "We did not do any evil." 'The angels will say,' "No! Surely Allah fully knows what you used to do

²⁹So enter the gates of Hell, to stay there forever. Indeed, what an evil home for the arrogant!"

³⁰And 'when' it is said to those mindful 'of Allah', "What has your Lord revealed?" They say, "All the best!" For those who do good in this world, there is goodness. But far better is the 'eternal' Home of the Hereafter. How excellent indeed is the home of the righteous

³¹the Gardens of Eternity which they will enter, under which rivers flow. In it they will have whatever they desire. This is how Allah rewards the righteous—

³²those whose souls the angels take while they are virtuous, saying 'to them', "Peace be upon you! Enter Paradise for what you used to do."

³³Are they only awaiting the coming of the angels or the command of your Lord 'O Prophet'? So were those before them. And Allah never wronged them, but it was they who wronged themselves

³⁴Then the evil ‘consequences’ of their deeds overtook them, and they were overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

³⁵The polytheists argue, “Had Allah willed, neither we nor our forefathers would have worshipped anything other than Him, nor prohibited anything without His command.” So did those before them. Is not the messengers’ duty only to deliver ‘the message’ clearly

³⁶We surely sent a messenger to every community, saying, “Worship Allah and shun false gods.” But some of them were guided by Allah, while others were destined to stray. So travel throughout the land and see the fate of the deniers

³⁷Even though you ‘O Prophet’ are keen on their guidance, Allah certainly does not guide those He leaves to stray, and they will have no helpers

³⁸They swear by Allah their most solemn oaths that Allah will never raise the dead to life. Yes ‘He will’! It is a true promise binding on Him, but most people do not know

³⁹‘He will do that’ to make clear to them what they disagreed on, and for the disbelievers to know that they were liars

⁴⁰If We ever will something ‘to exist’, all We say is: “Be!” And it is

⁴¹As for those who emigrated in 'the cause of' Allah after being persecuted, We will surely bless them with a good home in this world. But the reward of the Hereafter is far better, if only they knew

⁴²'It is' they who have patiently endured, and in their Lord they put their trust

⁴³We did not send 'messengers' before you 'O Prophet' except mere men inspired by Us. If you 'polytheists' do not know 'this already', then ask those who have knowledge 'of the Scriptures'

⁴⁴'We sent them' with clear proofs and divine Books. And We have sent down to you 'O Prophet' the Reminder, so that you may explain to people what has been revealed for them, and perhaps they will reflect

⁴⁵Do those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allah will not cause the earth to swallow them? Or that the torment will not come upon them in ways they cannot comprehend

⁴⁶Or that He will not seize them while they go about 'their day', for then they will have no escape

⁴⁷Or that He will not destroy them gradually? But your Lord is truly Ever Gracious, Most Merciful

⁴⁸Have they not considered how the shadows of everything Allah has created incline to the right and the left 'as the sun moves', totally submitting to Allah in all humility

⁴⁹And to Allah 'alone' bows down 'in submission' whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth of living creatures, as do the angels—who are not too proud 'to do so'

⁵⁰They fear their Lord above them, and do whatever they are commanded

⁵¹And Allah has said, "Do not take two gods. There is only One God. So be in awe of Me 'alone'."

⁵²To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth, and to Him 'alone' is the everlasting devotion. Will you then fear any other than Allah

⁵³Whatever blessings you have are from Allah. Then whenever hardship touches you, to Him 'alone' you cry 'for help'

⁵⁴Then as soon as He removes the hardship from you, a group of you associates 'others' with their Lord 'in worship'

⁵⁵only returning Our favours with ingratitude. So enjoy yourselves, for you will soon know

⁵⁶And they 'even' assign to those 'idols'—who know nothing—a share of what We have provided for them. By Allah! You

will certainly be questioned about whatever 'lies' you used to fabricate 'against Allah'

⁵⁷And they attribute 'angels as' daughters to Allah—glory be to Him!—the opposite of what they desire for themselves

⁵⁸Whenever one of them is given the good news of a baby girl, his face grows gloomy, as he suppresses his rage

⁵⁹He hides himself from the people because of the bad news he has received. Should he keep her in disgrace, or bury her 'alive' in the ground? Evil indeed is their judgment

⁶⁰To those who disbelieve in the Hereafter belong all evil qualities, whereas to Allah belong the finest attributes. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

⁶¹If Allah were to punish people 'immediately' for their wrongdoing, He would not have left a single living being on earth. But He delays them for an appointed term. And when their time arrives, they cannot delay it for a moment, nor could they advance it

⁶²They attribute to Allah what they hate 'for themselves', and their tongues utter the lie that they will have the finest reward. Without a doubt, for them is the Fire, where they will be abandoned

⁶³By Allah! We have surely sent messengers to communities before you 'O Prophet', but Satan made their misdeeds appealing to them. So he is their patron today, and they will suffer a painful punishment

⁶⁴We have revealed to you the Book only to clarify for them what they differed about, and as a guide and mercy for those who believe

⁶⁵And Allah sends down rain from the sky, giving life to the earth after its death. Surely in this is a sign for those who listen

⁶⁶And there is certainly a lesson for you in cattle: We give you to drink of what is in their bellies, from between digested food and blood: pure milk, pleasant to drink

⁶⁷And from the fruits of palm trees and grapevines you derive intoxicants as well as wholesome provision. Surely in this is a sign for those who understand

⁶⁸And your Lord inspired the bees: "Make 'your' homes in the mountains, the trees, and in what people construct

⁶⁹and feed from 'the flower of' any fruit 'you please' and follow the ways your Lord has made easy for you." From their bellies comes forth liquid of varying colours, in which there

is healing for people. Surely in this is a sign for those who reflect

⁷⁰Allah has created you, and then causes you to die. And some of you are left to reach the most feeble stage of life so that they may know nothing after having known much. Indeed, Allah is All-Knowing, Most Capable

⁷¹And Allah has favoured some of you over others in provision. But those who have been much favoured would not share their wealth with those 'bondspeople' in their possession, making them their equals. Do they then deny Allah's favours

⁷²And Allah has made for you spouses of your own kind, and given you through your spouses children and grandchildren. And He has granted you good, lawful provisions. Are they then faithful to falsehood and ungrateful for Allah's favours

⁷³Yet they worship besides Allah those 'idols' who do not afford them any provision from the heavens and the earth, nor do they have the power to

⁷⁴So do not set up equals to Allah, for Allah certainly knows and you do not know

⁷⁵ Allah sets forth a parable: a slave who lacks all means, compared to a 'free' man to whom We granted a good provision, of which he donates 'freely,' openly and secretly. Are they equal? Praise be to Allah. In fact, most of them do not know

⁷⁶ And Allah sets forth a parable of two men: one of them is dumb, incapable of anything. He is a burden on his master. Wherever he is sent, he brings no good. Can such a person be equal to the one who commands justice and is on the Straight Path

⁷⁷ To Allah 'alone' belongs 'the knowledge of' the unseen in the heavens and the earth. Bringing about the Hour would only take the blink of an eye, or even less. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁷⁸ And Allah brought you out of the wombs of your mothers while you knew nothing, and gave you hearing, sight, and intellect so perhaps you would be thankful

⁷⁹ Have they not seen the birds glide in the open sky? None holds them up except Allah. Surely in this are signs for those who believe

⁸⁰ And Allah has made your homes a place to rest, and has given you tents from the hide of animals, light to handle when

you travel and when you camp. And out of their wool, fur, and hair He has given you furnishings and goods for a while

⁸¹And Allah has provided you shade out of what He created, and has given you shelter in the mountains. He has also provided you with clothes protecting you from the heat 'and cold', and armour shielding you in battle. This is how He perfects His favour upon you, so perhaps you will 'fully' submit 'to Him'

⁸²But if they turn away, then your duty 'O Prophet' is only to deliver 'the message' clearly

⁸³They are aware of Allah's favours, but still deny them. And most of them are 'truly' ungrateful

⁸⁴'Consider, O Prophet,' the Day We will call 'a prophet as' a witness from every faith-community. Then the disbelievers will neither be allowed to plead nor appease 'their Lord'

⁸⁵And when the wrongdoers face the punishment, it will not be lightened for them, nor will they be delayed 'from it'

⁸⁶And when the polytheists see their associate-gods, they will say, "Our Lord! These are our associate-gods that we used to invoke besides You." Their gods will throw a rebuttal at them, 'saying,' "You are definitely liars."

⁸⁷They will offer 'full' submission to Allah on that Day, and whatever 'gods' they fabricated will fail them

⁸⁸For those who disbelieve and hinder 'others' from the Way of Allah, We will add more punishment to their punishment for all the corruption they spread

⁸⁹'Consider, O Prophet,' the Day We will call against every faith-community a witness of their own. And We will call you to be a witness against these 'people of yours'. We have revealed to you the Book as an explanation of all things, a guide, a mercy, and good news for those who 'fully' submit

⁹⁰Indeed, Allah commands justice, grace, as well as courtesy to close relatives. He forbids indecency, wickedness, and aggression. He instructs you so perhaps you will be mindful

⁹¹Honour Allah's covenant when you make a pledge, and do not break your oaths after confirming them, having made Allah your guarantor. Surely Allah knows all you do

⁹²Do not be like the woman who 'foolishly' unravels her yarn after it is firmly spun, by taking your oaths as a means of deceiving one another in favour of a stronger group. Surely Allah tests you through this. And on the Day of Judgment He will certainly make your differences clear to you

⁹³Had Allah willed, He could have easily made you one community 'of believers', but He leaves to stray whoever He wills and guides whoever He wills. And you will certainly be questioned about what you used to do

⁹⁴And do not take your oaths as a means of deceiving one another or your feet will slip after they have been firm. Then you will taste the evil 'consequences' of hindering 'others' from the Way of Allah, and you will suffer a tremendous punishment

⁹⁵And do not trade Allah's covenant for a fleeting gain. What is with Allah is certainly far better for you, if only you knew

⁹⁶Whatever you have will end, but whatever Allah has is everlasting. And We will certainly reward the steadfast according to the best of their deeds

⁹⁷Whoever does good, whether male or female, and is a believer, We will surely bless them with a good life, and We will certainly reward them according to the best of their deeds

⁹⁸When you recite the Quran, seek refuge with Allah from Satan, the accursed

⁹⁹He certainly has no authority over those who believe and put their trust in their Lord

100 His authority is only over those who take him as a patron and who—under his influence—associate ‘others’ with Allah ‘in worship’

101 When We replace a verse with another—and Allah knows best what He reveals—they say, “You ‘Muḥammad’ are just a fabricator.” In fact, most of them do not know

102 Say, “The holy spirit has brought it down from your Lord with the truth to reassure the believers, and as a guide and good news for those who submit ‘to Allah’.”

103 And We surely know that they say, “No one is teaching him except a human.” But the man they refer to speaks a foreign tongue, whereas this ‘Quran’ is ‘in’ eloquent Arabic

104 Surely those who do not believe in Allah’s revelations will never be guided by Allah, and they will suffer a painful punishment

105 No one fabricates lies except those who disbelieve in Allah’s revelations, and it is they who are the ‘true’ liars

106 Whoever disbelieves in Allah after their belief—not those who are forced while their hearts are firm in faith, but those who embrace disbelief wholeheartedly—they will be condemned by Allah and suffer a tremendous punishment

107 This is because they prefer the life of this world over the Hereafter. Surely Allah never guides those who 'choose to' disbelieve

108 They are the ones whose hearts, ears, and eyes are sealed by Allah, and it is they who are 'truly' heedless

109 Without a doubt, they will be the losers in the Hereafter

110 As for those who emigrated after being compelled 'to renounce Islam', then struggled 'in Allah's cause', and persevered, your Lord 'O Prophet' is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful after all

111 'Consider' the Day 'when' every soul will come pleading for itself, and each will be paid in full for what it did, and none will be wronged

112 And Allah sets forth the example of a society which was safe and at ease, receiving its provision in abundance from all directions. But its people met Allah's favours with ingratitude, so Allah made them taste the clutches of hunger and fear for their misdeeds

113 A messenger of their own actually did come to them, but they denied him. So the torment overtook them while they persisted in wrongdoing

114 So eat from the good, lawful things which Allah has provided for you, and be grateful for Allah's favours, if you 'truly' worship Him 'alone'

115 He has only forbidden you 'to eat' carrion, blood, swine, and what is slaughtered in the name of any other than Allah. But if someone is compelled by necessity—neither driven by desire nor exceeding immediate need—then surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

116 Do not falsely declare with your tongues, "This is lawful, and that is unlawful," 'only' fabricating lies against Allah. Indeed, those who fabricate lies against Allah will never succeed

117 'It is only' a brief enjoyment, then they will suffer a painful punishment

118 To the Jews, We have forbidden what We related to you before. We did not wrong them, but it was they who wronged themselves

119 As for those who commit evil ignorantly 'or recklessly', then repent afterwards and mend their ways, then your Lord is surely All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹²⁰Indeed, Abraham was a model of excellence: devoted to Allah, ‘perfectly’ upright—not a polytheist—

¹²¹‘utterly’ grateful for Allah’s favours. ‘So’ He chose him and guided him to the Straight Path

¹²²We blessed him with all goodness in this world, and in the Hereafter he will certainly be among the righteous

¹²³Then We revealed to you ‘O Prophet, saying’: “Follow the faith of Abraham, the upright, who was not one of the polytheists.”

¹²⁴‘Honouring’ the Sabbath was ordained only for those who disputed about Abraham. And surely your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Judgment regarding their disputes

¹²⁵Invite ‘all’ to the Way of your Lord with wisdom and kind advice, and only debate with them in the best manner. Surely your Lord ‘alone’ knows best who has strayed from His Way and who is ‘rightly’ guided

¹²⁶If you retaliate, then let it be equivalent to what you have suffered. But if you patiently endure, it is certainly best for those who are patient

¹²⁷Be patient 'O Prophet', for your patience is only with Allah's help. Do not grieve over those 'who disbelieve', nor be distressed by their schemes

¹²⁸Surely Allah is with those who shun evil and who do good 'deeds'

Al-Isrā'

The Night Journey • 111 verses

¹Glory be to the One Who took His servant 'Muḥammad' by night from the Sacred Mosque to the Farthest Mosque whose surroundings We have blessed, so that We may show him some of Our signs. Indeed, He alone is the All-Hearing, All-Seeing

²And We gave Moses the Scripture and made it a guide for the Children of Israel, 'stating:' "Do not take besides Me any other Trustee of Affairs

³'O' descendants of those We carried with Noah 'in the Ark'! He was indeed a grateful servant."

⁴And We warned the Children of Israel in the Scripture, "You will certainly cause corruption in the land twice, and you will become extremely arrogant

⁵When the first of the two warnings would come to pass, We would send against you some of Our servants of great might,

who would ravage your homes. This would be a warning fulfilled

⁶Then 'after your repentance' We would give you the upper hand over them and aid you with wealth and offspring, causing you to outnumber them

⁷If you act rightly, it is for your own good, but if you do wrong, it is to your own loss. "And when the second warning would come to pass, your enemies would 'be left to' totally disgrace you and enter the Temple 'of Jerusalem' as they entered it the first time, and utterly destroy whatever would fall into their hands

⁸Perhaps your Lord will have mercy on you 'if you repent', but if you return 'to sin', We will return 'to punishment'. And We have made Hell a 'permanent' confinement for the disbelievers."

⁹Surely this Quran guides to what is most upright, and gives good news to the believers—who do good—that they will have a mighty reward

¹⁰And 'it warns' those who do not believe in the Hereafter 'that' We have prepared for them a painful punishment

¹¹And humans 'swiftly' pray for evil as they pray for good.
For humankind is ever hasty

¹²We made the day and night as two signs. So We made the sign of the night devoid of light, and We made the sign of the day 'perfectly' bright, so that you may seek the bounty of your Lord and know the number of years and calculation 'of time'. And We have explained everything in detail

¹³We have bound every human's destiny to their neck. And on the Day of Judgment We will bring forth to each 'person' a record which they will find laid open

¹⁴And it will be said, "Read your record. You 'alone' are sufficient this Day to take account of yourself."

¹⁵Whoever chooses to be guided, it is only for their own good. And whoever chooses to stray, it is only to their own loss. No soul burdened with sin will bear the burden of another. And We would never punish 'a people' until We have sent a messenger 'to warn them'

¹⁶Whenever We intend to destroy a society, We command its elite 'to obey Allah' but they act rebelliously in it. So the decree 'of punishment' is justified, and We destroy it utterly

¹⁷Imagine how many peoples We have destroyed after Noah! And sufficient is your Lord as All-Aware and All-Seeing of the sins of His servants

¹⁸Whoever desires this fleeting world 'alone', We hasten in it whatever We please to whoever We will; then We destine them for Hell, where they will burn, condemned and rejected

¹⁹But whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it accordingly, and is a 'true' believer, it is they whose striving will be appreciated

²⁰We provide both the former and the latter from the bounty of your Lord. And the bounty of your Lord can never be withheld

²¹See how We have favoured some over others 'in this life', but the Hereafter is certainly far greater in rank and in favour

²²Do not set up any other god with Allah, or you will end up condemned, abandoned

²³For your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And honour your parents. If one or both of them reach old age in your care, never say to them 'even' 'ugh,' nor yell at them. Rather, address them respectfully

²⁴And be humble with them out of mercy, and pray, "My Lord! Be merciful to them as they raised me when I was young."

²⁵Your Lord knows best what is within yourselves. If you are righteous, He is certainly All-Forgiving to those who 'constantly' turn to Him

²⁶Give to close relatives their due, as well as the poor and 'needy' travellers. And do not spend wastefully

²⁷Surely the wasteful are 'like' brothers to the devils. And the Devil is ever ungrateful to his Lord

²⁸But if you must turn them down 'because you lack the means to give'—while hoping to receive your Lord's bounty—then 'at least' give them a kind word

²⁹Do not be so tight-fisted, for you will be blameworthy; nor so open-handed, for you will end up in poverty

³⁰Surely your Lord gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills. He is certainly All-Aware, All-Seeing of His servants

³¹Do not kill your children for fear of poverty. We provide for them and for you. Surely killing them is a heinous sin

³²Do not go near adultery. It is truly a shameful deed and an evil way

³³Do not take a 'human' life—made sacred by Allah—except with 'legal' right. If anyone is killed unjustly, We have given their heirs the authority, but do not let them exceed limits in retaliation, for they are already supported 'by law'

³⁴Do not come near the wealth of the orphan—unless intending to enhance it—until they attain maturity. Honour 'your' pledges, for you will surely be accountable for them

³⁵Give in full when you measure, and weigh with an even balance. That is fairest and best in the end

³⁶Do not follow what you have no 'sure' knowledge of. Indeed, all will be called to account for 'their' hearing, sight, and intellect

³⁷And do not walk on the earth arrogantly. Surely you can neither crack the earth nor stretch to the height of the mountains

³⁸The violation of any of these 'commandments' is detestable to your Lord

³⁹This is part of the wisdom which your Lord has revealed to you 'O Prophet'. And do not set up any other god with Allah 'O humanity', or you will be cast into Hell, blameworthy, rejected

⁴⁰Has your Lord favoured you 'pagans' with sons and taken angels as 'His' daughters? You are truly making an outrageous claim

⁴¹We have surely varied 'the signs' in this Quran so perhaps they may be mindful, but it only drives them farther away

⁴²Say, 'O Prophet,' "Had there been other gods besides Him—as they claim—then they would have certainly sought a way to 'challenge' the Lord of the Throne."

⁴³Glorified and Highly Exalted is He above what they claim

⁴⁴The seven heavens, the earth, and all those in them glorify Him. There is not a single thing that does not glorify His praises—but you 'simply' cannot comprehend their glorification. He is indeed Most Forbearing, All-Forgiving

⁴⁵When you 'O Prophet' recite the Quran, We put a hidden barrier between you and those who do not believe in the Hereafter

⁴⁶We have cast veils over their hearts—leaving them unable to comprehend it—and deafness in their ears. And when you mention your Lord alone in the Quran, they turn their backs in aversion

⁴⁷We know best how they listen to your recitation and what they say privately—when the wrongdoers say, “You would only be following a bewitched man.”

⁴⁸See how they call you names ‘O Prophet’! So they have gone so ‘far’ astray that they cannot find the ‘Right’ Way

⁴⁹And they say ‘mockingly’, “When we are reduced to bones and ashes, will we really be raised as a new creation?”

⁵⁰Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “‘Yes, even if’ you become stones, or iron

⁵¹or whatever you think is harder to bring to life!” Then they will ask ‘you’, “Who will bring us back ‘to life?’” Say, “The One Who created you the first time.” They will then shake their heads at you and ask, “When will that be?” Say, “Perhaps it is soon!”

⁵²On the Day He will call you, you will ‘instantly’ respond by praising Him, thinking you had remained ‘in the world’ only for a little while

⁵³Tell My ‘believing’ servants to say only what is best. Satan certainly seeks to sow discord among them. Satan is indeed a sworn enemy to humankind

⁵⁴Your Lord knows you best. He may have mercy on you if He wills, or punish you if He wills. We have not sent you 'O Prophet' as a keeper over them

⁵⁵Your Lord knows best all those in the heavens and the earth. And We have surely favoured some prophets above others, and to David We gave the Psalms

⁵⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "Invoke those you claim 'to be divine' besides Him—they do not have the power to undo harm from you or transfer it 'to someone else'."

⁵⁷'Even' the closest 'to Allah' of those invoked would be seeking a way to their Lord, hoping for His mercy, and fearing His punishment. Indeed, your Lord's torment is fearsome

⁵⁸There is not a 'wicked' society that We will not destroy or punish with a severe torment before the Day of Judgment. That is written in the Record

⁵⁹Nothing keeps Us from sending the 'demanded' signs except that they had 'already' been denied by earlier peoples. And We gave Thamûd the she-camel as a clear sign, but they wrongfully rejected it. We only send the signs as a warning

⁶⁰And 'remember, O Prophet' when We told you, "Certainly your Lord encompasses the people." And We have made what

We brought you to see as well as the cursed tree ‘mentioned’ in the Quran only as a test for the people. We keep warning them, but it only increases them greatly in defiance

⁶¹And ‘remember’ when We said to the angels, “Prostrate before Adam,” so they all did—but not Iblīs, who protested, “Should I prostrate to the one You have created from mud?”

⁶²Adding, “Do you see this one you honoured above me? If you delay my end until the Day of Judgment, I will certainly take hold of his descendants, except for a few.”

⁶³Allah responded, “Be gone! Whoever of them follows you, Hell will surely be the reward for all of you—an ample reward

⁶⁴And incite whoever you can of them with your voice, mobilize against them all your cavalry and infantry, manipulate them in their wealth and children, and make them promises.” But Satan promises them nothing but delusion

⁶⁵‘Allah added,’ “You will truly have no authority over My ‘faithful’ servants.” And sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian

⁶⁶It is your Lord Who steers the ships for you through the sea, so that you may seek His bounty. Surely He is ever Merciful to you

⁶⁷When you are touched with hardship at sea, you 'totally' forget all 'the gods' you 'normally' invoke, except Him. But when He delivers you 'safely' to shore, you turn away. Humankind is ever ungrateful

⁶⁸Do you feel secure that He will not cause the land to swallow you up, or unleash upon you a storm of stones? Then you will find none to protect you

⁶⁹Or do you feel secure that He will not send you back to sea once again, and send upon you a violent storm, drowning you for your denial? Then you will find none to avenge you against Us

⁷⁰Indeed, We have dignified the children of Adam, carried them on land and sea, granted them good and lawful provisions, and privileged them far above many of Our creatures

⁷¹'Beware of' the Day We will summon every people with their leader. So whoever will be given their record in their right hand will read it 'happily' and will not be wronged 'even by the width of' the thread of a date stone

⁷²But whoever is blind 'to the truth' in this 'world' will be blind in the Hereafter, and 'even' far more astray from the 'Right' Way

⁷³They definitely ‘thought they’ were about to lure you away from what We have revealed to you ‘O Prophet’, hoping that you would attribute something else to Us falsely—and then they would have certainly taken you as a close friend

⁷⁴Had We not made you steadfast, you probably would have inclined to them a little

⁷⁵and then We truly would have made you taste double ‘punishment’ both in this life and after death, and you would have found no helper against Us

⁷⁶They were about to intimidate you to drive you out of the land ‘of Mecca’, but then they would not have survived after you ‘had left’ except for a little while

⁷⁷‘This has been’ Our way with the messengers We sent before you. And you will never find any change in Our way

⁷⁸Observe the prayer from the decline of the sun until the darkness of the night and the dawn prayer, for certainly the dawn prayer is witnessed ‘by angels’

⁷⁹And rise at ‘the last’ part of the night, offering additional prayers, so your Lord may raise you to a station of praise

⁸⁰And say, "My Lord! Grant me an honourable entrance and an honourable exit and give me a supporting authority from Yourself."

⁸¹And declare, "The truth has come and falsehood has vanished. Indeed, falsehood is bound to vanish."

⁸²We send down the Quran as a healing and mercy for the believers, but it only increases the wrongdoers in loss

⁸³When We grant people Our favours, they turn away, acting arrogantly. But when touched with evil, they lose all hope

⁸⁴Say, 'O Prophet,' "Everyone acts in their own way. But your Lord knows best whose way is rightly guided."

⁸⁵They ask you 'O Prophet' about the spirit. Say, "Its nature is known only to my Lord, and you 'O humanity' have been given but little knowledge."

⁸⁶If We willed, We could have certainly taken away what We have revealed to you 'O Prophet'—then you would find none to guarantee its return from Us—

⁸⁷had it not been for the mercy of your Lord. Indeed, His favour upon you is immense

⁸⁸Say, 'O Prophet,' "If 'all' humans and jinn were to come together to produce the equivalent of this Quran, they could

not produce its equal, no matter how they supported each other.”

⁸⁹And We have truly set forth every ‘kind of’ lesson for humanity in this Quran, yet most people persist in disbelief

⁹⁰They challenge ‘the Prophet’, “We will never believe in you until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us

⁹¹or until you have a garden of palm trees and vineyards, and cause rivers to flow abundantly in it

⁹²or cause the sky to fall upon us in pieces, as you have claimed, or bring Allah and the angels before us, face to face

⁹³or until you have a house of gold, or you ascend into heaven—and even then we will not believe in your ascension until you bring down to us a book that we can read.” Say, “Glory be to my Lord! Am I not only a human messenger?”

⁹⁴And nothing has prevented people from believing when guidance comes to them except their protest: “Has Allah sent a human as a messenger?”

⁹⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Had there been angels walking the earth, well settled, We would have surely sent down for them an angel from heaven as a messenger.”

⁹⁶Say, "Sufficient is Allah as a Witness between me and you. He is certainly All-Knowing, All-Seeing of His servants."

⁹⁷Whoever Allah guides is truly guided. And whoever He leaves to stray, you will find no guardians for them besides Him. And We will drag them on their faces on the Day of Judgment—deaf, dumb, and blind. Hell will be their home. Whenever it dies down, We will flare it up for them

⁹⁸That is their reward for rejecting Our signs and asking 'mockingly', "When we are reduced to bones and ashes, will we really be raised as a new creation?"

⁹⁹Have they not realized that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, can 'easily' re-create them? He has 'already' set for them a time, about which there is no doubt. But the wrongdoers persist in denial

¹⁰⁰Say 'to them, O Prophet', "Even if you were to possess the 'infinite' treasures of my Lord's mercy, then you would certainly withhold 'them', fearing they would run out—for humankind is ever stingy!"

¹⁰¹We surely gave Moses nine clear signs. 'You, O Prophet, can' ask the Children of Israel. When Moses came to them, Pharaoh said to him, "I really think that you, O Moses, are bewitched."

102 Moses replied, “You know well that none has sent these ‘signs’ down except the Lord of the heavens and the earth as insights. And I really think that you, O Pharaoh, are doomed.”

103 So Pharaoh wanted to scare the Israelites out of the land ‘of Egypt’, but We drowned him and all of those with him

104 And We said to the Children of Israel after Pharaoh, “Reside in the land, but when the promise of the Hereafter comes to pass, We will bring you all together.”

105 We have sent down the Quran in truth, and with the truth it has come down. We have sent you ‘O Prophet’ only as a deliverer of good news and a warner

106 ‘It is’ a Quran We have revealed in stages so that you may recite it to people at a deliberate pace. And We have sent it down in successive revelations

107 Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Believe in this ‘Quran’, or do not. Indeed, when it is recited to those who were gifted with knowledge before it ‘was revealed’, they fall upon their faces in prostration

108 and say, ‘Glory be to our Lord! Surely the promise of our Lord has been fulfilled.’

109 And they fall down upon their faces weeping, and it increases them in humility.”

110 Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Call upon Allah or call upon the Most Compassionate—whichever you call, He has the Most Beautiful Names.” Do not recite your prayers too loudly or silently, but seek a way between

111 And say, “All praise is for Allah, Who has never had ‘any’ offspring; nor does He have a partner in ‘governing’ the kingdom; nor is He pathetic, needing a protector. And revere Him immensely.”

Al-Kahf

The Cave • 110 verses

- ¹All praise is for Allah Who has revealed the Book to His servant, allowing no crookedness in it
- ²making it perfectly upright, to warn the disbelievers of a severe torment from Him; to give good news to the believers—who do good—that they will have a fine reward
- ³in which they will remain forever
- ⁴and to warn those who claim, “Allah has offspring.”
- ⁵They have no knowledge of this, nor did their forefathers. What a terrible claim that comes out of their mouths! They say nothing but lies
- ⁶Now, perhaps you O Prophet will grieve yourself to death over their denial, if they continue to disbelieve in this message
- ⁷We have indeed made whatever is on earth as an adornment for it, in order to test which of them is best in deeds

⁸And We will certainly reduce whatever is on it to barren ground

⁹Have you 'O Prophet' thought that the people of the cave and the plaque were 'the only' wonders of Our signs

¹⁰'Remember' when those youths took refuge in the cave, and said, "Our Lord! Grant us mercy from Yourself and guide us rightly through our ordeal."

¹¹So We caused them to fall into a dead sleep in the cave for many years

¹²then We raised them so We may show which of the two groups would make a better estimation of the length of their stay

¹³We relate to you 'O Prophet' their story in truth. They were youths who truly believed in their Lord, and We increased them in guidance

¹⁴And We strengthened their hearts when they stood up and declared, "Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth. We will never call upon any god besides Him, or we would truly be uttering an outrageous lie."

¹⁵'Then they said to one another,' "These people of ours have taken gods besides Him. Why do they not produce a clear

proof of them? Who then does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah

¹⁶Since you have distanced yourselves from them and what they worship besides Allah, take refuge in the cave. Your Lord will extend His mercy to you and accommodate you in your ordeal.”

¹⁷And you would have seen the sun, as it rose, inclining away from their cave to the right, and as it set, declining away from them to the left, while they lay in its open space. That is one of the signs of Allah. Whoever Allah guides is truly guided. But whoever He leaves to stray, you will never find for them a guiding mentor

¹⁸And you would have thought they were awake, though they were asleep. We turned them over, to the right and left, while their dog stretched his forelegs at the entrance. Had you looked at them, you would have certainly fled away from them, filled with horror

¹⁹And so We awakened them so that they might question one another. One of them exclaimed, “How long have you remained ‘asleep’?” Some replied, “Perhaps a day, or part of a day.” They said ‘to one another’, “Your Lord knows best how long you have remained. So send one of you with these

silver coins of yours to the city, and let him find which food is the purest, and then bring you provisions from it. Let him be 'exceptionally' cautious, and do not let him give you away

²⁰For, indeed, if they find out about you, they will stone you 'to death', or force you back into their faith, and then you will never succeed."

²¹That is how We caused them to be discovered so that their people might know that Allah's promise 'of resurrection' is true and that there is no doubt about the Hour. When the people disputed with each other about the case of the youth 'after their death', some proposed, "Build a structure around them. Their Lord knows best about them." Those who prevailed in the matter said, "We will surely build a place of worship over them."

²²Some will say, "They were three, their dog was the fourth," while others will say, "They were five, their dog was the sixth," 'only' guessing blindly. And others will say, "They were seven and their dog was the eighth." Say, 'O Prophet,' "My Lord knows best their 'exact' number. Only a few people know as well." So do not argue about them except with sure knowledge, nor consult any of those 'who debate' about them

²³And never say of anything, “I will definitely do this tomorrow,”

²⁴without adding, “if Allah so wills!” But if you forget, then remember your Lord, and say, “I trust my Lord will guide me to what is more right than this.”

²⁵They had remained in their cave for three hundred years, adding nine

²⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Allah knows best how long they stayed. With Him ‘alone’ is ‘the knowledge of’ the unseen of the heavens and the earth. How perfectly He hears and sees! They have no guardian besides Him, and He shares His command with none.”

²⁷Recite what has been revealed to you from the Book of your Lord. None can change His Words, nor can you find any refuge besides Him

²⁸And patiently stick with those who call upon their Lord morning and evening, seeking His pleasure. Do not let your eyes look beyond them, desiring the luxuries of this worldly life. And do not obey those whose hearts We have made heedless of Our remembrance, who follow ‘only’ their desires and whose state is ‘total’ loss

29 And say, 'O Prophet,' "'This is' the truth from your Lord. Whoever wills let them believe, and whoever wills let them disbelieve.'" Surely We have prepared for the wrongdoers a Fire whose walls will 'completely' surround them. When they cry for aid, they will be aided with water like molten metal, which will burn 'their' faces. What a horrible drink! And what a terrible place to rest

30 As for those who believe and do good, We certainly never deny the reward of those who are best in deeds

31 It is they who will have the Gardens of Eternity, with rivers flowing under their feet. There they will be adorned with bracelets of gold, and wear green garments of fine silk and rich brocade, reclining there on 'canopied' couches. What a marvellous reward! And what a fabulous place to rest

32 Give them 'O Prophet' an example of two men. To 'the disbelieving' one We gave two gardens of grapevines, which We surrounded with palm trees and placed 'various' crops in between

33 Each garden yielded 'all' its produce, never falling short. And We caused a river to flow between them

³⁴And he had other resources 'as well'. So he boasted to a 'poor' companion of his, while conversing with him, "I am greater than you in wealth and superior in manpower."

³⁵And he entered his property, while wronging his soul, saying, "I do not think this will ever perish

³⁶nor do I think the Hour will 'ever' come. And if in fact I am returned to my Lord, I will definitely get a far better outcome than 'all' this."

³⁷His 'believing' companion replied, while conversing with him, "Do you disbelieve in the One Who created you from dust, then 'developed you' from a sperm-drop, then formed you into a man

³⁸But as for me: He is Allah, my Lord, and I will never associate anyone with my Lord 'in worship'

³⁹If only you had said, upon entering your property, "This is what Allah has willed! There is no power except with Allah!" Even though you see me inferior to you in wealth and offspring

⁴⁰perhaps my Lord will grant me 'something' better than your garden, and send down upon your garden a thunderbolt from the sky, turning it into a barren waste

⁴¹Or its water may sink 'into the earth', and then you will never be able to seek it out."

⁴²And so all his produce was 'totally' ruined, so he started to wring his hands for all he had spent on it, while it had collapsed on its trellises. He cried, "Alas! I wish I had never associated anyone with my Lord 'in worship'!"

⁴³And he had no manpower to help him against Allah, nor could he 'even' help himself

⁴⁴At this time, support comes 'only' from Allah—the True 'Lord'. He is best in reward and best in outcome

⁴⁵And give them a parable of this worldly life. 'It is' like the plants of the earth, thriving when sustained by the rain We send down from the sky. Then they 'soon' turn into chaff scattered by the wind. And Allah is fully capable of 'doing' all things

⁴⁶Wealth and children are the adornment of this worldly life, but the everlasting good deeds are far better with your Lord in reward and in hope

⁴⁷"Beware of" the Day We will blow the mountains away, and you will see the earth laid bare. And We will gather all 'humankind', leaving none behind

⁴⁸They will be presented before your Lord in rows, ‘and the deniers will be told,’ “You have surely returned to Us ‘all alone’ as We created you the first time, although you ‘always’ claimed that We would never appoint a time for your return.”

⁴⁹And the record ‘of deeds’ will be laid ‘open’, and you will see the wicked in fear of what is ‘written’ in it. They will cry, “Woe to us! What kind of record is this that does not leave any sin, small or large, unlisted?” They will find whatever they did present ‘before them’. And your Lord will never wrong anyone

⁵⁰And ‘remember’ when We said to the angels, “Prostrate before Adam,” so they all did—but not Iblīs, who was one of the jinn, but he rebelled against the command of his Lord. Would you then take him and his descendants as patrons instead of Me, although they are your enemy? What an evil alternative for the wrongdoers ‘to choose’

⁵¹I never called them to witness the creation of the heavens and the earth or ‘even’ their own creation, nor would I take the misleaders as helpers

⁵²And ‘beware of’ the Day He will say, “Call upon those you claimed were My associate-gods.” So they will call them, but

will receive no response. And We will make them 'all' share in the same doom

⁵³The wicked will see the Fire and realize that they are bound to fall into it, and will find no way to avoid it

⁵⁴We have surely set forth in this Quran every 'kind of' lesson for people, but humankind is the most argumentative of all beings

⁵⁵And nothing prevents people from believing when guidance comes to them and from seeking their Lord's forgiveness except 'their demand' to meet the same fate of earlier deniers or that the torment would confront them face to face

⁵⁶We do not send the messengers except as deliverers of good news and warners. But the disbelievers argue in falsehood, 'hoping' to discredit the truth with it, and make a mockery of My revelations and warnings

⁵⁷And who does more wrong than those who, when reminded of their Lord's revelations, turn away from them and forget what their own hands have done? We have certainly cast veils over their hearts—leaving them unable to comprehend this 'Quran'—and deafness in their ears. And if you 'O Prophet' invite them to 'true' guidance, they will never be 'rightly' guided

⁵⁸Your Lord is the All-Forgiving, Full of Mercy. If He were to seize them 'immediately' for what they commit, He would have certainly hastened their punishment. But they have an appointed time, from which they will find no refuge

⁵⁹Those 'are the' societies We destroyed when they persisted in wrong, and We had set a time for their destruction

⁶⁰And 'remember' when Moses said to his young assistant, "I will never give up until I reach the junction of the two seas, even if I travel for ages."

⁶¹But when they 'finally' reached the point where the seas met, they forgot their 'salted' fish, and it made its way into the sea, slipping away 'wondrously'

⁶²When they had passed further, he said to his assistant, "Bring us our meal! We have certainly been exhausted by today's journey."

⁶³He replied, "Do you remember when we rested by the rock? 'That is when' I forgot the fish. None made me forget to mention this except Satan. And the fish made its way into the sea miraculously."

⁶⁴Moses responded, "That is 'exactly' what we were looking for." So they returned, retracing their footsteps

⁶⁵There they found a servant of Ours, to whom We had granted mercy from Us and enlightened with knowledge of Our Own

⁶⁶Moses said to him, “May I follow you, provided that you teach me some of the right guidance you have been taught?”

⁶⁷He said, “You certainly cannot be patient ‘enough’ with me

⁶⁸And how can you be patient with what is beyond your ‘realm of’ knowledge?”

⁶⁹Moses assured ‘him’, “You will find me patient, Allah willing, and I will not disobey any of your orders.”

⁷⁰He responded, “Then if you follow me, do not question me about anything until I ‘myself’ clarify it for you.”

⁷¹So they set out, but after they had boarded a ship, the man made a hole in it. Moses protested, “Have you done this to drown its people? You have certainly done a terrible thing!”

⁷²He replied, “Did I not say that you cannot have patience with me?”

⁷³Moses pleaded, “Excuse me for forgetting, and do not be hard on me.”

⁷⁴So they proceeded until they came across a boy, and the man killed him. Moses protested, “Have you killed an inno-

cent soul, who killed no one? You have certainly done a horrible thing.”

⁷⁵He answered, “Did I not tell you that you cannot have patience with me?”

⁷⁶Moses replied, “If I ever question you about anything after this, then do not keep me in your company, for by then I would have given you enough of an excuse.”

⁷⁷So they moved on until they came to the people of a town. They asked them for food, but the people refused to give them hospitality. There they found a wall ready to collapse, so the man set it right. Moses protested, “If you wanted, you could have demanded a fee for this.”

⁷⁸He replied, “This is the parting of our ways. I will explain to you what you could not bear patiently

⁷⁹“As for the ship, it belonged to some poor people, working at sea. So I intended to damage it, for there was a ‘tyrant’ king ahead of them who seizes every ‘good’ ship by force

⁸⁰“And as for the boy, his parents were ‘true’ believers, and we feared that he would pressure them into defiance and disbelief

⁸¹So we hoped that their Lord would give them another, more virtuous and caring in his place

⁸²“And as for the wall, it belonged to two orphan boys in the city, and under the wall was a treasure that belonged to them, and their father had been a righteous man. So your Lord willed that these children should come of age and retrieve their treasure, as a mercy from your Lord. I did not do it ‘all’ on my own. This is the explanation of what you could not bear patiently.”

⁸³They ask you ‘O Prophet’ about Zul-Qarnain. Say, “I will relate to you something of his narrative.”

⁸⁴Surely We established him in the land, and gave him the means to all things

⁸⁵So he travelled a course

⁸⁶until he reached the setting ‘point’ of the sun, which appeared to him to be setting in a spring of murky water, where he found some people. We said, “O Zul-Qarnain! Either punish them or treat them kindly.”

⁸⁷He responded, “Whoever does wrong will be punished by us, then will be returned to their Lord, Who will punish them with a horrible torment

⁸⁸As for those who believe and do good, they will have the finest reward, and we will assign them easy commands.”

⁸⁹Then he travelled a ‘different’ course

⁹⁰until he reached the rising ‘point’ of the sun. He found it rising on a people for whom We had provided no shelter from it

⁹¹So it was. And We truly had full knowledge of him

⁹²Then he travelled a ‘third’ course

⁹³until he reached ‘a pass’ between two mountains. He found in front of them a people who could hardly understand ‘his’ language

⁹⁴They pleaded, “O Zul-Qarnain! Surely Gog and Magog are spreading corruption throughout the land. Should we pay you tribute, provided that you build a wall between us and them?”

⁹⁵He responded, “What my Lord has provided for me is far better. But assist me with resources, and I will build a barrier between you and them

⁹⁶Bring me blocks of iron!” Then, when he had filled up ‘the gap’ between the two mountains, he ordered, “Blow!” When

the iron became red hot, he said, “Bring me molten copper to pour over it.”

⁹⁷And so the enemies could neither scale nor tunnel through it

⁹⁸He declared, “This is a mercy from my Lord. But when the promise of my Lord comes to pass, He will level it to the ground. And my Lord’s promise is ever true.”

⁹⁹On that Day, We will let them surge ‘like waves’ over one another. Later, the Trumpet will be blown, and We will gather all ‘people’ together

¹⁰⁰On that Day We will display Hell clearly for the disbelievers

¹⁰¹those who turned a blind eye to My Reminder and could not stand listening ‘to it’

¹⁰²Do the disbelievers think they can ‘simply’ take My servants as lords instead of Me? We have surely prepared Hell as an accommodation for the disbelievers

¹⁰³Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Shall we inform you of who will lose the most deeds

¹⁰⁴‘They are’ those whose efforts are in vain in this worldly life, while they think they are doing good!”

105 It is they who reject the signs of their Lord and their meeting with Him, rendering their deeds void, so We will not give their deeds any weight on Judgment Day

106 That is their reward: Hell, for their disbelief and mockery of My signs and messengers

107 Indeed, those who believe and do good will have the Gardens of Paradise as an accommodation

108 where they will be forever, never desiring anywhere else

109 Say, 'O Prophet,' "If the ocean were ink for 'writing' the Words of my Lord, it would certainly run out before the Words of my Lord were finished, even if We refilled it with its equal."

110 Say, 'O Prophet,' "I am only a man like you, 'but' it has been revealed to me that your God is only One God. So whoever hopes for the meeting with their Lord, let them do good deeds and associate none in the worship of their Lord."

Maryam

Mary • 98 verses

¹Kāf-Ha-Ya-'Aīn- Šād

²"This is" a reminder of your Lord's mercy to His servant Zachariah
³when he cried out to his Lord privately

⁴saying, "My Lord! Surely my bones have become brittle, and grey hair has spread across my head, but I have never been disappointed in my prayer to You, my Lord

⁵And I am concerned about "the faith of" my relatives after me, since my wife is barren. So grant me, by Your grace, an heir

⁶who will inherit "prophethood" from me and the family of Jacob, and make him, O Lord, pleasing "to You"!"

⁷"The angels announced," "O Zachariah! Indeed, We give you the good news of "the birth of" a son, whose name will be John—a name We have not given to anyone before."

⁸He wondered, “My Lord! How can I have a son when my wife is barren, and I have become extremely old?”

⁹An angel replied, “So will it be! Your Lord says, ‘It is easy for Me, just as I created you before, when you were nothing!’”

¹⁰Zachariah said, “My Lord! Grant me a sign.” He responded, “Your sign is that you will not ‘be able to’ speak to people for three nights, despite being healthy.”

¹¹So he came out to his people from the sanctuary, signalling to them to glorify ‘Allah’ morning and evening

¹²‘It was later said,’ “O John! Hold firmly to the Scriptures.” And We granted him wisdom while ‘he was still’ a child

¹³as well as purity and compassion from Us. And he was God-fearing

¹⁴and kind to his parents. He was neither arrogant nor disobedient

¹⁵Peace be upon him the day he was born, and the day of his death, and the day he will be raised back to life

¹⁶And mention in the Book ‘O Prophet, the story of’ Mary when she withdrew from her family to a place in the east

¹⁷screening herself off from them. Then We sent to her Our angel, ‘Gabriel,’ appearing before her as a man, perfectly formed

¹⁸She appealed, “I truly seek refuge in the Most Compassionate from you! ‘So leave me alone’ if you are God-fearing.”

¹⁹He responded, “I am only a messenger from your Lord, ‘sent’ to bless you with a pure son.”

²⁰She wondered, “How can I have a son when no man has ever touched me, nor am I unchaste?”

²¹He replied, “So will it be! Your Lord says, ‘It is easy for Me. And so will We make him a sign for humanity and a mercy from Us.’ It is a matter ‘already’ decreed.”

²²So she conceived him and withdrew with him to a remote place

²³Then the pains of labour drove her to the trunk of a palm tree. She cried, “Alas! I wish I had died before this, and was a thing long forgotten!”

²⁴So a voice reassured her from below her, “Do not grieve! Your Lord has provided a stream at your feet

²⁵And shake the trunk of this palm tree towards you, it will drop fresh, ripe dates upon you

²⁶So eat and drink, and put your heart at ease. But if you see any of the people, say, ‘I have vowed silence to the Most Compassionate, so I am not talking to anyone today.’”

²⁷Then she returned to her people, carrying him. They said 'in shock', "O Mary! You have certainly done a horrible thing

²⁸O sister of Aaron! Your father was not an indecent man, nor was your mother unchaste."

²⁹So she pointed to the baby. They exclaimed, "How can we talk to someone who is an infant in the cradle?"

³⁰'Jesus' declared, "I am truly a servant of Allah. He has destined me to be given the Scripture and to be a prophet

³¹He has made me a blessing wherever I go, and bid me to establish prayer and give alms-tax as long as I live

³²and to be kind to my mother. He has not made me arrogant or defiant

³³Peace be upon me the day I was born, the day I die, and the day I will be raised back to life!"

³⁴That is Jesus, son of Mary. 'And this is' a word of truth, about which they dispute

³⁵It is not for Allah to take a son! Glory be to Him. When He decrees a matter, He simply tells it, "Be!" And it is

³⁶'Jesus also declared,' "Surely Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him 'alone'. This is the Straight Path."

³⁷Yet their 'various' groups have differed among themselves 'about him', so woe to the disbelievers when they face a tremendous Day

³⁸How clearly will they hear and see on the Day they will come to Us! But today the wrongdoers are clearly astray

³⁹And warn them 'O Prophet' of the Day of Regret, when all matters will be settled, while they are 'engrossed' in heedlessness and disbelief

⁴⁰Indeed, it is We Who will succeed the earth and whoever is on it. And to Us they will 'all' be returned

⁴¹And mention in the Book 'O Prophet, the story of' Abraham. He was surely a man of truth and a prophet

⁴²'Remember' when he said to his father, "O dear father! Why do you worship what can neither hear nor see, nor benefit you at all

⁴³O dear father! I have certainly received some knowledge which you have not received, so follow me and I will guide you to the Straight Path

⁴⁴O dear father! Do not worship Satan. Surely Satan is ever rebellious against the Most Compassionate

⁴⁵O dear father! I truly fear that you will be touched by a torment from the Most Compassionate, and become Satan's companion 'in Hell'."

⁴⁶He threatened, "How dare you reject my idols, O Abraham! If you do not desist, I will certainly stone you 'to death'. So be gone from me for a long time!"

⁴⁷Abraham responded, "Peace be upon you! I will pray to my Lord for your forgiveness. He has truly been Most Gracious to me

⁴⁸As I distance myself from 'all of' you and from whatever you invoke besides Allah, I will 'continue to' call upon my Lord 'alone', trusting that I will never be disappointed in invoking my Lord."

⁴⁹So after he had left them and what they worshipped besides Allah, We granted him Isaac and Jacob, and made each of them a prophet

⁵⁰We showered them with Our mercy, and blessed them with honourable mention

⁵¹And mention in the Book 'O Prophet, the story of' Moses. He was truly a chosen man, and was a messenger and a prophet

⁵²We called him from the right side of Mount Tûr, and drew him near, speaking 'with him' directly

⁵³And We appointed for him—out of Our grace—his brother, Aaron, as a prophet

⁵⁴And mention in the Book 'O Prophet, the story of' Ishmael. He was truly a man of his word, and was a messenger and a prophet

⁵⁵He used to urge his people to pray and give alms-tax. And his Lord was well pleased with him

⁵⁶And mention in the Book 'O Prophet, the story of' Enoch. He was surely a man of truth and a prophet

⁵⁷And We elevated him to an honourable status

⁵⁸Those were 'some of' the prophets who Allah has blessed from among the descendants of Adam, and of those We carried with Noah 'in the Ark', and of the descendants of Abraham and Israel, and of those We 'rightly' guided and chose. Whenever the revelations of the Most Compassionate were recited to them, they fell down, prostrating and weeping

⁵⁹But they were succeeded by generations who neglected prayer and followed their lusts and so will soon face the evil consequences

⁶⁰As for those who repent, believe, and do good, it is they who will be admitted into Paradise, never being denied any reward

⁶¹They will be in the Gardens of Eternity, promised in trust by the Most Compassionate to His servants. Surely His promise will be fulfilled

⁶²There they will never hear any idle talk—only greetings of peace. And there they will have their provisions morning and evening

⁶³That is Paradise, which We will grant to whoever is devout among Our servants

⁶⁴“We only descend by the command of your Lord. To Him belongs whatever is before us, and whatever is behind us, and everything in between. And your Lord is never forgetful

⁶⁵He is the Lord of the heavens, and the earth, and everything in between. So worship Him alone, and be steadfast in His worship. Do you know of anyone equal to Him in His attributes?”

⁶⁶Yet some people ask mockingly, “After I die, will I really be raised to life again?”

⁶⁷Do 'such' people not remember that We created them before, when they were nothing

⁶⁸By your Lord 'O Prophet'! We will surely gather them along with the devils, and then set them around Hell on their knees

⁶⁹Then We will certainly begin by dragging out of every group the ones most defiant to the Most Compassionate

⁷⁰And We truly know best who is most deserving of burning in it

⁷¹There is none of you who will not pass over it. 'This is' a decree your Lord must fulfil

⁷²Then We will deliver those who were devout, leaving the wrongdoers there on their knees

⁷³When Our clear revelations are recited to them, the disbelievers ask the believers 'mockingly', "Which of the two of us is better in status and superior in assembly?"

⁷⁴Imagine, O Prophet' how many peoples We have destroyed before them, who were far better in luxury and splendour

⁷⁵Say, 'O Prophet,' "Whoever is 'entrenched' in misguidance, the Most Compassionate will allow them plenty of time, until—behold!—they face what they are threatened with: either the

torment or the Hour. Only then will they realize who is worse in position and inferior in manpower.”

⁷⁶And Allah increases in guidance those who are ‘rightly’ guided. And the everlasting good deeds are far better with your Lord in reward and in outcome

⁷⁷Have you seen ‘O Prophet’ the one who rejects Our revelations yet boasts, “I will definitely be granted ‘plenty of’ wealth and children ‘if there is an afterlife’.”

⁷⁸Has he looked into the unseen or taken a pledge from the Most Compassionate

⁷⁹Not at all! We certainly record whatever he claims and will increase his punishment extensively

⁸⁰And We will inherit what he boasts of, and he will come before Us all by himself

⁸¹They have taken other gods, instead of Allah, seeking strength ‘and protection’ through them

⁸²But no! Those ‘gods’ will deny their worship and turn against them

⁸³Do you ‘O Prophet’ not see that We have sent the devils against the disbelievers, constantly inciting them

⁸⁴So do not be in haste against them, for indeed We are ‘closely’ counting down their days

⁸⁵‘Watch for’ the Day We will gather the righteous before the Most Compassionate as an honoured delegation

⁸⁶and drive the wicked to Hell like a thirsty herd

⁸⁷None will have the right to intercede, except those who have taken a covenant from the Most Compassionate

⁸⁸They say, “The Most Compassionate has offspring.”

⁸⁹You have certainly made an outrageous claim

⁹⁰by which the heavens are about to burst, the earth to split apart, and the mountains to crumble to pieces

⁹¹in protest of attributing children to the Most Compassionate

⁹²It does not befit ‘the majesty of’ the Most Compassionate to have children

⁹³There is none in the heavens or the earth who will not return to the Most Compassionate in full submission

⁹⁴Indeed, He fully knows them and has counted them precisely

⁹⁵And each of them will return to Him on the Day of Judgment all alone

⁹⁶As for those who believe and do good, the Most Compassionate will 'certainly' bless them with 'genuine' love

⁹⁷Indeed, We have made this 'Quran' easy in your own language 'O Prophet' so with it you may give good news to the righteous and warn those who are contentious

⁹⁸'Imagine' how many peoples We have destroyed before them! Do you 'still' see any of them, or 'even' hear from them the slightest sound

Ṭā Hā

Ṭā Hā • 135 verses

¹Ṭā-Hā

²We have not revealed the Quran to you 'O Prophet' to cause you distress

³but as a reminder to those in awe 'of Allah'

⁴'It is' a revelation from the One Who created the earth and the high heavens—

⁵the Most Compassionate, 'Who is' established on the Throne

⁶To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth and whatever is in between and whatever is underground

⁷Whether you speak openly 'or not', He certainly knows what is secret and what is even more hidden

⁸Allah—there is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. He has the Most Beautiful Names

⁹Has the story of Moses reached you 'O Prophet'

¹⁰When he saw a fire, he said to his family, “Wait here, ‘for’ I have spotted a fire. Perhaps I can bring you a torch from it, or find some guidance at the fire.”

¹¹But when he approached it, he was called, “O Moses

¹²It is truly I. I am your Lord! So take off your sandals, for you are in the sacred valley of Ṭuwa

¹³I have chosen you, so listen to what is revealed

¹⁴‘It is truly I. I am Allah! There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Me. So worship Me ‘alone’, and establish prayer for My remembrance

¹⁵The Hour is sure to come. My Will is to keep it hidden, so that every soul may be rewarded according to their efforts

¹⁶So do not let those who disbelieve in it and follow their desires distract you from it, or you will be doomed.”

¹⁷Allah added, “And what is that in your right hand, O Moses?”

¹⁸He replied, “It is my staff! I lean on it, and with it I beat down ‘branches’ for my sheep, and have other uses for it.”

¹⁹Allah said, “Throw it down, O Moses!”

²⁰So he did, then—behold!—it became a serpent, slithering

²¹Allah said, “Take it, and have no fear. We will return it to its former state

²²And put your hand under your armpit, it will come out
‘shining’ white, unblemished, as another sign

²³so that We may show you some of Our greatest signs

²⁴Go to Pharaoh, for he has truly transgressed ‘all bounds’.”

²⁵Moses prayed, “My Lord! Uplift my heart for me

²⁶and make my task easy

²⁷and remove the impediment from my tongue

²⁸so people may understand my speech

²⁹and grant me a helper from my family

³⁰Aaron, my brother

³¹Strengthen me through him

³²and let him share my task

³³so that we may glorify You much

³⁴and remember You much

³⁵for truly You have ‘always’ been overseeing us.”

³⁶Allah responded, “All that you requested has been granted,
O Moses

³⁷And surely We had shown You favour before

³⁸when We inspired your mother with this

³⁹‘Put him into a chest, then put it into the river. The river will wash it ashore, and he will be taken by ‘Pharaoh,’ an enemy of Mine and his.’ And I blessed you with lovability from Me ‘O Moses’ so that you would be brought up under My ‘watchful’ Eye

⁴⁰‘Remember’ when your sister came along and proposed, ‘Shall I direct you to someone who will nurse him?’ So We reunited you with your mother so that her heart would be put at ease, and she would not grieve. ‘Later’ you killed a man ‘by mistake’, but We saved you from sorrow, as well as other tests We put you through. Then you stayed for a number of years among the people of Midian. Then you came here as pre-destined, O Moses

⁴¹And I have selected you for My service

⁴²Go forth, you and your brother, with My signs and never falter in remembering Me

⁴³Go, both of you, to Pharaoh, for he has truly transgressed ‘all bounds’

⁴⁴Speak to him gently, so perhaps he may be mindful ‘of Me’ or fearful ‘of My punishment’.”

⁴⁵They both pleaded, “Our Lord! We fear that he may be quick to harm us or act tyrannically.”

⁴⁶Allah reassured ‘them’, “Have no fear! I am with you, hearing and seeing

⁴⁷So go to him and say, ‘Indeed we are both messengers from your Lord, so let the Children of Israel go with us, and do not oppress them. We have come to you with a sign from your Lord. And salvation will be for whoever follows the ‘right’ guidance

⁴⁸It has indeed been revealed to us that the punishment will be upon whoever denies ‘the truth’ and turns away.”

⁴⁹Pharaoh asked, “Who then is the Lord of you two, O Moses?”

⁵⁰He answered, “Our Lord is the One Who has given everything its ‘distinctive’ form, then guided ‘it’.”

⁵¹Pharaoh asked, “And what about previous peoples?”

⁵²He replied, “That knowledge is with my Lord in a Record. My Lord neither falters nor forgets ‘anything’.”

⁵³‘He is the One’ Who has laid out the earth for ‘all of’ you, and set in it pathways for you, and sends down rain from the sky, causing various types of plants to grow

⁵⁴so^r eat and graze your cattle. Surely in this are signs for people of sound judgment

⁵⁵From the earth We created you, and into it We will return you, and from it We will bring you back again

⁵⁶And We certainly showed Pharaoh all of Our signs, but he denied them and refused ^rto believe^r

⁵⁷He said, “Have you come to drive us out of our land with your magic, O Moses

⁵⁸We can surely meet you with similar magic. So set for us an appointment that neither of us will fail to keep, in a central place.”

⁵⁹Moses said, “Your appointment is on the Day of the Festival, and let the people be gathered mid-morning.”

⁶⁰Pharaoh then withdrew, orchestrated his scheme, then returned

⁶¹Moses warned the magicians, “Woe to you! Do not fabricate a lie against Allah, or He will wipe you out with a torment. Whoever fabricates ^rlies^r is bound to fail.”

⁶²So the magicians disputed the matter among themselves, conversing privately

⁶³They concluded, “These two are only magicians who want to drive you out of your land with their magic, and do away with your most cherished traditions

⁶⁴So orchestrate your plan, then come forward in ‘perfect’ ranks. And whoever prevails today will certainly be successful.”

⁶⁵They said, “O Moses! Either you cast, or let us be the first to cast.”

⁶⁶Moses responded, “No, you go first.” And suddenly their ropes and staffs appeared to him—by their magic—to be slithering

⁶⁷So Moses concealed fear within himself

⁶⁸We reassured ‘him’, “Do not fear! It is certainly you who will prevail

⁶⁹Cast what is in your right hand, and it will swallow up what they have made, for what they have made is no more than a magic trick. And magicians can never succeed wherever they go.”

⁷⁰So the magicians fell down in prostration, declaring, “We believe in the Lord of Aaron and Moses.”

⁷¹Pharaoh threatened, “How dare you believe in him before I give you permission? He must be your master who taught you magic. I will certainly cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, and crucify you on the trunks of palm trees. You will really see whose punishment is more severe and more lasting.”

⁷²They responded, “By the One Who created us! We will never prefer you over the clear proofs that have come to us. So do whatever you want! Your authority only covers the ‘fleeting’ life of this world

⁷³Indeed, we have believed in our Lord so He may forgive our sins and that magic you have forced us to practice. And Allah is far superior ‘in reward’ and more lasting ‘in punishment’.”

⁷⁴Whoever comes to their Lord as an evildoer will certainly have Hell, where they can neither live nor die

⁷⁵But whoever comes to Him as a believer, having done good, they will have the highest ranks

⁷⁶the Gardens of Eternity, under which rivers flow, where they will stay forever. That is the reward of those who purify themselves

⁷⁷And We surely inspired Moses, ‘saying,’ “Leave with My servants ‘at night’ and strike a dry passage for them across the sea. Have no fear of being overtaken, nor be concerned ‘of drowning’.”

⁷⁸Then Pharaoh pursued them with his soldiers—but how overwhelming were the waters that submerged them

⁷⁹And ‘so’ Pharaoh led his people astray, and did not guide ‘them rightly’

⁸⁰O Children of Israel! We saved you from your enemy, and made an appointment with you on the right side of Mount Ṭûr, and sent down to you manna and quails

⁸¹‘saying,’ “Eat from the good things We have provided for you, but do not transgress in them, or My wrath will befall you. And whoever My wrath befalls is certainly doomed

⁸²But I am truly Most Forgiving to whoever repents, believes, and does good, then persists on ‘true’ guidance.”

⁸³‘Allah asked,’ “Why have you come with such haste ahead of your people, O Moses?”

⁸⁴He replied, “They are close on my tracks. And I have hastened to You, my Lord, so You will be pleased.”

⁸⁵Allah responded, “We have indeed tested your people in your absence, and the Sâmiri has led them astray.”

⁸⁶So Moses returned to his people, furious and sorrowful. He said, “O my people! Had your Lord not made you a good promise? Has my absence been too long for you? Or have you wished for wrath from your Lord to befall you, so you broke your promise to me?”

⁸⁷They argued, “We did not break our promise to you of our own free will, but we were made to carry the burden of the people’s ‘golden’ jewellery, then we threw it ‘into the fire’, and so did the Sâmiri.”

⁸⁸Then he moulded for them an idol of a calf that made a lowing sound. They said, “This is your god and the god of Moses, but Moses forgot ‘where it was!’”

⁸⁹Did they not see that it did not respond to them, nor could it protect or benefit them

⁹⁰Aaron had already warned them beforehand, “O my people! You are only being tested by this, for indeed your ‘one true’ Lord is the Most Compassionate. So follow me and obey my orders.”

⁹¹They replied, “We will not cease to worship it until Moses returns to us.”

⁹²Moses scolded ‘his brother’, “O Aaron! What prevented you, when you saw them going astray

⁹³from following after me? How could you disobey my orders?”

⁹⁴Aaron pleaded, “O son of my mother! Do not seize me by my beard or ‘the hair of’ my head. I really feared that you would say, ‘You have caused division among the Children of Israel, and did not observe my word.’”

⁹⁵Moses then asked, “What did you think you were doing, O Sâmiri?”

⁹⁶He said, “I saw what they did not see, so I took a handful ‘of dust’ from the hoof-prints of ‘the horse of’ the messenger-angel ‘Gabriel’ then cast it ‘on the moulded calf’. This is what my lower-self tempted me into.”

⁹⁷Moses said, “Go away then! And for ‘the rest of your’ life you will surely be crying, ‘Do not touch ‘me’!’ Then you will certainly have a fate that you cannot escape. Now look at your god to which you have been devoted: we will burn it up, then scatter it in the sea completely.”

⁹⁸“Then Moses addressed his people, ‘Your only god is Allah, there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him. He encompasses everything in ‘His’ knowledge.”

⁹⁹This is how We relate to you ‘O Prophet’ some of the stories of the past. And We have certainly granted you a Reminder from Us

¹⁰⁰Whoever turns away from it will surely bear the burden ‘of sin’ on the Day of Judgment

¹⁰¹suffering its consequences forever. What an evil burden they will carry on Judgment Day

¹⁰²‘Beware of’ the Day the Trumpet will be blown, and We will gather the wicked on that Day blue-faced ‘from horror and thirst’

¹⁰³They will whisper among themselves, “You stayed no more than ten days ‘on the earth’.”

¹⁰⁴We know best what they will say—the most reasonable of them will say, “You stayed no more than a day.”

¹⁰⁵And ‘if’ they ask you ‘O Prophet’ about the mountains, ‘then’ say, “My Lord will wipe them out completely

¹⁰⁶leaving the earth level and bare

¹⁰⁷with neither depressions nor elevations to be seen.”

108 On that Day all will follow the caller ‘for assembly’, ‘and’ none will dare to deviate. All voices will be hushed before the Most Compassionate. Only whispers will be heard

109 On that Day no intercession will be of any benefit, except by those granted permission by the Most Compassionate and whose words are agreeable to Him

110 He ‘fully’ knows what is ahead of them and what is behind them, but they cannot encompass Him in ‘their’ knowledge

111 And all faces will be humbled before the Ever-Living, All-Sustaining. And those burdened with wrongdoing will be in loss

112 But whoever does good and is a believer will have no fear of being wronged or denied ‘their reward’

113 And so We have sent it down as an Arabic Quran and varied the warnings in it, so perhaps they will shun evil or it may cause them to be mindful

114 Exalted is Allah, the True King! Do not rush to recite ‘a revelation of’ the Quran ‘O Prophet’ before it is ‘properly’ conveyed to you, and pray, “My Lord! Increase me in knowledge.”

115 And indeed, We once made a covenant with Adam, but he forgot, and 'so' We did not find determination in him

116 And 'remember' when We said to the angels, "Prostrate before Adam," so they all did—but not Iblīs, who refused 'arrogantly'

117 So We cautioned, "O Adam! This is surely an enemy to you and to your wife. So do not let him drive you both out of Paradise, for you 'O Adam' would then suffer 'hardship'

118 Here it is guaranteed that you will never go hungry or unclothed

119 nor will you 'ever' suffer from thirst or 'the sun's' heat."

120 But Satan whispered to him, saying, "O Adam! Shall I show you the Tree of Immortality and a kingdom that does not fade away?"

121 So they both ate from the tree and then their nakedness was exposed to them, prompting them to cover themselves with leaves from Paradise. So Adam disobeyed his Lord, and 'so' lost his way

122 Then his Lord chose him 'for His grace', accepted his repentance, and guided him 'rightly'

¹²³ Allah said, “Descend, both of you, from here together ‘with Satan’ as enemies to each other. Then when guidance comes to you from Me, whoever follows My guidance will neither go astray ‘in this life’ nor suffer ‘in the next’

¹²⁴ But whoever turns away from My Reminder will certainly have a miserable life, then We will raise them up blind on the Day of Judgment.”

¹²⁵ They will cry, “My Lord! Why have you raised me up blind, although I used to see?”

¹²⁶ Allah will respond, “It is so, just as Our revelations came to you and you neglected them, so Today you are neglected.”

¹²⁷ This is how We reward whoever transgresses and does not believe in the revelations of their Lord. And the punishment of the Hereafter is far more severe and more lasting

¹²⁸ Is it not yet clear to them how many peoples We destroyed before them, whose ruins they still pass by? Surely in this are signs for people of sound judgment

¹²⁹ Had it not been for a prior decree from your Lord ‘O Prophet’ and a term already set, their ‘instant’ doom would have been inevitable

130 So be patient 'O Prophet' with what they say. And glorify the praises of your Lord before sunrise and before sunset, and glorify Him in the hours of the night and at both ends of the day, so that you may be pleased 'with the reward'

131 Do not let your eyes crave what We have allowed some of the disbelievers to enjoy; the 'fleeting' splendour of this worldly life, which We test them with. But your Lord's provision 'in the Hereafter' is far better and more lasting

132 Bid your people to pray, and be diligent in 'observing' it. We do not ask you to provide. It is We Who provide for you. And the ultimate outcome is 'only' for 'the people of' righteousness

133 They demand, "If only he could bring us a sign from his Lord!" Have they not 'already' received a confirmation of what is in earlier Scriptures

134 Had We destroyed them with a torment before this 'Prophet came', they would have surely argued, "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a messenger, we would have followed Your revelations before being humiliated and put to shame."

135 Say 'to them, O Prophet', "Each 'of us' is waiting, so keep waiting! You will soon know who is on the Straight Path and is 'rightly' guided."

Al-Anbiyā'

The Prophets • 112 verses

¹The time of people's judgment has drawn near, yet they are heedlessly turning away

²Whatever new reminder comes to them from their Lord, they only listen to it jokingly

³with their hearts 'totally' distracted. The evildoers would converse secretly, 'saying,' "Is this 'one' not human like yourselves? Would you fall for 'this' witchcraft, even though you can 'clearly' see?"

⁴The Prophet responded, "My Lord 'fully' knows every word spoken in the heavens and the earth. For He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing."

⁵Yet they say, "This 'Quran' is a set of confused dreams! No, he has fabricated it! No, he must be a poet! So let him bring us a 'tangible' sign like those 'prophets' sent before."

⁶Not a 'single' society We destroyed before them ever believed 'after receiving the signs'. Will these 'pagans' then believe

⁷We did not send 'messengers' before you 'O Prophet' except mere men inspired by Us. If you 'polytheists' do not know 'this already', then ask those who have knowledge 'of the Scriptures'

⁸We did not give those messengers 'supernatural' bodies that did not need food, nor were they immortal

⁹Then We fulfilled Our promise to them, saving them along with whoever We willed and destroying the transgressors

¹⁰We have surely revealed to you a Book, in which there is glory for you. Will you not then understand

¹¹'Imagine' how many societies of wrongdoers We have destroyed, raising up other people after them

¹²When the wrongdoers sensed 'the arrival of' Our torment, they started to run away from their cities

¹³'They were told,' "Do not run away! Return to your luxuries and your homes, so you may be questioned 'about your fate'."

¹⁴They cried, "Woe to us! We have surely been wrongdoers."

¹⁵They kept repeating their cry until We mowed them down, 'leaving them' lifeless

¹⁶We did not create the heavens and the earth and everything in between for sport

¹⁷Had We intended to take 'some' amusement, We could have found it in Our presence, if that had been Our Will

¹⁸In fact, We hurl the truth against falsehood, leaving it crushed, and it quickly vanishes. And woe be to you for what you claim

¹⁹To Him belong all those in the heavens and the earth. And those nearest to Him are not too proud to worship Him, nor do they tire

²⁰They glorify 'Him' day and night, never wavering

²¹Or have they taken gods from the earth, who can raise the dead

²²Had there been other gods besides Allah in the heavens or the earth, both 'realms' would have surely been corrupted. So Glorified is Allah, Lord of the Throne, far above what they claim

²³He cannot be questioned about what He does, but they will 'all' be questioned

²⁴Or have they taken other gods besides Him? Say, 'O Prophet,' "Show 'me' your proof. Here is 'the Quran,' the Reminder for

those with me; along with 'earlier Scriptures,' the Reminder for those before me." But most of them do not know the truth, so they turn away

²⁵We never sent a messenger before you 'O Prophet' without revealing to him: "There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Me, so worship Me 'alone'."

²⁶And they say, "The Most Compassionate has offspring!" Glory be to Him! In fact, those 'angels' are only 'His' honoured servants

²⁷who do not speak until He has spoken, 'only' acting at His command

²⁸He 'fully' knows what is ahead of them and what is behind them. They do not intercede except for whom He approves, and they tremble in awe of Him

²⁹Whoever of them were to say, "I am a god besides Him," they would be rewarded with Hell by Us. This is how We reward the wrongdoers

³⁰Do the disbelievers not realize that the heavens and earth were 'once' one mass then We split them apart? And We created from water every living thing. Will they not then believe

³¹And We have placed firm mountains upon the earth so it does not shake with them, and made in it broad pathways so they may find their way

³²And We have made the sky a well-protected canopy, still they turn away from its signs

³³And He is the One Who created the day and the night, the sun and the moon—each travelling in an orbit

³⁴We have not granted immortality to any human before you 'O Prophet': so if you die, will they live forever

³⁵Every soul will taste death. And We test you 'O humanity' with good and evil as a trial, then to Us you will 'all' be returned

³⁶When the disbelievers see you 'O Prophet', they only make fun of you, 'saying,' "Is this the one who speaks 'ill' of your gods?" while they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Compassionate

³⁷Humankind is made of haste. I will soon show you My signs, so do not ask Me to hasten them

³⁸They ask 'the believers', "When will this threat come to pass if what you say is true?"

³⁹If only the disbelievers knew that a time will come when they will not be able to keep the Fire off their faces or backs, nor will they be helped

⁴⁰In fact, the Hour will take them by surprise, leaving them stunned. So they will not be able to avert it, nor will it be delayed from them

⁴¹‘Other’ messengers had already been ridiculed before you ‘O Prophet’, but those who mocked them were overtaken by what they used to ridicule

⁴²Ask ‘them, O Prophet,’ “Who can defend you by day or by night against the Most Compassionate?” Still they turn away from the remembrance of their Lord

⁴³Or do they have gods—other than Us—that can protect them? They cannot ‘even’ protect themselves, nor will they be aided against Us

⁴⁴In fact, We have allowed enjoyment for these ‘Meccans’ and their forefathers for such a long time ‘that they took it for granted’. Do they not see that We gradually reduce ‘their’ land from its borders? Is it they who will then prevail

⁴⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I warn you only by revelation.” But the deaf cannot hear the call when they are warned

⁴⁶If they were touched by even a breath of your Lord's torment, they would certainly cry, "Woe to us! We have really been wrongdoers."

⁴⁷We will set up the scales of justice on the Day of Judgment, so no soul will be wronged in the least. And 'even' if a deed is the weight of a mustard seed, We will bring it forth. And sufficient are We as a 'vigilant' Reckoner

⁴⁸Indeed, We granted Moses and Aaron the standard 'to distinguish between right and wrong'—a light and a reminder for the righteous

⁴⁹who are in awe of their Lord without seeing Him, and are fearful of the Hour

⁵⁰And this 'Quran' is a blessed reminder which We have revealed. Will you 'pagans' then deny it

⁵¹And indeed, We had granted Abraham sound judgment early on, for We knew him well 'to be worthy of it'

⁵²'Remember' when he questioned his father and his people, "What are these statues to which you are so devoted?"

⁵³They replied, "We found our forefathers worshipping them."

⁵⁴He responded, "Indeed, you and your forefathers have been clearly astray."

⁵⁵They asked, “Have you come to us with the truth, or is this a joke?”

⁵⁶He replied, “In fact, your Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, Who created them ‘both’. And to that I bear witness.”

⁵⁷“Then he said to himself, ‘By Allah! I will surely plot against your idols after you have turned your backs and gone away.’”

⁵⁸So he smashed them into pieces, except the biggest of them, so they might turn to it ‘for answers’

⁵⁹They protested, “Who dared do this to our gods? It must be an evildoer!”

⁶⁰Some said, “We heard a young man, called Abraham, speaking ‘ill’ of them.”

⁶¹They demanded, “Bring him before the eyes of the people, so that they may witness ‘his trial’.”

⁶²They asked, “Was it you who did this to our gods, O Abraham?”

⁶³He replied ‘sarcastically’, “No, this one—the biggest of them—did it! So ask them, if they can talk!”

⁶⁴So they came back to their senses, saying ‘to one another’, “You yourselves are truly the wrongdoers!”

⁶⁵Then they 'quickly' regressed to their 'original' mind-set, 'arguing,' "You already know that those 'idols' cannot talk."

⁶⁶He rebuked 'them', "Do you then worship—instead of Allah—what can neither benefit nor harm you in any way

⁶⁷Shame on you and whatever you worship instead of Allah! Do you not have any sense?"

⁶⁸They concluded, "Burn him up to avenge your gods, if you must act."

⁶⁹We ordered, "O fire! Be cool and safe for Abraham!"

⁷⁰They had sought to harm him, but We made them the worst losers

⁷¹Then We delivered him, along with Lot, to the land We had showered with blessings for all people

⁷²And We blessed him with Isaac 'as a son' and Jacob 'as a grandson', as an additional favour—making all of them righteous

⁷³We 'also' made them leaders, guiding by Our command, and inspired them to do good deeds, establish prayer, and pay alms-tax. And they were devoted to Our worship

⁷⁴And to Lot We gave wisdom and knowledge, and delivered him from the society engrossed in shameful practices. They were certainly an evil, rebellious people

⁷⁵And We admitted him into Our mercy, 'for' he was truly one of the righteous

⁷⁶And 'remember' when Noah had cried out to Us earlier, so We responded to him and delivered him and his family from the great distress

⁷⁷And We made him prevail over those who had rejected Our signs. They were truly an evil people, so We drowned them all

⁷⁸And 'remember' when David and Solomon passed judgment regarding the crops ruined 'at night' by someone's sheep, and We were witness to their judgments

⁷⁹We guided 'young' Solomon to a fairer settlement, and granted each of them wisdom and knowledge. We subjected the mountains as well as the birds to hymn 'Our praises' along with David. It is We Who did 'it all'

⁸⁰We taught him the art of making body armour to protect you in battle. Will you then be grateful

⁸¹And to Solomon We subjected the raging winds, blowing by his command to the land We had showered with blessings. It is We Who know everything

⁸²And 'We subjected' some jinn that dived for him, and performed other duties. It is We Who kept them in check

⁸³And 'remember' when Job cried out to his Lord, "I have been touched with adversity, and You are the Most Merciful of the merciful."

⁸⁴So We answered his prayer and removed his adversity, and gave him back his family, twice as many, as a mercy from Us and a lesson for the 'devoted' worshippers

⁸⁵And 'remember' Ishmael, Enoch, and Zul-Kifl. They were all steadfast

⁸⁶We admitted them into Our mercy, for they were truly of the righteous

⁸⁷And 'remember' when the Man of the Whale stormed off 'from his city' in a rage, thinking We would not restrain him. Then in the 'veils of' darkness he cried out, "There is no god 'worthy of worship' except You. Glory be to You! I have certainly done wrong."

⁸⁸So We answered his prayer and rescued him from anguish.
And so do We save the 'true' believers

⁸⁹And 'remember' when Zachariah cried out to his Lord, "My Lord! Do not leave me childless, though You are the Best of Successors."

⁹⁰So We answered his prayer, granted him John, and made his wife fertile. Indeed, they used to race in doing good, and call upon Us with hope and fear, totally humbling themselves before Us

⁹¹And 'remember' the one who guarded her chastity, so We breathed into her through Our angel, 'Gabriel,' making her and her son a sign for all peoples

⁹²'O prophets!' Indeed, this religion of yours is 'only' one, and I am your Lord, so worship Me 'alone'

⁹³Yet the people have divided it into sects. But to Us they will all return

⁹⁴So whoever does good and is a believer will never be denied 'the reward for' their striving, for We are recording it all

⁹⁵It is impossible for a society which We have destroyed to ever rise again

⁹⁶until 'after' Gog and Magog have broken loose 'from the barrier', swarming down from every hill

⁹⁷ushering in the True Promise. Then—behold!—the disbelievers will stare 'in horror, crying,' "Oh, woe to us! We have truly been heedless of this. In fact, we have been wrongdoers."

⁹⁸Certainly you 'disbelievers' and whatever you worship instead of Allah will be the fuel of Hell. You are 'all' bound to enter it

⁹⁹Had those idols been 'true' gods, they would not have entered it. And they will be there forever

¹⁰⁰In it they will groan, and will not be able to hear

¹⁰¹Surely those for whom We have destined the finest reward will be kept far away from Hell

¹⁰²not even hearing the slightest hissing from it. And they will delight forever in what their souls desire

¹⁰³The Supreme Horror 'of that Day' will not disturb them, and the angels will greet them, 'saying,' "This is your Day, which you have been promised."

¹⁰⁴On that Day We will roll up the heavens like a scroll of writings. Just as We produced the first creation, 'so' shall We

reproduce it. That is a promise binding on Us. We truly uphold 'Our promises'

105 Surely, following the 'heavenly' Record, We decreed in the Scriptures: "My righteous servants shall inherit the land."

106 Surely this 'Quran' is sufficient 'as a reminder' for those devoted to worship

107 We have sent you 'O Prophet' only as a mercy for the whole world

108 Say, "What has been revealed to me is this: 'Your God is only One God.' Will you then submit?"

109 If they turn away, then say, "I have warned you all equally. I do not know if what you are threatened with is near or far

110 Allah surely knows what you say openly and whatever you hide

111 I do not know if this 'delay' is possibly a test for you and an enjoyment for a while."

112 "In the end," the Prophet said, "My Lord! Judge 'between us' in truth. And our Lord is the Most Compassionate, Whose help is sought against what you claim."

Al-Ḥajj

The Pilgrimage • 78 verses

¹O humanity! Fear your Lord, for the 'violent' quaking at the Hour is surely a dreadful thing

²The Day you see it, every nursing mother will abandon what she is nursing, and every pregnant woman will deliver her burden 'prematurely'. And you will see people 'as if they were' drunk, though they will not be drunk; but the torment of Allah is 'terribly' severe

³'Still' there are some who dispute about Allah without knowledge, and follow every rebellious devil

⁴It has been decreed for such devils that whoever takes them as a guide will be misguided and led by them into the torment of the Blaze

⁵O humanity! If you are in doubt about the Resurrection, then 'know that' We did create you from dust, then from a sperm-drop, then 'developed you into' a clinging clot 'of blood',

then a lump of flesh—fully formed or unformed—in order to demonstrate ‘Our power’ to you. ‘Then’ We settle whatever ‘embryo’ We will in the womb for an appointed term, then bring you forth as infants, so that you may reach your prime. Some of you ‘may’ die ‘young’, while others are left to reach the most feeble stage of life so that they may know nothing after having known much. And you see the earth lifeless, but as soon as We send down rain upon it, it begins to stir ‘to life’ and swell, producing every type of pleasant plant

⁶That is because Allah ‘alone’ is the Truth, He ‘alone’ gives life to the dead, and He ‘alone’ is Most Capable of everything

⁷And certainly the Hour is coming, there is no doubt about it. And Allah will surely resurrect those in the graves

⁸‘Still’ there are some who dispute about Allah without knowledge, guidance, or an enlightening scripture

⁹turning away ‘in pride’ to lead ‘others’ astray from Allah’s Way. They will suffer disgrace in this world, and on the Day of Judgment We will make them taste the torment of burning

¹⁰‘They will be told,’ “This is ‘the reward’ for what your hands have done. And Allah is never unjust to ‘His’ creation.”

¹¹And there are some who worship Allah on the verge 'of faith': if they are blessed with something good, they are content with it; but if they are afflicted with a trial, they relapse 'into disbelief', losing this world and the Hereafter. That is 'truly' the clearest loss

¹²They call besides Allah what can neither harm nor benefit them. That is 'truly' the farthest one can stray

¹³They invoke those whose worship leads to harm, not benefit. What an evil patron and what an evil associate

¹⁴Indeed, Allah will admit those who believe and do good into Gardens, under which rivers flow. Surely Allah does what He wills

¹⁵Whoever thinks that Allah will not help His Prophet in this world and the Hereafter, let them stretch out a rope to the ceiling and strangle themselves, then let them see if this plan will do away with 'the cause of' their rage

¹⁶And so We revealed this 'Quran' as clear verses. And Allah certainly guides whoever He wills

¹⁷Indeed, the believers, Jews, Sabians, Christians, Magi, and the polytheists—Allah will judge between them 'all' on Judgment Day. Surely Allah is a Witness over all things

¹⁸Do you not see that to Allah bow down ‘in submission’ all those in the heavens and all those on the earth, as well as the sun, the moon, the stars, the mountains, the trees, and ‘all’ living beings, as well as many humans, while many are deserving of punishment. And whoever Allah disgraces, none can honour. Surely Allah does what He wills

¹⁹These are two opposing groups that disagree about their Lord: as for the disbelievers, garments of Fire will be cut out for them and boiling water will be poured over their heads

²⁰melting whatever is in their bellies, along with their skin

²¹And awaiting them are maces of iron

²²Whenever they try to escape from Hell—out of anguish—they will be forced back into it, ‘and will be told,’ “Taste the torment of burning!”

²³‘But’ Allah will surely admit those who believe and do good into Gardens, under which rivers flow, where they will be adorned with bracelets of gold and pearls, and their clothing will be silk

²⁴for they have been guided to the best of speech, and they have been guided to the Commendable Path

²⁵Indeed, those who persist in disbelief and hinder 'others' from the Way of Allah and from the Sacred Mosque—which We have appointed for all people, residents and visitors alike—along with whoever intends to deviate by doing wrong in it, We will cause them to taste a painful punishment

²⁶And 'remember' when We assigned to Abraham the site of the House, 'saying,' "Do not associate anything with Me 'in worship' and purify My House for those who circle 'the Ka'bah', stand 'in prayer', and bow and prostrate themselves

²⁷Call 'all' people to the pilgrimage. They will come to you on foot and on every lean camel from every distant path

²⁸so they may obtain the benefits 'in store' for them, and pronounce the Name of Allah on appointed days over the sacrificial animals He has provided for them. So eat from their meat and feed the desperately poor

²⁹Then let them groom themselves, fulfil their vows, and circle the Ancient House."

³⁰That is so. And whoever honours the rituals of Allah, it is best for them in the sight of their Lord. The 'meat of' cattle has been made lawful for you, except what has 'already' been recited to you. So shun the impurity of idolatry, and shun words of falsehood

³¹Be upright 'in devotion' to Allah, associating none with Him 'in worship'. For whoever associates 'others' with Allah is like someone who has fallen from the sky and is either snatched away by birds or swept by the wind to a remote place

³²That is so. And whoever honours the symbols of Allah, it is certainly out of the piety of the heart

³³You may benefit from sacrificial animals for an appointed term, then their place of sacrifice is at the Ancient House

³⁴For every community We appointed a rite of sacrifice so that they may pronounce the Name of Allah over the sacrificial animals He has provided for them. For your God is only One God, so submit yourselves to Him 'alone'. And give good news 'O Prophet' to the humble

³⁵those whose hearts tremble at the remembrance of Allah, who patiently endure whatever may befall them, and who establish prayer and donate from what We have provided for them

³⁶We have made sacrificial camels 'and cattle' among the symbols of Allah, in which there is 'much' good for you. So pronounce the Name of Allah over them when they are lined up 'for sacrifice'. Once they have fallen 'lifeless' on their sides, you may eat from their meat, and feed the needy—those who

do not beg, and those who do. In this way We have subjected these 'animals' to you so that you may be grateful

³⁷Neither their meat nor blood reaches Allah. Rather, it is your piety that reaches Him. This is how He has subjected them to you so that you may proclaim the greatness of Allah for what He has guided you to, and give good news to the good-doers

³⁸Indeed, Allah defends those who believe. Surely Allah does not like whoever is deceitful, ungrateful

³⁹Permission 'to fight back' is 'hereby' granted to those being fought, for they have been wronged. And Allah is truly Most Capable of helping them 'prevail'

⁴⁰'They are' those who have been expelled from their homes for no reason other than proclaiming: "Our Lord is Allah." Had Allah not repelled 'the aggression of' some people by means of others, destruction would have surely claimed monasteries, churches, synagogues, and mosques in which Allah's Name is often mentioned. Allah will certainly help those who stand up for Him. Allah is truly All-Powerful, Almighty

⁴¹'They are' those who, if established in the land by Us, would perform prayer, pay alms-tax, encourage what is good, and

forbid what is evil. And with Allah rests the outcome of all affairs

⁴²If they deny you 'O Prophet', so did the people of Noah before them, as well as 'the tribes of 'Âd and Thamûd

⁴³the people of Abraham, the people of Lot

⁴⁴and the residents of Midian. And Moses was denied 'too'. But I delayed 'the fate of' the disbelievers 'until their appointed time' then seized them. And how severe was My response

⁴⁵Many are the societies We have destroyed for persisting in wrongdoing, leaving them in total ruin. 'Many are' also the abandoned wells and lofty palaces

⁴⁶Have they not travelled throughout the land so their hearts may reason, and their ears may listen? Indeed, it is not the eyes that are blind, but it is the hearts in the chests that grow blind

⁴⁷They challenge you 'O Prophet' to hasten the torment. And Allah will never fail in His promise. But a day with your Lord is indeed like a thousand years by your counting

⁴⁸Many are the societies whose end We delayed while they did wrong, then seized them. And to Me is the final return

⁴⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "O humanity! I am only sent to you with a clear warning

⁵⁰So those who believe and do good will have forgiveness and an honourable provision

⁵¹But those who strive to discredit Our revelations, they will be the residents of the Hellfire."

⁵²Whenever We sent a messenger or a prophet before you 'O Prophet' and he recited 'Our revelations', Satan would influence 'people's understanding of' his recitation. But 'eventually' Allah would eliminate Satan's influence. Then Allah would 'firmly' establish His revelations. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁵³All that so He may make Satan's influence a trial for those 'hypocrites' whose hearts are sick and those 'disbelievers' whose hearts are hardened. Surely the wrongdoers are totally engrossed in opposition

⁵⁴"This is' also so that those gifted with knowledge would know that this 'revelation' is the truth from your Lord, so they have faith in it, and so their hearts would submit humbly to it. And Allah surely guides the believers to the Straight Path

⁵⁵Yet the disbelievers will persist in doubt about this 'revelation' until the Hour takes them by surprise, or the torment of a terminating Day comes to them

⁵⁶All authority on that Day is for Allah 'alone'. He will judge between them. So those who believe and do good will be in the Gardens of Bliss

⁵⁷But those who disbelieve and deny Our revelations, it is they who will suffer a humiliating punishment

⁵⁸As for those who emigrate in the cause of Allah and then are martyred or die, Allah will indeed grant them a good provision. Surely Allah is the Best Provider

⁵⁹He will certainly admit them into a place they will be pleased with. For Allah is truly All-Knowing, Most Forbearing

⁶⁰That is so. And whoever retaliates in equivalence to the injury they have received, and then are wronged 'again', Allah will certainly help them. Surely Allah is Ever-Pardoning, All-Forgiving

⁶¹That is because Allah causes the night to merge into the day, and the day into the night. Indeed, Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing

⁶²That is because Allah 'alone' is the Truth and what they invoke besides Him is falsehood, and Allah 'alone' is truly the Most High, All-Great

⁶³Do you not see that Allah sends down rain from the sky, then the earth becomes green? Surely Allah is Most Subtle, All-Aware

⁶⁴To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Allah 'alone' is truly the Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

⁶⁵Do you not see that Allah has subjected to you whatever is in the earth as well as the ships 'that' sail through the sea by His command? He keeps the sky from falling down on the earth except by His permission. Surely Allah is Ever Gracious and Most Merciful to humanity

⁶⁶And He is the One Who gave you life, then will cause you to die, and then will bring you back to life. 'But' surely humankind is ever ungrateful

⁶⁷For every community We appointed a code of life to follow. So do not let them dispute with you 'O Prophet' in this matter. And invite 'all' to your Lord, for you are truly on the Right Guidance

⁶⁸But if they argue with you, then say, “Allah knows best what you do.”

⁶⁹Allah will judge between you ‘all’ on Judgment Day regarding your differences

⁷⁰Do you not know that Allah ‘fully’ knows whatever is in the heavens and the earth? Surely it is all ‘written’ in a Record. That is certainly easy for Allah

⁷¹Yet they worship besides Allah that for which He has sent down no authority, and of which they have no knowledge. The wrongdoers will have no helper

⁷²Whenever Our clear revelations are recited to them, you ‘O Prophet’ recognize rage on the faces of the disbelievers, as if they are going to snap at those who recite Our revelations to them. Say, “Shall I inform you of something far more enraging than that? ‘It is’ the Fire with which Allah has threatened those who disbelieve. What an evil destination!”

⁷³O humanity! A lesson is set forth, so listen to it ‘carefully’: those ‘idols’ you invoke besides Allah can never create ‘so much as’ a fly, even if they ‘all’ were to come together for that. And if a fly were to snatch anything away from them, they cannot ‘even’ retrieve it from the fly. How powerless are those who invoke and those invoked

⁷⁴They have not shown Allah the reverence He deserves. Surely Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty

⁷⁵Allah selects messengers from both angels and people, for Allah is truly All-Hearing, All-Seeing

⁷⁶He knows what is ahead of them and what is behind them. And to Allah 'all' matters will be returned 'for judgment'

⁷⁷O believers! Bow down, prostrate yourselves, worship your Lord, and do 'what is' good so that you may be successful

⁷⁸Strive for 'the cause of' Allah in the way He deserves, for 'it is' He 'Who' has chosen you, and laid upon you no hardship in the religion—the way of your forefather Abraham. 'It is Allah' Who named you 'the ones who submit' 'in the' earlier 'Scriptures' and in this 'Quran', so that the Messenger may be a witness over you, and that you may be witnesses over humanity. So establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and hold fast to Allah. He 'alone' is your Guardian. What an excellent Guardian, and what an excellent Helper

Al-Mu'minūn

The Believers • 118 verses

- ¹Successful indeed are the believers
²those who humble themselves in prayer
³those who avoid idle talk
⁴those who pay alms-tax
⁵those who guard their chastity
⁶except with their wives or those 'bondwomen' in their possession, for then they are free from blame
⁷but whoever seeks beyond that are the transgressors
⁸'the believers are also' those who are true to their trusts and covenants
⁹and those who are 'properly' observant of their prayers
¹⁰These are the ones who will be awarded
¹¹Paradise as their own. They will be there forever
¹²And indeed, We created humankind from an extract of clay
¹³then placed each 'human' as a sperm-drop in a secure place

¹⁴then We developed the drop into a clinging clot 'of blood', then developed the clot into a lump 'of flesh', then developed the lump into bones, then clothed the bones with flesh, then We brought it into being as a new creation. So Blessed is Allah, the Best of Creators

¹⁵After that you will surely die

¹⁶then on the Day of Judgment you will be resurrected

¹⁷And indeed, We created above you seven levels 'of heaven'. We are never unmindful of 'Our' creation

¹⁸We send down rain from the sky in perfect measure, causing it to soak into the earth. And We are surely able to take it away

¹⁹With it We produce for you gardens of palm trees and grapevines, in which there are abundant fruits, and from which you may eat

²⁰as well as 'olive' trees which grow at Mount Sinai, providing oil and a condiment to eat

²¹And there is certainly a lesson for you in cattle, from whose bellies We give you 'milk' to drink, and in them are many other benefits for you, and from them you may eat

²²And you are carried upon 'some of' them and upon ships

²³Indeed, We sent Noah to his people. He declared, “O my people! Worship Allah ‘alone’. You have no god other than Him. Will you not then fear ‘Him’?”

²⁴But the disbelieving chiefs of his people said ‘to the masses’, “This is only a human like you, who wants to be superior to you. Had Allah willed, He could have easily sent down angels ‘instead’. We have never heard of this in ‘the history of’ our forefathers

²⁵He is simply insane, so bear with him for a while.”

²⁶Noah prayed, “My Lord! Help me, because they have denied ‘me’.”

²⁷So We inspired him: “Build the Ark under Our ‘watchful’ Eyes and directions. Then when Our command comes and the oven bursts ‘with water’, take on board a pair from every species along with your family—except those against whom the decree ‘to drown’ has already been passed. And do not plead with Me for those who have done wrong, for they will surely be drowned.”

²⁸Then when you and those with you have settled in the Ark, say, “All praise is for Allah, Who saved us from the wrongdoing people.”

²⁹And pray, “My Lord! Allow me a blessed landing, for You are the best accommodator.”

³⁰Surely in this are lessons. And We ‘always’ put ‘people’ to the test

³¹Then We raised another generation after them

³²and sent to them a messenger from among themselves, ‘declaring,’ “Worship Allah ‘alone’. You have no god other than Him. Will you not then fear ‘Him’?”

³³But the chiefs of his people—who disbelieved, denied the meeting ‘with Allah’ in the Hereafter, and were spoiled by the worldly luxuries We had provided for them—said ‘to the masses’, “This is only a human like you. He eats what you eat, and drinks what you drink

³⁴And if you ‘ever’ obey a human like yourselves, then you would certainly be losers

³⁵Does he promise you that once you are dead and reduced to dust and bones, you will be brought forth ‘alive’

³⁶Impossible, simply impossible is what you are promised

³⁷There is nothing beyond our worldly life. We die, others are born, and none will be resurrected

³⁸He is no more than a man who has fabricated a lie about Allah, and we will never believe in him.”

³⁹The messenger prayed, “My Lord! Help me, because they have denied ‘me’.”

⁴⁰Allah responded, “Soon they will be truly regretful.”

⁴¹Then the ‘mighty’ blast overtook them with justice, and We reduced them to rubble. So away with the wrongdoing people

⁴²Then We raised other generations after them

⁴³No people can advance their doom, nor can they delay it

⁴⁴Then We sent Our messengers in succession: whenever a messenger came to his people, they denied him. So We destroyed them, one after the other, reducing them to ‘cautionary’ tales. So away with the people who refuse to believe

⁴⁵Then We sent Moses and his brother Aaron with Our signs and compelling proof

⁴⁶to Pharaoh and his chiefs, but they behaved arrogantly and were a tyrannical people

⁴⁷They argued, “Will we believe in two humans, like ourselves, whose people are slaves to us?”

⁴⁸So they rejected them both, and 'so' were among those destroyed

⁴⁹And We certainly gave Moses the Scripture, so perhaps his people would be 'rightly' guided

⁵⁰And We made the son of Mary and his mother a sign, and gave them refuge on high ground—a 'suitable' place for rest with flowing water

⁵¹O messengers! Eat from what is good and lawful, and act righteously. Indeed, I fully know what you do

⁵²Surely this religion of yours is 'only' one, and I am your Lord, so fear Me 'alone'

⁵³Yet the people have divided it into different sects, each rejoicing in what they have

⁵⁴So leave them 'O Prophet' in their heedlessness for a while

⁵⁵Do they think, since We provide them with wealth and children

⁵⁶that We hasten to 'honour' them 'with' all kinds of good? No! They are not aware

⁵⁷Surely those who tremble in awe of their Lord

⁵⁸and who believe in the revelations of their Lord

⁵⁹and who associate none with their Lord

⁶⁰and who do whatever 'good' they do with their hearts fearful, 'knowing' that they will return to their Lord—

⁶¹it is they who race to do good deeds, always taking the lead

⁶²We never require of any soul more than what it can afford. And with Us is a record which speaks the truth. None will be wronged

⁶³But the hearts of those 'who disbelieve' are oblivious to 'all of' this, and they have other 'evil' deeds, opposite to this, in which they are engrossed

⁶⁴But as soon as We seize their elite with torment, they start to cry for help

⁶⁵'They will be told,' "Do not cry for help today. Surely you will never be saved from Us

⁶⁶Indeed, My revelations were recited to you, but you used to back away 'in disgust'

⁶⁷boasting of the Sacred House, and babbling 'nonsense about the Quran' by night."

⁶⁸Is it because they have never contemplated the Word 'of Allah'? Or 'because' there has come to them something that did not come to their forefathers

⁶⁹Or 'because' they failed to recognize their Messenger, and so they denied him

⁷⁰Or 'because' they say, "He is insane?" In fact, he has come to them with the truth, but most of them are resentful of the truth

⁷¹Had the truth followed their desires, the heavens, the earth, and all those in them would have certainly been corrupted. In fact, We have brought them 'the means to' their glory, but they turn away from it

⁷²Or 'is it because' you 'O Prophet' are asking them for tribute? But the reward of your Lord is best, for He is the Best Provider

⁷³And surely you are calling them to the Straight Path

⁷⁴but those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are certainly deviating from that Path

⁷⁵'Even' if We had mercy on them and removed their affliction, they would still persist in their transgression, wandering blindly

⁷⁶And We have already seized them with torment, but they never humbled themselves to their Lord, nor did they 'submissively' appeal 'to Him'

⁷⁷But as soon as We open for them a gate of severe punishment, they will be utterly desperate

⁷⁸He is the One Who created for you hearing, sight, and intellect. 'Yet' you hardly give any thanks

⁷⁹And He is the One Who has dispersed you 'all' over the earth, and to Him you will 'all' be gathered

⁸⁰And He is the One Who gives life and causes death, and to Him belongs the alternation of the day and night. Will you not then understand

⁸¹But they 'just' say what their predecessors said

⁸²They said, "Once we are dead and reduced to dust and bones, will we really be resurrected

⁸³We have already been promised this, as well as our forefathers earlier. This is nothing but ancient fables!"

⁸⁴Ask 'them, O Prophet', "To whom belong the earth and all those on it, if you 'really' know?"

⁸⁵They will reply, "To Allah!" Say, "Why are you not then mindful?"

⁸⁶'And' ask 'them', "Who is the Lord of the seven heavens and the Lord of the Mighty Throne?"

⁸⁷They will reply, "Allah." Say, "Will you not then fear 'Him'?"

⁸⁸Ask ‘them also,’ “In Whose Hands is the authority over all things, protecting ‘all’ while none can protect against Him, if you ‘really’ know?”

⁸⁹They will reply, “Allah.” Say, “How are you then so deluded?”

⁹⁰In fact, We have brought them the truth, and they are certainly liars

⁹¹Allah has never had ‘any’ offspring, nor is there any god besides Him. Otherwise, each god would have taken away what he created, and they would have tried to dominate one another. Glorified is Allah above what they claim

⁹²‘He is the’ Knower of the seen and unseen. Exalted is He above what they associate ‘with Him’

⁹³Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “My Lord! Should You show me what they are threatened with

⁹⁴then, my Lord, do not count me among the wrongdoing people.”

⁹⁵We are indeed able to show you what We have threatened them with

⁹⁶Respond to evil with what is best. We know well what they claim

⁹⁷And say, “My Lord! I seek refuge in You from the temptations of the devils

⁹⁸And I seek refuge in You, my Lord, that they ‘even’ come near me.”

⁹⁹When death approaches any of them, they cry, “My Lord! Let me go back

¹⁰⁰so I may do good in what I left behind.” Never! It is only a ‘useless’ appeal they make. And there is a barrier behind them until the Day they are resurrected

¹⁰¹Then, when the Trumpet will be blown, there will be no kinship between them on that Day, nor will they ‘even care to’ ask about one another

¹⁰²As for those whose scale is heavy ‘with good deeds’, it is they who will be successful

¹⁰³But those whose scale is light, they will have doomed themselves, staying in Hell forever

¹⁰⁴The Fire will burn their faces, leaving them deformed

¹⁰⁵It will be said, ‘Were My revelations not recited to you, but you used to deny them?’

¹⁰⁶They will cry, “Our Lord! Our ill-fate took hold of us, so we became a misguided people

107 Our Lord! Take us out of this 'Fire'. Then if we ever return 'to denial', we will truly be wrongdoers."

108 Allah will respond, "Be despised in there! Do not 'ever' plead with Me 'again'

109 Indeed, there was a group of My servants who used to pray, 'Our Lord! We have believed, so forgive us and have mercy on us, for You are the best of those who show mercy,'

110 but you were 'so busy' making fun of them that it made you forget My remembrance. And you used to laugh at them

111 Today I have indeed rewarded them for their perseverance: they are certainly the triumphant."

112 He will ask 'them', "How many years did you remain on earth?"

113 They will reply, "We remained 'only' a day or part of a day. But ask those who kept count."

114 He will say, "You only remained for a little while, if only you knew

115 Did you then think that We had created you without purpose, and that you would never be returned to Us?"

116 Exalted is Allah, the True King! There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him, the Lord of the Honourable Throne

117Whoever invokes, besides Allah, another god—for which they can have no proof—they will surely find their penalty with their Lord. Indeed, the disbelievers will never succeed

118Say, 'O Prophet,' "My Lord! Forgive and have mercy, for You are the best of those who show mercy."

An-Nûr

The Light • 64 verses

¹This is¹ a sûrah which We have revealed and made ²its rulings² obligatory, and revealed in it clear commandments so that you may be mindful

²As for female and male fornicators, give each of them one hundred lashes, and do not let pity for them make you lenient in ³enforcing³ the law of Allah, if you ⁴truly⁴ believe in Allah and the Last Day. And let a number of believers witness their punishment

³A male fornicator would only marry a female fornicator or idolatress. And a female fornicator would only be married to a fornicator or idolater. This is ⁵all⁵ forbidden to the believers

⁴Those who accuse chaste women ⁶of adultery⁶ and fail to produce four witnesses, give them eighty lashes ⁷each⁷. And do not ever accept any testimony from them—for they are indeed the rebellious—

⁵except those who repent afterwards and mend their ways, then surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶And those who accuse their wives 'of adultery' but have no witness except themselves, the accuser must testify, swearing four times by Allah that he is telling the truth

⁷and a fifth oath that Allah may condemn him if he is lying

⁸For her to be spared the punishment, she must swear four times by Allah that he is telling a lie

⁹and a fifth oath that Allah may be displeased with her if he is telling the truth

¹⁰'You would have suffered,' had it not been for Allah's grace and mercy upon you, and had Allah not been Accepting of Repentance, All-Wise

¹¹Indeed, those who came up with that 'outrageous' slander are a group of you. Do not think this is bad for you. Rather, it is good for you. They will be punished, each according to their share of the sin. As for their mastermind, he will suffer a tremendous punishment

¹²If only the believing men and women had thought well of one another, when you heard this 'rumour', and said, "This is clearly 'an outrageous' slander!"

¹³Why did they not produce four witnesses? Now, since they have failed to produce witnesses, they are 'truly' liars in the sight of Allah

¹⁴Had it not been for Allah's grace and mercy upon you in this world and the Hereafter, you would have certainly been touched with a tremendous punishment for what you plunged into—

¹⁵when you passed it from one tongue to the other, and said with your mouths what you had no knowledge of, taking it lightly while it is 'extremely' serious in the sight of Allah

¹⁶If only you had said upon hearing it, "How can we speak about such a thing! Glory be to You 'O Lord'! This is a heinous slander!"

¹⁷Allah forbids you from ever doing something like this again, if you are 'true' believers

¹⁸And Allah makes 'His' commandments clear to you, for Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹⁹Indeed, those who love to see indecency spread among the believers will suffer a painful punishment in this life and the Hereafter. Allah knows and you do not know

²⁰‘You would have suffered,’ had it not been for Allah’s grace and mercy upon you, and had Allah not been Ever Gracious, Most Merciful

²¹O believers! Do not follow the footsteps of Satan. Whoever follows Satan’s footsteps, then ‘let them know that’ he surely bids ‘all to’ immorality and wickedness. Had it not been for Allah’s grace and mercy upon you, none of you would have ever been purified. But Allah purifies whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²²Do not let the people of virtue and affluence among you swear to suspend donations to their relatives, the needy, and the emigrants in the cause of Allah. Let them pardon and forgive. Do you not love to be forgiven by Allah? And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²³Surely those who accuse chaste, unsuspecting, believing women are cursed in this life and the Hereafter. And they will suffer a tremendous punishment

²⁴on the Day their tongues, hands, and feet will testify against them for what they used to do

²⁵On that Day, Allah will give them their just penalty in full, and they will ‘come to’ know that Allah ‘alone’ is the Ultimate Truth

²⁶Wicked women are for wicked men, and wicked men are for wicked women. And virtuous women are for virtuous men, and virtuous men are for virtuous women. The virtuous are innocent of what the wicked say. They will have forgiveness and an honourable provision

²⁷O believers! Do not enter any house other than your own until you have asked for permission and greeted its occupants. This is best for you, so perhaps you will be mindful

²⁸If you find no one at home, do not enter it until you have been given permission. And if you are asked to leave, then leave. That is purer for you. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of what you do

²⁹There is no blame on you if you enter public places where there is something of benefit for you. And Allah knows what you reveal and what you conceal

³⁰'O Prophet!' Tell the believing men to lower their gaze and guard their chastity. That is purer for them. Surely Allah is All-Aware of what they do

³¹And tell the believing women to lower their gaze and guard their chastity, and not to reveal their adornments except what normally appears. Let them draw their veils over their chests, and not reveal their 'hidden' adornments except to their hus-

bands, their fathers, their fathers-in-law, their sons, their stepsons, their brothers, their brothers' sons or sisters' sons, their fellow women, those 'bondwomen' in their possession, male attendants with no desire, or children who are still unaware of women's nakedness. Let them not stomp their feet, drawing attention to their hidden adornments. Turn to Allah in repentance all together, O believers, so that you may be successful

³²Marry off the 'free' singles among you, as well as the righteous of your bondmen and bondwomen. If they are poor, Allah will enrich them out of His bounty. For Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing

³³And let those who do not have the means to marry keep themselves chaste until Allah enriches them out of His bounty. And if any of those 'bondspeople' in your possession desires a deed of emancipation, make it possible for them, if you find goodness in them. And give them some of Allah's wealth which He has granted you. Do not force your 'slave' girls into prostitution for your own worldly gains while they wish to remain chaste. And if someone coerces them, then after such a coercion Allah is certainly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful 'to them'

³⁴Indeed, We have sent down to you clear revelations, along with examples of those who had gone before you, and a lesson to the God-fearing

³⁵Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth. His light is like a niche in which there is a lamp, the lamp is in a crystal, the crystal is like a shining star, lit from 'the oil of' a blessed olive tree, 'located' neither to the east nor the west, whose oil would almost glow, even without being touched by fire. Light upon light! Allah guides whoever He wills to His light. And Allah sets forth parables for humanity. For Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

³⁶'That light shines' through houses 'of worship' which Allah has ordered to be raised, and where His Name is mentioned. He is glorified there morning and evening

³⁷by men who are not distracted—either by buying or selling—from Allah's remembrance, or performing prayer, or paying alms-tax. They fear a Day when hearts and eyes will tremble

³⁸'hoping' that Allah may reward them according to the best of their deeds, and increase them out of His grace. And Allah provides for whoever He wills without limit

³⁹As for the disbelievers, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert, which the thirsty perceive as water, but when they

approach it, they find it to be nothing. Instead, they find Allah there 'in the Hereafter, ready' to settle their account. And Allah is swift in reckoning

⁴⁰Or 'their deeds are' like the darkness in a deep sea, covered by waves upon waves, topped by 'dark' clouds. Darkness upon darkness! If one stretches out their hand, they can hardly see it. And whoever Allah does not bless with light will have no light

⁴¹Do you not see that Allah is glorified by all those in the heavens and the earth, even the birds as they soar? Each 'instinctively' knows their manner of prayer and glorification. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all they do

⁴²To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. And to Allah is the final return

⁴³Do you not see that Allah gently drives the clouds, then joins them together, piling them up into masses, from which you see raindrops come forth? And He sends down from the sky mountains 'of clouds' loaded with hail, pouring it on whoever He wills and averting it from whoever He wills. The flash of the clouds' lightning nearly takes away eyesight

⁴⁴Allah alternates the day and night. Surely in this is a lesson for people of insight

⁴⁵And Allah has created from water every living creature. Some of them crawl on their bellies, some walk on two legs, and some walk on four. Allah creates whatever He wills. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁴⁶We have indeed sent down revelations clarifying 'the truth'. But Allah 'only' guides whoever He wills to the Straight Path

⁴⁷And the hypocrites say, "We believe in Allah and the Messenger, and we obey." Then a group of them turns away soon after that. These are not 'true' believers

⁴⁸And as soon as they are called to Allah and His Messenger so he may judge between them, a group of them turns away

⁴⁹But if the truth is in their favour, they come to him, fully submitting

⁵⁰Is there a sickness in their hearts? Or are they in doubt? Or do they fear that Allah and His Messenger will be unjust to them? In fact, it is they who are the 'true' wrongdoers

⁵¹The only response of the 'true' believers, when they are called to Allah and His Messenger so he may judge between them, is to say, "We hear and obey." It is they who will 'truly' succeed

⁵²For whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, and fears Allah and is mindful of Him, then it is they who will 'truly' triumph

⁵³They swear by Allah their most solemn oaths that if you 'O Prophet' were to command them, they would certainly march forth 'in Allah's cause'. Say, "You' do not 'have to' swear; your obedience is well known!" Surely Allah is All-Aware of what you do."

⁵⁴Say, "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger. But if you turn away, then he is only responsible for his duty and you are responsible for yours. And if you obey him, you will be 'rightly' guided. The Messenger's duty is only to deliver 'the message' clearly."

⁵⁵Allah has promised those of you who believe and do good that He will certainly make them successors in the land, as He did with those before them; and will surely establish for them their faith which He has chosen for them; and will indeed change their fear into security—"provided that' they worship Me, associating nothing with Me. But whoever disbelieves after this 'promise', it is they who will be the rebellious

⁵⁶Moreover, establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and obey the Messenger, so you may be shown mercy

⁵⁷Do not think 'O Prophet' that the disbelievers can escape in the land. The Fire will be their home. Indeed, what an evil destination

⁵⁸O believers! Let those 'bondspeople' in your possession and those of you who are still under age ask for your permission 'to come in' at three times: before dawn prayer, when you take off your 'outer' clothes at noon, and after the late evening prayer. 'These are' three times of privacy for you. Other than these times, there is no blame on you or them to move freely, attending to one another. This is how Allah makes the revelations clear to you, for Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁵⁹And when your children reach the age of puberty, let them seek permission 'to come in', as their seniors do. This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you, for Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁶⁰As for elderly women past the age of marriage, there is no blame on them if they take off their 'outer' garments, without revealing their adornments. But it is better for them if they avoid this 'altogether'. And Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁶¹There is no restriction on the blind, or the disabled, or the sick. Nor on yourselves if you eat from your homes, or the

homes of your fathers, or your mothers, or your brothers, or your sisters, or your paternal uncles, or your paternal aunts, or your maternal uncles, or your maternal aunts, or from the homes in your trust, or 'the homes of' your friends. There is no blame on you eating together or separately. However, when you enter houses, greet one another with a greeting 'of peace' from Allah, blessed and good. This is how Allah makes His revelations clear to you, so perhaps you will understand

⁶²The 'true' believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger, and when they are with him on a public matter, they do not leave without his permission. Indeed, those who ask your permission 'O Prophet' are the ones who 'truly' believe in Allah and His Messenger. So when they ask your permission for a private matter, grant permission to whoever you wish and ask Allah's forgiveness for them. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶³Do not treat the Messenger's summons to you 'as lightly' as your summons to one another. Allah certainly knows those of you who slip away, hiding behind others. So let those who disobey his orders beware, for an affliction may befall them, or a painful torment may overtake them

⁶⁴ Surely to Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. He knows well what you stand for. And 'on' the Day all will be returned to Him, He will inform them of what they did. For Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

Al-Furqān

The Standard • 77 verses

¹Blessed is the One Who sent down the Standard to His servant, so that he may be a warner to the whole world

²ʾAllah is ʾthe One to Whom belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth, Who has never had ʾany ʾoffspring, nor does He have a partner in ʾgoverning ʾthe kingdom. He has created everything, ordaining it precisely

³Yet they have taken besides Him gods who cannot create anything but are themselves created. Nor can they protect or benefit themselves. Nor can they control life, death, or resurrection

⁴The disbelievers say, “This ʾQuran ʾis nothing but a fabrication which he made up with the help of others.” Their claim is totally unjustified and untrue

⁵And they say, “‘These revelations are only’ ancient fables which he has had written down, and they are rehearsed to him morning and evening.”

⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “This ‘Quran’ has been revealed by the One Who knows the secrets of the heavens and the earth. Surely He is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful.”

⁷And they say ‘mockingly’, “What kind of messenger is this who eats food and goes about in market-places ‘for a living’? If only an angel had been sent down with him to be his co-warner

⁸or a treasure had been cast down to him, or he had had a garden from which he may eat!” And the wrongdoers say ‘to the believers’, “You are only following a bewitched man.”

⁹See ‘O Prophet’ how they call you names! So they have gone so ‘far’ astray that they cannot find the ‘Right’ Way

¹⁰Blessed is the One Who—if He wills—can give you far better than ‘all’ that: gardens under which rivers flow, and palaces as well

¹¹In fact, they deny the Hour. And for the deniers of the Hour, We have prepared a blazing Fire

¹²Once it sees them from a distance, they will hear it fuming and growling

¹³And when they are tossed into a narrow place inside 'Hell', chained together, then and there they will cry out for 'instant' destruction

¹⁴'They will be told,' "Do not cry only once for destruction, but cry many times over!"

¹⁵Say, 'O Prophet,' "Is this better or the Garden of Eternity which the righteous have been promised, as a reward and 'an ultimate' destination

¹⁶There they will have whatever they wish for, forever. That is a promise 'to be sought after', binding on your Lord."

¹⁷'Watch for' the Day He will gather them along with what they used to worship besides Allah, and ask 'the objects of worship', "Was it you who misled these servants of Mine, or did they stray from the Way 'on their own'?"

¹⁸They will say, "Glory be to You! It was not right for 'others like' us to take any lords besides You, but You allowed enjoyment for them and their forefathers 'for so long' that they forgot 'Your' remembrance and became a doomed people."

19“The doomed will be told”, “Your gods have clearly denied your claims. So now you can neither ward off ‘the punishment’ nor get any help.” And whoever of you does wrong, We will make them taste a horrible punishment

20We never sent any messenger before you ‘O Prophet’, who did not eat food and go about in market-places. We have made some of you a trial for others. Will you ‘not then’ be patient? And your Lord is All-Seeing

21Those who do not expect to meet Us say, “If only the angels were sent down to us, or we could see our Lord!” They have certainly been carried away by their arrogance and have entirely exceeded all limits

22“But’ on the Day they will see the angels, there will be no good news for the wicked, who will cry, “Keep away! Away ‘from us’!”

23Then We will turn to whatever ‘good’ deeds they did, reducing them to scattered dust

24“But’ on that Day the residents of Paradise will have the best settlement and the finest place to rest

25“Watch for’ the Day the heavens will burst with clouds, and the angels will be sent down in successive ranks

²⁶True authority on that Day will belong 'only' to the Most Compassionate. And it will be a hard day for the disbelievers

²⁷And 'beware of' the Day the wrongdoer will bite his nails 'in regret' and say, "Oh! I wish I had followed the Way along with the Messenger

²⁸Woe to me! I wish I had never taken so-and-so as a close friend

²⁹It was he who truly made me stray from the Reminder after it had reached me." And Satan has always betrayed humanity

³⁰The Messenger has cried, "O my Lord! My people have indeed received this Quran with neglect."

³¹Similarly, We made enemies for every prophet from among the wicked, but sufficient is your Lord as a Guide and Helper

³²The disbelievers say, "If only the Quran had been sent down to him all at once!" 'We have sent it' as such 'in stages' so We may reassure your heart with it. And We have revealed it at a deliberate pace

³³Whenever they bring you an argument, We come to you with the right refutation and the best explanation

³⁴Those who will be dragged into Hell on their faces will be in the worst place, and are 'now' farthest from the 'Right' Way

³⁵We certainly gave Moses the Book and appointed his brother Aaron as his helper

³⁶We had ordered 'them', "Go to the people who would deny Our signs." Then We annihilated the deniers entirely

³⁷And when the people of Noah rejected the messengers, We drowned them, making them an example to humanity. And We have prepared a painful punishment for the wrongdoers

³⁸Also 'We destroyed' 'Âd, Thamûd, and the people of the Water-pit, as well as many peoples in between

³⁹For each We set forth 'various' lessons, and We ultimately destroyed each

⁴⁰They have certainly passed by the city 'of Sodom', which had been showered with a dreadful rain 'of stones'. Have they not seen its ruins? But they do not expect to be resurrected

⁴¹When they see you 'O Prophet', they only make fun of you, 'saying,' "Is this the one that Allah has sent as a messenger

⁴²He would have almost tricked us away from our gods, had we not been so devoted to them." 'But' soon they will know,

when they face the punishment, who is far astray from the 'Right' Way

⁴³Have you seen 'O Prophet' the one who has taken their own desires as their god? Will you then be a keeper over them

⁴⁴Or do you think that most of them listen or understand? They are only like cattle—no, more than that, they are astray from the 'Right' Way

⁴⁵Have you not seen how your Lord extends the shade—He could have simply made it 'remain' still if He so willed—then We make the sun its guide

⁴⁶causing the shade to retreat gradually

⁴⁷He is the One Who has made the night for you as a cover, and 'made' sleep for resting, and the day for rising

⁴⁸And He is the One Who sends the winds ushering in His mercy, and We send down pure rain from the sky

⁴⁹giving life to a lifeless land, and providing water for countless animals and humans of Our Own creation

⁵⁰We certainly disperse it among them so they may be mindful, but most people persist in ungratefulness

⁵¹Had We willed, We could have easily sent a warner to every society

⁵²So do not yield to the disbelievers, but strive diligently against them with this 'Quran'

⁵³And He is the One Who merges the two bodies of water: one fresh and palatable and the other salty and bitter, placing between them a barrier they cannot cross

⁵⁴And He is the One Who creates human beings from a 'humble' liquid, then establishes for them bonds of kinship and marriage. For your Lord is Most Capable

⁵⁵Yet they worship besides Allah what can neither benefit nor harm them. And the disbeliever always collaborates against their Lord

⁵⁶And We have sent you 'O Prophet' only as a deliverer of good news and a warner

⁵⁷Say, "I do not ask you for any reward for this 'message', but whoever wishes, let them pursue the Way to their Lord."

⁵⁸Put your trust in the Ever-Living, Who never dies, and glorify His praises. Sufficient is He as All-Aware of the sins of His servants

⁵⁹'He is' the One Who created the heavens and the earth and everything in between in six Days, then established Himself

on the Throne. 'He is' the Most Compassionate! Ask 'none other than' the All-Knowledgeable about Himself

⁶⁰When it is said to them, "Prostrate to the Most Compassionate," they ask 'in disgust', "What is 'the Most Compassionate'? Will we prostrate to whatever you order us to?" And it only drives them farther away

⁶¹Blessed is the One Who has placed constellations in the sky, as well as a 'radiant' lamp and a luminous moon

⁶²And He is the One Who causes the day and the night to alternate, 'as a sign' for whoever desires to be mindful or to be grateful

⁶³The 'true' servants of the Most Compassionate are those who walk on the earth humbly, and when the foolish address them 'improperly', they only respond with peace

⁶⁴'They are' those who spend 'a good portion of' the night, prostrating themselves and standing before their Lord

⁶⁵'They are' those who pray, "Our Lord! Keep the punishment of Hell away from us, for its punishment is indeed unrelenting

⁶⁶It is certainly an evil place to settle and reside."

⁶⁷“They are” those who spend neither wastefully nor stingily, but moderately in between

⁶⁸“They are” those who do not invoke any other god besides Allah, nor take a “human” life—made sacred by Allah—except with “legal” right, nor commit fornication. And whoever does “any of” this will face the penalty

⁶⁹Their punishment will be multiplied on the Day of Judgment, and they will remain in it forever, in disgrace

⁷⁰As for those who repent, believe, and do good deeds, they are the ones whose evil deeds Allah will change into good deeds. For Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁷¹And whoever repents and does good has truly turned to Allah properly

⁷²“They are” those who do not bear false witness, and when they come across falsehood, they pass “it” by with dignity

⁷³“They are” those who, when reminded of the revelation of their Lord, do not turn a blind eye or a deaf ear to it

⁷⁴“They are” those who pray, “Our Lord! Bless us with “pious” spouses and offspring who will be the joy of our hearts, and make us models for the righteous.”

⁷⁵It is they who will be rewarded with 'elevated' mansions 'in Paradise' for their perseverance, and will be received with salutations and 'greetings of' peace

⁷⁶staying there forever. What an excellent place to settle and reside

⁷⁷Say, 'O Prophet,' "You 'all' would not 'even' matter to my Lord were it not for your faith 'in Him'. But now you 'dis-believers' have denied 'the truth', so the torment is bound to come."

Ash-Shu‘arā’

The Poets • 227 verses

¹Ṭâ-Sīn-Mīm

²These are the verses of the clear Book

³Perhaps you ‘O Prophet’ will grieve yourself to death over their disbelief

⁴If We willed, We could send down upon them a ‘compelling’ sign from the heavens, leaving their necks bent in ‘utter’ submission to it

⁵Whatever new reminder comes to them from the Most Compassionate, they always turn away from it

⁶They have certainly denied ‘the truth’, so they will soon face the consequences of their ridicule

⁷Have they failed to look at the earth, ‘to see’ how many types of fine plants We have caused to grow in it

⁸Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

⁹And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

¹⁰Remember when your Lord called out to Moses, “Go to the wrongdoing people—

¹¹the people of Pharaoh. Will they not fear Allah?”

¹²He replied, “My Lord! I fear that they will reject me

¹³And so my heart will be broken and my tongue will be tied. So send Aaron along as a messenger

¹⁴Also, they have a charge against me, so I fear they may kill me.”

¹⁵Allah responded, “Certainly not! So go, both of you, with Our signs. We will be with you, listening

¹⁶Go to Pharaoh and say, ‘We are messengers from the Lord of all worlds

¹⁷commanded to say: ‘Let the Children of Israel go with us.’”

¹⁸Pharaoh protested, “Did we not raise you among us as a child, and you stayed several years of your life in our care

¹⁹Then you did what you did, being utterly ungrateful!”

²⁰Moses replied, “I did it then, lacking guidance

²¹So I fled from you when I feared you. Then my Lord granted me wisdom and made me one of the messengers

²²How can that be a 'favour,' of which you remind me, when 'it was only because' you 'have' enslaved the Children of Israel?"

²³Pharaoh asked, "And what is 'the Lord of all worlds'?"

²⁴Moses replied, "'He is' the Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything in between, if only you had sure faith."

²⁵Pharaoh said to those around him, "Did you hear 'what he said'?"

²⁶Moses added, "'He is' your Lord and the Lord of your forefathers."

²⁷Pharaoh said 'mockingly', "Your messenger, who has been sent to you, must be insane."

²⁸Moses responded: "'He is' the Lord of the east and west, and everything in between, if only you had any sense."

²⁹Pharaoh threatened, "If you take any other god besides me, I will certainly have you imprisoned."

³⁰Moses responded, "Even if I bring you a clear proof?"

³¹Pharaoh demanded, "Bring it then, if what you say is true."

³²So he threw down his staff and—behold!—it became a real snake

³³Then he drew his hand 'out of his collar' and it was 'shining' white for all to see

³⁴Pharaoh said to the chiefs around him, "He is indeed a skilled magician

³⁵who seeks to drive you from your land by his magic. So what do you propose?"

³⁶They replied, "Let him and his brother wait and dispatch mobilizers to all cities

³⁷to bring you every skilled magician."

³⁸So the magicians were assembled at the set time on the appointed day

³⁹And the people were asked, "Will you join the gathering

⁴⁰so that we may follow the magicians if they prevail?"

⁴¹When the magicians came, they asked Pharaoh, "Shall we have a 'suitable' reward if we prevail?"

⁴²He replied, "Yes, and you will then certainly be among those closest to me."

⁴³Moses said to them, "Cast whatever you wish to cast."

⁴⁴So they cast down their ropes and staffs, saying, "By Pharaoh's might, it is we who will surely prevail."

⁴⁵Then Moses threw down his staff, and—behold!—it devoured the objects of their illusion

⁴⁶So the magicians fell down, prostrating

⁴⁷They declared, “We ‘now’ believe in the Lord of all worlds—

⁴⁸the Lord of Moses and Aaron.”

⁴⁹Pharaoh threatened, “How dare you believe in him before I give you permission? He must be your master who taught you magic, but soon you will see. I will certainly cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, then crucify you all.”

⁵⁰They responded, “‘That would be’ no harm! Surely to our Lord we will ‘all’ return

⁵¹We really hope that our Lord will forgive our sins, as we are the first to believe.”

⁵²And We inspired Moses, ‘saying,’ “Leave with My servants at night, for you will surely be pursued.”

⁵³Then Pharaoh sent mobilizers to all cities

⁵⁴‘and said,’ “These ‘outcasts’ are just a handful of people

⁵⁵who have really enraged us

⁵⁶but we are all on the alert.”

⁵⁷So We lured the tyrants out of ‘their’ gardens, springs

⁵⁸treasures, and splendid residences

⁵⁹So it was. And We awarded it 'all' to the Children of Israel

⁶⁰And so they pursued them at sunrise

⁶¹When the two groups came face to face, the companions of Moses cried out, "We are overtaken for sure."

⁶²Moses reassured 'them', "Absolutely not! My Lord is certainly with me—He will guide me."

⁶³So We inspired Moses: "Strike the sea with your staff," and the sea was split, each part was like a huge mountain

⁶⁴We drew the pursuers to that place

⁶⁵and delivered Moses and those with him all together

⁶⁶Then We drowned the others

⁶⁷Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

⁶⁸And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

⁶⁹Relate to them 'O Prophet' the story of Abraham

⁷⁰when he questioned his father and his people, "What is that you worship 'besides Allah'?"

⁷¹They replied, "We worship idols, to which we are fully devoted."

⁷²Abraham asked, "Can they hear you when you call upon them

⁷³Or can they benefit or harm you?"

⁷⁴They replied, "No! But we found our forefathers doing the same."

⁷⁵Abraham responded, "Have you 'really' considered what you have been worshipping—

⁷⁶you and your ancestors

⁷⁷They are 'all' enemies to me, except the Lord of all worlds

⁷⁸He is' the One Who created me, and He 'alone' guides me

⁷⁹He is' the One Who provides me with food and drink

⁸⁰And He 'alone' heals me when I am sick

⁸¹And He 'is the One Who' will cause me to die, and then bring me back to life

⁸²And He is 'the One' Who, I hope, will forgive my flaws on Judgment Day."

⁸³"My Lord! Grant me wisdom, and join me with the righteous

⁸⁴Bless me with honourable mention among later generations

⁸⁵Make me one of those awarded the Garden of Bliss

⁸⁶Forgive my father, for he is certainly one of the misguided

⁸⁷And do not disgrace me on the Day all will be resurrected—

⁸⁸the Day when neither wealth nor children will be of any benefit

⁸⁹Only those who come before Allah with a pure heart [۞]will be saved[۞].”

⁹⁰[۞]On that Day[۞] Paradise will be brought near to the God-fearing

⁹¹and the Hellfire will be displayed to the deviant

⁹²And it will be said to them, “Where are those you used to worship

⁹³besides Allah? Can they help you or even help themselves?”

⁹⁴Then the idols will be hurled headlong into Hell, along with the deviant

⁹⁵and the soldiers of Iblîs, all together

⁹⁶There the deviant will cry while disputing with their idols

⁹⁷“By Allah! We were clearly mistaken

⁹⁸when we made you equal to the Lord of all worlds

⁹⁹And none led us astray other than the wicked

¹⁰⁰Now we have none to intercede for us

¹⁰¹nor a close friend

¹⁰²If only we could have a second chance, then we would be believers.”

¹⁰³Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

104 And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

105 The people of Noah rejected the messengers

106 when their brother Noah said to them, "Will you not fear
ʿAllahʿ

107 I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

108 So fear Allah, and obey me

109 I do not ask you for any reward for this 'message'. My
reward is only from the Lord of all worlds

110 So fear Allah, and obey me."

111 They argued, "How can we believe in you, when you are
followed 'only' by the lowest of the low?"

112 He responded, "And what knowledge do I have of what
they do

113 Their judgment is with my Lord, if you had any sense

114 I am not going to expel the believers

115 I am only sent with a clear warning."

116 They threatened, "If you do not desist, O Noah, you will
surely be stoned 'to death'."

117 Noah prayed, "My Lord! My people have truly rejected me

118 So judge between me and them decisively, and save me
and the believers with me."

¹¹⁹So We saved him and those with him in the fully loaded Ark

¹²⁰Then afterwards We drowned the rest

¹²¹Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

¹²²And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

¹²³The people of 'Âd rejected the messengers

¹²⁴when their brother Hûd said to them, "Will you not fear 'Allah'?"

¹²⁵I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

¹²⁶So fear Allah, and obey me

¹²⁷I do not ask you for any reward for this 'message'. My reward is only from the Lord of all worlds

¹²⁸'Why' do you build a landmark on every high place in vanity

¹²⁹and construct castles, as if you are going to live forever

¹³⁰and act so viciously when you attack 'others'?

¹³¹So fear Allah, and obey me

¹³²Fear the One Who has provided you with 'the good' things you know

¹³³He provided you with cattle, and children

¹³⁴and gardens, and springs

¹³⁵I truly fear for you the torment of a tremendous day.”

¹³⁶They responded, “It is all the same to us whether you warn
‘us’ or not

¹³⁷This is simply the tradition of our predecessors

¹³⁸And we will never be punished.”

¹³⁹So they rejected him, and ‘so’ We destroyed them. Surely
in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

¹⁴⁰And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

¹⁴¹The people of Thamûd rejected the messengers

¹⁴²when their brother Şâliḥ said to them, “Will you not fear
‘Allah’

¹⁴³I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

¹⁴⁴So fear Allah, and obey me

¹⁴⁵I do not ask you for any reward for this ‘message’. My
reward is only from the Lord of all worlds

¹⁴⁶Do you think you will be ‘forever’ left secure in what you
have here

¹⁴⁷amid gardens and springs

¹⁴⁸and ‘various’ crops, and palm trees ‘loaded’ with tender
fruit

¹⁴⁹to carve homes in the mountains with great skill

150 So fear Allah, and obey me

151 And do not follow the command of the transgressors

152 who spread corruption throughout the land, never setting things right.”

153 They replied, “You are simply bewitched

154 You are only a human being like us, so bring forth a sign if what you say is true.”

155 Şâlih said, “Here is a camel. She will have her turn to drink as you have yours, each on an appointed day

156 And do not ever touch her with harm, or you will be overtaken by the torment of a tremendous day.”

157 But they killed her, becoming regretful

158 So the punishment overtook them. Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

159 And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

160 The people of Lot rejected the messengers

161 when their brother Lot said to them, “Will you not fear ‘Allah’

162 I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

163 So fear Allah, and obey me

- ¹⁶⁴I do not ask you for any reward for this 'message'. My reward is only from the Lord of all worlds
- ¹⁶⁵Why do you 'men' lust after fellow men
- ¹⁶⁶leaving the wives that your Lord has created for you? In fact, you are a transgressing people.”
- ¹⁶⁷They threatened, “If you do not desist, O Lot, you will surely be expelled.”
- ¹⁶⁸Lot responded, “I am truly one of those who despise your 'shameful' practice
- ¹⁶⁹My Lord! Save me and my family from 'the consequences of' what they do.”
- ¹⁷⁰So We saved him and all of his family
- ¹⁷¹except an old woman, who was one of the doomed
- ¹⁷²Then We utterly destroyed the rest
- ¹⁷³pouring upon them a rain 'of brimstone'. How evil was the rain of those who had been warned
- ¹⁷⁴Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe
- ¹⁷⁵And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful
- ¹⁷⁶The residents of the Forest rejected the messengers
- ¹⁷⁷when Shu'aib said to them, “Will you not fear 'Allah'
- ¹⁷⁸I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

179 So fear Allah, and obey me

180 I do not ask you for any reward for this 'message'. My reward is only from the Lord of all worlds

181 Give full measure, and cause no loss 'to others'

182 Weigh with an even balance

183 and do not defraud people of their property. Nor go about spreading corruption in the land

184 And fear the One Who created you and 'all' earlier peoples."

185 They replied, "You are simply bewitched

186 Also, you are only a human being like us, and we think you are indeed a liar

187 So cause 'deadly' pieces of the sky to fall upon us, if what you say is true."

188 Shu'aib responded, "My Lord knows best whatever you do."

189 So they rejected him, and 'so' were overtaken by the torment of the day of the 'deadly' cloud. That was really a torment of a tremendous day

190 Surely in this is a sign. Yet most of them would not believe

191 And your Lord is certainly the Almighty, Most Merciful

¹⁹²This is certainly a revelation from the Lord of all worlds
¹⁹³which the trustworthy spirit 'Gabriel' brought down
¹⁹⁴into your heart 'O Prophet'—so that you may be one of the
warners—

¹⁹⁵in a clear Arabic tongue

¹⁹⁶And it has indeed been 'foretold' in the Scriptures of those
before

¹⁹⁷Was it not sufficient proof for the deniers that it has been
recognized by the knowledgeable among the Children of Is-
rael

¹⁹⁸Had We revealed it to a non-Arab

¹⁹⁹who would then recite it to the deniers 'in fluent Arabic',
still they would not have believed in it

²⁰⁰This is how We allow denial 'to steep' into the hearts of the
wicked

²⁰¹They will not believe in it until they see the painful pun-
ishment

²⁰²which will take them by surprise when they least expect
'it'

²⁰³Then they will cry, "Can we be allowed more time?"

²⁰⁴Do they 'really' seek to hasten Our torment

205 Imagine 'O Prophet' if We allowed them enjoyment for years

206 then there came to them what they had been threatened with

207 would that enjoyment be of any benefit to them 'at all'

208 We have never destroyed a society without warners

209 to remind 'them', for We would never wrong 'anyone'

210 It was not the devils who brought this 'Quran' down

211 it is not for them 'to do so', nor can they

212 for they are strictly barred from 'even' overhearing 'it'

213 So do not ever call upon any other god besides Allah, or you will be one of the punished

214 And warn 'all, starting with' your closest relatives

215 and be gracious to the believers who follow you

216 But if they disobey you, say, "I am certainly free of what you do."

217 Put your trust in the Almighty, Most Merciful

218 Who sees you when you rise 'for prayer at night'

219 as well as your movements 'in prayer' along with 'fellow' worshippers

220 He 'alone' is indeed the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²²¹ Shall I inform you of whom the devils 'actually' descend upon

²²² They descend upon every sinful liar

²²³ who gives an 'attentive' ear 'to half-truths', mostly passing on sheer lies

²²⁴ As for poets, they are followed 'merely' by deviants

²²⁵ Do you not see how they rant in every field

²²⁶ only saying what they never do

²²⁷ Except those who believe, do good, remember Allah often, and 'poetically' avenge 'the believers' after being wrongfully slandered. The wrongdoers will come to know what 'evil' end they will meet

An-Naml

The Ants • 93 verses

¹Ṭâ-Sîn. These are the verses of the Quran; the clear Book

²It is a guide and good news for the believers

³those who establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and have sure faith in the Hereafter

⁴As for those who do not believe in the Hereafter, We have certainly made their 'evil' deeds appealing to them, so they wander blindly

⁵It is they who will suffer a dreadful torment, and in the Hereafter they will 'truly' be the greatest losers

⁶And indeed, you 'O Prophet' are receiving the Quran from the One 'Who is' All-Wise, All-Knowing

⁷'Remember' when Moses said to his family, "I have spotted a fire. I will either bring you some directions from there, or a burning torch so you may warm yourselves."

⁸But when he came to it, he was called 'by Allah', "Blessed is the one at the fire, and whoever is around it! Glory be to Allah, the Lord of all worlds

⁹O Moses! It is truly I. I am Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise

¹⁰Now, throw down your staff!" But when he saw it slithering like a snake, he ran away without looking back. 'Allah reassured him,' "O Moses! Do not be afraid! Messengers should have no fear in My presence

¹¹'Fear is' only for those who do wrong. But if they later mend 'their' evil 'ways' with good, then I am certainly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹²Now put your hand through 'the opening of' your collar, it will come out 'shining' white, unblemished. 'These are two' of nine signs for Pharaoh and his people. They have truly been a rebellious people."

¹³But when Our enlightening signs came to them, they said, "This is pure magic."

¹⁴And, although their hearts were convinced the signs were true, they still denied them wrongfully and arrogantly. See then what was the end of the corruptors

¹⁵Indeed, We granted knowledge to David and Solomon. And they said ‘in acknowledgment’, “All praise is for Allah Who has privileged us over many of His faithful servants.”

¹⁶And David was succeeded by Solomon, who said, “O people! We have been taught the language of birds, and been given everything ‘we need’. This is indeed a great privilege.”

¹⁷Solomon’s forces of jinn, humans, and birds were rallied for him, perfectly organized

¹⁸And when they came across a valley of ants, an ant warned, “O ants! Go quickly into your homes so Solomon and his armies do not crush you, unknowingly.”

¹⁹So Solomon smiled in amusement at her words, and prayed, “My Lord! Inspire me to ‘always’ be thankful for Your favours which You have blessed me and my parents with, and to do good deeds that please you. Admit me, by Your mercy, into ‘the company of’ Your righteous servants.”

²⁰‘One day’ he inspected the birds, and wondered, “Why is it that I cannot see the hoopoe? Or could he be absent

²¹I will surely subject him to a severe punishment, or ‘even’ slaughter him, unless he brings me a compelling excuse.”

²²It was not long before the bird came and said, “I have found out something you do not know. I have just come to you from Sheba with sure news

²³Indeed, I found a woman ruling over them, who has been given everything ‘she needs’, and who has a magnificent throne

²⁴I found her and her people prostrating to the sun instead of Allah. For Satan has made their deeds appealing to them—hindering them from the ‘Right’ Way and leaving them unguided—

²⁵so they do not prostrate to Allah, Who brings forth what is hidden in the heavens and the earth, and knows what you ‘all’ conceal and what you reveal

²⁶‘He is’ Allah! There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him, the Lord of the Mighty Throne.”

²⁷Solomon said, “We will see whether you are telling the truth or lying

²⁸Go with this letter of mine and deliver it to them, then stand aside and see how they will respond.”

²⁹The Queen ‘later’ announced, “O chiefs! Indeed, a noble letter has been delivered to me

³⁰It is from Solomon, and it reads: ‘In the Name of Allah—the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

³¹Do not be arrogant with me, but come to me, fully submitting ‘to Allah’.”

³²She said, “O chiefs! Advise me in this matter of mine, for I would never make any decision without you.”

³³They responded, “We are a people of strength and great ‘military’ might, but the decision is yours, so decide what you will command.”

³⁴She reasoned, “Indeed, when kings invade a land, they ruin it and debase its nobles. They really do so

³⁵But I will certainly send him a gift, and see what ‘response’ my envoys will return with.”

³⁶When the chief-envoy came to him, Solomon said, “Do you offer me wealth? What Allah has granted me is far greater than what He has granted you. No! It is you who rejoice in ‘receiving’ gifts

³⁷Go back to them, for we will certainly mobilize against them forces which they can never resist, and we will drive them out from there in disgrace, fully humbled.”

³⁸Solomon asked, “O chiefs! Which of you can bring me her throne before they come to me in ‘full’ submission?”

³⁹One mighty jinn responded, “I can bring it to you before you rise from this council of yours. And I am quite strong and trustworthy for this ‘task’.”

⁴⁰But the one who had knowledge of the Scripture said, “I can bring it to you in the blink of an eye.” So when Solomon saw it placed before him, he exclaimed, “This is by the grace of my Lord to test me whether I am grateful or ungrateful. And whoever is grateful, it is only for their own good. But whoever is ungrateful, surely my Lord is Self-Sufficient, Most Generous.”

⁴¹“Then” Solomon said, “Disguise her throne for her so we may see whether she will recognize ‘it’ or she will not be able to.”

⁴²So when she arrived, it was said ‘to her’, “Is your throne like this?” She replied, “It looks to be the same. We have ‘already’ received knowledge ‘of Solomon’s prophethood’ before this ‘miracle’, and have submitted ‘to Allah’.”

⁴³But she had been hindered by what she used to worship instead of Allah, for she was indeed from a disbelieving people

⁴⁴Then she was told, “Enter the palace.” But when she saw the hall, she thought it was a body of water, so she bared her legs. Solomon said. “It is just a palace paved with crystal.” ‘At last’ she declared, “My Lord! I have certainly wronged my soul. Now I ‘fully’ submit myself along with Solomon to Allah, the Lord of all worlds.”

⁴⁵And We certainly sent to the people of Thamûd their brother Şâlih, proclaiming, “Worship Allah,” but they suddenly split into two opposing groups

⁴⁶He urged ‘the disbelieving group’, “O my people! Why do you ‘seek to’ hasten the torment rather than grace? If only you sought Allah’s forgiveness so you may be shown mercy!”

⁴⁷They replied, “You and your followers are a bad omen for us.” He responded, “Your omens are destined by Allah. In fact, you are ‘only’ a people being tested.”

⁴⁸And there were in the city nine ‘elite’ men who spread corruption in the land, never doing what is right

⁴⁹They vowed, “Let us swear by Allah that we will take him and his family down by night. Then we will certainly say to his ‘closest’ heirs, ‘We did not witness the murder of his family. We are definitely telling the truth.’”

⁵⁰And 'so' they made a plan, but We too made a plan, while they were unaware

⁵¹See then what the consequences of their plan were: We 'utterly' destroyed them and their people all together

⁵²So their homes are there, 'but completely' ruined because of their wrongdoing. Surely in this is a lesson for people of knowledge

⁵³And We delivered those who were faithful and were mindful 'of Allah'

⁵⁴And 'remember' Lot, when he rebuked 'the men of' his people, "Do you commit that shameful deed while you can see 'one another'

⁵⁵Do you really lust after men instead of women? In fact, you are 'only' a people acting ignorantly."

⁵⁶But his people's only response was to say, "Expel Lot's followers from your land! They are a people who wish to remain chaste!"

⁵⁷So We delivered him and his family, except his wife. We had destined her to be one of the doomed

⁵⁸And We poured upon them a rain 'of brimstone'. How evil was the rain of those who had been warned

⁵⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Praise be to Allah, and peace be upon the servants He has chosen." 'Ask the disbelievers,' "Which is better: Allah or whatever 'gods' they associate 'with Him'?"

⁶⁰Or 'ask them,' "Who created the heavens and the earth, and sends down rain for you from the sky, by which We cause delightful gardens to grow? You could never cause their trees to grow. Was it another god besides Allah?" Absolutely not! But they are a people who set up equals 'to Allah'

⁶¹Or 'ask them,' "Who made the earth a place of settlement, caused rivers to flow through it, placed firm mountains upon it, and set a barrier between 'fresh and salt' bodies of water? Was it another god besides Allah?" Absolutely not! But most of them do not know

⁶²Or 'ask them,' "Who responds to the distressed when they cry to Him, relieving 'their' affliction, and 'Who' makes you successors in the earth? Is it another god besides Allah? Yet you are hardly mindful!"

⁶³Or 'ask them,' "Who guides you in the darkness of the land and sea, and sends the winds ushering in His mercy? Is it another god besides Allah? Exalted is Allah above what they associate 'with Him'

⁶⁴Or ‘ask them,’ “Who originates the creation then resurrects it, and gives you provisions from the heavens and the earth? Is it another god besides Allah?” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Show ‘me’ your proof, if what you say is true.”

⁶⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “None in the heavens and the earth has knowledge of the unseen except Allah. Nor do they know when they will be resurrected

⁶⁶No! Their knowledge of the Hereafter amounts to ignorance. In fact, they are in doubt about it. In truth, they are ‘totally’ blind to it

⁶⁷The disbelievers ask, “When we and our fathers are reduced to dust, will we really be brought forth ‘alive’

⁶⁸We have already been promised this, as well as our forefathers earlier. This is nothing but ancient fables!”

⁶⁹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Travel throughout the land and see the fate of the wicked.”

⁷⁰Do not grieve for them, nor be distressed by their schemes

⁷¹They ask ‘the believers’, “When will this threat come to pass, if what you say is true?”

⁷²Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Perhaps some of what you seek to hasten is close at hand.”

⁷³ Surely your Lord is ever Bountiful to humanity, but most of them are ungrateful

⁷⁴ And surely your Lord knows what their hearts conceal and what they reveal

⁷⁵ For there is nothing hidden in the heavens or the earth without being 'written' in a perfect Record

⁷⁶ Indeed, this Quran clarifies for the Children of Israel most of what they differ over

⁷⁷ And it is truly a guide and mercy for the believers

⁷⁸ Your Lord will certainly judge between them by His justice, for He is the Almighty, All-Knowing

⁷⁹ So put your trust in Allah, for you are surely upon the 'Path of' clear truth

⁸⁰ You certainly cannot make the dead hear 'the truth'. Nor can you make the deaf hear the call when they turn their backs and walk away

⁸¹ Nor can you lead the blind out of their misguidance. You can make none hear 'the truth' except those who believe in Our revelations, 'fully' submitting 'to Allah'

⁸² And when the decree 'of the Hour' comes to pass against them, We will bring forth for them a beast from the earth,

telling them that the people had no sure faith in Our revelations

⁸³“Watch for” the Day We will gather from every faith-community a group of those who denied Our revelations, and they will be driven in ranks

⁸⁴When they “finally” come before their Lord, He will ask “them”, “Did you deny My revelations without “even” comprehending them? Or what “exactly” did you do?”

⁸⁵And the decree “of torment” will be justified against them for their wrongdoing, leaving them speechless

⁸⁶Do they not see that We made the night for them to rest in and the day bright? Surely in this are signs for those who believe

⁸⁷And “beware of” the Day the Trumpet will be blown, and all those in the heavens and all those on the earth will be horrified “to the point of death”, except those Allah wills “to spare”. And all will come before Him, fully humbled

⁸⁸Now you see the mountains, thinking they are firmly fixed, but they are travelling “just” like clouds. “That is” the design of Allah, Who has perfected everything. Surely He is All-Aware of what you do

⁸⁹Whoever comes with a good deed will be rewarded with what is better, and they will be secure from the horror on that Day

⁹⁰And whoever comes with an evil deed will be hurled face-first into the Fire. Are you rewarded except for what you used to do

⁹¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "I have only been commanded to worship the Lord of this city 'of Mecca', Who has made it sacred, and to Him belongs everything. And I am commanded to be one of those who 'fully' submit 'to Him'

⁹²and to recite the Quran." Then whoever chooses to be guided, it is only for their own good. But whoever chooses to stray, say, 'O Prophet,' "I am only a warner."

⁹³And say, "All praise is for Allah! He will show you His signs, and you will recognize them. And your Lord is never unaware of what you do."

Al-Qaṣaṣ

The Narration • 88 verses

¹Ṭâ-Sîn-Mîm

²These are the verses of the clear Book

³We narrate to you 'O Prophet' part of the story of Moses and Pharaoh in truth for people who believe

⁴Indeed, Pharaoh 'arrogantly' elevated himself in the land and divided its people into 'subservient' groups, one of which he persecuted, slaughtering their sons and keeping their women. He was truly one of the corruptors

⁵But it was Our Will to favour those who were oppressed in the land, making them models 'of faith' as well as successors

⁶and to establish them in the land; and through them show Pharaoh, Hamân, and their soldiers 'the fulfilment of' what they feared

⁷We inspired the mother of Moses: "Nurse him, but when you fear for him, put him then into the river, and do not fear

or grieve. We will certainly return him to you, and make him one of the messengers.”

⁸And ‘it so happened that’ Pharaoh’s people picked him up, only to become their enemy and source of grief. Surely Pharaoh, Hamân, and their soldiers were sinful

⁹Pharaoh’s wife said ‘to him’, “‘This baby is’ a source of joy for me and you. Do not kill him. Perhaps he may be useful to us or we may adopt him as a son.” They were unaware ‘of what was to come’

¹⁰And the heart of Moses’ mother ached so much that she almost gave away his identity, had We not reassured her heart in order for her to have faith ‘in Allah’s promise’

¹¹And she said to his sister, “Keep track of him!” So she watched him from a distance, while they were unaware

¹²And We had caused him to refuse all wet-nurses at first, so his sister suggested, “Shall I direct you to a family who will bring him up for you and take good care of him?”

¹³This is how We returned him to his mother so that her heart would be put at ease, and not grieve, and that she would know that Allah’s promise is ‘always’ true. But most people do not know

¹⁴And when he reached full strength and maturity, We gave him wisdom and knowledge. This is how We reward the good-doers

¹⁵One day he entered the city unnoticed by its people. There he found two men fighting: one of his own people, and the other of his enemies. The man from his people called to him for help against his foe. So Moses punched him, causing his death. Moses cried, "This is from Satan's handiwork. He is certainly a sworn, misleading enemy."

¹⁶He pleaded, "My Lord! I have definitely wronged my soul, so forgive me." So He forgave him, for He is indeed the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁷Moses pledged, "My Lord! For all Your favours upon me, I will never side with the wicked."

¹⁸And so Moses became fearful, watching out in the city, when suddenly the one who sought his help the day before cried out to him again for help. Moses rebuked him, "Indeed, you are clearly a trouble-maker."

¹⁹Then when Moses was about to lay his hands on their foe, the enemy said, "O Moses! Do you intend to kill me as you killed a man yesterday? You only want to be a tyrant in the land. You do not intend to make peace!"

²⁰And there came a man, rushing from the farthest end of the city. He said, “O Moses! The chiefs are actually conspiring against you to put you to death, so leave ‘the city’. I really advise you ‘to do so’.”

²¹So Moses left the city in a state of fear and caution, praying, “My Lord! Deliver me from the wrongdoing people.”

²²And as he made his way towards Midian, he said, “I trust my Lord will guide me to the right way.”

²³When he arrived at the well of Midian, he found a group of people watering ‘their herds’. Apart from them, he noticed two women holding back ‘their herd’. He asked ‘them’, “What is the problem?” They replied, “We cannot water ‘our animals’ until the ‘other’ shepherds are done, for our father is a very old man.”

²⁴So he watered ‘their herd’ for them, then withdrew to the shade and prayed, “My Lord! I am truly in ‘desperate’ need of whatever provision You may have in store for me.”

²⁵Then one of the two women came to him, walking bashfully. She said, “My father is inviting you so he may reward you for watering ‘our animals’ for us.” When Moses came to him and told him his whole story, the old man said, “Have no fear! You are ‘now’ safe from the wrongdoing people.”

²⁶One of the two daughters suggested, “O my dear father! Hire him. The best man for employment is definitely the strong and trustworthy ‘one’.”

²⁷The old man proposed, “I wish to marry one of these two daughters of mine to you, provided that you stay in my service for eight years. If you complete ten, it will be ‘a favour’ from you, but I do not wish to make it difficult for you. Allah willing, you will find me an agreeable man.”

²⁸Moses responded, “‘Then’ it is ‘settled’ between you and I. Whichever term I fulfill, there will be no ‘further’ obligation on me. And Allah is a Witness to what we say.”

²⁹When Moses had completed the term and was travelling with his family, he spotted a fire on the side of Mount Tûr. He said to his family, “Stay here, ‘for’ I have spotted a fire. Perhaps from there I can bring you some directions or a torch from the fire so you may warm yourselves.”

³⁰But when he came to it, he was called from the bush in the sacred ground to the right side of the valley: “O Moses! It is truly I. I am Allah—the Lord of all worlds

³¹Now, throw down your staff!” But when he saw it slithering like a snake, he ran away without looking back. ‘Allah

reassured him, “O Moses! Draw near, and have no fear. You are perfectly secure

³²Now put your hand through ‘the opening of’ your collar, it will come out ‘shining’ white, unblemished. And cross your arms tightly to calm your fears. These are two proofs from your Lord to Pharaoh and his chiefs. They have truly been a rebellious people.”

³³Moses appealed, “My Lord! I have indeed killed a man from them, so I fear they may kill me

³⁴And my brother Aaron is more eloquent than I, so send him with me as a helper to support what I say, for I truly fear they may reject me.”

³⁵Allah responded, “We will assist you with your brother and grant you both authority, so they cannot harm you. With Our signs, you and those who follow you will ‘certainly’ prevail.”

³⁶But when Moses came to them with Our clear signs, they said ‘arrogantly’, “This is nothing but conjured magic ‘tricks’. We have never heard of this in ‘the history of’ our forefathers.”

³⁷Moses responded, “My Lord knows best who has come with ‘true’ guidance from Him and will fare best in the end. Indeed, the wrongdoers will never succeed.”

³⁸Pharaoh declared, “O chiefs! I know of no other god for you but myself. So bake bricks out of clay for me, O Hamân, and build a high tower so I may look at the God of Moses, although I am sure he is a liar.”

³⁹And so he and his soldiers behaved arrogantly in the land with no right, thinking they would never be returned to Us

⁴⁰So We seized him and his soldiers, casting them into the sea. See then what was the end of the wrongdoers

⁴¹We made them leaders inviting ‘others’ to the Fire. And on the Day of Judgment they will not be helped

⁴²We caused a curse to follow them in this world. And on the Day of Judgment they will be among the outcasts

⁴³Indeed, We gave Moses the Scripture—after destroying earlier nations—as an insight for the people, a guide, and mercy so perhaps they would be mindful

⁴⁴You were not there ‘O Prophet’ on the western side of the mountain when We entrusted the Commandments to Moses, nor were you present ‘in his time’

⁴⁵But We 'later' raised 'several' generations, and the ages took their toll on them. Nor were you living among the people of Midian, rehearsing Our revelations with them. But it is We Who have sent 'this revelation to you'

⁴⁶And you were not at the side of Mount Ṭûr when We called out 'to Moses'. But 'you have been sent' as a mercy from your Lord to warn a people to whom no warner has come before you, so perhaps they may be mindful

⁴⁷Also so they would not say, if struck by an affliction for what their hands have done: "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a messenger, we would have followed Your revelations and become believers."

⁴⁸But when the truth came to them from Us, they said, "If only he was given the like of what Moses had been given." Did they not deny what had been given to Moses earlier? They claimed, "Both 'Scriptures' are works of magic, supporting each other!" Adding, "We truly deny both."

⁴⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Bring then a scripture from Allah which is a better guide than these two so I may follow it, if your claim is true."

⁵⁰So if they fail to respond to you, then know that they only follow their desires. And who could be more astray than

those who follow their desires with no guidance from Allah?
Surely Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

⁵¹Indeed, We have steadily delivered the Word 'of Allah' to
the people so they may be mindful

⁵²As for those 'faithful' to whom We had given the Scripture
before this 'Quran', they do believe in it

⁵³When it is recited to them, they declare, "We believe in it.
This is definitely the truth from our Lord. We had already
submitted 'even' before this."

⁵⁴These 'believers' will be given a double reward for their
perseverance, responding to evil with good, and for donating
from what We have provided for them

⁵⁵When they hear slanderous talk, they turn away from it,
saying, "We are accountable for our deeds and you for yours.
Peace 'is our only response' to you! We want nothing to do
with those who act ignorantly."

⁵⁶You surely cannot guide whoever you like 'O Prophet', but
it is Allah Who guides whoever He wills, and He knows best
who are 'fit to be' guided

⁵⁷They say 'to the Prophet', "If we were to follow 'true' guid-
ance with you, we would certainly be snatched away from

our land.” Have We not established for them a safe haven ‘in Mecca’ to which fruits of all kinds are brought as a provision from Us? But most of them do not know ‘this favour’

⁵⁸‘Imagine’ how many societies We have destroyed that had been spoiled by their ‘comfortable’ living! Those are their residences, never inhabited after them except passingly. And We ‘alone’ were the Successor

⁵⁹Your Lord would never destroy a society until He had sent to its capital a messenger, reciting Our revelations to them. Nor would We ever destroy a society unless its people persisted in wrongdoing

⁶⁰Whatever ‘pleasure’ you have been given is no more than ‘a fleeting’ enjoyment and adornment of this worldly life. But what is with Allah is far better and more lasting. Will you not then understand

⁶¹Can those to whom We have made a fine promise—which they will see fulfilled—be like those who We have allowed to enjoy the pleasures of this worldly life, but on the Day of Judgment will be brought ‘for punishment’

⁶²‘Watch for’ the Day He will call to them, “Where are those you claimed were My associate-gods?”

⁶³Those ‘misleaders’ against whom the decree ‘of torment’ is justified will cry, “Our Lord! These ‘followers’ are the ones we caused to deviate. We led them into deviance, for we ourselves were deviant. We disassociate ourselves ‘from them’ before You. It was not us that they used to worship.”

⁶⁴It will be said ‘to the disbelievers’, “Call upon your associate-gods ‘for help’.” So they will call them, but will receive no response. And they will face the punishment, wishing they had been ‘rightly’ guided

⁶⁵And ‘watch for’ the Day He will call to them, asking, “What response did you give to the messengers?”

⁶⁶They will be too dumbstruck on that Day to ask one another ‘for answers’

⁶⁷As for those who repent, believe, and do good ‘in this world’, it is right to hope that they will be among the successful

⁶⁸Your Lord creates and chooses whatever He wills—the choice is not theirs. Glorified and Exalted is Allah above what they associate ‘with Him’

⁶⁹And your Lord knows what their hearts conceal and what they reveal

⁷⁰He is Allah. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. All praise belongs to Him in this life and the next. All authority is His. And to Him you will 'all' be returned

⁷¹Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Imagine if Allah were to make the night perpetual for you until the Day of Judgment, which god other than Allah could bring you sunlight? Will you not then listen?"

⁷²Ask 'them also', "Imagine if Allah were to make the day perpetual for you until the Day of Judgment, which god other than Allah could bring you night to rest in? Will you not then see?"

⁷³It is out of His mercy that He has made for you the day and night so that you may rest 'in the latter' and seek His bounty 'in the former', and perhaps you will be grateful

⁷⁴And 'watch for' the Day He will call to them, "Where are those you claimed were My associate-gods?"

⁷⁵And We will bring forth a witness from every faith-community and ask 'the polytheists', "Show 'Us' your proof." Then they will 'come to' know that the truth is with Allah 'alone'. And whatever 'gods' they fabricated will fail them

⁷⁶Indeed, Korah was from the people of Moses, but he behaved arrogantly towards them. We had granted him such treasures that even their keys would burden a group of strong men. 'Some of' his people advised him, "Do not be prideful! Surely Allah does not like the prideful

⁷⁷Rather, seek the 'reward' of the Hereafter by means of what Allah has granted you, without forgetting your share of this world. And be good 'to others' as Allah has been good to you. Do not seek to spread corruption in the land, for Allah certainly does not like the corruptors."

⁷⁸He replied, "I have been granted all this because of some knowledge I have." Did he not know that Allah had already destroyed some from the generations before him who were far superior to him in power and greater in accumulating 'wealth'? There will be no need for the wicked to be asked about their sins

⁷⁹Then he came out before his people in all his glamour. Those who desired the life of this world wished, "If only we could have something like what Korah has been given. He is truly a man of great fortune!"

⁸⁰But those gifted with knowledge said, “Shame on you! Allah’s reward is far better for those who believe and do good. But none will attain this except the steadfast.”

⁸¹Then We caused the earth to swallow him up, along with his home. There was no one to help him against Allah, nor could he even help himself

⁸²And those who had craved his position the previous day began to say, “Ah! It is certainly Allah Who gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills of His servants. Had it not been for the grace of Allah, He could have surely caused the earth to swallow us up! Oh, indeed! The disbelievers will never succeed.”

⁸³That ‘eternal’ Home in the Hereafter We reserve ‘only’ for those who seek neither tyranny nor corruption on the earth. The ultimate outcome belongs ‘only’ to the righteous

⁸⁴Whoever comes with a good deed will be rewarded with what is better. And whoever comes with an evil deed, then the evildoers will only be rewarded for what they used to do

⁸⁵Most certainly, the One Who has ordained the Quran for you will ‘ultimately’ bring you back home ‘to Mecca’. Say, “My Lord knows best who has come with ‘true’ guidance and who is clearly astray.”

⁸⁶You never expected this Book to be revealed to you, but 'it came' only 'as' a mercy from your Lord. So never side with the disbelievers 'in their disbelief'

⁸⁷Do not let them turn you away from the revelations of Allah after they have been sent down to you. Rather, invite 'all' to 'the Way of' your Lord, and never be one of the polytheists

⁸⁸And do not invoke any other god with Allah. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. Everything is bound to perish except He Himself. All authority belongs to Him. And to Him you will 'all' be returned

Al-‘Ankabūt

The Spider • 69 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²Do people think once they say, “We believe,” that they will be left without being put to the test

³We certainly tested those before them. And ‘in this way’ Allah will clearly distinguish between those who are truthful and those who are liars

⁴Or do the evildoers ‘simply’ think that they will escape Us? How wrong is their judgment

⁵Whoever hopes for the meeting with Allah, ‘let them know that’ Allah’s appointed time is sure to come. He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁶And whoever strives ‘in Allah’s cause’, only does so for their own good. Surely Allah is not in need of ‘any of’ His creation

⁷As for those who believe and do good, We will certainly absolve them of their sins, and reward them according to the best of what they used to do

⁸We have commanded people to honour their parents. But if they urge you to associate with Me what you have no knowledge of, then do not obey them. To Me you will 'all' return, and then I will inform you of what you used to do

⁹Those who believe and do good will surely be admitted by Us into 'the company of' the righteous

¹⁰There are some who say, "We believe in Allah," but when they suffer in the cause of Allah, they mistake 'this' persecution at the hands of people for the punishment of Allah. But when victory comes from your Lord, they surely say 'to the believers', "We have always been with you." Does Allah not know best what is in the hearts of all beings

¹¹Allah will certainly distinguish between those who have 'sure' faith and the hypocrites

¹²The disbelievers say to the believers, "'Just' follow our way, and we will bear 'the burden of' your sins." But they would never 'want to' bear any of the believers' sins. They are simply lying

¹³Yet they will certainly ‘be made to’ carry their own burdens, as well as other burdens along with their own. And they will surely be questioned on Judgment Day about what they used to fabricate

¹⁴Indeed, We sent Noah to his people, and he remained among them for a thousand years, less fifty. Then the Flood overtook them, while they persisted in wrongdoing

¹⁵But We delivered him and those in the Ark, making it a sign for all people

¹⁶And ‘remember’ when Abraham said to his people, “Worship Allah, and fear Him. This is better for you, if only you knew

¹⁷You worship besides Allah nothing but idols, simply creating lies ‘about them’. Those you worship besides Allah certainly cannot give you any provision. So seek provision from Allah ‘alone’, worship Him, and be grateful to Him. To Him you will ‘all’ be returned

¹⁸If you ‘Meccans’ persist in denial, so did ‘many’ communities before you. The Messenger’s duty is only to deliver ‘the message’ clearly.”

¹⁹Have they not seen how Allah originates the creation then resurrects it? That is certainly easy for Allah

²⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "Travel throughout the land and see how He originated the creation, then Allah will bring it into being one more time. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

²¹He punishes whoever He wills, and shows mercy to whoever He wills. And you will 'all' be returned to Him

²²And you cannot escape Him on earth or in heaven. Nor have you any protector or helper besides Allah."

²³As for those who disbelieve in Allah's signs and the meeting with Him, it is they who will have no hope in His mercy. And it is they who will suffer a painful punishment

²⁴But the only response of Abraham's people was to say: "Kill him or burn him!" But Allah saved him from the fire. Surely in this are signs for people who believe

²⁵He said 'to his people', "You have taken idols 'for worship' instead of Allah, only to keep 'the bond of' harmony among yourselves in this worldly life. But on the Day of Judgment you will disown and curse one another. Your home will be the Fire, and you will have no helper!"

²⁶So Lot believed in him. And Abraham said, “I am emigrating ‘in obedience’ to my Lord. He ‘alone’ is indeed the Almighty, All-Wise.”

²⁷We blessed him with Isaac and ‘later’ Jacob, and reserved prophethood and revelation for his descendants. We gave him his reward in this life, and in the Hereafter he will certainly be among the righteous

²⁸And ‘remember’ when Lot rebuked ‘the men of’ his people: “You certainly commit a shameful deed that no man has ever done before you

²⁹Do you really lust after ‘other’ men, abuse the travellers, and practice immorality ‘openly’ in your gatherings?” His people’s only response was to say ‘mockingly’: “Bring Allah’s punishment upon us, if what you say is true.”

³⁰Lot prayed, “My Lord! Help me against the people of corruption.”

³¹When Our messenger-angels came to Abraham with the good news ‘of the birth of Isaac’, they said, “We are going to destroy the people of this city ‘of Sodom’, for its people have persisted in wrongdoing.”

³²He said, “But Lot is there!” They responded, “We know best who is there. We will certainly save him and his family—except his wife, who is one of the doomed.”

³³And when Our messenger-angels came to Lot, he was distressed and worried by their arrival. They reassured ‘him’, “Do not fear, nor grieve. We will surely deliver you and your family—except your wife, who is one of the doomed

³⁴We are certainly bringing down a punishment from heaven upon the people of this city for their rebelliousness.”

³⁵And We did leave ‘some of’ its ruins as a clear lesson for people of understanding

³⁶And to the people of Midian ‘We sent’ their brother Shu’aib. He said, “O my people! Worship Allah, and hope for ‘the reward of’ the Last Day. And do not go about spreading corruption in the land.”

³⁷But they rejected him, so an ‘overwhelming’ earthquake struck them and they fell lifeless in their homes

³⁸And the people of ‘Âd and Thamûd ‘met a similar fate’, which must be clear to you ‘Meccans’ from their ruins. Satan made their ‘evil’ deeds appealing to them, hindering them from the ‘Right’ Way, although they were capable of reasoning

³⁹‘We’ also ‘destroyed’ Korah, Pharaoh, and Hamân. Indeed, Moses had come to them with clear proofs, but they behaved arrogantly in the land. Yet they could not escape ‘Us’

⁴⁰So We seized each ‘people’ for their sin: against some of them We sent a storm of stones, some were overtaken by a ‘mighty’ blast, some We caused the earth to swallow, and some We drowned. Allah would not have wronged them, but it was they who wronged themselves

⁴¹The parable of those who take protectors other than Allah is that of a spider spinning a shelter. And the flimsiest of all shelters is certainly that of a spider, if only they knew

⁴²Allah surely knows that whatever ‘gods’ they invoke besides Him are ‘simply’ nothing. For He is the Almighty, All-Wise

⁴³These are the parables We set forth for humanity, but none will understand them except the people of knowledge

⁴⁴Allah created the heavens and the earth for a purpose. Surely in this is a sign for the people of faith

⁴⁵Recite what has been revealed to you of the Book and establish prayer. Indeed, ‘genuine’ prayer should deter ‘one’ from indecency and wickedness. The remembrance of Allah

is 'an' even greater 'deterrent'. And Allah 'fully' knows what you 'all' do

⁴⁶Do not argue with the People of the Book unless gracefully, except with those of them who act wrongfully. And say, "We believe in what has been revealed to us and what was revealed to you. Our God and your God is 'only' One. And to Him we 'fully' submit."

⁴⁷Similarly 'to earlier messengers', We have revealed to you a Book 'O Prophet'. 'The faithful of' those to whom We gave the Scriptures believe in it, as do some of these 'pagan Arabs'. And none denies Our revelations except the 'stubborn' disbelievers

⁴⁸You 'O Prophet' could not read any writing 'even' before this 'revelation', nor could you write at all. Otherwise, the people of falsehood would have been suspicious

⁴⁹But this 'Quran' is 'a set of' clear revelations 'preserved' in the hearts of those gifted with knowledge. And none denies Our revelations except the 'stubborn' wrongdoers

⁵⁰They say, "If only 'some' signs had been sent down to him from his Lord!" Say, 'O Prophet,' "Signs are only with Allah. And I am only sent with a clear warning."

⁵¹Is it not enough for them that We have sent down to you the Book, ‘which is’ recited to them. Surely in this ‘Quran’ is a mercy and reminder for people who believe

⁵²Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Sufficient is Allah as a Witness between me and you. He ‘fully’ knows whatever is in the heavens and the earth. And those who believe in falsehood and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the ‘true’ losers.”

⁵³They challenge you ‘O Prophet’ to hasten the punishment. Had it not been for a time already set, the punishment would have certainly come to them ‘at once’. But it will definitely take them by surprise when they least expect it

⁵⁴They urge you to hasten the punishment. And Hell will certainly encompass the disbelievers

⁵⁵on the Day the punishment will overwhelm them from above them and from below their feet. And it will be said, “Reap what you sowed.”

⁵⁶O My believing servants! My earth is truly spacious, so worship Me ‘alone’

⁵⁷Every soul will taste death, then to Us you will ‘all’ be returned

⁵⁸As for those who believe and do good, We will certainly house them in elevated mansions in Paradise, under which rivers flow, to stay there forever. How excellent is the reward for those who work righteousness!—

⁵⁹those who patiently endure, and put their trust in their Lord

⁶⁰How many are the creatures that cannot secure their provisions! It is Allah Who provides for them and you as well. He is indeed the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

⁶¹If you ask them O Prophet who created the heavens and the earth and subjected the sun and the moon for your benefit, they will certainly say, “Allah!” How can they then be deluded from the truth

⁶²Allah gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills of His servants. Surely Allah has full knowledge of everything

⁶³And if you ask them who sends down rain from the sky, giving life to the earth after its death, they will surely say, “Allah!” Say, “Praise be to Allah!” In fact, most of them do not understand

⁶⁴This worldly life is no more than play and amusement. But the Hereafter is indeed the real life, if only they knew

⁶⁵If they happen to be aboard a ship 'caught in a storm', they cry out to Allah 'alone' in sincere devotion. But as soon as He delivers them 'safely' to shore, they associate 'others with Him once again'

⁶⁶So let them be ungrateful for all We have given them, and 'let them' enjoy themselves 'for now'! For they will soon know

⁶⁷Have they not seen how We have made 'Mecca' a safe haven, whereas people 'all' around them are snatched away? How can they then believe in falsehood and deny Allah's favours

⁶⁸And who does more wrong than those who fabricate lies against Allah or reject the truth after it has reached them? Is Hell not a 'fitting' home for the disbelievers

⁶⁹As for those who struggle in Our cause, We will surely guide them along Our Way. And Allah is certainly with the good-doers

Ar-Rūm

The Romans • 60 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²The Romans have been defeated

³in a nearby land. Yet following their defeat, they will triumph

⁴within three to nine years. The 'whole' matter rests with Allah before and after 'victory'. And on that day the believers will rejoice

⁵at the victory willed by Allah. He gives victory to whoever He wills. For He is the Almighty, Most Merciful

⁶'This is' the promise of Allah. 'And' Allah never fails in His promise. But most people do not know

⁷They 'only' know the worldly affairs of this life, but are 'totally' oblivious to the Hereafter

⁸Have they not reflected upon their own being? Allah only created the heavens and the earth and everything in between

for a purpose and an appointed term. Yet most people are truly in denial of the meeting with their Lord

⁹Have they not travelled throughout the land to see what was the end of those 'destroyed' before them? They were far superior in might; they cultivated the land and developed it more than these 'Meccans' ever have. Their messengers came to them with clear proofs. Allah would have never wronged them, but it was they who wronged themselves

¹⁰Then most evil was the end of the evildoers for denying and mocking the signs of Allah

¹¹It is Allah Who originates the creation, and will resurrect it. And then to Him you will 'all' be returned

¹²On the Day the Hour will arrive, the wicked will be dumb-struck

¹³There will be no intercessors for them from among their associate-gods, and they will 'totally' deny their associate-gods

¹⁴And on the Day the Hour will arrive, the people will then be split 'into two groups'

¹⁵As for those who believed and did good, they will be rejoicing in a Garden

¹⁶And as for those who disbelieved, and denied Our signs and the meeting 'with Allah' in the Hereafter, they will be confined in punishment

¹⁷So glorify Allah in the evening and in the morning—

¹⁸all praise is for Him in the heavens and the earth—as well as in the afternoon, and at noon

¹⁹He brings forth the living from the dead and the dead from the living. And He gives life to the earth after its death. And so will you be brought forth 'from the grave'

²⁰One of His signs is that He created you from dust, then—behold!—you are human beings spreading over 'the earth'

²¹And one of His signs is that He created for you spouses from among yourselves so that you may find comfort in them. And He has placed between you compassion and mercy. Surely in this are signs for people who reflect

²²And one of His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the diversity of your languages and colours. Surely in this are signs for those of 'sound' knowledge

²³And one of His signs is your sleep by night and by day 'for rest' as well as your seeking His bounty 'in both'. Surely in this are signs for people who listen

²⁴And one of His signs is that He shows you lightning, inspiring 'you with' hope and fear. And He sends down rain from the sky, reviving the earth after its death. Surely in this are signs for people who understand

²⁵And one of His signs is that the heavens and the earth persist by His command. Then when He calls you out of the earth just once, you will instantly come forth

²⁶And to Him belong all those in the heavens and the earth—all are subject to His Will

²⁷And He is the One Who originates the creation then will resurrect it—which is even easier for Him. To Him belong the finest attributes in the heavens and the earth. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

²⁸He sets forth for you an example 'drawn' from your own lives: would you allow some of those 'bondspeople' in your possession to be your equal partners in whatever 'wealth' We have provided you, keeping them in mind as you are mindful of your peers? This is how We make the signs clear for people who understand

²⁹In fact, the wrongdoers merely follow their desires with no knowledge. Who then can guide those Allah has left to stray? They will have no helpers

³⁰So be steadfast in faith in all uprightness 'O Prophet'—the natural Way of Allah which He has instilled in 'all' people. Let there be no change in this creation of Allah. That is the Straight Way, but most people do not know

³¹'O believers!' Always turn to Him 'in repentance', be mindful of Him, and establish prayers. And do not be polytheists—

³²'like' those who have divided their faith and split into sects, each rejoicing in what they have

³³When people are touched with hardship, they cry out to their Lord, turning to Him 'alone'. But as soon as He gives them a taste of His mercy, a group of them associates 'others' with their Lord 'in worship'

³⁴becoming ungrateful for whatever 'favours' We have given them. So enjoy yourselves, for soon you will know

³⁵Or have We sent down to them an authority which attests to what they associate 'with Him'

³⁶If We give people a taste of mercy, they become prideful 'because' of it. But if they are afflicted with an evil for what their hands have done, they instantly fall into despair

³⁷Have they not seen that Allah gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills? Surely in this are signs for people who believe

³⁸So give your close relatives their due, as well as the poor and the 'needy' traveller. That is best for those who seek the pleasure of Allah, and it is they who will be successful

³⁹Whatever loans you give, 'only' seeking interest at the expense of people's wealth will not increase with Allah. But whatever charity you give, 'only' seeking the pleasure of Allah—it is they whose reward will be multiplied

⁴⁰It is Allah Who created you, then gives you provisions, then will cause you to die, and then will bring you back to life. Can any of your associate-gods do any of this? Glorified and Exalted is He above what they associate with Him 'in worship'

⁴¹Corruption has spread on land and sea as a result of what people's hands have done, so that Allah may cause them to taste 'the consequences of' some of their deeds and perhaps they might return 'to the Right Path'

⁴²Say, 'O Prophet,' "Travel throughout the land and see what was the end of those 'destroyed' before 'you'—most of them were polytheists."

⁴³So be steadfast in the Upright Faith 'O Prophet', before the coming of a Day from Allah that cannot be averted. On that Day the people will be divided

⁴⁴those who disbelieved will bear 'the burden of' their own disbelief; and those who did good will have prepared for themselves 'eternal homes'

⁴⁵so that He may 'generously' reward those who believe and do good, out of His grace. He truly does not like the disbelievers

⁴⁶And one of His signs is that He sends the winds, ushering in good news 'of rain' so that He may give you a taste of His mercy, and that ships may sail by His command, and that you may seek His bounty, and perhaps you will be grateful

⁴⁷Indeed, We sent before you 'O Prophet' messengers, each to their own people, and they came to them with clear proofs. Then We inflicted punishment upon those who persisted in wickedness. For it is Our duty to help the believers

⁴⁸It is Allah Who sends the winds, which then stir up 'vapour, forming' clouds, which He then spreads out in the sky or piles up into masses as He wills, from which you see rain come forth. Then as soon as He causes it to fall on whoever He wills of His servants, they rejoice

⁴⁹although they had utterly lost hope just before it was sent down to them

⁵⁰See then the impact of Allah's mercy: how He gives life to the earth after its death! Surely That 'same God' can raise the dead. For He is Most Capable of everything

⁵¹Then if We send a 'harsh' wind which they see withering 'their' crops, they will definitely deny 'old favours' right after

⁵²So you 'O Prophet' certainly cannot make the dead hear 'the truth'. Nor can you make the deaf hear the call when they turn their backs and walk away

⁵³Nor can you lead the blind out of their misguidance. You can make none hear 'the truth' except those who believe in Our revelations, 'fully' submitting 'to Allah'

⁵⁴It is Allah Who created you in a state of weakness, then developed 'your' weakness into strength, then developed 'your' strength into weakness and old age. He creates whatever He wills. For He is the All-Knowing, Most Capable

⁵⁵And on the Day the Hour will arrive, the wicked will swear that they did not stay 'in this world' more than an hour. In this way they were always deluded 'in the world'

⁵⁶But those gifted with knowledge and faith will say ‘to them’, “You did actually stay—as destined by Allah—until the Day of Resurrection. So here is the Day of Resurrection ‘which you denied’! But you did not know ‘it was true’.”

⁵⁷So on that Day the wrongdoers’ excuses will not benefit them, nor will they be allowed to appease ‘their Lord’

⁵⁸We have certainly set forth every ‘kind of’ lesson for people in this Quran. And no matter what sign you bring to them ‘O Prophet’, the disbelievers will definitely say ‘to the believers’, “You are only a people of falsehood.”

⁵⁹This is how Allah seals the hearts of those unwilling to know ‘the truth’

⁶⁰So be patient, for the promise of Allah certainly is true. And do not be disturbed by those who have no sure faith

Luqmān

Luqmān • 34 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²These are the verses of the Book, rich in wisdom

³‘It is’ a guide and mercy for the good-doers—

⁴those who establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and have sure faith
in the Hereafter

⁵It is they who are ‘truly’ guided by their Lord, and it is they
who will be successful

⁶But there are some who employ theatrics, only to lead others
away from Allah’s Way—without any knowledge—and to
make a mockery of it. They will suffer a humiliating punishment

⁷Whenever Our revelations are recited to them, they turn
away in arrogance as if they did not hear them, as if there
is deafness in their ears. So give them good news ‘O Prophet’
of a painful punishment

⁸ Surely those who believe and do good will have the Gardens of Bliss

⁹ staying there forever. Allah's promise is true. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

¹⁰ He created the heavens without pillars—as you can see—and placed firm mountains upon the earth so it does not shake with you, and scattered throughout it all types of creatures. And We send down rain from the sky, causing every type of fine plant to grow on earth

¹¹ This is Allah's creation. Now show Me what those 'gods' other than Him have created. In fact, the wrongdoers are clearly astray

¹² Indeed, We blessed Luqmân with wisdom, 'saying', "Be grateful to Allah, for whoever is grateful, it is only for their own good. And whoever is ungrateful, then surely Allah is Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy."

¹³ And 'remember' when Luqmân said to his son, while advising him, "O my dear son! Never associate 'anything' with Allah 'in worship', for associating 'others with Him' is truly the worst of all wrongs."

¹⁴And We have commanded people to ‘honour’ their parents. Their mothers bore them through hardship upon hardship, and their weaning takes two years. So be grateful to Me and your parents. To Me is the final return

¹⁵But if they pressure you to associate with Me what you have no knowledge of, do not obey them. Still keep their company in this world courteously, and follow the way of those who turn to Me ‘in devotion’. Then to Me you will ‘all’ return, and then I will inform you of what you used to do

¹⁶Luqmân added, ‘O my dear son! ‘Even’ if a deed were the weight of a mustard seed—be it ‘hidden’ in a rock or in the heavens or the earth—Allah will bring it forth. Surely Allah is Most Subtle, All-Aware

¹⁷“O my dear son! Establish prayer, encourage what is good and forbid what is evil, and endure patiently whatever befalls you. Surely this is a resolve to aspire to

¹⁸“And do not turn your nose up to people, nor walk pridefully upon the earth. Surely Allah does not like whoever is arrogant, boastful

¹⁹Be moderate in your pace. And lower your voice, for the ugliest of all voices is certainly the braying of donkeys.”

²⁰Have you not seen that Allah has subjected for you whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth, and has lavished His favours upon you, both seen and unseen? 'Still' there are some who dispute about Allah without knowledge, or guidance, or an enlightening scripture

²¹When it is said to them, "Follow what Allah has revealed," they reply, "No! We 'only' follow what we found our forefathers practicing." 'Would they still do so' even if Satan is inviting them to the torment of the Blaze

²²Whoever fully submits themselves to Allah and is a good-doer, they have certainly grasped the firmest hand-hold. And with Allah rests the outcome of 'all' affairs

²³But whoever disbelieves, do not let their disbelief grieve you 'O Prophet'. To Us is their return, and We will inform them of all they did. Surely Allah knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

²⁴We allow them enjoyment for a little while, then 'in time' We will force them into a harsh torment

²⁵And if you ask them who created the heavens and the earth, they will definitely say, "Allah!" Say, "Praise be to Allah!" In fact, most of them do not know

²⁶To Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. Allah is truly the Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

²⁷If all the trees on earth were pens and the ocean 'were ink', refilled by seven other oceans, the Words of Allah would not be exhausted. Surely Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

²⁸The creation and resurrection of you 'all' is as simple 'for Him' as that of a single soul. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing

²⁹Do you not see that Allah causes the night to merge into the day and the day into the night, and has subjected the sun and the moon, each orbiting for an appointed term, and that Allah is All-Aware of what you do

³⁰That is because Allah 'alone' is the Truth and what they invoke besides Him is falsehood, and 'because' Allah 'alone' is the Most High, All-Great

³¹Do you not see that the ships sail 'smoothly' through the sea by the grace of Allah so that He may show you some of His signs? Surely in this are signs for whoever is steadfast, grateful

³²And as soon as they are overwhelmed by waves like mountains, they cry out to Allah 'alone' in sincere devotion. But

when He delivers them 'safely' to shore, only some become relatively grateful. And none rejects Our signs except whoever is deceitful, ungrateful

33 O humanity! Be mindful of your Lord, and beware of a Day when no parent will be of any benefit to their child, nor will a child be of any benefit to their parent. Surely Allah's promise is true. So do not let the life of this world deceive you, nor let the Chief Deceiver deceive you about Allah

34 Indeed, Allah 'alone' has the knowledge of the Hour. He sends down the rain, and knows what is in the wombs. No soul knows what it will earn for tomorrow, and no soul knows in what land it will die. Surely Allah is All-Knowing, All-Aware

As-Sajdah

The Prostration • 30 verses

¹Alif-Lām-Mīm

²The revelation of this Book is—beyond doubt—from the Lord of all worlds

³Or do they say, “He has fabricated it!”? No! It is the truth from your Lord in order for you to warn a people to whom no warner has come before you, so they may be ‘rightly’ guided

⁴It is Allah Who has created the heavens and the earth and everything in between in six Days, then established Himself on the Throne. You have no protector or intercessor besides Him. Will you not then be mindful

⁵He conducts every affair from the heavens to the earth, then it all ascends to Him on a Day whose length is a thousand years by your counting

⁶That is the Knower of the seen and unseen—the Almighty, Most Merciful

⁷Who has perfected everything He created. And He originated the creation of humankind from clay

⁸Then He made his descendants from an extract of a humble fluid

⁹then He fashioned them and had a spirit of His Own 'creation' breathed into them. And He gave you hearing, sight, and intellect. 'Yet' you hardly give any thanks

¹⁰'Still' they ask 'mockingly', "When we are disintegrated into the earth, will we really be raised as a new creation?" In fact, they are in denial of the meeting with their Lord

¹¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Your soul will be taken by the Angel of Death, who is in charge of you. Then to your Lord you will 'all' be returned."

¹²If only you could see the wicked hanging their heads 'in shame' before their Lord, 'crying:' "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back and we will do good. We truly have sure faith 'now'!"

¹³Had We willed, We could have easily imposed guidance on every soul. But My Word will come to pass: I will surely fill up Hell with jinn and humans all together

¹⁴So taste 'the punishment' for neglecting the meeting of this Day of yours. We 'too' will certainly neglect you. And taste the torment of eternity for what you used to do

¹⁵The only 'true' believers in Our revelation are those who—when it is recited to them—fall into prostration and glorify the praises of their Lord and are not too proud

¹⁶They abandon their beds, invoking their Lord with hope and fear, and donate from what We have provided for them

¹⁷No soul can imagine what delights are kept in store for them as a reward for what they used to do

¹⁸Is the one who is a believer equal 'before Allah' to the one who is rebellious? They are not equal

¹⁹As for those who believe and do good, they will have the Gardens of 'Eternal' Residence—as an accommodation for what they used to do

²⁰But as for those who are rebellious, the Fire will be their home. Whenever they try to escape from it, they will be forced back into it, and will be told, "Taste the Fire's torment, which you used to deny."

²¹We will certainly make them taste some of the minor torment 'in this life' before the major torment 'of the Hereafter', so perhaps they will return 'to the Right Path'

²²And who does more wrong than the one who is reminded of Allah's revelations then turns away from them? We will surely inflict punishment upon the wicked

²³Indeed, We gave the Scripture to Moses—so let there be no doubt 'O Prophet' that you 'too' are receiving revelations—and We made it a guide for the Children of Israel

²⁴We raised from among them leaders, guiding by Our command, when they patiently endured and firmly believed in Our signs

²⁵Indeed, your Lord will decide between them on the Day of Judgment regarding their differences

²⁶Is it not yet clear to them how many peoples We destroyed before them, whose ruins they still pass by? Surely in this are signs. Will they not then listen

²⁷Do they not see how We drive rain to parched land, producing 'various' crops from which they and their cattle eat? Will they not then see

²⁸They ask 'mockingly', "When is this 'Day of final' Decision, if what you say is true?"

²⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "On the Day of Decision it will not benefit the disbelievers to believe then, nor will they be delayed 'from punishment'."

³⁰So turn away from them, and wait! They too are waiting

Al-Aḥzāb

The Combined Forces • 73 verses

¹O Prophet! 'Always' be mindful of Allah, and do not yield to the disbelievers and the hypocrites. Indeed, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

²Follow what is revealed to you from your Lord. Surely Allah is All-Aware of what you 'all' do

³And put your trust in Allah, for Allah is sufficient as a Trustee of Affairs

⁴Allah does not place two hearts in any person's chest. Nor does He regard your wives as 'unlawful for you like' your real mothers, 'even' if you say they are. Nor does He regard your adopted children as your real children. These are only your baseless assertions. But Allah declares the truth, and He 'alone' guides to the 'Right' Way

⁵Let your adopted children keep their family names. That is more just in the sight of Allah. But if you do not know their fa-

thers, then they are 'simply' your fellow believers and close associates. There is no blame on you for what you do by mistake, but 'only' for what you do intentionally. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶The Prophet has a stronger affinity to the believers than they do themselves. And his wives are their mothers. As ordained by Allah, blood relatives are more entitled 'to inheritance' than 'other' believers and immigrants, unless you 'want to' show kindness to your 'close' associates 'through bequest'. This is decreed in the Record

⁷And 'remember' when We took a covenant from the prophets, as well as from you 'O Prophet', and from Noah, Abraham, Moses, and Jesus, son of Mary. We did take a solemn covenant from 'all of' them

⁸so that He may question these men of truth about their 'delivery of the' truth. And He has prepared a painful punishment for the disbelievers

⁹O believers! Remember Allah's favour upon you when 'enemy' forces came to 'besiege' you 'in Medina', so We sent against them a 'bitter' wind and forces you could not see. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

¹⁰Remember when they came at you from east and west, when your eyes grew wild in horror and your hearts jumped into your throats, and you entertained conflicting thoughts about Allah

¹¹Then and there the believers were put to the test, and were violently shaken

¹²And remember when the hypocrites and those with sickness in their hearts said, "Allah and His Messenger have promised us nothing but delusion!"

¹³And remember when a group of them said, "O people of Yathrib! There is no point in you staying here, so retreat!" Another group of them asked the Prophet's permission to leave, saying, "Our homes are vulnerable," while in fact they were not vulnerable. They only wished to flee

¹⁴Had their city been sacked from all sides and they had been asked to abandon faith, they would have done so with little hesitation

¹⁵They had already pledged to Allah earlier never to turn their backs in retreat. And a pledge to Allah must be answered for

¹⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "Fleeing will not benefit you if you 'try to' escape a natural or violent death. 'If it is not your time,' you will only be allowed enjoyment for a little while."

¹⁷Ask 'them, O Prophet,' "Who can put you out of Allah's reach if He intends to harm you or show you mercy?" They can never find any protector or helper besides Allah

¹⁸Allah knows well those among you who discourage 'others from fighting', saying 'secretly' to their brothers, "Stay with us," and who themselves hardly take part in fighting

¹⁹"They are' totally unwilling to assist you. When danger comes, you see them staring at you with their eyes rolling like someone in the throes of death. But once the danger is over, they slash you with razor-sharp tongues, ravenous for 'worldly' gains. Such people have not 'truly' believed, so Allah has rendered their deeds void. And that is easy for Allah

²⁰They 'still' think that the enemy alliance has not 'yet' withdrawn. And if the allies were to come 'again', the hypocrites would wish to be away in the desert among nomadic Arabs, 'only' asking for news about you 'believers'. And if the hypocrites were in your midst, they would hardly take part in the fight

²¹Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day, and remembers Allah often

²²When the believers saw the enemy alliance, they said, “This is what Allah and His Messenger had promised us. The promise of Allah and His Messenger has come true.” And this only increased them in faith and submission

²³Among the believers are men who have proven true to what they pledged to Allah. Some of them have fulfilled their pledge ‘with their lives’, others are waiting ‘their turn’. They have never changed ‘their commitment’ in the least

²⁴‘It all happened’ so Allah may reward the faithful for their faithfulness, and punish the hypocrites if He wills or turn to them ‘in mercy’. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²⁵And Allah drove back the disbelievers in their rage, totally empty-handed. And Allah spared the believers from fighting. For Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty

²⁶And He brought down those from the People of the Book who supported the enemy alliance from their own strongholds, and cast horror into their hearts. You ‘believers’ killed some, and took others captive

²⁷He has also caused you to take over their lands, homes, and wealth, as well as lands you have not yet set foot on. And Allah is Most Capable of everything

²⁸O Prophet! Say to your wives, "If you desire the life of this world and its luxury, then come, I will give you a 'suitable' compensation 'for divorce' and let you go graciously

²⁹But if you desire Allah and His Messenger and the 'everlasting' Home of the Hereafter, then Surely Allah has prepared a great reward for those of you who do good."

³⁰O wives of the Prophet! If any of you were to commit a blatant misconduct, the punishment would be doubled for her. And that is easy for Allah

³¹And whoever of you devoutly obeys Allah and His Messenger and does good, We will grant her double the reward, and We have prepared for her an honourable provision

³²O wives of the Prophet! You are not like any other women: if you are mindful 'of Allah', then do not be overly effeminate in speech 'with men' or those with sickness in their hearts may be tempted, but speak in a moderate tone

³³Settle in your homes, and do not display yourselves as women did in the days of 'pre-Islamic' ignorance. Establish prayer,

pay alms-tax, and obey Allah and His Messenger. Allah only intends to keep 'the causes of' evil away from you and purify you completely, O members of the 'Prophet's' family

³⁴'Always' remember what is recited in your homes of Allah's revelations and 'prophetic' wisdom. Surely Allah is Most Subtle, All-Aware

³⁵Surely 'for' Muslim men and women, believing men and women, devout men and women, truthful men and women, patient men and women, humble men and women, charitable men and women, fasting men and women, men and women who guard their chastity, and men and women who remember Allah often—for 'all of' them Allah has prepared forgiveness and a great reward

³⁶It is not for a believing man or woman—when Allah and His Messenger decree a matter—to have any other choice in that matter. Indeed, whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger has clearly gone 'far' astray

³⁷And 'remember, O Prophet,' when you said to the one for whom Allah has done a favour and you 'too' have done a favour, "Keep your wife and fear Allah," while concealing within yourself what Allah was going to reveal. And 'so' you were considering the people, whereas Allah was more wor-

thy of your consideration. So when Zaid totally lost interest in 'keeping' his wife, We gave her to you in marriage, so that there would be no blame on the believers for marrying the ex-wives of their adopted sons after their divorce. And Allah's command is totally binding

³⁸There is no blame on the Prophet for doing what Allah has ordained for him. That has been the way of Allah with those 'prophets' who had gone before. And Allah's command has been firmly decreed

³⁹That is His way with 'those 'prophets' who deliver the messages of Allah, and consider Him, and none but Allah. And sufficient is Allah as a 'vigilant' Reckoner

⁴⁰Muḥammad is not the father of any of your men, but is the Messenger of Allah and the seal of the prophets. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

⁴¹O believers! Always remember Allah often

⁴²and glorify Him morning and evening

⁴³He is the One Who showers His blessings upon you—and His angels pray for you—so that He may bring you out of darkness and into light. For He is ever Merciful to the believers

⁴⁴Their greeting on the Day they meet Him will be, "Peace!"
And He has prepared for them an honourable reward

⁴⁵O Prophet! We have sent you as a witness, and a deliverer
of good news, and a warner

⁴⁶and a caller to 'the Way of' Allah by His command, and a
beacon of light

⁴⁷Give good news to the believers that they will have a great
bounty from Allah

⁴⁸Do not yield to the disbelievers and the hypocrites. Over-
look their annoyances, and put your trust in Allah. For Allah
is sufficient as a Trustee of Affairs

⁴⁹O believers! If you marry believing women and then di-
vorce them before you touch them, they will have no waiting
period for you to count, so give them a 'suitable' compensa-
tion, and let them go graciously

⁵⁰O Prophet! We have made lawful for you your wives to
whom you have paid their 'full' dowries as well as those 'bond-
women' in your possession, whom Allah has granted you.
And 'you are allowed to marry' the daughters of your pater-
nal uncles and aunts, and the daughters of your maternal un-
cles and aunts, who have emigrated like you. Also 'allowed

for marriage is' a believing woman who offers herself to the Prophet 'without dowry' if he is interested in marrying her—'this is' exclusively for you, not for the rest of the believers. We know well what 'rulings' We have ordained for the believers in relation to their wives and those 'bondwomen' in their possession. As such, there would be no blame on you. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁵¹It is up to you 'O Prophet' to delay or receive whoever you please of your wives. There is no blame on you if you call back any of those you have set aside. That is more likely that they will be content, not grieved, and satisfied with what you offer them all. Allah 'fully' knows what is in your hearts. And Allah is All-Knowing, Most Forbearing

⁵²It is not lawful for you 'O Prophet' to marry more women after this, nor can you replace any of your present wives with another, even if her beauty may attract you—except those 'bondwomen' in your possession. And Allah is ever Watchful over all things

⁵³O believers! Do not enter the homes of the Prophet without permission 'and if invited' for a meal, do not 'come too early and' linger until the meal is ready. But if you are invited, then enter 'on time'. Once you have eaten, then go on your

way, and do not stay for casual talk. Such behaviour is truly annoying to the Prophet, yet he is too shy to ask you to leave. But Allah is never shy of the truth. And when you 'believers' ask his wives for something, ask them from behind a barrier. This is purer for your hearts and theirs. And it is not right for you to annoy the Messenger of Allah, nor ever marry his wives after him. This would certainly be a major offence in the sight of Allah

⁵⁴Whether you reveal something or conceal it, surely Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

⁵⁵There is no blame on the Prophet's wives 'if they appear unveiled' before their fathers, their sons, their brothers, their brothers' sons, their sisters' sons, their fellow 'Muslim' women, and those 'bondspeople' in their possession. And be mindful of Allah 'O wives of the Prophet!' Surely Allah is a Witness over all things

⁵⁶Indeed, Allah showers His blessings upon the Prophet, and His angels pray for him. O believers! Invoke Allah's blessings upon him, and salute him with worthy greetings of peace

⁵⁷Surely those who offend Allah and His Messenger are condemned by Allah in this world and the Hereafter. And He has prepared for them a humiliating punishment

⁵⁸As for those who abuse believing men and women unjustifiably, they will definitely bear the guilt of slander and blatant sin

⁵⁹O Prophet! Ask your wives, daughters, and believing women to draw their cloaks over their bodies. In this way it is more likely that they will be recognized 'as virtuous' and not be harassed. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶⁰If the hypocrites, and those with sickness in their hearts, and rumour-mongers in Medina do not desist, We will certainly incite you 'O Prophet' against them, and then they will not be your neighbours there any longer

⁶¹'They deserve to be' condemned. 'If they were to persist,' they would get themselves seized and killed relentlessly wherever they are found

⁶²That was Allah's way with those 'hypocrites' who have gone before. And you will find no change in Allah's way

⁶³People ask you 'O Prophet' about the Hour. Say, "That knowledge is only with Allah. You never know, perhaps the Hour is near."

⁶⁴Surely Allah condemns the disbelievers, and has prepared for them a blazing Fire

⁶⁵to stay there for ever and ever—never will they find any protector or helper

⁶⁶On the Day their faces are ‘constantly’ flipped in the Fire, they will cry, “Oh! If only we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger!”

⁶⁷And they will say, “Our Lord! We obeyed our leaders and elite, but they led us astray from the ‘Right’ Way

⁶⁸Our Lord! Give them double ‘our’ punishment, and condemn them tremendously.”

⁶⁹O believers! Do not be like those who slandered Moses, but Allah cleared him of what they said. And he was honourable in the sight of Allah

⁷⁰O believers! Be mindful of Allah, and say what is right

⁷¹He will bless your deeds for you, and forgive your sins. And whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, has truly achieved a great triumph

⁷²Indeed, We offered the trust to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, but they ‘all’ declined to bear it, being fearful of it. But humanity assumed it, ‘for’ they are truly wrongful ‘to themselves’ and ignorant ‘of the consequences’

⁷³so that Allah will punish hypocrite men and women and polytheistic men and women, and Allah will turn in mercy to believing men and women. For Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

Saba'

Sheba • 54 verses

¹All praise is for Allah, to Whom belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And praise be to Him in the Hereafter. He is the All-Wise, All-Aware

²He knows whatever goes into the earth and whatever comes out of it, and whatever descends from the sky and whatever ascends into it. And He is the Most Merciful, All-Forgiving

³The disbelievers say, “The Hour will never come to us.” Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Yes—by my Lord, the Knower of the unseen—it will certainly come to you!” Not ‘even’ an atom’s weight is hidden from Him in the heavens or the earth; nor anything smaller or larger than that, but is ‘written’ in a perfect Record

⁴So He may reward those who believe and do good. It is they who will have forgiveness and an honourable provision

⁵As for those who strive to discredit Our revelations, it is they who will suffer the ‘worst’ torment of agonizing pain

⁶Those gifted with knowledge 'clearly' see that what has been revealed to you from your Lord 'O Prophet' is the truth, and that it guides to the Path of the Almighty, the Praiseworthy

⁷The disbelievers say 'mockingly to one another', "Shall we show you a man who claims that when you have been utterly disintegrated you will be raised as a new creation

⁸Has he fabricated a lie against Allah or is he insane?" In fact, those who do not believe in the Hereafter are bound for torment and have strayed farthest 'from the truth'

⁹Have they not then seen all that surrounds them of the heavens and the earth? If We willed, We could cause the earth to swallow them up, or cause 'deadly' pieces of the sky to fall upon them. Surely in this is a sign for every servant who turns 'to Allah'

¹⁰Indeed, We granted David a 'great' privilege from Us, 'commanding: "O mountains! Echo his hymns! And the birds as well." We made iron mouldable for him

¹¹instructing: "Make full-length armour, 'perfectly' balancing the links. And work righteousness 'O family of David!'. Indeed, I am All-Seeing of what you do."

¹²And to Solomon 'We subjected' the wind: its morning stride was a month's journey and so was its evening stride. And We caused a stream of molten copper to flow for him, and 'We subjected' some of the jinn to work under him by his Lord's Will. And whoever of them deviated from Our command, We made them taste the torment of the blaze

¹³They made for him whatever he desired of sanctuaries, statues, basins as large as reservoirs, and cooking pots fixed 'into the ground'. 'We ordered:' "Work gratefully, O family of David!" 'Only' a few of My servants are 'truly' grateful

¹⁴When We decreed Solomon's death, nothing indicated to the 'subjected' jinn that he was dead except the termites eating away his staff. So when he collapsed, the jinn realized that if they had 'really' known the unseen, they would not have remained in 'such' humiliating servitude

¹⁵Indeed, there was a sign for 'the tribe of' Sheba in their homeland: two orchards—one to the right and the other to the left. 'They were told:' "Eat from the provision of your Lord, and be grateful to Him. 'Yours is' a good land and a forgiving Lord."

¹⁶But they turned away. So We sent against them a devastating flood, and replaced their orchards with two others pro-

ducing bitter fruit, fruitless bushes, and a few 'sparse' thorny trees

¹⁷This is how We rewarded them for their ingratitude. Would We ever punish 'anyone in such a way' except the ungrateful

¹⁸We had also placed between them and the cities We showered with blessings 'many small' towns within sight of one another. And We set moderate travel distances in between, 'saying,' "Travel between them by day and night safely."

¹⁹But they said, "Our Lord! Make 'the distances of' our journeys longer," wronging themselves. So We reduced them to 'cautionary' tales, and scattered them utterly. Surely in this are lessons for whoever is steadfast, grateful

²⁰Indeed, Iblîs' assumption about them has come true, so they 'all' follow him, except a group of 'true' believers

²¹He does not have any authority over them, but 'Our Will is' only to distinguish those who believe in the Hereafter from those who are in doubt about it. And your Lord is a 'vigilant' Keeper over all things."

²²Say, 'O Prophet,' "Call upon those you claim 'to be divine' besides Allah. They do not possess 'even' an atom's weight

either in the heavens or the earth, nor do they have any share in 'governing' them. Nor is any of them a helper to Him."

²³No intercession will be of any benefit with Him, except by those granted permission by Him. 'At last,' when the dread 'of Judgment Day' is relieved from their hearts 'because they are permitted to intercede', they will 'excitedly' ask 'the angels', "What has your Lord 'just' said?" The angels will reply, "The truth! And He is the Most High, All-Great."

²⁴Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Who provides for you from the heavens and the earth?" Say, "Allah! Now, certainly one of our two groups is 'rightly' guided; the other is clearly astray."

²⁵Say, "You will not be accountable for our misdeeds, nor will we be accountable for your deeds."

²⁶Say, "Our Lord will gather us together; then He will judge between us with the truth. For He is the All-Knowing Judge."

²⁷Say, "Show me those 'idols' you have joined with Him as partners. No! In fact, He 'alone' is Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise."

²⁸We have sent you 'O Prophet' only as a deliverer of good news and a warner to all of humanity, but most people do not know

²⁹And they ask 'the believers', "When will this threat come to pass, if what you say is true?"

³⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "A Day has 'already' been appointed for you, which you can neither delay nor advance by a 'single' moment."

³¹The disbelievers vow, "We will never believe in this Quran, nor in those 'Scriptures' before it." If only you could see when the wrongdoers will be detained before their Lord, throwing blame at each other! The lowly 'followers' will say to the arrogant 'leaders', "Had it not been for you, we would certainly have been believers."

³²The arrogant will respond to the lowly, "Did we ever hinder you from guidance after it came to you? In fact, you were wicked 'on your own'."

³³The lowly will say to the arrogant, "No! It was your plotting by day and night—when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and to set up equals with Him." They will 'all' hide 'their' remorse when they see the torment. And We will put shackles around the necks of the disbelievers. Will they be rewarded except for what they used to do

³⁴Whenever We sent a warner to a society, its elite would say, "We truly reject what you have been sent with."

³⁵Adding, "We are far superior 'to the believers' in wealth and children, and we will never be punished."

³⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "Surely 'it is' my Lord 'Who' gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills. But most people do not know."

³⁷It is not your wealth or children that bring you closer to Us. But those who believe and do good—it is they who will have a multiplied reward for what they did, and they will be secure in 'elevated' mansions

³⁸As for those who strive to discredit Our revelations, it is they who will be confined in punishment

³⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "Surely 'it is' my Lord 'Who' gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills of His servants. And whatever you spend in charity, He will compensate 'you' for it. For He is the Best Provider."

⁴⁰And 'consider' the Day He will gather them all together, and then ask the angels, "Was it you that these 'polytheists' used to worship?"

⁴¹They will say, "Glory be to You! Our loyalty is to You, not them. In fact, they 'only' followed the 'temptations of evil' jinn, in whom most of them had faith."

⁴²So Today neither of you can benefit or protect each other. And We will say to the wrongdoers, “Taste the torment of the Fire, which you used to deny.”

⁴³When Our clear revelations are recited to them, they say, “This is only a man who wishes to hinder you from what your forefathers used to worship.” They also say, “This ‘Quran’ is no more than a fabricated lie.” And the disbelievers say of the truth when it has come to them, “This is nothing but pure magic.”

⁴⁴“They say so even though We had never given them any scriptures to study, nor did We ever send them a warner before you ‘O Prophet’

⁴⁵Those ‘destroyed’ before them denied as well—and these ‘Meccans’ have not attained even one-tenth of what We had given their predecessors. Yet ‘when’ they denied My messengers, how severe was My response

⁴⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I advise you to do ‘only’ one thing: stand up for ‘the sake of’ Allah—individually or in pairs—then reflect. Your fellow man is not insane. He is only a warner to you before ‘the coming of’ a severe punishment.”

⁴⁷Say, "If I had ever asked you for a reward, you could keep it. My reward is only from Allah. And He is a Witness over all things."

⁴⁸Say, "Surely my Lord hurls the truth 'against falsehood'. 'He is' the Knower of all unseen."

⁴⁹Say, "The truth has come, and falsehood will vanish, never to return."

⁵⁰Say, "If I am astray, the loss is only mine. And if I am guided, it is 'only' because of what my Lord reveals to me. He is indeed All-Hearing, Ever Near."

⁵¹If only you could see when they will be horrified with no escape 'on Judgment Day'! And they will be seized from a nearby place

⁵²They will 'then' cry, "We do 'now' believe in it 'all'." But how could they 'possibly' attain faith from a place so far-off 'from the world'

⁵³while they had already rejected it before, guessing blindly from a place 'equally' far-away 'from the Hereafter'

⁵⁴They will be sealed off from whatever they desire, as was done to their counterparts before. Indeed, they were 'all' in alarming doubt

Fāṭir

The Originator • 45 verses

¹All praise is for Allah, the Originator of the heavens and the earth, Who made angels 'as His' messengers with wings—two, three, or four. He increases in creation whatever He wills. Surely Allah is Most Capable of everything

²Whatever mercy Allah opens up for people, none can withhold it. And whatever He withholds, none but Him can release it. For He is the Almighty, All-Wise

³O humanity! Remember Allah's favours upon you. Is there any creator other than Allah who provides for you from the heavens and the earth? There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. How can you then be deluded 'from the truth'

⁴If you are rejected by them, so too were messengers before you. And to Allah 'all' matters will be returned 'for judgment'

⁵O humanity! Indeed, Allah's promise is true. So do not let the life of this world deceive you, nor let the Chief Deceiver deceive you about Allah

⁶Surely Satan is an enemy to you, so take him as an enemy. He only invites his followers to become inmates of the Blaze

⁷Those who disbelieve will have a severe punishment. But those who believe and do good will have forgiveness and a great reward

⁸Are those whose evil-doing is made so appealing to them that they deem it good 'like those who are rightly guided'? 'It is' certainly Allah 'Who' leaves to stray whoever He wills, and guides whoever He wills. So do not grieve yourself to death over them 'O Prophet'. Surely Allah is All-Knowing of what they do

⁹And it is Allah Who sends the winds, which then stir up 'vapour, forming' clouds, and then We drive them to a lifeless land, giving life to the earth after its death. Similar is the Resurrection

¹⁰Whoever seeks honour and power, then 'let them know that' all honour and power belongs to Allah. To Him 'alone' good words ascend, and righteous deeds are raised up by

Him. As for those who plot evil, they will suffer a severe punishment. And the plotting of such 'people' is doomed 'to fail'

¹¹And 'it is' Allah 'Who' created you from dust, then 'developed you' from a sperm-drop, then made you into pairs. No female ever conceives or delivers without His knowledge. And no one's life is made long or cut short but is 'written' in a Record. That is certainly easy for Allah

¹²The two bodies of water are not alike: one is fresh, palatable, and pleasant to drink and the other is salty and bitter. Yet from them both you eat tender seafood and extract ornaments to wear. And you see the ships ploughing their way through both, so you may seek His bounty and give thanks 'to Him'

¹³He merges the night into the day and the day into the night, and has subjected the sun and the moon, each orbiting for an appointed term. That is Allah—your Lord! All authority belongs to Him. But those 'idols' you invoke besides Him do not possess even the skin of a date stone

¹⁴If you call upon them, they cannot hear your calls. And if they were to hear, they could not respond to you. On the Day of Judgment they will disown your worship 'of them'. And no one can inform you 'O Prophet' like the All-Knowledgeable

¹⁵O humanity! It is you who stand in need of Allah, but Allah 'alone' is the Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

¹⁶If He willed, He could eliminate you and produce a new creation

¹⁷And that is not difficult for Allah 'at all'

¹⁸No soul burdened with sin will bear the burden of another. And if a sin-burdened soul cries for help with its burden, none of it will be carried—even by a close relative. You 'O Prophet' can only warn those who stand in awe of their Lord without seeing Him and establish prayer. Whoever purifies themselves, they only do so for their own good. And to Allah is the final return

¹⁹Those blind 'to the truth' and those who can see are not equal

²⁰nor are the darkness and the light

²¹nor the 'scorching' heat and the 'cool' shade

²²Nor are the dead and the living equal. Indeed, Allah 'alone' makes whoever He wills hear, but you 'O Prophet' can never make those in the graves hear 'your call'

²³You are only a warner

²⁴We have surely sent you with the truth as a deliverer of good news and a warner. There is no community that has not had a warner

²⁵If they deny you, so did those before them. Their messengers came to them with clear proofs, divine Books, and enlightening Scriptures

²⁶Then I seized those who persisted in disbelief. How severe was My response

²⁷Do you not see that Allah sends down rain from the sky with which We bring forth fruits of different colours? And in the mountains are streaks of varying shades of white, red, and raven black

²⁸just as people, living beings, and cattle are of various colours as well. Of all of Allah's servants, only the knowledgeable 'of His might' are 'truly' in awe of Him. Allah is indeed Almighty, All-Forgiving

²⁹Surely those who recite the Book of Allah, establish prayer, and donate from what We have provided for them—secretly and openly—'can' hope for an exchange that will never fail

³⁰so that He will reward them in full and increase them out of His grace. He is truly All-Forgiving, Most Appreciative

³¹The Book We have revealed to you ‘O Prophet’ is the truth, confirming what came before it. Surely Allah is All-Aware, All-Seeing of His servants

³²Then We granted the Book to those We have chosen from Our servants. Some of them wrong themselves, some follow a middle course, and some are foremost in good deeds by Allah’s Will. That is ‘truly’ the greatest bounty

³³They will enter the Gardens of Eternity, where they will be adorned with bracelets of gold and pearls, and their clothing will be silk

³⁴And they will say, “Praise be to Allah, Who has kept away from us all ‘causes of’ sorrow. Our Lord is indeed All-Forgiving, Most Appreciative

³⁵‘He is the One’ Who—out of His grace—has settled us in the Home of Everlasting Stay, where we will be touched by neither fatigue nor weariness.”

³⁶As for the disbelievers, they will have the Fire of Hell, where they will not be ‘allowed to be’ finished by death, nor will its torment be lightened for them. This is how We reward every ‘stubborn’ disbeliever

³⁷There they will be 'fervently' screaming, "Our Lord! Take us out 'and send us back'. We will do good, unlike what we used to do." 'They will be told,' "Did We not give you lives long enough so that whoever wanted to be mindful could have done so? And the warner came to you. So taste 'the punishment', for the wrongdoers have no helper."

³⁸Indeed, Allah is the Knower of the unseen of the heavens and the earth. He surely knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

³⁹He is the One Who has placed you as successors on earth. So whoever disbelieves will bear 'the burden of' their own disbelief. The disbelievers' denial only increases them in contempt in the sight of their Lord, and it will only contribute to their loss

⁴⁰Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Have you considered your associate-gods which you invoke besides Allah? Show me what they have created on earth! Or do they have a share in 'the creation of' the heavens? Or have We given the polytheists a Book, which serves as a clear proof for them? In fact, the wrongdoers promise each other nothing but delusion."

⁴¹Indeed, Allah 'alone' keeps the heavens and the earth from falling apart. If they were to fall apart, none but Him could hold them up. He is truly Most Forbearing, All-Forgiving

⁴²They swore by Allah their most solemn oaths that if a warner were to come to them, they would certainly be better guided than any other community. Yet when a warner did come to them, it only drove them farther away—

⁴³behaving arrogantly in the land and plotting evil. But evil plotting only backfires on those who plot. Are they awaiting anything but the fate of those 'destroyed' before? You will find no change in the way of Allah, nor will you find it diverted 'to someone else'

⁴⁴Have they not travelled throughout the land to see what was the end of those 'destroyed' before them? They were far superior in might. But there is nothing that can escape Allah in the heavens or the earth. He is certainly All-Knowing, Most Capable

⁴⁵If Allah were to punish people 'immediately' for what they have committed, He would not have left a single living being on earth. But He delays them for an appointed term. And when their time arrives, then surely Allah is All-Seeing of His servants

Yā Sīn

Yā Sīn • 83 verses

¹Yâ-Sīn

²By the Quran, rich in wisdom

³You 'O Prophet' are truly one of the messengers

⁴upon the Straight Path

⁵'This is' a revelation from the Almighty, Most Merciful

⁶so that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, and so are heedless

⁷The decree 'of torment' has already been justified against most of them, for they will never believe

⁸'It is as if' We have put shackles around their necks up to their chins, so their heads are forced up

⁹and have placed a barrier before them and a barrier behind them and covered them 'all' up, so they fail to see 'the truth'

¹⁰It is the same whether you warn them or not—they will never believe

¹¹You can only warn those who follow the Reminder and are in awe of the Most Compassionate without seeing Him. So give them good news of forgiveness and an honourable reward

¹²It is certainly We Who resurrect the dead, and write what they send forth and what they leave behind. Everything is listed by Us in a perfect Record

¹³Give them an example 'O Prophet' of the residents of a town, when the messengers came to them

¹⁴We sent them two messengers, but they rejected both. So We reinforced 'the two' with a third, and they declared, "We have indeed been sent to you 'as messengers'."

¹⁵The people replied, "You are only humans like us, and the Most Compassionate has not revealed anything. You are simply lying!"

¹⁶The messengers responded, "Our Lord knows that we have truly been sent to you

¹⁷And our duty is only to deliver 'the message' clearly."

¹⁸The people replied, "We definitely see you as a bad omen for us. If you do not desist, we will certainly stone you 'to

death¹ and you will be touched with a painful punishment from us.”

¹⁹The messengers said, “Your bad omen lies within yourselves. Are you saying this because you are reminded ¹of the truth²? In fact, you are a transgressing people.”

²⁰Then from the farthest end of the city a man came, rushing. He advised, “O my people! Follow the messengers

²¹Follow those who ask no reward of you, and are ¹‘rightly’ guided

²²And why should I not worship the One Who has originated me, and to Whom you will be returned

²³How could I take besides Him other gods whose intercession would not be of any benefit to me, nor could they save me if the Most Compassionate intended to harm me

²⁴Indeed, I would then be clearly astray

²⁵I do believe in your Lord, so listen to me.”

²⁶¹But they killed him, then² he was told ¹‘by the angels’, “Enter Paradise!” He said, “If only my people knew

²⁷of how my Lord has forgiven me, and made me one of the honourable.”

²⁸We did not send any soldiers from the heavens against his people after his death, nor did We need to

²⁹All it took was one ‘mighty’ blast, and they were extinguished at once

³⁰Oh pity, such beings! No messenger ever came to them without being mocked

³¹Have the deniers not considered how many peoples We destroyed before them who never came back to life again

³²Yet they will all be brought before Us

³³There is a sign for them in the dead earth: We give it life, producing grain from it for them to eat

³⁴And We have placed in it gardens of palm trees and grapevines, and caused springs to gush forth in it

³⁵so that they may eat from its fruit, which they had no hand in making. Will they not then give thanks

³⁶Glory be to the One Who created all ‘things in’ pairs—‘be it’ what the earth produces, their genders, or what they do not know

³⁷There is also a sign for them in the night: We strip from it daylight, then—behold!—they are in darkness

³⁸The sun travels for its fixed term. That is the design of the Almighty, All-Knowing

³⁹As for the moon, We have ordained 'precise' phases for it, until it ends up like an old, curved palm stalk

⁴⁰It is not for the sun to catch up with the moon, nor does the night outrun the day. Each is travelling in an orbit of their own

⁴¹Another sign for them is that We carried their ancestors 'with Noah' in the fully loaded Ark

⁴²and created for them similar things to ride in

⁴³If We willed, We could drown them: then no one would respond to their cries, nor would they be rescued—

⁴⁴except by mercy from Us, allowing them enjoyment for a 'little' while

⁴⁵'Still they turn away' when it is said to them, "Beware of what is ahead of you 'in the Hereafter' and what is behind you 'of destroyed nations' so you may be shown mercy."

⁴⁶Whenever a sign comes to them from their Lord, they turn away from it

⁴⁷And when it is said to them, "Donate from what Allah has provided for you," the disbelievers say to the believers, "Why

should we feed those whom Allah could have fed if He wanted to? You are clearly astray!”

⁴⁸And they ask ‘the believers’, “When will this threat come to pass, if what you say is true?”

⁴⁹They must be awaiting a single Blast, which will seize them while they are ‘entrenched’ in ‘worldly’ disputes

⁵⁰Then they will not be able to make a ‘last’ will, nor can they return to their own people

⁵¹The Trumpet will be blown ‘a second time’, then—behold!—they will rush from the graves to their Lord

⁵²They will cry, “Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of rest? This must be what the Most Compassionate warned us of; the messengers told the truth!”

⁵³It will only take one Blast, then at once they will all be brought before Us

⁵⁴On that Day no soul will be wronged in the least, nor will you be rewarded except for what you used to do

⁵⁵Indeed, on that Day the residents of Paradise will be busy enjoying themselves

⁵⁶They and their spouses will be in ‘cool’ shade, reclining on ‘canopied’ couches

⁵⁷There they will have fruits and whatever they desire

⁵⁸And “Peace!” will be ‘their’ greeting from the Merciful Lord

⁵⁹‘Then the disbelievers will be told,’ “Step away ‘from the believers’ this Day, O wicked ones

⁶⁰Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, not to follow Satan, for he is truly your sworn enemy

⁶¹but to worship Me ‘alone’? This is the Straight Path

⁶²Yet he already misled great multitudes of you. Did you not have any sense

⁶³This is the Hell you were warned of

⁶⁴Burn in it Today for your disbelief.”

⁶⁵On this Day We will seal their mouths, their hands will speak to Us, and their feet will testify to what they used to commit

⁶⁶Had We willed, We could have easily blinded their eyes, so they would struggle to find their way. How then could they see

⁶⁷And had We willed, We could have transfigured them on the spot, so they could neither progress forward nor turn back

⁶⁸And whoever We grant a long life, We reverse them in development. Will they not then understand

⁶⁹We have not taught him poetry, nor is it fitting for him. This 'Book' is only a Reminder and a clear Quran

⁷⁰to warn whoever is 'truly' alive and fulfil the decree 'of torment' against the disbelievers

⁷¹Do they not see that We singlehandedly created for them, among other things, cattle which are under their control

⁷²And We have subjected these 'animals' to them, so they may ride some and eat others

⁷³And they derive from them other benefits and drinks. Will they not then give thanks

⁷⁴Still they have taken other gods besides Allah, hoping to be helped 'by them'

⁷⁵They cannot help the pagans, even though they serve the idols as dedicated guards

⁷⁶So do not let their words grieve you 'O Prophet'. Indeed, We 'fully' know what they conceal and what they reveal

⁷⁷Do people not see that We have created them from a sperm-drop, then—behold!—they openly challenge 'Us'

⁷⁸And they argue with Us—forgetting they were created—saying, "Who will give life to decayed bones?"

⁷⁹Say, 'O Prophet, '“They will be revived by the One Who produced them the first time, for He has 'perfect' knowledge of every created being

⁸⁰'He is the One' Who gives you fire from green trees, and—behold!—you kindle 'fire' from them

⁸¹Can the One Who created the heavens and the earth not 'easily' resurrect these 'deniers'?" Yes 'He can'! For He is the Master Creator, All-Knowing

⁸²All it takes, when He wills something 'to be', is simply to say to it: “Be!” And it is

⁸³So glory be to the One in Whose Hands is the authority over all things, and to Whom 'alone' you will 'all' be returned

Aṣ-Ṣāffāt

Those Lined Up in Ranks • 182 verses

- ¹By those 'angels' lined up in ranks
²and those who diligently drive 'the clouds'
³and those who recite the Reminder
⁴Surely your God is One
⁵'He is' the Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything
in between, and the Lord of all points of sunrise
⁶Indeed, We have adorned the lowest heaven with the stars
for decoration
⁷and 'for' protection from every rebellious devil
⁸They cannot listen to the highest assembly 'of angels' for
they are pelted from every side
⁹'fiercely' driven away. And they will suffer an everlasting
torment
¹⁰But whoever manages to stealthily eavesdrop is 'instantly'
pursued by a piercing flare

¹¹So ask them 'O Prophet', which is harder to create: them or other marvels of Our creation? Indeed, We created them from a sticky clay

¹²In fact, you are astonished 'by their denial', while they ridicule 'you'

¹³When they are reminded, they are never mindful

¹⁴And whenever they see a sign, they make fun of it

¹⁵saying, "This is nothing but pure magic

¹⁶When we are dead and reduced to dust and bones, will we really be resurrected

¹⁷And our forefathers as well?"

¹⁸Say, "Yes! And you will be fully humbled."

¹⁹It will only take one Blast, then at once they will see 'it all'

²⁰They will cry, "Oh, woe to us! This is the Day of Judgment!"

²¹'They will be told,' "This is the Day of 'Final' Decision which you used to deny."

²²'Allah will say to the angels,' "Gather 'all' the wrongdoers along with their peers, and whatever they used to worship

²³instead of Allah, then lead them 'all' to the path of Hell

²⁴And detain them, for they must be questioned."

²⁵Then they will be asked, “What is the matter with you that you can no longer help each other?”

²⁶In fact, on that Day they will be ‘fully’ submissive

²⁷They will turn on each other, throwing blame

²⁸The misled will say, “It was you who deluded us away from what is right.”

²⁹The misleaders will reply, “No! You disbelieved on your own

³⁰We had no authority over you. In fact, you yourselves were a transgressing people

³¹The decree of our Lord has come to pass against us ‘all’: we will certainly taste ‘the punishment’

³²We caused you to deviate, for we ourselves were deviant.”

³³Surely on that Day they will ‘all’ share in the punishment

³⁴That is certainly how We deal with the wicked

³⁵For whenever it was said to them ‘in the world’, “There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Allah,” they acted arrogantly

³⁶and argued, “Should we really abandon our gods for a mad poet?”

³⁷In fact, he came with the truth, confirming 'earlier' messengers

³⁸You will certainly taste the painful torment

³⁹and will only be rewarded for what you used to do

⁴⁰But not the chosen servants of Allah

⁴¹They will have a known provision

⁴²fruits 'of every type'. And they will be honoured

⁴³in the Gardens of Bliss

⁴⁴facing each other on thrones

⁴⁵A drink 'of pure wine' will be passed around to them from a flowing stream

⁴⁶crystal-white, delicious to drink

⁴⁷It will neither harm 'them', nor will they be intoxicated by it

⁴⁸And with them will be maidens of modest gaze and gorgeous eyes

⁴⁹as if they were pristine pearls

⁵⁰Then they will turn to one another inquisitively

⁵¹One of them will say, "I once had a companion 'in the world'

⁵²who used to ask 'me', 'Do you actually believe 'in resurrection'

⁵³When we are dead and reduced to dust and bones, will we really be brought to judgment?”

⁵⁴He will ‘then’ ask, “Would you care to see ‘his fate’?”

⁵⁵Then he ‘and the others’ will look and spot him in the midst of the Hellfire

⁵⁶He will ‘then’ say, “By Allah! You nearly ruined me

⁵⁷Had it not been for the grace of my Lord, I ‘too’ would have certainly been among those brought ‘to Hell’.”

⁵⁸‘Then he will ask his fellow believers,’ “Can you imagine that we will never die

⁵⁹except our first death, nor be punished ‘like the others’?”

⁶⁰This is truly the ultimate triumph

⁶¹For such ‘honour’ all should strive

⁶²Is this ‘bliss’ a better accommodation or the tree of Zaqqûm

⁶³We have surely made it a test for the wrongdoers

⁶⁴Indeed, it is a tree that grows in the depths of Hell

⁶⁵bearing fruit like devils’ heads

⁶⁶The evildoers will certainly ‘be left to’ eat from it, filling up their bellies with it

⁶⁷Then on top of that they will be given a blend of boiling drink

⁶⁸Then they will ultimately return to 'their place in' Hell

⁶⁹Indeed, they found their forefathers astray

⁷⁰so they rushed in their footsteps

⁷¹And surely most of the earlier generations had strayed before them

⁷²although We had certainly sent warners among them

⁷³See then what was the end of those who had been warned

⁷⁴But not the chosen servants of Allah

⁷⁵Indeed, Noah cried out to Us, and how excellent are We in responding

⁷⁶We delivered him and his family from the great distress

⁷⁷and made his descendants the sole survivors

⁷⁸And We blessed him 'with honourable mention' among later generations

⁷⁹"Peace be upon Noah among all peoples."

⁸⁰Indeed, this is how We reward the good-doers

⁸¹'For' he was truly one of Our faithful servants

⁸²Then We drowned the others

⁸³And indeed, one of those who followed his way was Abraham

- ⁸⁴Remember when he came to his Lord with a pure heart
⁸⁵and said to his father and his people, "What are you worshipping
⁸⁶Is it false gods that you desire instead of Allah
⁸⁷What then do you expect from the Lord of all worlds?"
⁸⁸He later looked up to the stars 'in contemplation'
⁸⁹then said, "I am really sick."
⁹⁰So they turned their backs on him and went away
⁹¹Then he 'stealthily' advanced towards their gods, and said 'mockingly', "Will you not eat 'your offerings'
⁹²What is wrong with you that you cannot speak?"
⁹³Then he swiftly turned on them, striking 'them' with his right hand
⁹⁴Later, his people came rushing towards him 'furiously'
⁹⁵He argued, "How can you worship what you carve 'with your own hands'
⁹⁶when it is Allah Who created you and whatever you do?"
⁹⁷They said 'to one another', "Build him a furnace and cast him into the blazing fire."
⁹⁸And so they sought to harm him, but We made them inferior

⁹⁹He later said, "I am leaving 'in obedience' to my Lord. He will guide me

¹⁰⁰My Lord! Bless me with righteous offspring."

¹⁰¹So We gave him good news of a forbearing son

¹⁰²Then when the boy reached the age to work with him, Abraham said, "O my dear son! I have seen in a dream that I 'must' sacrifice you. So tell me what you think." He replied, "O my dear father! Do as you are commanded. Allah willing, you will find me steadfast."

¹⁰³Then when they submitted 'to Allah's Will', and Abraham laid him on the side of his forehead 'for sacrifice'

¹⁰⁴We called out to him, "O Abraham

¹⁰⁵You have already fulfilled the vision." Indeed, this is how We reward the good-doers

¹⁰⁶That was truly a revealing test

¹⁰⁷And We ransomed his son with a great sacrifice

¹⁰⁸and blessed Abraham 'with honourable mention' among later generations

¹⁰⁹"Peace be upon Abraham."

¹¹⁰This is how We reward the good-doers

¹¹¹He was truly one of Our faithful servants

¹¹²We ‘later’ gave him good news of Isaac—a prophet, and one of the righteous

¹¹³We blessed him and Isaac as well. Some of their descendants did good, while others clearly wronged themselves

¹¹⁴And We certainly showed favour to Moses and Aaron

¹¹⁵and delivered them and their people from the great distress

¹¹⁶We helped them so it was they who prevailed

¹¹⁷We gave them the clear Scripture

¹¹⁸and guided them to the Straight Path

¹¹⁹And We blessed them ‘with honourable mention’ among later generations

¹²⁰“Peace be upon Moses and Aaron.”

¹²¹Indeed, this is how We reward the good-doers

¹²²They were truly ‘two’ of Our faithful servants

¹²³And Elias was indeed one of the messengers

¹²⁴‘Remember’ when he said to his people, “Will you not fear ‘Allah’

¹²⁵Do you call upon ‘the idol of’ Ba’l and abandon the Best of Creators—

¹²⁶Allah, your Lord and the Lord of your forefathers?”

¹²⁷But they rejected him, so they will certainly be brought
‘for punishment’

¹²⁸But not the chosen servants of Allah

¹²⁹We blessed him ‘with honourable mention’ among later
generations

¹³⁰“Peace be upon Elias.”

¹³¹Indeed, this is how We reward the good-doers

¹³²He was truly one of Our faithful servants

¹³³And Lot was indeed one of the messengers

¹³⁴‘Remember’ when We delivered him and all of his family

¹³⁵except an old woman, who was one of the doomed

¹³⁶Then We ‘utterly’ destroyed the rest

¹³⁷You ‘Meccans’ certainly pass by their ruins day

¹³⁸and night. Will you not then understand

¹³⁹And Jonah was indeed one of the messengers

¹⁴⁰‘Remember’ when he fled to the overloaded ship

¹⁴¹Then ‘to save it from sinking,’ he drew straws ‘with other
passengers’. He lost ‘and was thrown overboard’

¹⁴²Then the whale engulfed him while he was blameworthy

¹⁴³Had he not ‘constantly’ glorified ‘Allah’

¹⁴⁴he would have certainly remained in its belly until the Day of Resurrection

¹⁴⁵But We cast him onto the open 'shore', 'totally' worn out

¹⁴⁶and caused a squash plant to grow over him

¹⁴⁷We 'later' sent him 'back' to 'his city of' at least one hundred thousand people

¹⁴⁸who then believed 'in him', so We allowed them enjoyment for a while

¹⁴⁹Ask them 'O Prophet' if your Lord has daughters, while the pagans 'prefer to' have sons

¹⁵⁰Or 'ask them' if We created the angels as females right before their eyes

¹⁵¹Indeed, it is one of their 'outrageous' fabrications to say

¹⁵²"Allah has children." They are simply liars

¹⁵³Has He chosen daughters over sons

¹⁵⁴What is the matter with you? How do you judge

¹⁵⁵Will you not then be mindful

¹⁵⁶Or do you have 'any' compelling proof

¹⁵⁷Then bring 'us' your scripture, if what you say is true

¹⁵⁸They have also established a 'marital' relationship between Him and the jinn. Yet the jinn 'themselves' know well that such people will certainly be brought 'for punishment'

¹⁵⁹Glorified is Allah far above what they claim

¹⁶⁰But not the chosen servants of Allah

¹⁶¹Surely you 'pagans' and whatever 'idols' you worship

¹⁶²can never lure 'anyone' away from Him

¹⁶³except those 'destined' to burn in Hell

¹⁶⁴'The angels respond,' "There is not one of us without an assigned station 'of worship'

¹⁶⁵We are indeed the ones lined up in ranks 'for Allah'

¹⁶⁶And we are indeed the ones 'constantly' glorifying 'His praise'."

¹⁶⁷They certainly used to say

¹⁶⁸"If only we had a Reminder like 'those of' earlier peoples

¹⁶⁹we would have truly been Allah's devoted servants."

¹⁷⁰But 'now' they reject it, so they will soon know

¹⁷¹Our Word has already gone forth to Our servants, the messengers

¹⁷²that they would surely be helped

¹⁷³and that Our forces will certainly prevail

174 So turn away from the deniers for a while 'O Prophet'

175 You will see 'what will happen to' them, and they too will see

176 Do they 'really' wish to hasten Our punishment

177 Yet when it descends upon them: how evil will that morning be for those who had been warned

178 And turn away from them for a while

179 You will see, and they too will see

180 Glorified is your Lord—the Lord of Honour and Power—above what they claim

181 Peace be upon the messengers

182 And praise be to Allah—Lord of all worlds

Şād

Şād • 88 verses

¹Şād. By the Quran, full of reminders

²“This is the truth,” yet the disbelievers are “entrenched” in arrogance and opposition

³“Imagine” how many peoples We destroyed before them, and they cried out when it was too late to escape

⁴Now, the pagans are astonished that a warner has come to them from among themselves. And the disbelievers say, “This is a magician, a total liar

⁵Has he reduced “all” the gods to One God? Indeed, this is something totally astonishing.”

⁶The chiefs among them went forth saying, “Carry on, and stand firm in devotion to your gods. Certainly this is just a scheme “for power”

⁷We have never heard of this in the previous faith. This is nothing but a fabrication

⁸Has the Reminder been revealed 'only' to him out of 'all of us?' In fact, they are 'only' in doubt of My 'revealed' Reminder. In fact, 'they do so because' they have not yet tasted My punishment

⁹Or 'is it because' they possess the treasures of the mercy of your Lord—the Almighty, the Giver 'of all bounties'

¹⁰Or 'is it because' the kingdom of the heavens and the earth and everything in between belongs to them? Let them then climb their way 'to heaven, if their claim is true'

¹¹This is just another 'enemy' force bound for defeat out there

¹²Before them, the people of Noah denied 'the truth', as did 'Âd, Pharaoh of the mighty structures

¹³Thamûd, the people of Lot, and the residents of the Forest. These were 'all' enemy forces

¹⁴Each rejected their messenger, so My punishment was justified

¹⁵These 'pagans' are awaiting nothing but a single Blast that cannot be stopped

¹⁶They say 'mockingly', "Our Lord! Hasten for us our share 'of the punishment' before the Day of Reckoning."

¹⁷Be patient 'O Prophet' with what they say. And remember Our servant, David, the man of strength. Indeed, he 'constantly' turned 'to Allah'

¹⁸We truly subjected the mountains to hymn 'Our praises' along with him in the evening and after sunrise

¹⁹And 'We subjected' the birds, flocking together. All turned to him 'echoing his hymns'

²⁰We strengthened his kingship, and gave him wisdom and sound judgment

²¹Has the story of the two plaintiffs, who scaled the 'wall of David's' sanctuary, reached you 'O Prophet'

²²When they came into David's presence, he was startled by them. They said, "Have no fear. 'We are merely' two in a dispute: one of us has wronged the other. So judge between us with truth—do not go beyond 'it'—and guide us to the right way

²³This is my brother. He has ninety-nine sheep while I have 'only' one. 'Still' he asked me to give it up to him, overwhelming me with 'his' argument."

²⁴David 'eventually' ruled, "He has definitely wronged you in demanding 'to add' your sheep to his. And certainly many

partners wrong each other, except those who believe and do good—but how few are they!” Then David realized that We had tested him so he asked for his Lord’s forgiveness, fell down in prostration, and turned ‘to Him in repentance’

²⁵So We forgave that for him. And he will indeed have ‘a status of’ closeness to Us and an honourable destination

²⁶‘We instructed him:’ “O David! We have surely made you an authority in the land, so judge between people with truth. And do not follow ‘your’ desires or they will lead you astray from Allah’s Way. Surely those who go astray from Allah’s Way will suffer a severe punishment for neglecting the Day of Reckoning.”

²⁷We have not created the heavens and earth and everything in between without purpose—as the disbelievers think. So woe to the disbelievers because of the Fire

²⁸Or should We treat those who believe and do good like those who make mischief throughout the land? Or should We treat the righteous like the wicked

²⁹‘This is’ a blessed Book which We have revealed to you ‘O Prophet’ so that they may contemplate its verses, and people of reason may be mindful

³⁰And We blessed David with Solomon—what an excellent servant ‘he was’! Indeed, he ‘constantly’ turned ‘to Allah’

³¹‘Remember’ when the well-trained, swift horses were paraded before him in the evening

³²He then proclaimed, “I am truly in love with ‘these’ fine things out of remembrance for Allah,” until they went out of sight

³³‘He ordered,’ “Bring them back to me!” Then he began to rub down their legs and necks

³⁴And indeed, We tested Solomon, placing a ‘deformed’ body on his throne, then he turned ‘to Allah in repentance’

³⁵He prayed, “My Lord! Forgive me, and grant me an authority that will never be matched by anyone after me. You are indeed the Giver ‘of all bounties’.”

³⁶So We subjected to him the wind, blowing gently at his command to wherever he pleased

³⁷And ‘We subjected to him’ every builder and diver of the jinn

³⁸and others bound together in chains

³⁹‘Allah said,’ “This is Our gift, so give or withhold ‘as you wish’, never to be called to account.”

⁴⁰And he will indeed have 'a status of' closeness to Us and an honourable destination

⁴¹And remember Our servant Job, when he cried out to his Lord, "Satan has afflicted me with distress and suffering."

⁴²"We responded, ' "Stomp your foot: 'now' here is a cool 'and refreshing' spring for washing and drinking."

⁴³And We gave him back his family, twice as many, as a mercy from Us and a lesson for people of reason

⁴⁴"And We said to him, ' "Take in your hand a bundle of grass, and strike 'your wife' with it, and do not break your oath." We truly found him patient. What an excellent servant 'he was'! Indeed, he 'constantly' turned 'to Allah'

⁴⁵And remember Our servants: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—the men of strength and insight

⁴⁶We truly chose them for the honour of proclaiming the Hereafter

⁴⁷And in Our sight they are truly among the chosen and the finest

⁴⁸Also remember Ishmael, Elisha, and Zul-Kifl. All are among the best

⁴⁹This is 'all' a reminder. And the righteous will certainly have an honourable destination

⁵⁰the Gardens of Eternity, whose gates will be open for them

⁵¹There they will recline, calling for abundant fruit and drink

⁵²And with them will be maidens of modest gaze and equal age

⁵³This is what you are promised for the Day of Reckoning

⁵⁴This is indeed Our provision that will never end

⁵⁵That is that. And the transgressors will certainly have the worst destination

⁵⁶Hell, where they will burn. What an evil place to rest

⁵⁷Let them then taste this: boiling water and 'oozing' pus

⁵⁸and other torments of the same sort

⁵⁹'The misleaders will say to one another,' "Here is a crowd 'of followers' being thrown in with us. They are not welcome, 'for' they 'too' will burn in the Fire."

⁶⁰The followers will respond, "No! You are not welcome! You brought this upon us. What an evil place for settlement!"

⁶¹Adding, "Our Lord! Whoever brought this upon us, double their punishment in the Fire."

⁶²The tyrants will ask ‘one another’, “But why do we not see those we considered to be lowly

⁶³Were we wrong in mocking them ‘in the world’? Or do our eyes ‘just’ fail to see them ‘in the Fire’?”

⁶⁴This dispute between the residents of the Fire will certainly come to pass

⁶⁵Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I am only a warner. And there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Allah—the One, the Supreme

⁶⁶‘He is the’ Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything in between—the Almighty, Most Forgiving.”

⁶⁷Say, “This ‘Quran’ is momentous news

⁶⁸from which you ‘pagans’ are turning away.”

⁶⁹‘And say,’ “I had no knowledge of the highest assembly ‘in heaven’ when they differed ‘concerning Adam’

⁷⁰What is revealed to me is that I am only sent with a clear warning.”

⁷¹‘Remember, O Prophet’ when your Lord said to the angels, “I am going to create a human being from clay

⁷²So when I have fashioned him and had a spirit of My Own ‘creation’ breathed into him, fall down in prostration to him.”

⁷³So the angels prostrated all together—

⁷⁴but not Iblîs, who acted arrogantly, becoming unfaithful

⁷⁵Allah asked, “O Iblîs! What prevented you from prostrating to what I created with My Own Hands? Did you ‘just’ become proud? Or have you always been arrogant?”

⁷⁶He replied, “I am better than he is: You created me from fire and him from clay.”

⁷⁷Allah commanded, “Then get out of Paradise, for you are truly cursed

⁷⁸And surely upon you is My condemnation until the Day of Judgment.”

⁷⁹Satan appealed, “My Lord! Then delay my end until the Day of their resurrection.”

⁸⁰Allah said, “You will be delayed

⁸¹until the appointed Day.”

⁸²Satan said, “By Your Glory! I will certainly mislead them all

⁸³except Your chosen servants among them.”

⁸⁴Allah concluded, “The truth is—and I ‘only’ say the truth—

⁸⁵I will surely fill up Hell with you and whoever follows you from among them, all together.”

⁸⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I do not ask you for any reward for this ‘Quran’, nor do I pretend to be someone I am not

⁸⁷It is only a reminder to the whole world

⁸⁸And you will certainly know its truth before long.”

Az-Zumar

The Groups • 75 verses

¹The revelation of this Book is from Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise

²Indeed, We have sent down the Book to you ‘O Prophet’ in truth, so worship Allah ‘alone’, being sincerely devoted to Him

³Indeed, sincere devotion is due ‘only’ to Allah. As for those who take other lords besides Him, ‘saying,’ “We worship them only so they may bring us closer to Allah,” surely Allah will judge between all regarding what they differed about. Allah certainly does not guide whoever persists in lying and disbelief

⁴Had it been Allah’s Will to have offspring, He could have chosen whatever He willed of His creation. Glory be to Him! He is Allah—the One, the Supreme

⁵He created the heavens and the earth for a purpose. He wraps the night around the day, and wraps the day around the night. And He has subjected the sun and the moon, each orbiting for an appointed term. He is truly the Almighty, Most Forgiving

⁶He created you 'all' from a single soul, then from it He made its mate. And He produced for you four pairs of cattle. He creates you in the wombs of your mothers 'in stages', one development after another, in three layers of darkness. That is Allah—your Lord! All authority belongs to Him. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. How can you then be turned away

⁷If you disbelieve, then 'know that' Allah is truly not in need of you, nor does He approve of disbelief from His servants. But if you become grateful 'through faith', He will appreciate that from you. No soul burdened with sin will bear the burden of another. Then to your Lord is your return, and He will inform you of what you used to do. He certainly knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁸When one is touched with hardship, they cry out to their Lord, turning to Him 'alone'. But as soon as He showers them with blessings from Him, they 'totally' forget the One they

had cried to earlier, and set up equals to Allah to mislead 'others' from His Way. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Enjoy your disbelief for a little while! You will certainly be one of the inmates of the Fire."

⁹"Are they better' or those who worship 'their Lord' devoutly in the hours of the night, prostrating and standing, fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy of their Lord? Say, 'O Prophet,' "Are those who know equal to those who do not know?" None will be mindful 'of this' except people of reason

¹⁰Say 'O Prophet, that Allah says', "O My servants who believe! Be mindful of your Lord. Those who do good in this world will have a good reward. And Allah's earth is spacious. Only those who endure patiently will be given their reward without limit."

¹¹Say, "I am commanded to worship Allah, being sincerely devoted to Him 'alone'

¹²And I am commanded to be the first of those who submit 'to His Will'."

¹³Say, "I truly fear—if I were to disobey my Lord—the torment of a tremendous Day."

¹⁴Say, "It is 'only' Allah that I worship, being sincere in my devotion to Him

¹⁵Worship then whatever 'gods' you want instead of Him." Say, "The 'true' losers are those who will lose themselves and their families on Judgment Day. That is indeed the clearest loss."

¹⁶They will have layers of fire above and below them. That is what Allah warns His servants with. So fear Me, O My servants

¹⁷And those who shun the worship of false gods, turning to Allah 'alone', will have good news. So give good news to My servants 'O Prophet'—

¹⁸those who listen to what is said and follow the best of it. These are the ones 'rightly' guided by Allah, and these are 'truly' the people of reason

¹⁹What about those against whom the decree of torment has been justified? Is it you 'O Prophet' who will then save those bound for the Fire

²⁰But those mindful of their Lord will have 'elevated' mansions, built one above the other, under which rivers flow.

‘That is’ the promise of Allah. ‘And’ Allah never fails in ‘His’ promise

²¹Do you not see that Allah sends down rain from the sky—channelling it through streams in the earth—then produces with it crops of various colours, then they dry up and you see them wither, and then He reduces them to chaff? Surely in this is a reminder for people of reason

²²Can ‘the misguided be like’ those whose hearts Allah has opened to Islam, so they are enlightened by their Lord? So woe to those whose hearts are hardened at the remembrance of Allah! It is they who are clearly astray

²³‘It is’ Allah ‘Who’ has sent down the best message—a Book of perfect consistency and repeated lessons—which causes the skin ‘and hearts’ of those who fear their Lord to tremble, then their skin and hearts soften at the mention of ‘the mercy of’ Allah. That is the guidance of Allah, through which He guides whoever He wills. But whoever Allah leaves to stray will be left with no guide

²⁴Are those who will only have their ‘bare’ faces to shield themselves from the awful torment on Judgment Day ‘better than those in Paradise’? It will ‘then’ be said to the wrongdoers: “Reap what you sowed!”

²⁵Those before them 'also' rejected 'the truth', then the torment came upon them from where they least expected

²⁶So Allah made them taste humiliation in this worldly life, but far worse is the punishment of the Hereafter, if only they knew

²⁷We have certainly set forth every 'kind of' lesson for people in this Quran, so perhaps they will be mindful

²⁸'It is' a Quran 'revealed' in Arabic without any crookedness, so perhaps they will be conscious 'of Allah'

²⁹Allah sets forth the parable of a slave owned by several quarrelsome masters, and a slave owned by only one master. Are they equal in condition? Praise be to Allah! In fact, most of them do not know

³⁰You 'O Prophet' will certainly die, and they will die too

³¹Then on the Day of Judgment you will 'all settle your' dispute before your Lord

³²Who then does more wrong than those who lie about Allah and reject the truth after it has reached them? Is Hell not a 'fitting' home for the disbelievers

³³And the one who has brought the truth and those who embrace it—it is they who are the righteous

³⁴They will have whatever they desire with their Lord. That is the reward of the good-doers

³⁵As such, Allah will absolve them of 'even' the worst of what they did and reward them according to the best of what they used to do

³⁶Is Allah not sufficient for His servant? Yet they threaten you with other 'powerless' gods besides Him! Whoever Allah leaves to stray will be left with no guide

³⁷And whoever Allah guides, none can lead astray. Is Allah not Almighty, capable of punishment

³⁸If you ask them 'O Prophet' who created the heavens and the earth, they will certainly say, "Allah!" Ask 'them', "Consider then whatever 'idols' you invoke besides Allah: if it was Allah's Will to harm me, could they undo that harm? Or if He willed 'some' mercy for me, could they withhold His mercy?" Say, "Allah is sufficient for me. In Him 'alone' the faithful put their trust."

³⁹Say, 'O Prophet,' "O my people! Persist in your ways, for I 'too' will persist in mine. You will soon come to know

⁴⁰who will be visited by a humiliating torment 'in this life' and overwhelmed by an everlasting punishment 'in the next'."

⁴¹ Surely We have revealed to you the Book 'O Prophet' with the truth for humanity. So whoever chooses to be guided, it is for their own good. And whoever chooses to stray, it is only to their own loss. You are not a keeper over them

⁴² 'It is' Allah 'Who' calls back the souls 'of people' upon their death as well as 'the souls' of the living during their sleep. Then He keeps those for whom He has ordained death, and releases the others until 'their' appointed time. Surely in this are signs for people who reflect

⁴³ Or have they taken others besides Allah as intercessors? Say, 'O Prophet,' "Would they do so,' even though those 'idols' have neither authority nor intelligence?"

⁴⁴ Say, "All intercession belongs to Allah 'alone'. To Him belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. Then to Him you will 'all' be returned."

⁴⁵ Yet when Allah alone is mentioned, the hearts of those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are filled with disgust. But as soon as those 'gods' other than Him are mentioned, they are filled with joy

⁴⁶ Say, 'O Prophet,' "O Allah—Originator of the heavens and the earth, Knower of the seen and unseen! You will judge between Your servants regarding their differences."

⁴⁷Even if the wrongdoers were to possess everything in the world twice over, they would certainly offer it to ransom themselves from the horrible punishment on Judgment Day, for they will see from Allah what they had never expected

⁴⁸And the evil 'consequences' of their deeds will unfold before them, and they will be overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

⁴⁹When one is touched with hardship, they cry out to Us 'alone'. Then when We shower Our blessings upon them, they say, "I have been granted all this only because of 'my' knowledge." Not at all! It is 'no more than' a test. But most of them do not know

⁵⁰The same had already been said by those 'destroyed' before them, but their 'worldly' gains were of no benefit to them

⁵¹So the evil 'consequences' of their deeds overtook them. And the wrongdoers among these 'pagans' will be overtaken by the evil 'consequences' of their deeds. And they will have no escape

⁵²Do they not know that Allah gives abundant or limited provisions to whoever He wills? Surely in this are signs for people who believe

⁵³Say, 'O Prophet, that Allah says,' "O My servants who have exceeded the limits against their souls! Do not lose hope in Allah's mercy, for Allah certainly forgives all sins. He is indeed the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁵⁴Turn to your Lord 'in repentance', and 'fully' submit to Him before the punishment reaches you, 'for' then you will not be helped

⁵⁵Follow 'the Quran,' the best of what has been revealed to you from your Lord, before the punishment takes you by surprise while you are unaware

⁵⁶so that no 'sinful' soul will say 'on Judgment Day', 'Woe to me for neglecting 'my duties towards' Allah, while ridiculing 'the truth'.'

⁵⁷Or 'a soul will' say, 'If only Allah had guided me, I would have certainly been one of the righteous.'

⁵⁸Or say, upon seeing the torment, 'If only I had a second chance, I would have been one of the good-doers.'

⁵⁹Not at all! My revelations had already come to you, but you rejected them, acted arrogantly, and were one of the disbelievers."

⁶⁰On the Day of Judgment you will see those who lied about Allah with their faces gloomy. Is Hell not a 'fitting' home for the arrogant

⁶¹And Allah will deliver those who were mindful 'of Him' to their place of 'ultimate' triumph. No evil will touch them, nor will they grieve

⁶²Allah is the Creator of all things, and He is the Maintainer of everything

⁶³To Him belong the keys 'of the treasures' of the heavens and the earth. As for those who rejected the signs of Allah, it is they who will be the 'true' losers

⁶⁴Say, 'O Prophet,' "Are you urging me to worship 'anyone' other than Allah, O ignorant ones?"

⁶⁵It has already been revealed to you—and to those 'prophets' before you—that if you associate others 'with Allah', your deeds will certainly be void and you will truly be one of the losers

⁶⁶Rather, worship Allah 'alone' and be one of the grateful

⁶⁷They have not shown Allah His proper reverence—when on the Day of Judgment the 'whole' earth will be in His Grip,

and the heavens will be rolled up in His Right Hand. Glorified and Exalted is He above what they associate 'with Him'

⁶⁸The Trumpet will be blown and all those in the heavens and all those on the earth will fall dead, except those Allah wills 'to spare'. Then it will be blown again and they will rise up at once, looking on 'in anticipation'

⁶⁹The earth will shine with the light of its Lord, the record 'of deeds' will be laid 'open', the prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward—and judgment will be passed on all with fairness. None will be wronged

⁷⁰Every soul will be paid in full for its deeds, for Allah knows best what they have done

⁷¹Those who disbelieved will be driven to Hell in 'successive' groups. When they arrive there, its gates will be opened and its keepers will ask them: "Did messengers not come to you from among yourselves, reciting to you the revelations of your Lord and warning you of the coming of this Day of yours?" The disbelievers will cry, "Yes 'indeed'! But the decree of torment has come to pass against the disbelievers."

⁷²It will be said to them, "Enter the gates of Hell, to stay there forever." What an evil home for the arrogant

⁷³And those who were mindful of their Lord will be led to Paradise in 'successive' groups. When they arrive at its 'already' open gates, its keepers will say, "Peace be upon you! You have done well, so come in, to stay forever."

⁷⁴The righteous will say, "Praise be to Allah Who has fulfilled His promise to us, and made us inherit the 'everlasting' land to settle in Paradise wherever we please." How excellent is the reward of those who work 'righteousness'

⁷⁵You will see the angels all around the Throne, glorifying the praises of their Lord, for judgment will have been passed on all with fairness. And it will be said, "Praise be to Allah—Lord of all worlds!"

Ghāfir

The Forgiver • 85 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mîm

²The revelation of this Book is from Allah—the Almighty, All-Knowing

³the Forgiver of sin and Acceptor of repentance, the Severe in punishment, and Infinite in bounty. There is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him. To Him ‘alone’ is the final return

⁴None disputes the signs of Allah except the disbelievers, so do not be deceived by their prosperity throughout the land

⁵Before them, the people of Noah denied ‘the truth’, as did ‘other’ enemy forces afterwards. Every community plotted against its prophet to seize him, and argued in falsehood, ‘hoping’ to discredit the truth with it. So I seized them. And how ‘horrible’ was My punishment

⁶And so your Lord’s decree has been proven true against the disbelievers—that they will be the inmates of the Fire

⁷Those ‘angels’ who carry the Throne and those around it glorify the praises of their Lord, have faith in Him, and seek forgiveness for the believers, ‘praying:’ “Our Lord! You encompass everything in ‘Your’ mercy and knowledge. So forgive those who repent and follow Your Way, and protect them from the torment of the Hellfire

⁸Our Lord! Admit them into the Gardens of Eternity which You have promised them, along with the righteous among their parents, spouses, and descendants. You ‘alone’ are truly the Almighty, All-Wise

⁹And protect them from ‘the consequences of their’ evil deeds. For whoever You protect from the evil of their deeds on that Day will have been shown Your mercy. That is ‘truly’ the ultimate triumph.”

¹⁰Indeed, it will be announced to the disbelievers, “Allah’s contempt for you—as you disbelieved when invited to belief—was far worse than your contempt for one another ‘Today’.”

¹¹They will plead, “Our Lord! You made us lifeless twice, and gave us life twice. Now we confess our sins. So is there any way out?”

¹²They will be told, ‘ “No!’ This is because when Allah alone was invoked, you ‘staunchly’ disbelieved. But when others

were associated with Him 'in worship', you 'readily' believed. So 'Today' judgment belongs to Allah 'alone'—the Most High, All-Great.”

¹³He is the One Who shows you His signs and sends down 'rain as' a provision for you from the sky. 'But' none will be mindful except those who turn 'to Him'

¹⁴So call upon Allah with sincere devotion, even to the dismay of the disbelievers

¹⁵'He is' Highly Exalted in rank, Lord of the Throne. He sends down the revelation by His command to whoever He wills of His servants to warn 'all' of the Day of Meeting—

¹⁶the Day all will appear 'before Allah'. Nothing about them will be hidden from Him. 'He will ask,' “Who does all authority belong to this Day? To Allah—the One, the Supreme

¹⁷Today every soul will be rewarded for what it has done. No injustice Today! Surely Allah is swift in reckoning.”

¹⁸Warn them 'O Prophet' of the approaching Day when the hearts will jump into the throats, suppressing distress. The wrongdoers will have neither a close friend nor intercessor to be heard

¹⁹Allah 'even' knows the sly glances of the eyes and whatever the hearts conceal

²⁰And Allah judges with the truth, while those 'idols' they invoke besides Him cannot judge at all. Indeed, Allah 'alone' is the All-Hearing, All-Seeing

²¹Have they not travelled throughout the land to see what was the end of those 'destroyed' before them? They were far superior in might and 'richer in' monuments throughout the land. But Allah seized them for their sins, and they had no protector from Allah

²²That was because their messengers used to come to them with clear proofs, but they persisted in disbelief. So Allah seized them. Surely He is All-Powerful, severe in punishment

²³Indeed, We sent Moses with Our signs and compelling proof
²⁴to Pharaoh, Hamân, and Korah. But they responded: "Magician! Total liar!"

²⁵Then, when he came to them with the truth from Us, they said, "Kill the sons of those who believe with him and keep their women." But the plotting of the disbelievers was only in vain

²⁶And Pharaoh said, “Let me kill Moses, and let him call upon his Lord! I truly fear that he may change your traditions or cause mischief in the land.”

²⁷Moses replied, “I seek refuge in my Lord and your Lord from every arrogant person who does not believe in the Day of Reckoning.”

²⁸A believing man from Pharaoh’s people, who was hiding his faith, argued, “Will you kill a man ‘only’ for saying: ‘My Lord is Allah,’ while he has in fact come to you with clear proofs from your Lord? If he is a liar, it will be to his own loss. But if he is truthful, then you will be afflicted with some of what he is threatening you with. Surely Allah does not guide whoever is a transgressor, a total liar

²⁹O my people! Authority belongs to you today, reigning supreme in the land. But who would help us against the torment of Allah, if it were to befall us?” Pharaoh assured ‘his people’, “I am telling you only what I believe, and I am leading you only to the way of guidance.”

³⁰And the man who believed cautioned, “O my people! I truly fear for you the doom of ‘earlier’ enemy forces—

³¹like the fate of the people of Noah, 'Âd, Thamûd, and those after them. For Allah would never will to wrong 'His' servants

³²O my people! I truly fear for you the Day all will be crying out 'to each other'—

³³the Day you will 'try in vain to' turn your backs and run away, with no one to protect you from Allah. And whoever Allah leaves to stray will be left with no guide

³⁴Joseph already came to you earlier with clear proofs, yet you never ceased to doubt what he came to you with. When he died you said, 'Allah will never send a messenger after him.' This is how Allah leaves every transgressor and doubter to stray—

³⁵those who dispute Allah's signs with no proof given to them. How despicable is that for Allah and the believers! This is how Allah seals the heart of every arrogant tyrant.”

³⁶Pharaoh ordered, “O Hamân! Build me a high tower so I may reach the pathways

³⁷leading up to the heavens and look for the God of Moses, although I am sure he is a liar.” And so Pharaoh's evil deeds

were made so appealing to him that he was hindered from the 'Right' Way. But the plotting of Pharaoh was only in vain

³⁸And the man who believed urged, "O my people! Follow me, 'and' I will lead you to the Way of Guidance

³⁹O my people! This worldly life is only 'a fleeting' enjoyment, whereas the Hereafter is truly the home of settlement

⁴⁰Whoever does an evil deed will only be paid back with its equivalent. And whoever does good, whether male or female, and is a believer, they will enter Paradise, where they will be provided for without limit

⁴¹O my people! How is it that I invite you to salvation, while you invite me to the Fire

⁴²You invite me to disbelieve in Allah and associate with Him what I have no knowledge of, while I invite you to the Almighty, Most Forgiving

⁴³There is no doubt that whatever 'idols' you invite me to 'worship' are not worthy to be invoked either in this world or the Hereafter. 'Undoubtedly,' our return is to Allah, and the transgressors will be the inmates of the Fire

⁴⁴You will remember what I say to you, and I entrust my affairs to Allah. Surely Allah is All-Seeing of all 'His' servants."

⁴⁵So Allah protected him from the evil of their schemes. And Pharaoh's people were overwhelmed by an evil punishment

⁴⁶they are exposed to the Fire 'in their graves' morning and evening. And on the Day the Hour will be established 'it will be said', "Admit Pharaoh's people into the harshest punishment 'of Hell'."

⁴⁷"Consider the Day' when they will dispute in the Fire, and the lowly 'followers' will appeal to the arrogant 'leaders', "We were your 'dedicated' followers, will you then shield us from a portion of the Fire?"

⁴⁸The arrogant will say, "We are all in it! 'For' Allah has already passed judgment over 'His' servants."

⁴⁹And those in the Fire will cry out to the keepers of Hell, "Pray to your Lord to lighten the torment for us 'even' for one day!"

⁵⁰The keepers will reply, "Did your messengers not 'constantly' come to you with clear proofs?" They will say, "Yes 'they did'." The keepers will say, "Then pray! Though the prayer of the disbelievers is only in vain."

⁵¹We certainly help Our messengers and the believers, 'both' in this worldly life and on the Day the witnesses will stand forth 'for testimony'—

⁵²the Day the wrongdoers' excuses will be of no benefit to them. They will be condemned, and will have the worst outcome

⁵³And indeed, We gave Moses 'true' guidance, and made the Children of Israel inherit the Scripture—

⁵⁴a guide and a reminder to people of reason

⁵⁵So be patient 'O Prophet', 'for' Allah's promise is certainly true. Seek forgiveness for your shortcomings. And glorify the praises of your Lord morning and evening

⁵⁶Surely those who dispute Allah's signs—with no proof given to them—have nothing in their hearts but greed for dominance, which they will never attain. So seek refuge in Allah. Indeed, He alone is the All-Hearing, All-Seeing

⁵⁷The creation of the heavens and the earth is certainly greater than the re-creation of humankind, but most people do not know

⁵⁸Those blind 'to the truth' and those who can see are not equal, nor are those who believe and do good 'equal' to those who do evil. Yet you are hardly mindful

⁵⁹The Hour is certainly coming, there is no doubt about it. But most people do not believe

⁶⁰Your Lord has proclaimed, "Call upon Me, I will respond to you. Surely those who are too proud to worship Me will enter Hell, fully humbled."

⁶¹It is Allah Who has made the night for you to rest in and the day bright. Surely Allah is ever Bountiful to humanity, but most people are ungrateful

⁶²That is Allah, your Lord, the Creator of all things. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. How can you then be deluded 'from the truth'

⁶³This is how those who used to reject Allah's signs were 'also' deluded

⁶⁴It is Allah Who made the earth a place of settlement for you and the sky a canopy. He shaped you 'in the womb', perfecting your form. And He has provided you with what is good and lawful. That is Allah—your Lord. So Blessed is Allah, Lord of all worlds

⁶⁵He is the Ever-Living. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. So call upon Him with sincere devotion, 'saying,' "All praise is for Allah—Lord of all worlds."

⁶⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "I have been forbidden to worship those 'idols' you worship besides Allah, since clear proofs have come to me from my Lord. And I have been commanded to 'fully' submit to the Lord of all worlds."

⁶⁷He is the One Who created you from dust, then from a sperm-drop, then 'developed you into' a clinging clot 'of blood', then He brings you forth as infants, so that you may reach your prime, and become old—though some of you 'may' die sooner—reaching an appointed time, so perhaps you may understand 'Allah's power'

⁶⁸He is the One Who gives life and causes death. When He decrees a matter, He simply tells it, "Be!" And it is

⁶⁹Have you not seen how those who dispute Allah's signs are turned away

⁷⁰'They are' the ones who reject this Book and all 'scriptures' We sent Our messengers with. So they will know 'the consequences'

⁷¹when shackles will be around their necks and chains 'on their legs'. They will be dragged

⁷²through boiling water, then burned in the Fire 'as fuel'

⁷³Then they will be asked, "Where are those 'idols' you used to associate

⁷⁴with Allah?" They will cry, "They have 'all' failed us. In fact, we did not invoke anything 'real' before." This is how Allah leaves the disbelievers to stray

⁷⁵"They will be told," "This 'punishment' is for being prideful on earth unjustly and for acting arrogantly

⁷⁶Enter the gates of Hell, to stay there forever. What an evil home for the arrogant!"

⁷⁷So be patient 'O Prophet'. Surely Allah's promise is true. Whether We show you some of what We threaten them with, or cause you to die 'before that', to Us they will 'all' be returned

⁷⁸We already sent messengers before you. We have told you the stories of some of them, while others We have not. It was not for any messenger to bring a sign without Allah's permission. But when Allah's decree comes, judgment will be

passed with fairness, and the people of falsehood will then be in 'total' loss

⁷⁹It is Allah Who made cattle for you so that you may ride some and eat others

⁸⁰Also, you find in them 'other' benefits. And by means of them you may reach destinations you desire. And you are carried upon 'some of' them and upon ships

⁸¹And He shows you His signs. Now which of Allah's signs will you deny

⁸²Have they not travelled throughout the land to see what was the end of those who were 'destroyed' before them? They were far superior in might and 'richer in' monuments throughout the land, but their 'worldly' gains were of no benefit to them

⁸³When their messengers came to them with clear proofs, they were prideful in whatever 'worldly' knowledge they had, and were 'ultimately' overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

⁸⁴When they saw Our punishment, they cried, "'Now' we believe in Allah alone and reject what we had been associating with Him!"

⁸⁵But their faith was of no benefit to them when they saw Our torment. This has 'always' been Allah's way 'of dealing' with His 'wicked' servants. Then and there the disbelievers were in 'total' loss

Fuṣṣilat

Clearly Spelled Out • 54 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mîm

²“This is” a revelation from the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

³“It is” a Book whose verses are perfectly explained—a Quran in Arabic for people who know

⁴delivering good news and warning. Yet most of them turn away, so they do not hear

⁵They say, “Our hearts are veiled against what you are calling us to, there is deafness in our ears, and there is a barrier between us and you. So do ‘whatever you want’ and so shall we!”

⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I am only a man like you, ‘but’ it has been revealed to me that your God is only One God. So take the Straight Way towards Him, and seek His forgiveness. And woe to the polytheists—

⁷those who do not pay alms-tax and are in denial of the Hereafter

⁸‘But’ those who believe and do good will certainly have a never-ending reward

⁹Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “How can you disbelieve in the One Who created the earth in two Days? And how can you set up equals with Him? That is the Lord of all worlds

¹⁰He placed on the earth firm mountains, standing high, showered His blessings upon it, and ordained ‘all’ its means of sustenance—totaling four Days exactly—for all who ask

¹¹Then He turned towards the heaven when it was ‘still like’ smoke, saying to it and to the earth, ‘Submit, willingly or unwillingly.’ They both responded, ‘We submit willingly.’

¹²So He formed the heaven into seven heavens in two Days, assigning to each its mandate. And We adorned the lowest heaven with ‘stars like’ lamps ‘for beauty’ and for protection. That is the design of the Almighty, All-Knowing.”

¹³If they turn away, then say, ‘O Prophet,’ “I warn you of a ‘mighty’ blast, like the one that befell ‘Âd and Thamûd.”

¹⁴The messengers had come to them from all angles, ‘proclaiming,’ “Worship none but Allah.” They responded, “Had

our Lord willed, He could have easily sent down angels 'instead'. So we totally reject what you have been sent with.”

¹⁵As for 'Âd, they acted arrogantly throughout the land with no right, boasting, “Who is superior to us in might?” Did they not see that Allah 'Himself', Who created them, was far superior to them in might? Still they persisted in denying Our signs

¹⁶So We sent against them a furious wind, for 'several' miserable days, to make them taste a humiliating punishment in this worldly life. But far more humiliating will be the punishment of the Hereafter. And they will not be helped

¹⁷As for Thamûd, We showed them guidance, but they preferred blindness over guidance. So the blast of a disgracing punishment overtook them for what they used to commit

¹⁸And We delivered those who were faithful and were mindful 'of Allah'

¹⁹'Consider' the Day 'when' the enemies of Allah will be gathered for the Fire, all driven in ranks

²⁰When they reach it, their ears, eyes, and skin will testify against what they used to do

²¹They will ask their skin 'furiously', "Why have you testified against us?" It will say, "We have been made to speak by Allah, Who causes all things to speak. He 'is the One Who' created you the first time, and to Him you were bound to return

²²You did not 'bother to' hide yourselves from your ears, eyes, and skin to prevent them from testifying against you. Rather, you assumed that Allah did not know much of what you used to do

²³It was that 'false' assumption you entertained about your Lord that has brought about your doom, so you have become losers."

²⁴Even if they endure patiently, the Fire will 'always' be their home. And if they 'beg to' appease 'their Lord', they will never be allowed to

²⁵We placed at their disposal 'evil' associates who made their past and future 'misdeeds' appealing to them. 'So' the fate of earlier communities of jinn and humans has been justified against them 'as well', 'for' they were truly losers

²⁶The disbelievers advised 'one another', "Do not listen to this Quran but drown it out so that you may prevail."

²⁷So We will certainly make the disbelievers taste a severe punishment, and We will surely repay them according to the worst of their deeds

²⁸That is the reward of Allah's enemies: the Fire, which will be their eternal home—a 'fitting' reward for their denial of Our revelations

²⁹The disbelievers will 'then' cry, "Our Lord! Show us those jinn and humans who led us astray: we will put them under our feet so that they will be among the lowest 'in Hell'."

³⁰Surely those who say, "Our Lord is Allah," and then remain steadfast, the angels descend upon them, 'saying,' "Do not fear, nor grieve. Rather, rejoice in the good news of Paradise, which you have been promised

³¹We are your supporters in this worldly life and in the Hereafter. There you will have whatever your souls desire, and there you will have whatever you ask for

³²an accommodation from the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful 'Lord'."

³³And whose words are better than someone who calls 'others' to Allah, does good, and says, "I am truly one of those who submit."

³⁴Good and evil cannot be equal. Respond 'to evil' with what is best, then the one you are in a feud with will be like a close friend

³⁵But this cannot be attained except by those who are patient and who are truly fortunate

³⁶And if you are tempted by Satan, then seek refuge with Allah. Indeed, He 'alone' is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing

³⁷Among His signs are the day and the night, the sun and the moon. Do not prostrate to the sun or the moon, but prostrate to Allah, Who created them 'all', if you 'truly' worship Him 'alone'

³⁸But if the pagans are too proud, then 'let them know that' those 'angels' nearest to your Lord glorify Him day and night, and never grow weary

³⁹And among His signs is that you see the earth devoid of life, but as soon as We send down rain upon it, it begins to stir 'to life' and swell. Indeed, the One Who revives it can easily revive the dead. He is certainly Most Capable of everything

⁴⁰Indeed, those who abuse Our revelations are not hidden from Us. Who is better: the one who will be cast into the Fire

or the one who will be secure on Judgment Day? Do whatever you want. He is certainly All-Seeing of what you do

⁴¹Indeed, those who deny the Reminder after it has come to them 'are doomed', for it is truly a mighty Book

⁴²It cannot be proven false from any angle. 'It is' a revelation from the 'One Who is' All-Wise, Praiseworthy

⁴³'O Prophet!' Nothing is said to you 'by the deniers' except what was already said to the messengers before you. Surely your Lord is 'the Lord' of forgiveness and painful punishment

⁴⁴Had We revealed it as a non-Arabic Quran, they would have certainly argued, "If only its verses were made clear 'in our language'. What! A non-Arabic revelation for an Arab audience!" Say, 'O Prophet,' "It is a guide and a healing to the believers. As for those who disbelieve, there is deafness in their ears and blindness to it 'in their hearts'. It is as if they are being called from a faraway place."

⁴⁵Indeed, We had given Moses the Scripture, but differences arose regarding it. Had it not been for a prior decree from your Lord, their differences would have been settled 'at once'. They are truly in alarming doubt about it

⁴⁶Whoever does good, it is to their own benefit. And whoever does evil, it is to their own loss. Your Lord is never unjust to 'His' creation

⁴⁷With Him 'alone' is the knowledge of the Hour. No fruit comes out of its husk, nor does a female conceive or deliver without His knowledge. And 'consider' the Day He will call to them, "Where are My 'so-called' associate-gods?" They will cry, "We declare before you that none of us testifies to that 'any longer'."

⁴⁸Whatever 'idols' they used to invoke besides Allah will fail them. And they will realize that they will have no escape

⁴⁹One never tires of praying for good. And if touched with evil, they become desperate and hopeless

⁵⁰And if We let them taste a mercy from Us after being touched with adversity, they will certainly say, "This is what I deserve. I do not think the Hour will 'ever' come. And if in fact I am returned to my Lord, the finest reward with Him will definitely be mine." But We will surely inform the disbelievers of what they used to do. And We will certainly make them taste a harsh torment

⁵¹When We show favour to someone, they turn away, acting arrogantly. And when touched with evil, they make endless prayers 'for good'

⁵²Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Imagine if this 'Quran' is 'truly' from Allah and you deny it: who can be more astray than those who have gone too far in opposition 'to the truth'?"

⁵³We will show them Our signs in the universe and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that this 'Quran' is the truth. Is it not enough that your Lord is a Witness over all things

⁵⁴They are truly in doubt of the meeting with their Lord! 'But' He is indeed Fully Aware of everything

Ash-Shūrā

The Consultation • 53 verses

¹Hâ-Mīm

²Aīn-Sīn-Qāf

³And so you 'O Prophet' are sent revelation, just like those before you, by Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise

⁴To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. And He is the Most High, the Greatest

⁵The heavens nearly burst, one above the other, 'in awe of Him'. And the angels glorify the praises of their Lord, and seek forgiveness for those on earth. Surely Allah alone is the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶As for those who take other protectors besides Him, Allah is Watchful over them. And you 'O Prophet' are not a keeper over them

⁷And so We have revealed to you a Quran in Arabic, so you may warn the Mother of Cities and everyone around it, and

warn of the Day of Gathering—about which there is no doubt—
‘when’ a group will be in Paradise and another in the Blaze

⁸Had Allah willed, He could have easily made all ‘humanity’
into a single community ‘of believers’. But He admits into His
mercy whoever He wills. And the wrongdoers will have no
protector or helper

⁹How can they take protectors besides Him? Allah alone is
the Protector. He ‘alone’ gives life to the dead. And He ‘alone’
is Most Capable of everything

¹⁰‘Say to the believers, O Prophet,’ “Whatever you may differ
about, its judgment rests with Allah. That is Allah—my Lord.
In Him I put my trust, and to Him I ‘always’ turn.”

¹¹‘He is’ the Originator of the heavens and the earth. He has
made for you spouses from among yourselves, and ‘made’
mates for cattle ‘as well’—multiplying you ‘both’. There is
nothing like Him, for He ‘alone’ is the All-Hearing, All-Seeing

¹²To Him belong the keys ‘of the treasures’ of the heavens
and the earth. He gives abundant or limited provisions to
whoever He wills. Indeed, He has ‘perfect’ knowledge of all
things

¹³He has ordained for you 'believers' the Way which He decreed for Noah, and what We have revealed to you 'O Prophet' and what We decreed for Abraham, Moses, and Jesus, 'commanding:' "Uphold the faith, and make no divisions in it." What you call the polytheists to is unbearable for them. Allah chooses for Himself whoever He wills, and guides to Himself whoever turns 'to Him'

¹⁴They did not split 'into sects' out of mutual envy until knowledge came to them. Had it not been for a prior decree from your Lord for an appointed term, the matter would have certainly been settled between them 'at once'. And surely those who were made to inherit the Scripture after them are truly in alarming doubt about this 'Quran'

¹⁵Because of that, you 'O Prophet' will invite 'all'. Be steadfast as you are commanded, and do not follow their desires. And say, "I believe in every Scripture Allah has revealed. And I am commanded to judge fairly among you. Allah is our Lord and your Lord. We will be accountable for our deeds and you for yours. There is no 'need for' contention between us. Allah will gather us together 'for judgment'. And to Him is the final return."

¹⁶As for those who dispute about Allah after He is 'already' acknowledged 'by many', their argument is futile in the sight of their Lord. Upon them is wrath, and they will suffer a severe punishment

¹⁷It is Allah Who has revealed the Book with the truth and the balance 'of justice'. You never know, perhaps the Hour is near

¹⁸Those who disbelieve in it 'ask to' hasten it 'mockingly'. But the believers are fearful of it, knowing that it is the truth. Surely those who dispute about the Hour have gone far astray

¹⁹Allah is Ever Kind to His servants. He provides 'abundantly' to whoever He wills. And He is the All-Powerful, Almighty

²⁰Whoever desires the harvest of the Hereafter, We will increase their harvest. And whoever desires 'only' the harvest of this world, We will give them some of it, but they will have no share in the Hereafter

²¹Or do they have associate-gods who have ordained for them some 'polytheistic' beliefs, which Allah has not authorized? Had it not been for 'prior' decree on Judgment, the matter would have certainly been settled between them 'at once'. And surely the wrongdoers will suffer a painful punishment

²²You will see the wrongdoers fearful 'of the punishment' for what they committed but it will be inevitable for them, whereas those who believe and do good will be in the lush Gardens of Paradise. They will have whatever they desire from their Lord. That is 'truly' the greatest bounty

²³That 'reward' is the good news which Allah gives to His servants who believe and do good. Say, 'O Prophet,' "I do not ask you for a reward for this 'message'—only honour for 'our' kinship." Whoever earns a good deed, We will increase it in goodness for them. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Appreciative

²⁴Or do they say, "He has fabricated a lie about Allah!"? 'If you had,' Allah would have sealed your heart, if He willed. And Allah wipes out falsehood and establishes the truth by His Words. He certainly knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

²⁵He is the One Who accepts repentance from His servants and pardons 'their' sins. And He knows whatever you do

²⁶He responds to those who believe and do good, and increases their reward out of His grace. As for the disbelievers, they will suffer a severe punishment

²⁷Had Allah given abundant provisions to 'all' His servants, they would have certainly transgressed throughout the land. But He sends down whatever He wills in perfect measure. He is truly All-Aware, All-Seeing of His servants

²⁸He is the One Who sends down rain after people have given up hope, spreading out His mercy. He is the Guardian, the Praiseworthy

²⁹And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and all living beings He dispersed throughout both. And He is Most Capable of bringing all together whenever He wills

³⁰Whatever affliction befalls you is because of what your own hands have committed. And He pardons much

³¹You can never escape 'Him' on earth, nor do you have any protector or helper besides Allah

³²And among His signs are the ships like mountains 'sailing' in the sea

³³If He wills, He can calm the wind, leaving the ships motionless on the water. Surely in this are signs for whoever is steadfast, grateful

³⁴Or He can wreck the ships for what the people have committed—
though He forgives much—

³⁵so those who dispute about Our signs may know that they
have no refuge

³⁶Whatever 'pleasure' you have been given is 'no more than
a fleeting' enjoyment of this worldly life. But what is with
Allah is far better and more lasting for those who believe and
put their trust in their Lord

³⁷who avoid major sins and shameful deeds, and forgive when
angered

³⁸who respond to their Lord, establish prayer, conduct their
affairs by mutual consultation, and donate from what We
have provided for them

³⁹and who enforce justice when wronged

⁴⁰The reward of an evil deed is its equivalent. But whoever
pardons and seeks reconciliation, then their reward is with
Allah. He certainly does not like the wrongdoers

⁴¹There is no blame on those who enforce justice after being
wronged

⁴²Blame is only on those who wrong people and transgress in the land unjustly. It is they who will suffer a painful punishment

⁴³And whoever endures patiently and forgives—surely this is a resolve to aspire to

⁴⁴And whoever Allah leaves to stray will have no guide after Him. You will see the wrongdoers, when they face the torment, pleading, “Is there any way back ‘to the world’?”

⁴⁵And you will see them exposed to the Fire, fully humbled out of disgrace, stealing glances ‘at it’. And the believers will say, “The ‘true’ losers are those who have lost themselves and their families on Judgment Day.” The wrongdoers will certainly be in everlasting torment

⁴⁶They will have no protectors to help them against Allah. And whoever Allah leaves to stray, for them there is no way

⁴⁷Respond to your Lord before the coming of a Day from Allah that cannot be averted. There will be no refuge for you then, nor ‘grounds for’ denial ‘of sins’

⁴⁸But if they turn away, We have not sent you ‘O Prophet’ as a keeper over them. Your duty is only to deliver ‘the message’. And indeed, when We let someone taste a mercy from

Us, they become prideful 'because' of it. But when afflicted with evil because of what their hands have done, then one becomes totally ungrateful

⁴⁹To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He creates whatever He wills. He blesses whoever He wills with daughters, and blesses whoever He wills with sons

⁵⁰or grants both, sons and daughters, 'to whoever He wills', and leaves whoever He wills infertile. He is indeed All-Knowing, Most Capable

⁵¹It is not 'possible' for a human being to have Allah communicate with them, except through inspiration, or from behind a veil, or by sending a messenger-angel to reveal whatever He wills by His permission. He is surely Most High, All-Wise

⁵²And so We have sent to you 'O Prophet' a revelation by Our command. You did not know of 'this' Book and faith 'before'. But We have made it a light, by which We guide whoever We will of Our servants. And you are truly leading 'all' to the Straight Path—

⁵³the Path of Allah, to Whom belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Surely to Allah all matters will return 'for judgment'

Az-Zukhruf

The Gold Ornaments • 89 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mīm

²By the clear Book

³Certainly, We have made it a Quran in Arabic so perhaps you will understand

⁴And indeed, it is—in the Master Record with Us—highly esteemed, rich in wisdom

⁵Should We then turn the ‘Quranic’ Reminder away from you ‘simply’ because you have been a transgressing people

⁶‘Imagine’ how many prophets We sent to those ‘destroyed’ before

⁷But no prophet ever came to them without being mocked

⁸So We destroyed those who were far mightier than these ‘Meccans’. The examples of ‘their’ predecessors have ‘already’ been related

⁹If you ask them 'O Prophet' who created the heavens and the earth, they will certainly say, "The Almighty, All-Knowing did."

¹⁰'He is the One' Who has laid out the earth for you, and set in it pathways for you so that you may find your way

¹¹And 'He is the One' Who sends down rain from the sky in perfect measure, with which We give life to a lifeless land. And so will you be brought forth 'from the grave'

¹²And 'He is the One' Who created all 'things in' pairs, and made for you ships and animals to ride

¹³so that you may sit firmly on their backs, and remember your Lord's blessings once you are settled on them, saying, "Glory be to the One Who has subjected these for us, for we could have never done so 'on our own'

¹⁴And surely to our Lord we will 'all' return."

¹⁵Still the pagans have made some of His creation out to be a part of Him. Indeed, humankind is clearly ungrateful

¹⁶Has He taken 'angels as His' daughters from what He created, and favoured you 'O pagans' with sons

¹⁷Whenever one of them is given the good news of what they attribute to the Most Compassionate, his face grows gloomy, as he suppresses his rage

¹⁸‘Do they attribute to Him’ those who are brought up in fineries and are not commanding in disputes

¹⁹Still they have labelled the angels, who are servants of the Most Compassionate, as female. Did they witness their creation? Their statement will be recorded, and they will be questioned

²⁰And they argue, “Had the Most Compassionate willed, we would have never worshipped them.” They have no knowledge ‘in support’ of this ‘claim’. They do nothing but lie

²¹Or have We given them a Book ‘for proof’, before this ‘Quran’, to which they are holding firm

²²In fact, they say, “We found our forefathers following a ‘particular’ way, and we are following in their footsteps.”

²³Similarly, whenever We sent a warner to a society before you ‘O Prophet’, its ‘spoiled’ elite would say, “We found our forefathers following a ‘particular’ way, and we are walking in their footsteps.”

²⁴Each 'warner' asked, "Even if what I brought you is better guidance than what you found your forefathers practicing?" They replied, "We totally reject whatever you have been sent with."

²⁵So We inflicted punishment upon them. See then what was the fate of the deniers

²⁶'Remember, O Prophet' when Abraham declared to his father and his people, "I am totally free of whatever 'gods' you worship

²⁷except the One Who originated me, and He will surely guide me."

²⁸And he left this enduring declaration among his descendants, so they may 'always' turn back 'to Allah'

²⁹In fact, I had allowed enjoyment for these 'Meccans' and their forefathers, until the truth came to them along with a messenger making things clear

³⁰'But' when the truth came to them, they said, "This is magic, and we totally reject it."

³¹And they exclaimed, "If only this Quran was revealed to a great man from 'one of' the two cities!"

³²Is it they who distribute your Lord's mercy? We 'alone' have distributed their 'very' livelihood among them in this worldly life and raised some of them in rank above others so that some may employ others in service. 'But' your Lord's mercy is far better than whatever 'wealth' they amass

³³Were it not that people might 'be tempted to' become one community 'of disbelievers', We would have supplied the homes of 'only' those who disbelieve in the Most Compassionate with silver roofs and 'silver' stairways to ascend

³⁴as well as 'silver' gates and thrones to recline on

³⁵and ornaments 'of gold'. Yet all this is no more than a 'fleeting' enjoyment in this worldly life. 'But' the Hereafter with your Lord is 'only' for those mindful 'of Him'

³⁶And whoever turns a blind eye to the Reminder of the Most Compassionate, We place at the disposal of each a devilish one as their close associate

³⁷who will certainly hinder them from the 'Right' Way while they think they are 'rightly' guided

³⁸But when such a person comes to Us, one will say 'to their associate', "I wish you were as distant from me as the east is from the west! What an evil associate 'you were'!"

³⁹It will be said to both, “Since you all did wrong, sharing in the punishment will be of no benefit to you this Day.”

⁴⁰Can you make the deaf hear, or guide the blind or those clearly astray

⁴¹Even if We take you away ‘from this world’, We will surely inflict punishment upon them

⁴²Or if We show you what We threaten them with, We certainly have full power over them

⁴³So hold firmly to what has been revealed to you ‘O Prophet’. You are truly on the Straight Path

⁴⁴Surely this ‘Quran’ is a glory for you and your people. And you will ‘all’ be questioned ‘about it’

⁴⁵Ask ‘the followers of’ the messengers that We already sent before you if We ‘ever’ appointed ‘other’ gods to be worshipped besides the Most Compassionate

⁴⁶Indeed, We sent Moses with Our signs to Pharaoh and his chiefs, and he said: “I am a messenger of the Lord of all worlds.”

⁴⁷But as soon as he came to them with Our signs, they laughed at them

⁴⁸although every sign We showed them was greater than the one before. Ultimately, We seized them with torments so that they might return 'to the Right Path'

⁴⁹'Then' they pleaded, "O 'mighty' magician! Pray to your Lord on our behalf, by virtue of the covenant He made with you. We will certainly accept guidance."

⁵⁰But as soon as We removed the torments from them, they broke their promise

⁵¹And Pharaoh called out to his people, boasting, "O my people! Am I not sovereign over Egypt as well as 'all' these streams flowing at my feet? Can you not see

⁵²Am I not better than this nobody who can hardly express himself

⁵³Why then have no golden bracelets 'of kingship' been granted to him or angels come with him as escorts!"

⁵⁴And so he fooled his people, and they obeyed him. They were truly a rebellious people

⁵⁵So when they enraged Us, We inflicted punishment upon them, drowning them all

⁵⁶And We made them an example and a lesson for those after them

⁵⁷When the son of Mary was cited as an example 'in argument', your people 'O Prophet' broke into 'joyful' applause

⁵⁸They exclaimed, "Which is better: our gods or Jesus?" They cite him only to argue. In fact, they are a people prone to dispute

⁵⁹He was only a servant We showed favour to, and made as an example for the Children of Israel

⁶⁰Had We willed, We could have easily replaced you 'all' with angels, succeeding one another on earth

⁶¹And his 'second' coming is truly a sign for the Hour. So have no doubt about it, and follow me. This is the Straight Path

⁶²And do not let Satan hinder you, 'for' he is certainly your sworn enemy

⁶³When Jesus came with clear proofs, he declared, "I have come to you with wisdom, and to clarify to you some of what you differ about. So fear Allah, and obey me

⁶⁴Surely Allah 'alone' is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him 'alone'. This is the Straight Path."

⁶⁵Yet their 'various' groups have differed among themselves 'about him', so woe to the wrongdoers when they face the torment of a painful Day

⁶⁶Are they waiting for the Hour to take them by surprise when they least expect 'it'

⁶⁷Close friends will be enemies to one another on that Day, except the righteous

⁶⁸'who will be told,' "O My servants! There is no fear for you Today, nor will you grieve—

⁶⁹'those' who believed in Our signs and 'fully' submitted 'to Us'

⁷⁰Enter Paradise, you and your spouses, rejoicing."

⁷¹Golden trays and cups will be passed around to them. There will be whatever the souls desire and the eyes delight in. And you will be there forever

⁷²That is the Paradise which you will be awarded for what you used to do

⁷³There you will have abundant fruit to eat from

⁷⁴Indeed, the wicked will be in the torment of Hell forever

⁷⁵It will never be lightened for them, and there they will be overwhelmed with despair

⁷⁶We did not wrong them, but it was they who were the wrong-doers

⁷⁷They will cry, “O Mâlik! Let your Lord finish us off.” He will answer, “You are definitely here to stay.”

⁷⁸We certainly brought the truth to you, but most of you were resentful of the truth

⁷⁹Or have they mastered some ‘evil’ plan? Then We ‘too’ are surely planning

⁸⁰Or do they think that We do not hear their ‘evil’ thoughts and secret talks? Yes ‘We do’! And Our messenger-angels are in their presence, recording ‘it all’

⁸¹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “If the Most Compassionate ‘really’ had offspring, I would be the first worshipper.”

⁸²Glorified is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, the Lord of the Throne, far above what they claim

⁸³So let them indulge ‘in falsehood’ and amuse ‘themselves’ until they face their Day, which they have been warned of

⁸⁴It is He Who is ‘the only’ God in the heavens and ‘the only’ God on the earth. For He is the All-Wise, All-Knowing

⁸⁵And Blessed is the One to Whom belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth and everything in between! With Him ‘alone’ is the knowledge of the Hour. And to Him you will ‘all’ be returned

⁸⁶But those objects of worship they invoke besides Him have no power to intercede, except those who testify to the truth knowingly

⁸⁷If you ask them 'O Prophet' who created them, they will certainly say, "Allah!" How can they then be deluded 'from the truth'

⁸⁸Allah is Aware of the Prophet's cry: "O my Lord! Indeed, these are a people who persist in disbelief."

⁸⁹So bear with them and respond with peace. They will soon come to know

Ad-Dukhān

The Haze • 59 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mīm

²By the clear Book

³Indeed, We sent it down on a blessed night, for We always warn 'against evil'

⁴On that night every matter of wisdom is ordained

⁵by a command from Us, for We have always sent 'messengers'

⁶as a mercy from your Lord. He 'alone' is truly the All-Hearing, All-Knowing—

⁷the Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything in between, if only you had sure faith

⁸There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him. He 'alone' gives life and causes death. 'He is' your Lord, and the Lord of your forefathers

⁹In fact, they are in doubt, amusing themselves

¹⁰Wait then 'O Prophet' for the day 'when' the sky will be veiled in haze, clearly visible

¹¹overwhelming the people. 'They will cry,' "This is a painful torment

¹²Our Lord! Remove 'this' torment from us, 'and' we will certainly believe."

¹³How can they be reminded when a messenger has already come to them, making things clear

¹⁴then they turned away from him, saying, "A madman, taught by others!"

¹⁵Indeed, We will remove 'that' torment for a while, and you 'Meccans' will return 'to disbelief'

¹⁶"Then' on the Day We will deal 'you' the fiercest blow, We will surely inflict punishment

¹⁷Indeed, before them We tested Pharaoh's people: a noble messenger came to them

¹⁸"proclaiming,' "Hand over the servants of Allah to me. I am truly a trustworthy messenger to you

¹⁹And do not be arrogant with Allah. I have certainly come to you with a compelling proof

²⁰And indeed, I seek refuge with my Lord and your Lord so you do not stone me 'to death'

²¹'But' if you do not believe me, then let me be."

²²Ultimately, he cried out to his Lord, "These are a wicked people!"

²³'Allah responded,' "Leave with My servants at night, for you will surely be pursued

²⁴And leave the sea parted, for they are certainly an army bound to drown."

²⁵'Imagine' how many gardens and springs the tyrants left behind

²⁶as well as 'various' crops and splendid residences

²⁷and luxuries which they fully enjoyed

²⁸So it was. And We awarded it 'all' to another people

²⁹Neither heaven nor earth wept over them, nor was their fate delayed

³⁰And We certainly delivered the Children of Israel from the humiliating torment

³¹of Pharaoh. He was truly a tyrant, a transgressor

³²And indeed, We chose the Israelites knowingly above the others

³³And We showed them signs in which there was a clear test

³⁴Indeed, these 'Meccans' say

³⁵"There is nothing beyond our first death, and we will never be resurrected

³⁶Bring 'back' our forefathers, if what you say is true."

³⁷Are they superior to the people of Tubba' and those before them? We destroyed them 'all', 'for' they were truly wicked

³⁸We did not create the heavens and the earth and everything in between for sport

³⁹We only created them for a purpose, but most of these 'pagans' do not know

⁴⁰Surely the Day of 'Final' Decision is the time appointed for all—

⁴¹the Day no kith or kin will be of benefit to another whatsoever, nor will they be helped

⁴²except those shown mercy by Allah. He is truly the Almighty, Most Merciful

⁴³Surely 'the fruit of' the tree of Zaqqûm

⁴⁴will be the food of the evildoer

⁴⁵Like molten metal, it will boil in the bellies

⁴⁶like the boiling of hot water

⁴⁷It will be said, "Seize them and drag them into the depths of the Hellfire

⁴⁸Then pour over their heads the torment of boiling water."

⁴⁹The wicked will be told, "Taste this. You mighty, noble one

⁵⁰This is truly what you 'all' used to doubt."

⁵¹Indeed, the righteous will be in a secure place

⁵²amid Gardens and springs

⁵³dressed in fine silk and rich brocade, facing one another

⁵⁴So it will be. And We will pair them to maidens with gorgeous eyes

⁵⁵There they will call for every fruit in serenity

⁵⁶There they will never taste death, beyond the first death. And He will protect them from the punishment of the Hellfire—

⁵⁷as 'an act of' grace from your Lord. That is 'truly' the ultimate triumph

⁵⁸Indeed, We have made this 'Quran' easy in your own language 'O Prophet' so perhaps they will be mindful

⁵⁹Wait then! They too are certainly waiting

Al-Jāthiyah

The Kneeling • 37 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mīm

²The revelation of this Book is from Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise

³Surely in ‘the creation of’ the heavens and the earth are signs for the believers

⁴And in your own creation, and whatever living beings He dispersed, are signs for people of sure faith

⁵And ‘in’ the alternation of the day and the night, the provision sent down from the skies by Allah—reviving the earth after its death—and the shifting of the winds, are signs for people of understanding

⁶These are Allah’s revelations which We recite to you ‘O Prophet’ in truth. So what message will they believe in after ‘denying’ Allah and His revelations

⁷Woe to every sinful liar

⁸They hear Allah's revelations recited to them, then persist 'in denial' arrogantly as if they did not hear them. So give them good news of a painful punishment

⁹And whenever they learn anything of Our revelations, they make a mockery of it. It is they who will suffer a humiliating punishment

¹⁰Awaiting them is Hell. Their 'worldly' gains will not be of any benefit to them whatsoever, nor will those protectors they have taken besides Allah. And they will suffer a tremendous punishment

¹¹This 'Quran' is 'true' guidance. And those who deny their Lord's revelations will suffer the 'worst' torment of agonizing pain

¹²Allah is the One Who has subjected the sea for you so that ships may sail upon it by His command, and that you may seek His bounty, and that perhaps you will be grateful

¹³He 'also' subjected for you whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth—all by His grace. Surely in this are signs for people who reflect

¹⁴‘O Prophet!’ Tell the believers to forgive those who do not fear Allah’s days ‘of torment’, so that He will reward each group for what they used to commit

¹⁵Whoever does good, it is to their own benefit. And whoever does evil, it is to their own loss. Then to your Lord you will ‘all’ be returned

¹⁶Indeed, We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, wisdom, and prophethood; granted them good, lawful provisions; and favoured them above the others

¹⁷We ‘also’ gave them clear commandments regarding ‘their’ faith. But it was not until knowledge came to them that they differed out of mutual envy. Surely your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Judgment regarding their differences

¹⁸Now We have set you ‘O Prophet’ on the ‘clear’ Way of faith. So follow it, and do not follow the desires of those who do not know ‘the truth’

¹⁹They certainly can be of no benefit to you against Allah whatsoever. Surely the wrongdoers are patrons of each other, whereas Allah is the Patron of the righteous

²⁰This 'Quran' is an insight for humanity—a guide and mercy for people of sure faith

²¹Or do those who commit evil deeds 'simply' think that We will make them equal—in their life and after their death—to those who believe and do good? How wrong is their judgment

²²For Allah created the heavens and the earth for a purpose, so that every soul may be paid back for what it has committed. And none will be wronged

²³Have you seen 'O Prophet' those who have taken their own desires as their god? 'And so' Allah left them to stray knowingly, sealed their hearing and hearts, and placed a cover on their sight. Who then can guide them after Allah? Will you 'all' not then be mindful

²⁴And they argue, "There is nothing beyond our worldly life. We die; others are born. And nothing destroys us but 'the passage of' time." Yet they have no knowledge 'in support' of this 'claim'. They only speculate

²⁵And whenever Our clear revelations are recited to them, their only argument is to say: "Bring our forefathers back, if what you say is true!"

²⁶Say, 'O Prophet, '“It is' Allah 'Who' gives you life, then causes you to die, then will gather you 'all' on the Day of Judgment, about which there is no doubt. But most people do not know.”

²⁷To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. On the Day the Hour will be established, the people of falsehood will then be in 'total' loss

²⁸And you will see every faith-community on its knees. Every community will be summoned to its record 'of deeds'. 'They all will be told,' “This Day you will be rewarded for what you used to do

²⁹This record of Ours speaks the truth about you. Indeed, We always had your deeds recorded 'by the angels'.”

³⁰As for those who believed and did good, their Lord will admit them into His mercy. That is 'truly' the absolute triumph

³¹And as for those who disbelieved, 'they will be told,' “Were My revelations not recited to you, yet you acted arrogantly and were a wicked people

³²And whenever it was said 'to you', 'Surely Allah's promise 'of judgment' is true and there is no doubt about the Hour,' you said 'mockingly', 'We do not know what the Hour is! We

think it is no more than speculation, and we are not convinced 'that it will ever come'."

³³And the evil 'consequences' of their deeds will unfold before them, and they will be overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

³⁴It will be said, "This Day We will neglect you as you neglected the meeting of this Day of yours! Your home will be the Fire, and you will have no helpers

³⁵This is because you made a mockery of Allah's revelations, and were deluded by 'your' worldly life." So 'from' that Day 'on' they will not be taken out of the Fire, nor will they be allowed to appease 'their Lord'

³⁶So all praise is for Allah—Lord of the heavens and Lord of the earth, Lord of all worlds

³⁷To Him belongs 'all' Majesty in the heavens and the earth. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

Al-Aḥqāf

The Sand Dunes • 35 verses

¹Ḥâ-Mīm

²The revelation of this Book is from Allah—the Almighty, All-Wise

³We only created the heavens and the earth and everything in between for a purpose and an appointed term. Yet the disbelievers are turning away from what they have been warned about

⁴Ask ‘them, O Prophet’, “Have you considered whatever ‘idols’ you invoke besides Allah? Show me what they have created on earth! Or do they have a share in ‘the creation of’ the heavens? Bring me a scripture ‘revealed’ before this ‘Quran’ or a shred of knowledge, if what you say is true.”

⁵And who could be more astray than those who call upon others besides Allah—‘others’ that cannot respond to them

until the Day of Judgment, and are 'even' unaware of their calls

⁶And when 'such' people will be gathered together, those 'gods' will be their enemies and will disown their worship

⁷Whenever Our clear revelations are recited to them, the disbelievers say of the truth when it has come to them, "This is pure magic."

⁸Or do they say, "He has fabricated this 'Quran'!"? Say, 'O Prophet,' "If I have done so, then there is nothing whatsoever you can do to save me from Allah. He knows best what 'slurs' you indulge about it. Sufficient is He as a Witness between you and me. And He is the All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

⁹Say, "I am not the first messenger ever sent, nor do I know what will happen to me or you. I only follow what is revealed to me. And I am only sent with a clear warning."

¹⁰Ask 'them, O Prophet', "Consider if this 'Quran' is 'truly' from Allah and you deny it, and a witness from the Children of Israel attests to it and then believes, whereas you act arrogantly. Surely Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people."

¹¹The disbelievers say of the believers, "Had it been 'something' good, they would not have beaten us to it." Now since

they reject its guidance, they will say, “‘This is’ an ancient fabrication!”

¹²And before this ‘Quran’ the Book of Moses was ‘revealed as’ a guide and mercy. And this Book is a confirmation, in the Arabic tongue, to warn those who do wrong, and as good news to those who do good

¹³Surely those who say, “Our Lord is Allah,” and then remain steadfast—there will be no fear for them, nor will they grieve

¹⁴It is they who will be the residents of Paradise, staying there forever, as a reward for what they used to do

¹⁵We have commanded people to honour their parents. Their mothers bore them in hardship and delivered them in hardship. Their ‘period of’ bearing and weaning is thirty months. In time, when the child reaches their prime at the age of forty, they pray, “My Lord! Inspire me to ‘always’ be thankful for Your favours which You blessed me and my parents with, and to do good deeds that please You. And instil righteousness in my offspring. I truly repent to You, and I truly submit ‘to Your Will’.”

¹⁶It is from these ‘people’ that We will accept the good they did, and overlook their misdeeds—along with the residents

of Paradise, 'in fulfilment of' the true promise they have been given

¹⁷But some scold their parents, "Enough with you! Are you warning me that I will be brought forth 'from the grave', while many generations had already perished before me 'for good'?" The parents cry to Allah for help, 'and warn their child,' "Pity you. Have faith! Surely Allah's promise is true." But the deniers insist, "This is nothing but ancient fables."

¹⁸These are the ones against whom the fate of earlier communities of jinn and humans has been justified, 'for' they were truly losers

¹⁹Each 'of the two groups' will be ranked according to what they have done so He may fully reward all. And none will be wronged

²⁰'Watch for' the Day 'when' the disbelievers will be exposed to the Fire. 'They will be told,' "You 'already' exhausted your 'share of' pleasures during your worldly life, and 'fully' enjoyed them. So Today you will be rewarded with the torment of disgrace for your arrogance throughout the land with no right, and for your rebelliousness."

²¹And remember the brother of 'Âd, when he warned his people, who inhabited the sand-hills—there were certainly

warners before and after him—‘saying,’ “Worship none but Allah. I truly fear for you the torment of a tremendous day.”

²²They argued, “Have you come to turn us away from our gods? Bring us then whatever you threaten us with, if what you say is true.”

²³He responded, “The knowledge ‘of its time’ is only with Allah. I only convey to you what I have been sent with. But I can see that you are a people acting ignorantly.”

²⁴Then when they saw the torment as a ‘dense’ cloud approaching their valleys, they said ‘happily’, “This is a cloud bringing us rain.” ‘But Hûd replied,’ “No, it is what you sought to hasten: a ‘fierce’ wind carrying a painful punishment!”

²⁵It destroyed everything by the command of its Lord, leaving nothing visible except their ruins. This is how We reward the wicked people

²⁶Indeed, We had established them in a way We have not established you ‘Meccans’. And We gave them hearing, sight, and intellect. But neither their hearing, sight, nor intellect were of any benefit to them whatsoever, since they persisted in denying Allah’s signs. And ‘so’ they were overwhelmed by what they used to ridicule

²⁷We certainly destroyed the societies around you after having varied the signs so perhaps they would return 'to the Right Path'

²⁸Why then did those 'idols' they took as gods—hoping to get closer 'to Him'—not come to their aid? Instead, they failed them. That is 'the result of' their lies and their fabrications

²⁹'Remember, O Prophet,' when We sent a group of jinn your way to listen to the Quran. Then, upon hearing it, they said 'to one another', "Listen quietly!" Then when it was over, they returned to their fellow jinn as warners

³⁰They declared, "O our fellow jinn! We have truly heard a scripture revealed after Moses, confirming what came before it. It guides to the truth and the Straight Way

³¹O our fellow jinn! Respond to the caller of Allah and believe in him, He will forgive your sins and protect you from a painful punishment

³²And whoever does not respond to the caller of Allah will have no escape on earth, nor will they have any protectors against Him. It is they who are clearly astray."

³³Do they not realize that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth and did not tire in creating them, is able to give

life to the dead? Yes 'indeed'! He is certainly Most Capable of everything

³⁴And on the Day the disbelievers will be exposed to the Fire, 'they will be asked,' "Is this 'Hereafter' not the truth?" They will cry, "Absolutely, by our Lord!" It will be said, "Then taste the punishment for your disbelief."

³⁵So endure patiently, as did the Messengers of Firm Resolve. And do not 'seek to' hasten 'the torment' for the deniers. On the Day they see what they have been threatened with, it will be as if they had only stayed 'in this world' for an hour of a day. 'This is' a 'sufficient' warning! Then, will anyone be destroyed except the rebellious people

Muḥammad

Muḥammad • 38 verses

¹Those who disbelieve and hinder ‘others’ from the Way of Allah, He will render their deeds void

²As for those who believe, do good, and have faith in what has been revealed to Muḥammad—which is the truth from their Lord—He will absolve them of their sins and improve their condition

³This is because the disbelievers follow falsehood, while the believers follow the truth from their Lord. This is how Allah shows people their true state ‘of faith’

⁴So when you meet the disbelievers ‘in battle’, strike ‘their’ necks until you have thoroughly subdued them, then bind them firmly. Later ‘free them either as’ an act of grace or by ransom until the war comes to an end. So will it be. Had Allah willed, He ‘Himself’ could have inflicted punishment on them. But He does ‘this only to’ test some of you by means

of others. And those who are martyred in the cause of Allah, He will never render their deeds void

⁵He will guide them 'to their reward', improve their condition

⁶and admit them into Paradise, having made it known to them

⁷O believers! If you stand up for Allah, He will help you and make your steps firm

⁸As for the disbelievers, may they be doomed and may He render their deeds void

⁹That is because they detest what Allah has revealed, so He has rendered their deeds void

¹⁰Have they not travelled throughout the land to see what was the end of those before them? Allah annihilated them, and a similar fate awaits the disbelievers

¹¹This is because Allah is the Patron of the believers while the disbelievers have no patron

¹²Surely Allah will admit those who believe and do good into Gardens under which rivers flow. As for the disbelievers, they enjoy themselves and feed like cattle. But the Fire will be their home

¹³Imagine, O Prophet, how many societies We destroyed that were far superior in might than your society—which drove you out—and there was none to help them

¹⁴Can those ‘believers’ who stand on clear proof from their Lord be like those whose evil deeds are made appealing to them and ‘only’ follow their desires

¹⁵The description of the Paradise promised to the righteous is that in it are rivers of fresh water, rivers of milk that never changes in taste, rivers of wine delicious to drink, and rivers of pure honey. There they will ‘also’ have all kinds of fruit, and forgiveness from their Lord. ‘Can they be’ like those who will stay in the Fire forever, left to drink boiling water that will tear apart their insides

¹⁶There are some of them who listen to you ‘O Prophet’, but when they depart from you, they say ‘mockingly’ to those ‘believers’ gifted with knowledge, “What did he just say?” These are the ones whose hearts Allah has sealed and who ‘only’ follow their desires

¹⁷As for those who are ‘rightly’ guided, He increases them in guidance and blesses them with righteousness

¹⁸Are they only waiting for the Hour to take them by surprise? Yet 'some of' its signs have already come. Once it actually befalls them, will it not be too late to be mindful

¹⁹So, know 'well, O Prophet,' that there is no god 'worthy of worship' except Allah. And seek forgiveness for your shortcomings and for 'the sins of' the believing men and women. For Allah 'fully' knows your movements and places of rest 'O people'

²⁰And the believers say, "If only a sûrah was revealed 'allowing self-defence'!" Yet when a precise sûrah is revealed, in which fighting is 'explicitly' mentioned, you see those with sickness in their hearts staring at you like someone in the throes of death. It would have been better for them

²¹to obey and speak rightly. Then when fighting was ordained, it surely would have been better for them if they were true to Allah

²²Now if you 'hypocrites' turn away, perhaps you would then spread corruption throughout the land and sever your 'ties of' kinship

²³These are the ones who Allah has condemned, deafening them and blinding their eyes

²⁴Do they not then reflect on the Quran? Or are there locks upon their hearts

²⁵Indeed, those who relapse 'into disbelief' after 'true' guidance has become clear to them, 'it is' Satan 'that' has tempted them, luring them with false hopes

²⁶That is because they said 'privately' to those who 'also' detest what Allah has revealed, "We will obey you in some matters." But Allah 'fully' knows what they are hiding

²⁷Then how 'horrible' will it be when the angels take their souls, beating their faces and backs

²⁸This is because they follow whatever displeases Allah and hate whatever pleases Him, so He has rendered their deeds void

²⁹Or do those with sickness in their hearts think that Allah will not 'be able to' expose their malice

³⁰Had We willed, We could have truly shown them to you 'O Prophet', and you would have certainly recognized them by their appearance. But you will surely recognize them by their tone of speech. And Allah 'fully' knows your doings 'O people'

³¹We will certainly test you 'believers' until We prove those of you who 'truly' struggle 'in Allah's cause' and remain steadfast, and reveal how you conduct yourselves

³²Indeed, those who disbelieve, hinder 'others' from the Way of Allah, and defy the Messenger after 'true' guidance has become clear to them; they will not harm Allah in the least, but He will render their deeds void

³³O believers! Obey Allah and obey the Messenger, and do not let your deeds be in vain

³⁴Surely those who disbelieve, hinder 'others' from the Way of Allah, and then die as disbelievers; Allah will never forgive them

³⁵So do not falter or cry for peace, for you will have the upper hand and Allah is with you. And He will never let your deeds go to waste

³⁶This worldly life is no more than play and amusement. But if you are faithful and mindful 'of Allah', He will grant you your 'full' reward, and will not ask you 'to donate all' your wealth

³⁷If He were to do so and pressure you, you would withhold and He would bring out your resentment

³⁸Here you are, being invited to donate 'a little' in the cause of Allah. Still some of you withhold. And whoever does so, it is only to their own loss. For Allah is the Self-Sufficient, whereas you stand in need 'of Him'. If you 'still' turn away, He will replace you with another people. And they will not be like you

Al-Fath

The Triumph • 29 verses

¹Indeed, We have granted you a clear triumph 'O Prophet'

²so that Allah may forgive you for your past and future shortcomings, perfect His favour upon you, guide you along the Straight Path

³and so that Allah will help you tremendously

⁴He is the One Who sent down serenity upon the hearts of the believers so that they may increase even more in their faith. To Allah 'alone' belong the forces of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁵So He may admit believing men and women into Gardens under which rivers flow—to stay there forever—and absolve them of their sins. And that is a supreme achievement in the sight of Allah

⁶Also 'so that' He may punish hypocrite men and women and polytheistic men and women, who harbour evil thoughts of

Allah. May ill-fate befall them! Allah is displeased with them. He has condemned them and prepared for them Hell. What an evil destination

⁷To Allah 'alone' belong the forces of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

⁸Indeed, 'O Prophet,' We have sent you as a witness, a deliverer of good news, and a warner

⁹so that you 'believers' may have faith in Allah and His Messenger, support and honour him, and glorify Allah morning and evening

¹⁰Surely those who pledge allegiance to you 'O Prophet' are actually pledging allegiance to Allah. Allah's Hand is over theirs. Whoever breaks their pledge, it will only be to their own loss. And whoever fulfils their pledge to Allah, He will grant them a great reward

¹¹The nomadic Arabs, who stayed behind, will say to you 'O Prophet', "We were preoccupied with our wealth and families, so ask for forgiveness for us." They say with their tongues what is not in their hearts. Say, "Who then can stand between you and Allah in any way, if He intends harm or benefit for you? In fact, Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹²The truth is: you thought that the Messenger and the believers would never return to their families again. And that was made appealing in your hearts. You harboured evil thoughts 'about Allah', and 'so' became a doomed people."

¹³And whoever does not believe in Allah and His Messenger, then We surely have prepared for the disbelievers a blazing Fire

¹⁴To Allah 'alone' belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He forgives whoever He wills, and punishes whoever He wills. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁵Those who stayed behind will say, when you 'believers' set out to take the spoils of war, "Let us accompany you." They wish to change Allah's promise. Say, 'O Prophet,' "You will not accompany us. This is what Allah has said before." They will then say, "In fact, you are driven by jealousy against us!" The truth is: they can hardly comprehend

¹⁶Say to nomadic Arabs, who stayed behind, "You will be called 'to fight' against a people of great might, who you will fight unless they submit. If you then obey, Allah will grant you a fine reward. But if you turn away as you did before, He will inflict upon you a painful punishment."

¹⁷There is no blame on the blind, or the disabled, or the sick 'for staying behind'. And whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger will be admitted by Him into Gardens under which rivers flow. But whoever turns away will be subjected by Him to a painful punishment

¹⁸Indeed, Allah was pleased with the believers when they pledged allegiance to you 'O Prophet' under the tree. He knew what was in their hearts, so He sent down serenity upon them and rewarded them with a victory at hand

¹⁹and many spoils of war they will gain. For Allah is Almighty, All-Wise

²⁰Allah has promised you 'believers' abundant spoils, which you will gain, so He hastened this 'truce' for you. And He has held people's hands back from 'harming' you, so it may be a sign for the believers, and so He may guide you along the Straight Path

²¹And 'there are' other gains which are beyond your reach that Allah is keeping in store 'for you'. For Allah is Most Capable of everything

²²If the disbelievers were to fight you, they would certainly flee. Then they would never find any protector or helper

²³‘This is’ Allah’s way, already long established ‘in the past’.
And you will find no change in Allah’s way

²⁴He is the One Who held back their hands from you and your hands from them in the valley of ‘Ḥudaibiyah, near’ Mecca, after giving you the upper hand over ‘a group of’ them. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

²⁵They are the ones who persisted in disbelief and hindered you from the Sacred Mosque, preventing the sacrificial animals from reaching their destination. ‘We would have let you march through Mecca,’ had there not been believing men and women, unknown to you. You might have trampled them underfoot, incurring guilt for ‘what you did to’ them unknowingly. That was so Allah may admit into His mercy whoever He wills. Had those ‘unknown’ believers stood apart, We would have certainly inflicted a painful punishment on the disbelievers

²⁶‘Remember’ when the disbelievers had filled their hearts with pride—the pride of ‘pre-Islamic’ ignorance—then Allah sent down His serenity upon His Messenger and the believers, inspiring them to uphold the declaration of faith, for they were better entitled and more worthy of it. And Allah has ‘perfect’ knowledge of all things

²⁷Indeed, Allah will fulfil His Messenger's vision in all truth: Allah willing, you will surely enter the Sacred Mosque, in security—'some with' heads shaved and 'others with' hair shortened—without fear. He knew what you did not know, so He first granted you the triumph at hand

²⁸He is the One Who has sent His Messenger with 'right' guidance and the religion of truth, making it prevail over all others. And sufficient is Allah as a Witness

²⁹Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah. And those with him are firm with the disbelievers and compassionate with one another. You see them bowing and prostrating 'in prayer', seeking Allah's bounty and pleasure. The sign 'of brightness can be seen' on their faces from the trace of prostrating 'in prayer'. This is their description in the Torah. And their parable in the Gospel is that of a seed that sprouts its 'tiny' branches, making it strong. Then it becomes thick, standing firmly on its stem, to the delight of the planters—in this way Allah makes the believers a source of dismay for the disbelievers. To those of them who believe and do good, Allah has promised forgiveness and a great reward

Al-Hujurāt

The Private Quarters • 18 verses

¹O believers! Do not proceed 'in any matter' before 'a decree from' Allah and His Messenger. And fear Allah. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Knowing

²O believers! Do not raise your voices above the voice of the Prophet, nor speak loudly to him as you do to one another, or your deeds will become void while you are unaware

³Indeed, those who lower their voices in the presence of Allah's Messenger are the ones whose hearts Allah has refined for righteousness. They will have forgiveness and a great reward

⁴Indeed, most of those who call out to you 'O Prophet' from outside 'your' private quarters have no understanding 'of manners'

⁵Had they been patient until you could come out to them, it would have certainly been better for them. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁶O believers, if an evildoer brings you any news, verify 'it' so you do not harm people unknowingly, becoming regretful for what you have done

⁷And keep in mind that Allah's Messenger is 'still' in your midst. If he were to yield to you in many matters, you would surely suffer 'the consequences'. But Allah has endeared faith to you, making it appealing in your hearts. And He has made disbelief, rebelliousness, and disobedience detestable to you. Those are the ones rightly guided

⁸'This is' a bounty and a blessing from Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

⁹And if two groups of believers fight each other, then make peace between them. But if one of them transgresses against the other, then fight against the transgressing group until they 'are willing to' submit to the rule of Allah. If they do so, then make peace between both 'groups' in all fairness and act justly. Surely Allah loves those who uphold justice

¹⁰The believers are but one brotherhood, so make peace between your brothers. And be mindful of Allah so you may be shown mercy

¹¹O believers! Do not let some 'men' ridicule others, they may be better than them, nor let 'some' women ridicule other women, they may be better than them. Do not defame one another, nor call each other by offensive nicknames. How evil it is to act rebelliously after having faith! And whoever does not repent, it is they who are the 'true' wrongdoers

¹²O believers! Avoid many suspicions, 'for' indeed, some suspicions are sinful. And do not spy, nor backbite one another. Would any of you like to eat the flesh of their dead brother? You would despise that! And fear Allah. Surely Allah is 'the' Acceptor of Repentance, Most Merciful

¹³O humanity! Indeed, We created you from a male and a female, and made you into peoples and tribes so that you may 'get to' know one another. Surely the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous among you. Allah is truly All-Knowing, All-Aware

¹⁴'Some of' the nomadic Arabs say, "We believe." Say, 'O Prophet,' "You have not believed. But say, 'We have submitted,' for faith has not yet entered your hearts. But if you

obey Allah and His Messenger 'wholeheartedly', He will not discount anything from 'the reward of' your deeds. Allah is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

¹⁵The 'true' believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger—never doubting—and strive with their wealth and their lives in the cause of Allah. They are the ones true in faith

¹⁶Say, "Do you inform Allah of your faith, when Allah 'already' knows whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth? And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things."

¹⁷They regard their acceptance of Islam as a favour to you. Tell 'them, O Prophet', "Do not regard your Islam as a favour to me. Rather, it is Allah Who has done you a favour by guiding you to the faith, if 'indeed' you are faithful

¹⁸Surely Allah knows the unseen of the heavens and earth. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do."

Qāf

Qāf • 45 verses

¹Qāf. By the glorious Quran

²“All will be resurrected, yet the deniers are astonished that a warner has come to them from among themselves warning of resurrection”. So the disbelievers say, “This is an astonishing thing

³“Will we be returned to life, when we are dead and reduced to dust? Such a return is impossible.”

⁴We certainly know what the earth consumes of them after their death, and with us is a well-preserved Record

⁵In fact, they reject the truth when it has come to them, so they are in a confused state

⁶Have they not then looked at the sky above them: how We built it and adorned it with stars, leaving it flawless

⁷As for the earth, We spread it out and placed upon it firm mountains, and produced in it every type of pleasant plant—

⁸‘all as’ an insight and a reminder to every servant who turns
‘to Allah’

⁹And We send down blessed rain from the sky, bringing forth
gardens and grains for harvest

¹⁰and towering palm trees ‘loaded’ with clustered fruit

¹¹‘as’ a provision for ‘Our’ servants. And with this ‘rain’ We
revive a lifeless land. Similar is the emergence ‘from the
graves’

¹²Before them, the people of Noah denied ‘the truth,’ as did
the people of the Water-pit, Thamûd

¹³‘Âd, Pharaoh, the kinfolk of Lot

¹⁴the residents of the Forest, and the people of Tubba’. Each
rejected ‘their’ messenger, so My warning was fulfilled

¹⁵Were We incapable of creating ‘them’ the first time? In fact,
they are in doubt about ‘their’ re-creation

¹⁶Indeed, ‘it is’ We ‘Who’ created humankind and ‘fully’ know
what their souls whisper to them, and We are closer to them
than ‘their’ jugular vein

¹⁷As the two recording-angels—‘one’ sitting to the right, and
‘the other to’ the left—note ‘everything’

¹⁸not a word does a person utter without having a 'vigilant' observer ready 'to write it down'

¹⁹'Ultimately,' with the throes of death will come the truth. This is what you were trying to escape

²⁰And the Trumpet will be blown. This is the Day 'you were' warned of

²¹Each soul will come forth with an angel to drive it and another to testify

²²'It will be said to the denier,' "You were totally heedless of this. Now We have lifted this veil of yours, so Today your sight is sharp!"

²³And one's accompanying-angel will say, "Here is the record ready with me."

²⁴'It will be said to both angels,' "Throw into Hell every stubborn disbeliever

²⁵withholder of good, transgressor, and doubter

²⁶who set up another god with Allah. So cast them into the severe punishment."

²⁷One's 'devilish' associate will say, "Our Lord! I did not make them transgress. Rather, they were far astray 'on their own'."

²⁸Allah will respond, “Do not dispute in My presence, since I had already given you a warning

²⁹My Word cannot be changed, nor am I unjust to ‘My’ creation.”

³⁰‘Beware of’ the Day We will ask Hell, “Are you full ‘yet’?” And it will respond, “Are there any more?”

³¹And Paradise will be brought near to the righteous, not far off

³²‘And it will be said to them,’ “This is what you were promised, for whoever ‘constantly’ turned ‘to Allah’ and kept up ‘His commandments’—

³³who were in awe of the Most Compassionate without seeing ‘Him’, and have come with a heart turning ‘only to Him’

³⁴Enter it in peace. This is the Day of eternal life!”

³⁵There they will have whatever they desire, and with Us is ‘even’ more

³⁶‘Imagine’ how many peoples We destroyed before them, who were far mightier than them. Then ‘when the torment came,’ they ‘desperately’ sought refuge in the land. ‘But’ was there any escape

³⁷ Surely in this is a reminder for whoever has a 'mindful' heart and lends an attentive ear

³⁸ Indeed, We created the heavens and the earth and everything in between in six Days, and We were not 'even' touched with fatigue

³⁹ So be patient 'O Prophet' with what they say. And glorify the praises of your Lord before sunrise and before sunset

⁴⁰ And glorify Him during part of the night and after the prayers

⁴¹ And listen! On the Day the caller will call out from a near place

⁴² the Day all will hear the 'mighty' Blast in 'all' truth, that will be the Day of emergence 'from the graves'

⁴³ It is certainly We Who give life and cause death. And to Us is the final return

⁴⁴ 'Beware of' the Day the earth will split open, letting them rush forth. That will be an easy gathering for Us

⁴⁵ We know best what they say. And you 'O Prophet' are not 'there' to compel them 'to believe'. So remind with the Quran 'only' those who fear My warning

Adh-Dhāriyāt

The Scattering Winds • 60 verses

- ¹By the winds scattering 'dust'
²and 'the clouds' loaded with rain
³and 'the ships' gliding with ease
⁴and 'the angels' administering affairs by 'Allah's' command
⁵Indeed, what you are promised is true
⁶And the Judgment will certainly come to pass
⁷'And' by the heavens in their marvellous design
⁸Surely you are 'lost' in conflicting views 'regarding the truth'
⁹Only those 'destined to be' deluded are turned away from it
¹⁰Condemned are the liars—
¹¹those who are 'steeped' in ignorance, totally heedless
¹²They ask 'mockingly', "When is this Day of Judgment?"
¹³'It is' the Day they will be tormented over the Fire
¹⁴'They will be told,' "Taste your torment! This is what you sought to hasten."

- ¹⁵Indeed, the righteous will be amid Gardens and springs
¹⁶joyfully receiving what their Lord will grant them. Before
this reward they were truly good-doers in the world
¹⁷they used to sleep only little in the night
¹⁸and pray for forgiveness before dawn
¹⁹And in their wealth there was a rightful share fulfilled for
the beggar and the poor
²⁰There are countless signs on earth for those with sure faith
²¹as there are within yourselves. Can you not see
²²In heaven is your sustenance and whatever you are promised
²³Then by the Lord of heaven and earth! All this is certainly
as true as the fact that you can speak
²⁴Has the story of Abraham's honoured guests reached you
O Prophet
²⁵Remember when they entered his presence and greeted
him with, "Peace!" He replied, "Peace be upon you!" Then
he said to himself, "These are an unfamiliar people."
²⁶Then he slipped off to his family and brought a fat roasted
calf
²⁷and placed it before them, asking, "Will you not eat?"

²⁸They did not eat, so he grew fearful of them. They reassured him, “Do not be afraid,” and gave him good news of a knowledgeable son

²⁹Then his wife came forward with a cry, clasping her forehead in astonishment, exclaiming, “A baby from a barren, old woman!”

³⁰They replied, “Such has your Lord decreed. He is truly the All-Wise, All-Knowing.”

³¹Later, Abraham asked, “What is your mission, O messengers?”

³²They replied, “We have actually been sent to a wicked people

³³to send upon them stones of baked clay

³⁴marked by your Lord for the transgressors.”

³⁵Then before the torment We evacuated the believers from the city

³⁶But We only found one family that had submitted to Allah

³⁷And We have left a sign there as a lesson for those who fear the painful punishment

³⁸And in the story of Moses was another lesson, when We sent him to Pharaoh with compelling proof

³⁹but Pharaoh was carried away by his power, saying ‘of Moses’,
“A magician or a madman!”

⁴⁰So We seized him and his soldiers, casting them into the sea
while he was blameworthy

⁴¹And in ‘the story of’ ‘Âd ‘was another lesson,’ when We sent
against them the devastating wind

⁴²There was nothing it came upon that it did not reduce to
ashes

⁴³And in ‘the story of’ Thamûd ‘was another lesson,’ when
they were told, “Enjoy yourselves ‘only’ for a ‘short’ while.”

⁴⁴Still they persisted in defying the commands of their Lord,
so they were overtaken by a ‘mighty’ blast while they were
looking on

⁴⁵Then they were not able to rise up, nor were they helped

⁴⁶And the people of Noah ‘had also been destroyed’ earlier.
They were truly a rebellious people

⁴⁷We built the universe with ‘great’ might, and We are cer-
tainly expanding ‘it’

⁴⁸As for the earth, We spread it out. How superbly did We
smooth it out

⁴⁹And We created pairs of all things so perhaps you would be mindful

⁵⁰So 'proclaim, O Prophet': "Flee to Allah! I am truly sent by Him with a clear warning to you

⁵¹And do not set up another god with Allah. I am truly sent by Him with a clear warning to you."

⁵²Similarly, no messenger came to those before them without being told: "A magician or a madman!"

⁵³Have they passed this 'cliché' down to one another? In fact, they have 'all' been a transgressing people

⁵⁴So 'now' turn away from them 'O Prophet', for you will not be blamed

⁵⁵But 'continue to' remind. For certainly reminders benefit the believers

⁵⁶I did not create jinn and humans except to worship Me

⁵⁷I seek no provision from them, nor do I need them to feed Me

⁵⁸Indeed, Allah 'alone' is the Supreme Provider—Lord of all Power, Ever Mighty

⁵⁹The wrongdoers will certainly have a share 'of the torment' like that of their predecessors. So do not let them ask Me to hasten 'it'

⁶⁰Woe then to the disbelievers when they face their Day which they are warned of

At-Ṭūr

The Mount • 49 verses

¹By Mount Ṭūr

²And by the Book written

³on open pages ʿfor all to readʿ

⁴And by the ʿSacredʿ House frequently visited

⁵And by the canopy raised ʿhighʿ

⁶And by the seas set on fire

⁷Indeed, the punishment of your Lord will come to pass—

⁸none will avert it—

⁹on the Day the heavens will be shaken violently

¹⁰and the mountains will be blown away entirely

¹¹Then woe on that Day to the deniers—

¹²those who amuse themselves with falsehood

¹³ʿIt isʿ the Day they will be fiercely shoved into the Fire of Hell

¹⁴“They will be told, ‘This is the Fire which you used to deny

¹⁵Is this magic, or do you not see

¹⁶Burn in it! It is the same whether you endure ‘it’ patiently or not. You are only rewarded for what you used to do.”

¹⁷Indeed, the righteous will be in Gardens and bliss

¹⁸enjoying whatever their Lord will have granted them. And their Lord will have protected them from the torment of the Hellfire

¹⁹“They will be told, ‘Eat and drink happily for what you used to do.”

²⁰They will be reclining on thrones, ‘neatly’ lined up ‘facing each other’. And We will pair them to maidens with gorgeous eyes

²¹As for those who believe and whose descendants follow them in faith, We will elevate their descendants to their rank, never discounting anything ‘of the reward’ of their deeds. Every person will reap only what they sowed

²²And We will ‘continually’ provide them with whatever fruit or meat they desire

²³They will pass around to each other a drink ‘of pure wine,’ which leads to no idle talk or sinfulness

²⁴And they will be waited on by their youthful servants like spotless pearls

²⁵They will turn to one another inquisitively

²⁶They will say, “Before ‘this reward’ we used to be in awe ‘of Allah’ in the midst of our people

²⁷So Allah has graced us and protected us from the torment of ‘Hell’s’ scorching heat

²⁸Indeed, we used to call upon Him ‘alone’ before. He is truly the Most Kind, Most Merciful.”

²⁹So ‘continue to’ remind ‘all, O Prophet’. For you, by the grace of your Lord, are not a fortune-teller or a madman

³⁰Or do they say, “‘He is’ a poet, for whom we ‘eagerly’ await an ill-fate!”

³¹Say, “Keep waiting! I too am waiting with you.”

³²Or do their ‘intelligent’ minds prompt them to this ‘paradox’? Or are they ‘just’ a transgressing people

³³Or do they say, “He made this ‘Quran’ up!”? In fact, they have no faith

³⁴Let them then produce something like it, if what they say is true

³⁵Or were they created by nothing, or are they 'their own' creators

³⁶Or did they create the heavens and the earth? In fact, they have no firm belief 'in Allah'

³⁷Or do they possess the treasures of your Lord, or are they in control 'of everything'

³⁸Or do they have a stairway, by which they eavesdrop 'on the heavens'? Then let those who do so bring a compelling proof

³⁹Or does He have daughters 'as you claim', while you 'prefer to' have sons

⁴⁰Or are you 'O Prophet' asking them for a reward 'for the message' so that they are overburdened by debt

⁴¹Or do they have access to 'the Record in' the unseen, so they copy it 'for all to see'

⁴²Or do they intend to scheme 'against the Prophet'? Then it is the disbelievers who will fall victim to 'their' schemes

⁴³Or do they have a god other than Allah? Glorified is Allah far above what they associate 'with Him'

⁴⁴If they were to see a 'deadly' piece of the sky fall down 'upon them', still they would say, "'This is just' a pile of clouds."

⁴⁵So leave them until they face their Day in which they will be struck dead—

⁴⁶the Day their scheming will be of no benefit to them whatsoever, nor will they be helped

⁴⁷Also, the wrongdoers will certainly have another torment before that 'Day', but most of them do not know

⁴⁸So be patient with your Lord's decree, for you are truly under Our 'watchful' Eyes. And glorify the praises of your Lord when you rise

⁴⁹And glorify Him during part of the night and at the fading of the stars

An-Najm

The Stars • 62 verses

- ¹By the stars when they fade away
²Your fellow man is neither misguided nor astray
³Nor does he speak of his own whims
⁴It is only a revelation sent down 'to him'
⁵He has been taught by one 'angel' of mighty power
⁶and great perfection, who once rose to 'his' true form
⁷while on the highest point above the horizon
⁸then he approached 'the Prophet', coming so close
⁹that he was only two arms-lengths away or even less
¹⁰Then Allah revealed to His servant what He revealed 'through Gabriel'
¹¹The 'Prophet's' heart did not doubt what he saw
¹²How can you 'O pagans' then dispute with him regarding what he saw
¹³And he certainly saw that 'angel descend' a second time

¹⁴at the Lote Tree of the most extreme limit 'in the seventh heaven'—

¹⁵near which is the Garden of 'Eternal' Residence—

¹⁶while the Lote Tree was overwhelmed with 'heavenly' splendours

¹⁷The 'Prophet's' sight never wandered, nor did it overreach

¹⁸He certainly saw some of his Lord's greatest signs

¹⁹Now, have you considered 'the idols of' Lât and 'Uzza

²⁰and the third one, Manât, as well

²¹Do you 'prefer to' have sons while 'you attribute' to Him daughters

²²Then this is 'truly' a biased distribution

²³These 'idols' are mere names that you and your forefathers have made up—a practice Allah has never authorized. They follow nothing but 'inherited' assumptions and whatever 'their' souls desire, although 'true' guidance has already come to them from their Lord

²⁴Or should every person 'simply' have whatever 'intercessors' they desire

²⁵In fact, to Allah 'alone' belongs this world and the next

²⁶Imagine how many noble angels are in the heavens! Even their intercession would be of no benefit whatsoever, until Allah gives permission to whoever He wills and only for the people He approves

²⁷Indeed, those who do not believe in the Hereafter label angels as female

²⁸although they have no knowledge in support of this. They follow nothing but inherited assumptions. And surely assumptions can in no way replace the truth

²⁹So turn away O Prophet from whoever has shunned Our Reminder, only seeking the fleeting life of this world

³⁰This is the extent of their knowledge. Surely your Lord knows best who has strayed from His Way and who is rightly guided

³¹To Allah alone belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth so that He may reward the evildoers according to what they did, and reward the good-doers with the finest reward—

³²those who avoid major sins and shameful deeds, despite stumbling on minor sins. Surely your Lord is infinite in forgiveness. He knew well what would become of you as He cre-

ated you from the earth and while you were 'still' fetuses in the wombs of your mothers. So do not 'falsely' elevate yourselves. He knows best who is 'truly' righteous

³³Have you seen the one who turned away 'from Islam,'

³⁴and 'initially' paid a little 'for his salvation', and then stopped

³⁵Does he have the knowledge of the unseen so that he sees 'the Hereafter'

³⁶Or has he not been informed of what is in the Scripture of Moses

³⁷and 'that of' Abraham, who 'perfectly' fulfilled 'his covenant'

³⁸'They state' that no soul burdened with sin will bear the burden of another

³⁹and that each person will only have what they endeavoured towards

⁴⁰and that 'the outcome of' their endeavours will be seen 'in their record'

⁴¹then they will be fully rewarded

⁴²and that to your Lord 'alone' is the ultimate return 'of all things'

⁴³Moreover, He is the One Who brings about joy and sadness

⁴⁴And He is the One Who gives life and causes death

- ⁴⁵And He created the pairs—males and females—
⁴⁶from a sperm-drop when it is emitted
⁴⁷And it is upon Him to bring about re-creation
⁴⁸And He is the One Who enriches and impoverishes
⁴⁹And He alone is the Lord of Sirius
⁵⁰And He destroyed the first 'people of' 'Âd
⁵¹and 'then' Thamûd, sparing no one
⁵²And before 'that He destroyed' the people of Noah, who
were truly far worse in wrongdoing and transgression
⁵³And 'it was' He 'Who' turned the cities 'of Sodom and Go-
morrah' upside down
⁵⁴How overwhelming was what covered 'them'
⁵⁵Now, which of your Lord's favours will you dispute
⁵⁶This 'Prophet' is a warner like earlier ones
⁵⁷The approaching 'Hour' has drawn near
⁵⁸None but Allah can disclose it
⁵⁹Do you find this revelation astonishing
⁶⁰laughing 'at it' and not weeping 'in awe'
⁶¹while persisting in heedlessness
⁶²Instead, prostrate to Allah and worship 'Him alone'

Al-Qamar

The Moon • 55 verses

- ¹The Hour has drawn near and the moon was split 'in two'
- ²Yet, whenever they see a sign, they turn away, saying, "Same old magic!"
- ³They rejected 'the truth' and followed their own desires—
and every matter will be settled—
- ⁴even though the stories 'of destroyed nations' that have already come to them are a sufficient deterrent
- ⁵'This Quran is' profound 'in' wisdom, but warnings are of no benefit 'to them'
- ⁶So turn away from them 'O Prophet'. 'And wait for' the Day
'when' the caller will summon 'them' for something horrifying
- ⁷With eyes downcast, they will come forth from the graves
as if they were swarming locusts

⁸rushing towards the caller. The disbelievers will cry, “This is a difficult Day!”

⁹Before them, the people of Noah denied ‘the truth’ and rejected Our servant, calling ‘him’ insane. And he was intimidated

¹⁰So he cried out to his Lord, “I am helpless, so help ‘me’!”

¹¹So We opened the gates of the sky with pouring rain

¹²and caused the earth to burst with springs, so the waters met for a fate already set

¹³We carried him on that ‘Ark made’ of planks and nails

¹⁴sailing under Our ‘watchful’ Eyes—a ‘fair’ punishment on behalf of the one ‘they’ denied

¹⁵We certainly left this as a sign. So is there anyone who will be mindful

¹⁶Then how ‘dreadful’ were My punishment and warnings

¹⁷And We have certainly made the Quran easy to remember. So is there anyone who will be mindful

¹⁸‘Âd ‘also’ rejected ‘the truth’. Then how ‘dreadful’ were My punishment and warnings

¹⁹Indeed, We sent against them a furious wind, on a day of unrelenting misery

²⁰that snatched people up, leaving them like trunks of up-rooted palm trees

²¹Then how 'dreadful' were My punishment and warnings

²²And We have certainly made the Quran easy to remember.
So is there anyone who will be mindful

²³Thamûd rejected the warnings 'as well'

²⁴arguing, "How can we follow one 'average' human being from among us? We would then truly be misguided and insane

²⁵Has the revelation been sent down 'only' to him out of 'all of' us? In fact, he is a boastful liar."

²⁶"It was revealed to Şâlih," "They will soon know who the boastful liar is

²⁷We are sending the she-camel as a test for them. So watch them 'closely', and have patience

²⁸And tell them that the 'drinking' water must be divided between them 'and her', each taking a turn to drink 'every other day'."

²⁹But they roused a companion of theirs, so he dared to kill 'her'

³⁰Then how 'dreadful' were My punishment and warnings

³¹Indeed, We sent against them 'only' one 'mighty' blast, leaving them like the twigs of fence-builders

³²And We have certainly made the Quran easy to remember. So is there anyone who will be mindful

³³The people of Lot 'also' rejected the warnings

³⁴We unleashed upon them a storm of stones. As for 'the believers of' Lot's family, We delivered them before dawn

³⁵as a blessing from Us. This is how We reward whoever gives thanks

³⁶He had already warned them of Our 'crushing' blow but they disputed the warnings

³⁷And they even demanded his angel-guests from him, so We blinded their eyes. 'And they were told,' "Taste then My punishment and warnings!"

³⁸And indeed, by the early morning they were overwhelmed by an unrelenting torment

³⁹'Again they were told,' "Taste now My punishment and warnings!"

⁴⁰And We have certainly made the Quran easy to remember. So is there anyone who will be mindful

⁴¹And indeed, the warnings 'also' came to the people of Pharaoh

⁴²But they rejected all of Our signs, so We seized them with the 'crushing' grip of the Almighty, Most Powerful

⁴³Now, are you 'Meccan' disbelievers superior to those 'destroyed peoples'? Or have you 'been granted' immunity 'from punishment' in divine Books

⁴⁴Or do they say, "We are all 'a' united 'front', bound to prevail."

⁴⁵Soon their united front will be defeated and 'forced to' flee

⁴⁶Better yet, the Hour is their appointed time—and the Hour will be most catastrophic and most bitter

⁴⁷Indeed, the wicked are 'entrenched' in misguidance, and 'are bound for' blazes

⁴⁸On the Day they will be dragged into the Fire on their faces, 'they will be told,' "Taste the touch of Hell!"

⁴⁹Indeed, We have created everything, perfectly preordained

⁵⁰Our command is but a single word, done in the blink of an eye

⁵¹We have already destroyed the likes of you. So will any 'of you' be mindful

⁵²Everything they have done is 'listed' in 'their' records

⁵³Every matter, small and large, is written 'precisely'

⁵⁴Indeed, the righteous will be amid Gardens and rivers

⁵⁵at the Seat of Honour in the presence of the Most Powerful
Sovereign

Ar-Raḥmān

The Most Compassionate • 78 verses

- ¹The Most Compassionate
- ²taught the Quran
- ³created humanity
- ⁴and taught them speech
- ⁵The sun and the moon "travel" with precision
- ⁶The stars and the trees bow down "in submission"
- ⁷As for the sky, He raised it "high", and set the balance "of justice"
- ⁸so that you do not defraud the scales
- ⁹Weigh with justice, and do not give short measure
- ¹⁰He laid out the earth for all beings
- ¹¹In it are fruit, palm trees with date stalks
- ¹²and grain with husks, and aromatic plants
- ¹³Then which of your Lord's favours will you "humans and jinn" both deny

- ¹⁴He created humankind from 'sounding' clay like pottery
¹⁵and created jinn from a 'smokeless' flame of fire
¹⁶Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
¹⁷'He is' Lord of the two easts and the two wests
¹⁸Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
¹⁹He merges the two bodies of 'fresh and salt' water
²⁰yet between them is a barrier they never cross
²¹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
²²Out of both 'waters' come forth pearls and coral
²³Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
²⁴To Him belong the ships with raised sails, sailing through
the seas like mountains
²⁵Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
²⁶Every being on earth is bound to perish
²⁷Only your Lord Himself, full of Majesty and Honour, will
remain 'forever'
²⁸Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
²⁹All those in the heavens and the earth are dependent on
Him. Day in and day out He has something to bring about
³⁰Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

³¹We will soon attend to you 'for judgment', O two multitudes
'of jinn and humans'

³²Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

³³O assembly of jinn and humans! If you can penetrate beyond the realms of the heavens and the earth, then do so.
'But' you cannot do that without 'Our' authority

³⁴Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

³⁵Flames of fire and 'molten' copper will be sent against you,
and you will not be able to defend one another

³⁶Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

³⁷'How horrible will it be' when the heavens will split apart,
becoming rose-red like 'burnt' oil

³⁸Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

³⁹On that Day there will be no need for any human or jinn to
be asked about their sins

⁴⁰Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

⁴¹The wicked will be recognized by their appearance, then
will be seized by 'their' forelocks and feet

⁴²Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

⁴³'They will be told,' "This is the Hell which the wicked denied."

- ⁴⁴They will alternate between its flames and scalding water
- ⁴⁵Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁴⁶And whoever is in awe of standing before their Lord will have two Gardens
- ⁴⁷Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁴⁸'Both will be' with lush branches
- ⁴⁹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁵⁰In each 'Garden' will be two flowing springs
- ⁵¹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁵²In each will be two types of every fruit
- ⁵³Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁵⁴Those 'believers' will recline on furnishings lined with rich brocade. And the fruit of both Gardens will hang within reach
- ⁵⁵Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁵⁶In both 'Gardens' will be maidens of modest gaze, who no human or jinn has ever touched before
- ⁵⁷Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁵⁸Those 'maidens' will be 'as elegant' as rubies and coral
- ⁵⁹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
- ⁶⁰Is there any reward for goodness except goodness

- ⁶¹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁶²And below these two 'Gardens' will be two others
⁶³Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁶⁴Both will be dark green
⁶⁵Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁶⁶In each will be two gushing springs
⁶⁷Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁶⁸In both will be fruit, palm trees, and pomegranates
⁶⁹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁷⁰In all Gardens will be noble, pleasant mates
⁷¹Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁷²'They will be' maidens with gorgeous eyes, reserved in pavilions
⁷³Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁷⁴No human or jinn has ever touched these 'maidens' before
⁷⁵Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny
⁷⁶All 'believers' will be reclining on green cushions and splendid carpets
⁷⁷Then which of your Lord's favours will you both deny

⁷⁸Blessed is the Name of your Lord, full of Majesty and Honour

Al-Wāqī‘ah

The Inevitable Event • 96 verses

- ¹When the Inevitable Event takes place
²then no one can deny it has come
³It will debase ‘some’ and elevate ‘others’
⁴When the earth will be violently shaken
⁵and the mountains will be crushed to pieces
⁶becoming scattered ‘particles of’ dust
⁷you will ‘all’ be ‘divided into’ three groups
⁸the people of the right, how ‘blessed’ will they be
⁹the people of the left, how ‘miserable’ will they be
¹⁰and the foremost ‘in faith’ will be the foremost ‘in Paradise’
¹¹They are the ones nearest ‘to Allah’
¹²in the Gardens of Bliss
¹³‘They will be’ a multitude from earlier generations
¹⁴and a few from later generations

- 15^rAll will be^r on jewelled thrones
16^rreclining face to face
17^rThey will be waited on by eternal youths
18^rwith cups, pitchers, and a drink ^rof pure wine^r from a flowing stream
19^rthat will cause them neither headache nor intoxication
20^rThey will also be served^r any fruit they choose
21^rand meat from any bird they desire
22^rAnd ^rthey will have^r maidens with gorgeous eyes
23^rlike pristine pearls
24^rall^r as a reward for what they used to do
25^rThere they will never hear any idle or sinful talk—
26^ronly good and virtuous speech
27^rAnd the people of the right—how ^rblessed^r will they be
28^rThey will be^r amid thornless lote trees
29^rclusters of bananas
30^rextended shade
31^rflowing water
32^rabundant fruit—
33^rnever out of season nor forbidden—

³⁴and elevated furnishings

³⁵Indeed, We will have perfectly created their mates

³⁶making them virgins

³⁷loving and of equal age

³⁸for the people of the right

³⁹‘who will be’ a multitude from earlier generations

⁴⁰and a multitude from later generations

⁴¹And the people of the left—how ‘miserable’ will they be

⁴²‘They will be’ in scorching heat and boiling water

⁴³in the shade of black smoke

⁴⁴neither cool nor refreshing

⁴⁵Indeed, before this ‘torment’ they were spoiled by luxury

⁴⁶and persisted in the worst of sin

⁴⁷They used to ask ‘mockingly’, “When we are dead and reduced to dust and bones, will we really be resurrected

⁴⁸And our forefathers as well?”

⁴⁹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Most certainly, earlier and later generations

⁵⁰will surely be gathered ‘together’ for the appointed Day

⁵¹Then you, O misguided deniers

- ⁵²will certainly eat from 'the fruit of' the trees of Zaqqûm
⁵³filling up 'your' bellies with it
⁵⁴Then on top of that you will drink boiling water—
⁵⁵and you will drink 'it' like thirsty camels do.”
⁵⁶This will be their accommodation on the Day of Judgment
⁵⁷It is We Who created you. Will you not then believe 'in resurrection'
⁵⁸Have you considered what you ejaculate
⁵⁹Is it you who create 'a child out of' it, or is it We Who do so
⁶⁰We have ordained death for 'all of' you, and We cannot be prevented
⁶¹from transforming and recreating you in forms unknown to you
⁶²You already know how you were first created. Will you not then be mindful
⁶³Have you considered what you sow
⁶⁴Is it you who cause it to grow, or is it We Who do so
⁶⁵If We willed, We could simply reduce this 'harvest' to chaff, leaving you to lament
⁶⁶“We have truly suffered a 'great' loss
⁶⁷In fact, we have been deprived 'of our livelihood'.”

⁶⁸Have you considered the water you drink

⁶⁹Is it you who bring it down from the clouds, or is it We Who do so

⁷⁰If We willed, We could make it salty. Will you not then give thanks

⁷¹Have you considered the fire you kindle

⁷²Is it you who produce its trees, or is it We Who do so

⁷³We have made it 'as' a reminder 'of the Hellfire' and a provision for the travellers

⁷⁴So glorify the Name of your Lord, the Greatest

⁷⁵So I do swear by the positions of the stars—

⁷⁶and this, if only you knew, is indeed a great oath—

⁷⁷that this is truly a noble Quran

⁷⁸in a well-preserved Record

⁷⁹touched by none except the purified 'angels'

⁸⁰'It is' a revelation from the Lord of all worlds

⁸¹How can you then take this message lightly

⁸²and repay 'Allah for' your provisions with denial

⁸³Why then 'are you helpless' when the soul 'of a dying person' reaches 'their' throat

⁸⁴while you are looking on

⁸⁵And We are nearer to such a person than you, but you cannot see

⁸⁶Now, if you are not subject to Our Will 'as you claim'

⁸⁷bring that soul back, if what you say is true

⁸⁸So, if the deceased is one of those brought near 'to Us'

⁸⁹then 'such a person will have' serenity, fragrance, and a Garden of Bliss

⁹⁰And if the deceased is one of the people of the right

⁹¹then 'they will be told,' "Greetings to you from the people of the right."

⁹²But if such person is one of the misguided deniers

⁹³then their accommodation will be boiling water 'to drink'

⁹⁴and burning in Hellfire

⁹⁵Indeed, this is the absolute truth

⁹⁶So glorify the Name of your Lord, the Greatest

Al-Ḥadīd

Iron • 29 verses

¹Whatever is in the heavens and the earth glorifies Allah, for He is the Almighty, All-Wise

²To Him belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He gives life and causes death. And He is Most Capable of everything

³He is the First and the Last, the Most High and Most Near, and He has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

⁴He is the One Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days, then established Himself on the Throne. He knows whatever goes into the earth and whatever comes out of it, and whatever descends from the sky and whatever ascends into it. And He is with you wherever you are. For Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

⁵To Him belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. And to Allah all matters are returned

⁶He merges the night into day and the day into night. And He knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁷Believe in Allah and His Messenger, and donate from what He has entrusted you with. So those of you who believe and donate will have a mighty reward

⁸Why do you not believe in Allah while the Messenger is inviting you to have faith in your Lord, although He has already taken your covenant, if you will ever believe

⁹He is the One Who sends down clear revelations to His servant to bring you out of darkness and into light. For indeed Allah is Ever Gracious and Most Merciful to you

¹⁰And why should you not spend in the cause of Allah, while Allah is the 'sole' inheritor of the heavens and the earth? Those of you who donated and fought before the victory 'over Mecca' are unparalleled. They are far greater in rank than those who donated and fought afterwards. Yet Allah has promised each a fine reward. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹¹Who is it that will lend to Allah a good loan which Allah will multiply 'many times over' for them, and they will have an honourable reward

¹²On that Day you will see believing men and women with their light shining ahead of them and on their right. 'They will be told,' "Today you have good news of Gardens, under which rivers flow, 'for you' to stay in forever. This is 'truly' the ultimate triumph."

¹³On that Day hypocrite men and women will beg the believers, "Wait for us so that we may have some of your light." It will be said 'mockingly', "Go back 'to the world' and seek a light 'there'!" Then a 'separating' wall with a gate will be erected between them. On the near side will be grace and on the far side will be torment

¹⁴The tormented will cry out to those graced, "Were we not with you?" They will reply, "Yes 'you were'. But you chose to be tempted 'by hypocrisy', 'eagerly' awaited 'our demise', doubted 'the truth', and were deluded by false hopes until Allah's decree 'of your death' came to pass. And 'so' the Chief Deceiver deceived you about Allah

¹⁵So Today no ransom will be accepted from you 'hypocrites', nor from the disbelievers. Your home is the Fire—it is the 'only' fitting place for you. What an evil destination!"

¹⁶Has the time not yet come for believers' hearts to be humbled at the remembrance of Allah and what has been revealed

of the truth, and not be like those given the Scripture before—
‘those’ who were spoiled for so long that their hearts became
hardened. And many of them are ‘still’ rebellious

¹⁷Know that Allah revives the earth after its death. We have
certainly made the signs clear for you so perhaps you will
understand

¹⁸Indeed, those men and women who give in charity and lend
to Allah a good loan will have it multiplied for them, and they
will have an honourable reward

¹⁹‘As for’ those who believe in Allah and His messengers, it
is they who are ‘truly’ the people of truth. And the martyrs,
with their Lord, will have their reward and their light. But
‘as for’ those who disbelieve and reject Our signs, it is they
who will be the residents of the Hellfire

²⁰Know that this worldly life is no more than play, amuse-
ment, luxury, mutual boasting, and competition in wealth
and children. This is like rain that causes plants to grow, to
the delight of the planters. But later the plants dry up and
you see them wither; then they are reduced to chaff. And in
the Hereafter there will be either severe punishment or for-
giveness and pleasure of Allah, whereas the life of this world
is no more than the delusion of enjoyment

²¹‘So’ compete with one another for forgiveness from your Lord and a Paradise as vast as the heavens and the earth, prepared for those who believe in Allah and His messengers. This is the favour of Allah. He grants it to whoever He wills. And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

²²No calamity ‘or blessing’ occurs on earth or in yourselves without being ‘written’ in a Record before We bring it into being. This is certainly easy for Allah

²³‘We let you know this’ so that you neither grieve over what you have missed nor boast over what He has granted you. For Allah does not like whoever is arrogant, boastful—

²⁴those who are stingy and promote stinginess among people. And whoever turns away ‘should know that’ Allah ‘alone’ is truly the Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

²⁵Indeed, We sent Our messengers with clear proofs, and with them We sent down the Scripture and the balance ‘of justice’ so that people may administer justice. And We sent down iron with its great might, benefits for humanity, and means for Allah to prove who ‘is willing to’ stand up for Him and His messengers without seeing Him. Surely Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty

²⁶And indeed, We sent Noah and Abraham and reserved prophethood and revelation for their descendants. Some of them are 'rightly' guided, while most are rebellious

²⁷Then in the footsteps of these 'prophets', We sent Our messengers, and 'after them' We sent Jesus, son of Mary, and granted him the Gospel, and instilled compassion and mercy into the hearts of his followers. As for monasticism, they made it up—We never ordained it for them—only seeking to please Allah, yet they did not 'even' observe it strictly. So We rewarded those of them who were faithful. But most of them are rebellious

²⁸O people of faith! Fear Allah and believe in His Messenger. 'And' He will grant you a double share of His mercy, provide you with a light to walk in 'on Judgment Day', and forgive you. For Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²⁹'This is so' that the People of the Book 'who deny the Prophet' may know that they do not have any control over Allah's grace, and that all grace is in Allah's Hands. He grants it to whoever He wills. For Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

Al-Mujādilah

The Plea • 22 verses

¹Indeed, Allah has heard the argument of the woman who pleaded with you 'O Prophet' concerning her husband, and appealed to Allah. Allah has heard your exchange. Surely Allah is All-Hearing, All-Seeing

²Those of you who 'sinfully' divorce their wives by comparing them to their mothers 'should know that' their wives are in no way their mothers. None can be their mothers except those who gave birth to them. What they say is certainly detestable and false. Yet Allah is truly Ever-Pardoning, All-Forgiving

³Those who divorce their wives in this manner, then 'wish to' retract what they said, must free a slave before they touch each other. This 'penalty' is meant to deter you. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

⁴But if the husband cannot afford this, let him then fast two consecutive months before the couple touch each other. But

if he is unable 'to fast', then let him feed sixty poor people. This is to re-affirm your faith in Allah and His Messenger. These are the limits set by Allah. And the disbelievers will suffer a painful punishment

⁵Indeed, those who defy Allah and His Messenger will be debased, just like those before them. We have certainly sent down clear revelations. And the disbelievers will suffer a humiliating punishment

⁶On the Day Allah resurrects them all together, He will then inform them of what they have done. Allah has kept account of it all, while they have forgotten it. For Allah is a Witness over all things

⁷Do you not see that Allah knows whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth? If three converse privately, He is their fourth. If five, He is their sixth. Whether fewer or more, He is with them wherever they may be. Then, on the Day of Judgment, He will inform them of what they have done. Surely Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of all things

⁸Have you not seen those who were forbidden from secret talks, yet they 'always' return to what they were forbidden from, conspiring in sin, aggression, and disobedience to the Messenger? And when they come to you 'O Prophet', they

greet you not as Allah greets you, and say to one another, “Why does Allah not punish us for what we say?” Hell is enough for them—they will burn in it. And what an evil destination

⁹O believers! When you converse privately, let it not be for sin, aggression, or disobedience to the Messenger, but let it be for goodness and righteousness. And fear Allah, to Whom you will ‘all’ be gathered

¹⁰Secret talks are only inspired by Satan to grieve the believers. Yet he cannot harm them whatsoever except by Allah’s Will. So in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹¹O believers! When you are told to make room in gatherings, then do so. Allah will make room for you ‘in His grace’. And if you are told to rise, then do so. Allah will elevate those of you who are faithful, and ‘raise’ those gifted with knowledge in rank. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹²O believers! When you consult the Messenger privately, give something in charity before your consultation. That is better and purer for you. But if you lack the means, then Allah is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹³Are you afraid of spending in charity before your private consultations ‘with him’? Since you are unable to do so, and

Allah has turned to you in mercy, then 'continue to' establish prayer, pay alms-tax, and obey Allah and His Messenger. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹⁴Have you not seen those 'hypocrites' who ally themselves with a people with whom Allah is displeased? They are neither with you nor with them. And they swear to lies knowingly

¹⁵Allah has prepared for them a severe punishment. Evil indeed is what they do

¹⁶They have made their 'false' oaths as a shield, hindering 'others' from the cause of Allah. So they will suffer a humiliating punishment

¹⁷Neither their wealth nor children will be of any help to them against Allah whatsoever. It is they who will be the residents of the Fire. They will be there forever

¹⁸On the Day Allah resurrects them all, they will 'falsely' swear to Him as they swear to you, thinking they have something to stand on. Indeed, it is they who are the 'total' liars

¹⁹Satan has taken hold of them, causing them to forget the remembrance of Allah. They are the party of Satan. Surely Satan's party is bound to lose

²⁰As for those who defy Allah and His Messenger, they will definitely be among the most debased

²¹Allah has decreed, “I and My messengers will certainly prevail.” Surely Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty

²²You will never find a people who truly believe in Allah and the Last Day loyal to those who defy Allah and His Messenger, even if they were their parents, children, siblings, or extended family. For those believers, Allah has instilled faith in their hearts and strengthened them with a spirit from Him. He will admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there forever. Allah is pleased with them and they are pleased with Him. They are the party of Allah. Indeed, Allah’s party is bound to succeed

Al-Hashr

The Gathering • 24 verses

¹Whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth glorifies Allah. For He is the Almighty, All-Wise

²He is the One Who expelled the disbelievers of the People of the Book from their homes for 'their' first banishment 'ever'. You never thought they would go. And they thought their strongholds would put them out of Allah's reach. But 'the decree of' Allah came upon them from where they never expected. And He cast horror into their hearts so they destroyed their houses with their own hands and the hands of the believers. So take a lesson 'from this', O people of insight

³Had Allah not decreed exile for them, He would have certainly punished them in this world. And in the Hereafter they will suffer the punishment of the Fire

⁴This is because they defied Allah and His Messenger. And whoever defies Allah, then Allah is truly severe in punishment

⁵Whatever palm trees you 'believers' cut down or left standing intact, it was 'all' by Allah's Will, so that He might disgrace the rebellious

⁶As for the gains Allah has turned over to His Messenger from them—you did not 'even' spur on any horse or camel for such gains. But Allah gives authority to His messengers over whoever He wills. For Allah is Most Capable of everything

⁷As for gains granted by Allah to His Messenger from the people of 'other' lands, they are for Allah and the Messenger, his close relatives, orphans, the poor, and 'needy' travellers so that wealth may not merely circulate among your rich. Whatever the Messenger gives you, take it. And whatever he forbids you from, leave it. And fear Allah. Surely Allah is severe in punishment

⁸'Some of the gains will be' for poor emigrants who were driven out of their homes and wealth, seeking Allah's bounty and pleasure, and standing up for Allah and His Messenger. They are the ones true in faith

⁹As for those who had settled in the city and 'embraced' the faith before 'the arrival of' the emigrants, they love whoever immigrates to them, never having a desire in their hearts for whatever 'of the gains' is given to the emigrants. They give

‘the emigrants’ preference over themselves even though they may be in need. And whoever is saved from the selfishness of their own souls, it is they who are ‘truly’ successful

¹⁰And those who come after them will pray, “Our Lord! Forgive us and our fellow believers who preceded us in faith, and do not allow bitterness into our hearts towards those who believe. Our Lord! Indeed, You are Ever Gracious, Most Merciful.”

¹¹Have you ‘O Prophet’ not seen the hypocrites who say to their fellow disbelievers from the People of the Book, “If you are expelled, we will certainly leave with you, and We will never obey anyone against you. And if you are fought against, we will surely help you.”? But Allah bears witness that they are truly liars

¹²Indeed, if they are expelled, the hypocrites will never leave with them. And if they are fought against, the hypocrites will never help them. And even if the hypocrites did so, they would certainly flee, then the disbelievers would be left with no help

¹³Indeed, there is more fear in their hearts for you ‘believers’ than for Allah. That is because they are a people who do not comprehend

¹⁴Even united, they would not 'dare' fight against you except 'from' within fortified strongholds or from behind walls. Their malice for each other is intense: you think they are united, yet their hearts are divided. That is because they are a people with no 'real' understanding

¹⁵They are 'both just' like those who recently went down before them: they tasted the evil consequences of their doings. And they will suffer a painful punishment

¹⁶'They are' like Satan when he lures someone to disbelieve. Then after they have done so, he will say 'on Judgment Day', "I have absolutely nothing to do with you. I truly fear Allah—the Lord of all worlds."

¹⁷So they will both end up in the Fire, staying there forever. That is the reward of the wrongdoers

¹⁸O believers! Be mindful of Allah and let every soul look to what 'deeds' it has sent forth for tomorrow. And fear Allah, 'for' certainly Allah is All-Aware of what you do

¹⁹And do not be like those who forgot Allah, so He made them forget themselves. It is they who are 'truly' rebellious

²⁰The residents of the Fire cannot be equal to the residents of Paradise. 'Only' the residents of Paradise will be successful

²¹Had We sent down this Quran upon a mountain, you would have certainly seen it humbled and torn apart in awe of Allah. We set forth such comparisons for people, 'so' perhaps they may reflect

²²He is Allah—there is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him: Knower of the seen and unseen. He is the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful

²³He is Allah—there is no god except Him: the King, the Most Holy, the All-Perfect, the Source of Serenity, the Watcher 'of all', the Almighty, the Supreme in Might, the Majestic. Glorified is Allah far above what they associate with Him 'in worship'

²⁴He is Allah: the Creator, the Inventor, the Shaper. He 'alone' has the Most Beautiful Names. Whatever is in the heavens and the earth 'constantly' glorifies Him. And He is the Almighty, All-Wise

Al-Mumtaḥanah

The Examined Woman • 13 verses

¹O believers! Do not take My enemies and yours as trusted allies, showing them affection even though they deny what has come to you of the truth. They drove the Messenger and yourselves out 'of Mecca', simply for your belief in Allah, your Lord. If you 'truly' emigrated to struggle in My cause and seek My pleasure, 'then do not take them as allies,' disclosing secrets 'of the believers' to the pagans out of affection for them, when I know best whatever you conceal and whatever you reveal. And whoever of you does this has truly strayed from the Right Way

²If they gain the upper hand over you, they would be your 'open' enemies, unleashing their hands and tongues to harm you, and wishing that you would abandon faith

³Neither your relatives nor children will benefit you on Judgment Day—He will decide between you 'all'. For Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

⁴You already have an excellent example in Abraham and those with him, when they said to their people, “We totally dissociate ourselves from you and ‘shun’ whatever ‘idols’ you worship besides Allah. We reject you. The enmity and hatred that has arisen between us and you will last until you believe in Allah alone.” The only exception is when Abraham said to his father, “I will seek forgiveness for you,” adding, “but I cannot protect you from Allah at all.” ‘The believers prayed,’ “Our Lord! In You we trust. And to You we ‘always’ turn. And to You is the final return

⁵Our Lord! Do not subject us to the persecution of the disbelievers. Forgive us, our Lord! You ‘alone’ are truly the Almighty, All-Wise.”

⁶You certainly have an excellent example in them for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day. But whoever turns away, then surely Allah ‘alone’ is the Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

⁷‘In time,’ Allah may bring about goodwill between you and those of them you ‘now’ hold as enemies. For Allah is Most Capable. And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

⁸Allah does not forbid you from dealing kindly and fairly with those who have neither fought nor driven you out of your homes. Surely Allah loves those who are fair

⁹Allah only forbids you from befriending those who have fought you for 'your' faith, driven you out of your homes, or supported 'others' in doing so. And whoever takes them as friends, then it is they who are the 'true' wrongdoers

¹⁰O believers! When the believing women come to you as emigrants, test their intentions—their faith is best known to Allah—and if you find them to be believers, then do not send them back to the disbelievers. These 'women' are not lawful 'wives' for the disbelievers, nor are the disbelievers lawful 'husbands' for them. 'But' repay the disbelievers whatever 'dowries' they had paid. And there is no blame on you if you marry these 'women' as long as you pay them their dowries. And do not hold on to marriage with polytheistic women. 'But' demand 'repayment of' whatever 'dowries' you had paid, and let the disbelievers do the same. That is the judgment of Allah—He judges between you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

¹¹And if any of your wives desert you to the disbelievers, and later you take spoils from them, then pay those whose wives

have gone, the equivalent of whatever 'dowry' they had paid. And be mindful of Allah, in Whom you believe

¹²O Prophet! When the believing women come to you, pledging to you that they will neither associate anything with Allah 'in worship', nor steal, nor fornicate, nor kill their children, nor falsely attribute 'illegitimate' children to their husbands, nor disobey you in what is right, then accept their pledge, and ask Allah to forgive them. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹³O believers! Do not ally yourselves with a people Allah is displeased with. They already have no hope for the Hereafter, just like the disbelievers lying in 'their' graves

Aṣ-Ṣaff

The Ranks • 14 verses

¹Whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth glorifies Allah. For He ‘alone’ is the Almighty, All-Wise

²O believers! Why do you say what you do not do

³How despicable it is in the sight of Allah that you say what you do not do

⁴Surely Allah loves those who fight in His cause in ‘solid’ ranks as if they were one concrete structure

⁵‘Remember, O Prophet,’ when Moses said to his people, “O my people! Why do you hurt me when you already know I am Allah’s messenger to you?” So when they ‘persistently’ deviated, Allah caused their hearts to deviate. For Allah does not guide the rebellious people

⁶And ‘remember’ when Jesus, son of Mary, said, “O children of Israel! I am truly Allah’s messenger to you, confirming the Torah which came before me, and giving good news of a

messenger after me whose name will be Aḥmad.” Yet when the Prophet came to them with clear proofs, they said, “This is pure magic.”

⁷Who does more wrong than the one who fabricates lies about Allah when invited to submit ‘to Him’? For Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

⁸They wish to extinguish Allah’s light with their mouths, but Allah will ‘certainly’ perfect His light, even to the dismay of the disbelievers

⁹He is the One Who has sent His Messenger with ‘true’ guidance and the religion of truth, making it prevail over all others, even to the dismay of the polytheists

¹⁰O believers! Shall I guide you to an exchange that will save you from a painful punishment

¹¹‘It is to’ have faith in Allah and His Messenger, and strive in the cause of Allah with your wealth and your lives. That is best for you, if only you knew

¹²He will forgive your sins, and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow, and ‘house you in’ splendid homes in the Gardens of Eternity. That is the ultimate triumph

¹³He will also give you⁷ another favour that you long for: help from Allah and an imminent victory. 'So' give good news 'O Prophet' to the believers

¹⁴O believers! Stand up for Allah, as Jesus, son of Mary, asked the disciples, "Who will stand up with me for Allah?" The disciples replied, "We will stand up for Allah." Then a group from the Children of Israel believed while another disbelieved. We then supported the believers against their enemies, so they prevailed

Al-Jumu‘ah

Friday • 11 verses

¹Whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth
‘constantly’ glorifies Allah—the King, the Most Holy, the Almighty,
the All-Wise

²He is the One Who raised for the illiterate ‘people’ a mes-
senger from among themselves—reciting to them His revela-
tions, purifying them, and teaching them the Book and wis-
dom, for indeed they had previously been clearly astray—

³along with others of them who have not yet joined them ‘in
faith’. For He is the Almighty, All-Wise

⁴This is the favour of Allah. He grants it to whoever He wills.
And Allah is the Lord of infinite bounty

⁵The example of those who were entrusted with ‘observing’
the Torah but failed to do so, is that of a donkey carrying
books. How evil is the example of those who reject Allah’s
signs! For Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people

⁶Say, 'O Prophet,' "O Jews! If you claim to be Allah's chosen 'people' out of all humanity, then wish for death, if what you say is true."

⁷But they will never wish for that because of what their hands have done. And Allah has 'perfect' knowledge of the wrongdoers

⁸Say, "The death you are running away from will inevitably come to you. Then you will be returned to the Knower of the seen and unseen, and He will inform you of what you used to do."

⁹O believers! When the call to prayer is made on Friday, then proceed 'diligently' to the remembrance of Allah and leave off 'your' business. That is best for you, if only you knew

¹⁰Once the prayer is over, disperse throughout the land and seek the bounty of Allah. And remember Allah often so you may be successful

¹¹When they saw the fanfare along with the caravan, they 'almost all' flocked to it, leaving you 'O Prophet' standing 'on the pulpit'. Say, "What is with Allah is far better than amusement and merchandise. And Allah is the Best Provider."

Al-Munāfiqūn

The Hypocrites • 11 verses

¹When the hypocrites come to you ‘O Prophet’, they say, “We bear witness that you are certainly the Messenger of Allah”—and surely Allah knows that you are His Messenger—but Allah bears witness that the hypocrites are truly liars

²They have made their ‘false’ oaths as a shield, hindering ‘others’ from the Way of Allah. Evil indeed is what they do

³This is because they believed and then abandoned faith. Therefore, their hearts have been sealed, so they do not comprehend

⁴When you see them, their appearance impresses you. And when they speak, you listen to their ‘impressive’ speech. But they are ‘just’ like ‘worthless’ planks of wood leaned ‘against a wall’. They think every cry is against them. They are the enemy, so beware of them. May Allah condemn them! How can they be deluded ‘from the truth’

⁵When it is said to them, “Come! The Messenger of Allah will pray for you to be forgiven,” they turn their heads ‘in disgust’, and you see them ‘O Prophet’ turn away in arrogance

⁶It is the same whether you pray for their forgiveness or not, Allah will not forgive them. Surely Allah does not guide the rebellious people

⁷They are the ones who say ‘to one another’, “Do not spend ‘anything’ on those ‘emigrants’ with the Messenger of Allah so that they will break away ‘from him’.” But to Allah ‘alone’ belong the treasuries of the heavens and the earth, yet the hypocrites do not comprehend

⁸They say, “If we return to Medina, the honourable will definitely expel the inferior.” But all honour and power belongs to Allah, His Messenger, and the believers, yet the hypocrites do not know

⁹O believers! Do not let your wealth or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah. For whoever does so, it is they who are the ‘true’ losers

¹⁰And donate from what We have provided for you before death comes to one of you, and you cry, “My Lord! If only You delayed me for a short while, I would give in charity and be one of the righteous.”

11 But Allah never delays a soul when its appointed time comes.
And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

At-Taghābun

The Mutual Loss and Gain • 18 verses

¹Whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth 'constantly' glorifies Allah. The kingdom is His, and all praise is for Him. For He is Most Capable of everything

²He is the One Who created you, yet some of you are disbelievers while some are believers. And Allah is All-Seeing of what you do

³He created the heavens and the earth for a purpose. He shaped you 'in the womb', perfecting your form. And to Him is the final return

⁴He knows whatever is in the heavens and the earth. And He knows whatever you conceal and whatever you reveal. For Allah knows best what is 'hidden' in the heart

⁵Have the stories of those who disbelieved before not reached you 'pagans'? They tasted the evil consequences of their doings, and they will suffer a painful punishment

⁶That was because their messengers used to come to them with clear proofs, but they said 'mockingly', "How can humans be our guides?" So they persisted in disbelief and turned away. And Allah was not in need 'of their faith'. For Allah is Self-Sufficient, Praiseworthy

⁷The disbelievers claim they will not be resurrected. Say, 'O Prophet,' "Yes, by my Lord, you will surely be resurrected, then you will certainly be informed of what you have done. And that is easy for Allah."

⁸So believe in Allah and His Messenger and in the Light We have revealed. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do

⁹"Consider" the Day He will gather you 'all' for the Day of Gathering—that will be the Day of mutual loss and gain. So whoever believes in Allah and does good, He will absolve them of their sins and admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. That is the ultimate triumph

¹⁰As for those who disbelieve and reject Our revelations, they will be the residents of the Fire, staying there forever. What an evil destination

¹¹No calamity befalls 'anyone' except by Allah's Will. And whoever has faith in Allah, He will 'rightly' guide their hearts

‘through adversity’. And Allah has ‘perfect’ knowledge of all things

¹²Obey Allah and obey the Messenger! But if you turn away, then Our Messenger’s duty is only to deliver ‘the message’ clearly

¹³Allah—there is no god ‘worthy of worship’ except Him. So in Allah let the believers put their trust

¹⁴O believers! Indeed, some of your spouses and children are enemies to you, so beware of them. But if you pardon, overlook, and forgive ‘their faults’, then Allah is truly All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

¹⁵Your wealth and children are only a test, but Allah ‘alone’ has a great reward

¹⁶So be mindful of Allah to the best of your ability, hear and obey, and spend in charity—that will be best for you. And whoever is saved from the selfishness of their own souls, it is they who are ‘truly’ successful

¹⁷If you lend to Allah a good loan, He will multiply it for you and forgive you. For Allah is Most Appreciative, Most Forbearing

18 He is the Knower of the seen and unseen—the Almighty,
All-Wise

Aṭ-Ṭalāq

Divorce • 12 verses

¹O Prophet! 'Instruct the believers:' When you 'intend to' divorce women, then divorce them with concern for their waiting period, and count it accurately. And fear Allah, your Lord. Do not force them out of their homes, nor should they leave—unless they commit a blatant misconduct. These are the limits set by Allah. And whoever transgresses Allah's limits has truly wronged his own soul. You never know, perhaps Allah will bring about a change 'of heart' later

²Then when they have 'almost' reached the end of their waiting period, either retain them honourably or separate from them honourably. And call two of your reliable men to witness 'either way'—and 'let the witnesses' bear true testimony for 'the sake of' Allah. This is enjoined on whoever has faith in Allah and the Last Day. And whoever is mindful of Allah, He will make a way out for them

³and provide for them from sources they could never imagine. And whoever puts their trust in Allah, then He 'alone' is sufficient for them. Certainly Allah achieves His Will. Allah has already set a destiny for everything

⁴As for your women past the age of menstruation, in case you do not know, their waiting period is three months, and those who have not menstruated as well. As for those who are pregnant, their waiting period ends with delivery. And whoever is mindful of Allah, He will make their matters easy for them

⁵This is the commandment of Allah, which He has revealed to you. And whoever is mindful of Allah, He will absolve them of their sins and reward them immensely

⁶Let them live where you live 'during their waiting period', according to your means. And do not harass them to make their stay unbearable. If they are pregnant, then maintain them until they deliver. And if they nurse your child, compensate them, and consult together courteously. But if you fail to reach an agreement, then another woman will nurse 'the child' for the father

⁷Let the man of wealth provide according to his means. As for the one with limited resources, let him provide according

to whatever Allah has given him. Allah does not require of any soul beyond what He has given it. After hardship, Allah will bring about ease

⁸‘Imagine’ how many societies rebelled against the commandments of their Lord and His messengers, so We called each ‘society’ to a severe account and subjected them to a horrible punishment

⁹So they tasted the evil consequences of their doings, and the outcome of their doings was ‘total’ loss

¹⁰Allah has ‘also’ prepared for them a severe punishment. So fear Allah, O people of reason and faith. Allah has indeed revealed to you a Reminder

¹¹‘and sent’ a messenger reciting to you Allah’s revelations, making things clear so that He may bring those who believe and do good out of darkness and into light. And whoever believes in Allah and does good will be admitted by Him into Gardens under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. Allah will have indeed granted them an excellent provision

¹²Allah is the One Who created seven heavens ‘in layers’, and likewise for the earth. The ‘divine’ command descends between them so you may know that Allah is Most Capable of

everything and that Allah certainly encompasses all things in
'His' knowledge

At-Taḥrīm

The Prohibition • 12 verses

¹O Prophet! Why do you prohibit 'yourself' from what Allah has made lawful to you, seeking to please your wives? And Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

²Allah has already ordained for you 'believers' the way to absolve yourselves from your oaths. For Allah is your Guardian. And He is the All-Knowing, All-Wise

³'Remember' when the Prophet had 'once' confided something to one of his wives, then when she disclosed it 'to another wife' and Allah made it known to him, he presented 'to her' part of what was disclosed and overlooked a part. So when he informed her of it, she exclaimed, "Who told you this?" He replied, "I was informed by the All-Knowing, All-Aware."

⁴'It will be better' if you 'wives' both turn to Allah in repentance, for your hearts have certainly faltered. But if you 'continue to' collaborate against him, then 'know that' Allah Him-

self is his Guardian. And Gabriel, the righteous believers, and the angels are 'all' his supporters as well

⁵Perhaps, if he were to divorce you 'all', his Lord would replace you with better wives who are submissive 'to Allah', faithful 'to Him', devout, repentant, dedicated to worship and fasting—previously married or virgins

⁶O believers! Protect yourselves and your families from a Fire whose fuel is people and stones, overseen by formidable and severe angels, who never disobey whatever Allah orders—always doing as commanded

⁷'The deniers will then be told,' "O disbelievers! Make no excuses this Day! You are only rewarded for what you used to do."

⁸O believers! Turn to Allah in sincere repentance, so your Lord may absolve you of your sins and admit you into Gardens, under which rivers flow, on the Day Allah will not disgrace the Prophet or the believers with him. Their light will shine ahead of them and on their right. They will say, "Our Lord! Perfect our light for us, and forgive us. 'For' You are truly Most Capable of everything."

⁹O Prophet! Struggle against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be firm with them. Hell will be their home. What an evil destination

¹⁰Allah sets forth an example for the disbelievers: the wife of Noah and the wife of Lot. Each was married to one of Our righteous servants, yet betrayed them. So their husbands were of no benefit to them against Allah whatsoever. Both were told, “Enter the Fire, along with the others!”

¹¹And Allah sets forth an example for the believers: the wife of Pharaoh, who prayed, “My Lord! Build me a house in Paradise near You, deliver me from Pharaoh and his ‘evil’ doing, and save me from the wrongdoing people.”

¹²‘There is’ also ‘the example of’ Mary, the daughter of ‘Imrân, who guarded her chastity, so We breathed into her ‘womb’ through Our angel ‘Gabriel’. She testified to the words of her Lord and His Scriptures, and was one of the ‘sincerely’ devout

Al-Mulk

The Sovereignty • 30 verses

¹Blessed is the One in Whose Hands rests all authority. And He is Most Capable of everything

²‘He is the One’ Who created death and life in order to test which of you is best in deeds. And He is the Almighty, All-Forgiving

³‘He is the One’ Who created seven heavens, one above the other. You will never see any imperfection in the creation of the Most Compassionate. So look again: do you see any flaws

⁴Then look again and again—your sight will return frustrated and weary

⁵And indeed, We adorned the lowest heaven with ‘stars like’ lamps, and made them ‘as missiles’ for stoning ‘eavesdropping’ devils, for whom We have also prepared the torment of the Blaze

⁶Those who disbelieve in their Lord will suffer the punishment of Hell. What an evil destination

⁷When they are tossed into it, they will hear its roaring as it boils over

⁸almost bursting in fury. Every time a group is cast into it, its keepers will ask them, “Did a warner not come to you?”

⁹They will reply, “Yes, a warner did come to us, but we denied and said, ‘Allah has revealed nothing. You are extremely astray.’”

¹⁰And they will lament, “If only we had listened and reasoned, we would not be among the residents of the Blaze!”

¹¹And so they will confess their sins. So away with the residents of the Blaze

¹²Indeed, those in awe of their Lord without seeing Him will have forgiveness and a mighty reward

¹³Whether you speak secretly or openly—He surely knows best what is ‘hidden’ in the heart

¹⁴How could He not know His Own creation? For He ‘alone’ is the Most Subtle, All-Aware

¹⁵He is the One Who smoothed out the earth for you, so move about in its regions and eat from His provisions. And to Him is the resurrection 'of all'

¹⁶Do you feel secure that the One Who is in heaven will not cause the earth to swallow you up as it quakes violently

¹⁷Or do you feel secure that the One Who is in heaven will not unleash upon you a storm of stones. Only then would you know how 'serious' My warning was

¹⁸And certainly those before them denied 'as well', then how severe was My response

¹⁹Have they not seen the birds above them, spreading and folding their wings? None holds them up except the Most Compassionate. Indeed, He is All-Seeing of everything

²⁰Also, which 'powerless' force will come to your help instead of the Most Compassionate? Indeed, the disbelievers are only 'lost' in delusion

²¹Or who is it that will provide for you if He withholds His provision? In fact, they persist in arrogance and aversion 'to the truth'

²²Who is 'rightly' guided: the one who crawls facedown or the one who walks upright on the Straight Path

²³Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “He is the One Who brought you into being and gave you hearing, sight, and intellect. ‘Yet’ you hardly give any thanks.”

²⁴‘Also’ say, “He is the One Who has dispersed you ‘all’ over the earth, and to Him you will ‘all’ be gathered.”

²⁵‘Still’ they ask ‘the believers’, “When will this threat come to pass, if what you say is true?”

²⁶Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “That knowledge is with Allah alone, and I am only sent with a clear warning.”

²⁷Then when they see the torment drawing near, the faces of the disbelievers will become gloomy, and it will be said ‘to them’, “This is what you claimed would never come.”

²⁸Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “Consider this: whether Allah causes me and those with me to die or shows us mercy, who will save the disbelievers from a painful punishment?”

²⁹Say, “He is the Most Compassionate—in Him ‘alone’ we believe, and in Him ‘alone’ we trust. You will soon know who is clearly astray.”

³⁰Say, “Consider this: if your water were to sink ‘into the earth’, then who ‘else’ could bring you flowing water?”

Al-Qalam

The Pen • 52 verses

- ¹Nūn. By the pen and what everyone writes
²By the grace of your Lord, you 'O Prophet' are not insane
³You will certainly have a never-ending reward
⁴And you are truly 'a man' of outstanding character
⁵Soon you and the pagans will see
⁶which of you is mad
⁷Surely your Lord 'alone' knows best who has strayed from
His Way and who is 'rightly' guided
⁸So do not give in to the deniers
⁹They wish you would compromise so they would yield 'to
you'
¹⁰And do not obey the despicable, vain oath-taker
¹¹slanderer, gossip-monger
¹²withholder of good, transgressor, evildoer
¹³brute, and—on top of all that—an illegitimate child

¹⁴Now, 'simply' because he has been blessed with 'abundant' wealth and children

¹⁵whenever Our revelations are recited to him, he says, "Ancient fables!"

¹⁶We will soon mark his snout

¹⁷Indeed, We have tested those 'Meccans' as We tested the owners of the garden—when they swore they would surely harvest 'all' its fruit in the early morning

¹⁸leaving no thought for Allah's Will

¹⁹Then it was struck by a torment from your Lord while they slept

²⁰so it was reduced to ashes

²¹Then by daybreak they called out to each other

²²'saying,' "Go early to your harvest, if you want to pick 'all' the fruit."

²³So they went off, whispering to one another

²⁴"Do not let any poor person enter your garden today."

²⁵And they proceeded early, totally fixated on their purpose

²⁶But when they saw it 'devastated', they cried, "We must have lost 'our' way

²⁷In fact, we have been deprived 'of our livelihood'."

²⁸The most sensible of them said, “Did I not urge you to say, ‘Allah willing.’?”

²⁹They replied, “Glory be to our Lord! We have truly been wrongdoers.”

³⁰Then they turned on each other, throwing blame

³¹They said, “Woe to us! We have certainly been transgressors

³²We trust our Lord will give us a better garden than this, ‘for’ we are indeed turning to our Lord with hope.”

³³That is the ‘way of Our’ punishment ‘in this world’. But the punishment of the Hereafter is certainly far worse, if only they knew

³⁴Indeed, the righteous will have the Gardens of Bliss with their Lord

³⁵Should We then treat those who have submitted like the wicked

³⁶What is the matter with you? How do you judge

³⁷Or do you have a scripture, in which you read

³⁸that you will have whatever you choose

³⁹Or do you have oaths binding on Us until the Day of Judgment that you will have whatever you decide

⁴⁰Ask them 'O Prophet' which of them can guarantee all that

⁴¹Or do they have associate-gods 'supporting this claim'? Then let them bring forth their associate-gods, if what they say is true

⁴²'Beware of' the Day the Shin 'of Allah' will be bared, and the wicked will be asked to prostrate, but they will not be able to do so

⁴³with eyes downcast, totally covered with disgrace. For they were 'always' called to prostrate 'in the world' when they were fully capable 'but they chose not to'

⁴⁴So leave to Me 'O Prophet' those who reject this message. We will gradually draw them to destruction in ways they cannot comprehend

⁴⁵I 'only' delay their end for a while, but My planning is flawless

⁴⁶Or are you asking them for a reward 'for the message' so that they are overburdened by debt

⁴⁷Or do they have access to 'the Record in' the unseen, so they copy it 'for all to see'

⁴⁸So be patient with your Lord's decree, and do not be like 'Jonah,' the Man of the Whale, who cried out 'to Allah', in total distress

⁴⁹Had he not been shown grace by his Lord, he would have certainly been cast onto the open 'shore', still blameworthy

⁵⁰Then his Lord chose him, making him one of the righteous

⁵¹The disbelievers would almost cut you down with their eyes when they hear 'you recite' the Reminder, and say, "He is certainly a madman."

⁵²But it is simply a reminder to the whole world

Al-Ḥāqqah

The Inevitable Hour • 52 verses

¹The Inevitable Hour

²What is the Inevitable Hour

³And what will make you realize what the Inevitable Hour is

⁴Both Thamûd and 'Âd denied the Striking Disaster

⁵As for Thamûd, they were destroyed by an overwhelming blast

⁶And as for 'Âd, they were destroyed by a furious, bitter wind

⁷which Allah unleashed on them non-stop for seven nights and eight days, so that you would have seen its people lying dead like trunks of uprooted palm trees

⁸Do you see any of them left alive

⁹Also, Pharaoh and those before him, and 'the people of' the overturned cities 'of Lot' indulged in sin

¹⁰each disobeying their Lord's messenger, so He seized them with a crushing grip

¹¹Indeed, when the floodwater had overflowed, We carried you in the floating Ark 'with Noah'

¹²so that We may make this a reminder to you, and that attentive ears may grasp it

¹³At last, when the Trumpet will be blown with one blast

¹⁴and the earth and mountains will be lifted up and crushed with one blow

¹⁵on that Day the Inevitable Event will have come to pass

¹⁶The sky will then be so torn that it will be frail

¹⁷with the angels on its sides. On that Day eight 'mighty angels' will bear the Throne of your Lord above them

¹⁸You will then be presented 'before Him for judgment', and none of your secrets will stay hidden

¹⁹As for those given their records in their right hand, they will cry 'happily', "Here 'everyone'! Read my record

²⁰I surely knew I would face my reckoning."

²¹They will be in a life of bliss

²²in an elevated Garden

²³whose fruit will hang within reach

²⁴"They will be told," "Eat and drink joyfully for what you did in the days gone by."

- ²⁵And as for those given their record in their left hand, they
will cry 'bitterly', "I wish I had not been given my record
²⁶nor known anything of my reckoning
²⁷I wish death was the end
²⁸My wealth has not benefited me
²⁹My authority has been stripped from me."
³⁰"It will be said," "Seize and shackle them
³¹then burn them in Hell
³²then tie them up with chains seventy arms long
³³For they never had faith in Allah, the Greatest
³⁴nor encouraged the feeding of the poor
³⁵So this Day they will have no close friend here
³⁶nor any food except 'oozing' pus
³⁷which none will eat except the evildoers."
³⁸Now, I do swear by whatever you see
³⁹and whatever you cannot see
⁴⁰Indeed, this 'Quran' is the recitation of a noble Messenger
⁴¹It is not the prose of a poet 'as you claim', 'yet' you hardly
have any faith

⁴²Nor is it the mumbling of a fortune-teller, 'yet' you are hardly mindful

⁴³'It is' a revelation from the Lord of all worlds

⁴⁴Had the Messenger made up something in Our Name

⁴⁵We would have certainly seized him by his right hand

⁴⁶then severed his aorta

⁴⁷and none of you could have shielded him 'from Us'

⁴⁸Indeed, this 'Quran' is a reminder to those mindful 'of Allah'

⁴⁹And We certainly know that some of you will persist in denial

⁵⁰and it will surely be a source of regret for the disbelievers

⁵¹And indeed, this 'Quran' is the absolute truth

⁵²So glorify the Name of your Lord, the Greatest

Al-Ma‘ārij

The Ascending Stairways • 44 verses

- ¹A challenger has demanded a punishment bound to come
²for the disbelievers—to be averted by none—
³from Allah, Lord of pathways of ‘heavenly’ ascent
⁴‘through which’ the angels and the ‘holy’ spirit will ascend
to Him on a Day fifty thousand years in length
⁵So endure ‘this denial, O Prophet,’ with beautiful patience
⁶They truly see this ‘Day’ as impossible
⁷but We see it as inevitable
⁸On that Day the sky will be like molten brass
⁹and the mountains like ‘tufts of’ wool
¹⁰And no close friend will ask ‘about’ their friends
¹¹‘although’ they will be made to see each other. The wicked
will wish to ransom themselves from the punishment of that
Day by their children
¹²their spouses, their siblings

- ¹³their clan that sheltered them
- ¹⁴and everyone on earth altogether, just to save themselves
- ¹⁵But no! There will certainly be a raging Flame
- ¹⁶ripping off scalps
- ¹⁷It will summon whoever turned their backs 'on Allah' and
turned away 'from the truth'
- ¹⁸and gathered and hoarded 'wealth'
- ¹⁹Indeed, humankind was created impatient
- ²⁰distressed when touched with evil
- ²¹and withholding when touched with good—
- ²²except those who pray
- ²³consistently performing their prayers
- ²⁴and who give the rightful share of their wealth
- ²⁵to the beggar and the poor
- ²⁶and who 'firmly' believe in the Day of Judgment
- ²⁷and those who fear the punishment of their Lord—
- ²⁸'knowing that' none should feel secure from their Lord's
punishment—
- ²⁹and those who guard their chastity

³⁰except with their wives or those 'bondwomen' in their possession, for then they are free from blame

³¹but whoever seeks beyond that are the transgressors

³²'The faithful are' also those who are true to their trusts and covenants

³³and who are honest in their testimony

³⁴and who are 'properly' observant of their prayers

³⁵These will be in Gardens, held in honour

³⁶So what is the matter with the disbelievers that they rush 'head-long' towards you 'O Prophet'

³⁷from the right and the left, in groups 'to mock you'

³⁸Does every one of them expect to be admitted into a Garden of Bliss

³⁹But no! Indeed, they 'already' know what We created them from

⁴⁰So, I do swear by the Lord of 'all' the points of sunrise and sunset that We are truly capable

⁴¹of replacing them with 'others' better than them, and We cannot be prevented 'from doing so'

⁴²So let them indulge 'in falsehood' and amuse 'themselves' until they face their Day, which they have been threatened with—

⁴³the Day they will come forth from the graves swiftly, as if racing to an idol 'for a blessing'

⁴⁴with eyes downcast, utterly covered with disgrace. That is the Day they have 'always' been warned of

Nūḥ

Noah • 28 verses

¹Indeed, We sent Noah to his people 'saying to him', "Warn your people before a painful punishment comes to them."

²Noah proclaimed, "O my people! I am truly sent to you with a clear warning

³worship Allah 'alone', fear Him, and obey me

⁴He will forgive your sins, and delay your end until the appointed time. Indeed, when the time set by Allah comes, it cannot be delayed, if only you knew!"

⁵He cried, "My Lord! I have surely called my people day and night

⁶but my calls only made them run farther away

⁷And whenever I invite them to be forgiven by You, they press their fingers into their ears, cover themselves with their clothes, persist 'in denial', and act very arrogantly

⁸Then I certainly called them openly

⁹then I surely preached to them publicly and privately
¹⁰saying, ‘Seek your Lord’s forgiveness, ‘for’ He is truly Most Forgiving

¹¹He will shower you with abundant rain

¹²supply you with wealth and children, and give you gardens as well as rivers

¹³What is the matter with you that you are not in awe of the Majesty of Allah

¹⁴when He truly created you in stages ‘of development’

¹⁵Do you not see how Allah created seven heavens, one above the other

¹⁶placing the moon within them as a ‘reflected’ light, and the sun as a ‘radiant’ lamp

¹⁷Allah ‘alone’ caused you to grow from the earth like a plant

¹⁸Then He will return you to it, and then simply bring you forth ‘again’

¹⁹And Allah ‘alone’ spread out the earth for you

²⁰to walk along its spacious pathways.”

²¹‘Eventually,’ Noah cried, “My Lord! They have certainly persisted in disobeying me, and followed ‘instead’ those ‘elite’

whose 'abundant' wealth and children only increase them in loss

²²and who have devised a tremendous plot

²³urging 'their followers', 'Do not abandon your idols—especially Wadd, Suwâ', Yaghûth, Ya'ûq, and Nasr.'

²⁴Those 'elite' have already led many astray. So 'O Lord', only allow the wrongdoers to stray farther away."

²⁵So because of their sins, they were drowned, then admitted into the Fire. And they found none to help them against Allah

²⁶Noah had prayed, "My Lord! Do not leave a single disbeliever on earth

²⁷For if You spare 'any of' them, they will certainly mislead Your servants, and give birth only to 'wicked' sinners, staunch disbelievers

²⁸My Lord! Forgive me, my parents, and whoever enters my house in faith, and 'all' believing men and women. And increase the wrongdoers only in destruction."

Al-Jinn

The Jinn • 28 verses

¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "It has been revealed to me that a group of jinn listened 'to the Quran,' and said 'to their fellow jinn': 'Indeed, we have heard a wondrous recitation

²It leads to Right Guidance so we believed in it, and we will never associate anyone with our Lord 'in worship'

³'Now, we believe that' our Lord—Exalted is His Majesty—has neither taken a mate nor offspring

⁴and that the foolish of us used to utter 'outrageous' falsehoods about Allah

⁵We certainly thought that humans and jinn would never speak lies about Allah

⁶And some men used to seek refuge with some jinn—so they increased each other in wickedness

⁷And those 'humans' thought, just like you 'jinn', that Allah would not resurrect anyone 'for judgment'

⁸‘Earlier’ we tried to reach heaven ‘for news’, only to find it filled with stern guards and shooting stars

⁹We used to take up positions there for eavesdropping, but whoever dares eavesdrop now will find a flare lying in wait for them

¹⁰Now, we have no clue whether evil is intended for those on earth, or their Lord intends for them what is right

¹¹Among us are those who are righteous and those who are less so. We have been of different factions

¹²‘Now,’ we truly know that we cannot frustrate Allah on earth, nor can we escape from Him ‘into heaven’

¹³When we heard the guidance ‘of the Quran’, we ‘readily’ believed in it. For whoever believes in their Lord will have no fear of being denied ‘a reward’ or wronged

¹⁴And among us are those who have submitted ‘to Allah’ and those who are deviant. So ‘as for’ those who submitted, it is they who have attained Right Guidance

¹⁵And as for the deviant, they will be fuel for Hell.”

¹⁶Had the deniers followed the Right Way, We would have certainly granted them abundant rain to drink—

¹⁷as a test for them. And whoever turns away from the remembrance of their Lord will be admitted by Him into an overwhelming punishment

¹⁸The places of worship are 'only' for Allah, so do not invoke anyone besides Him

¹⁹Yet when the servant of Allah stood up calling upon Him 'alone', the pagans almost swarmed over him

²⁰Say, 'O Prophet,' "I call only upon my Lord, associating none with Him 'in worship'."

²¹Say, "It is not in my power to harm or benefit you."

²²Say, "No one can protect me from Allah 'if I were to disobey Him', nor can I find any refuge other than Him

²³'My duty is' only to convey 'the truth' from Allah and 'deliver' His messages." And whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger will certainly be in the Fire of Hell, to stay there for ever and ever

²⁴Only when they see what they have been threatened with will they know who is weaker in helpers and inferior in manpower

²⁵Say, "I do not know if what you are promised is near or my Lord has set a distant time for it

²⁶He is the ʾKnower of the unseen, disclosing none of it to anyone

²⁷except messengers of His choice. Then He appoints angel-guards before and behind them

²⁸to ensure that the messengers fully deliver the messages of their Lord—though He ʾalreadyʾ knows all about them, and keeps account of everything.”

Al-Muzzammil

The Wrapped One • 20 verses

- ¹O you wrapped 'in your clothes'
²Stand all night 'in prayer' except a little—
³'pray' half the night, or a little less
⁴or a little more—and recite the Quran 'properly' in a measured way
⁵'For' We will soon send upon you a weighty revelation
⁶Indeed, worship in the night is more impactful and suitable for recitation
⁷For during the day you are over-occupied 'with worldly duties'
⁸'Always' remember the Name of your Lord, and devote yourself to Him wholeheartedly
⁹'He is the' Lord of the east and the west. There is no god 'worthy of worship' except Him, so take Him 'alone' as a Trustee of Affairs

¹⁰Be patient 'O Prophet' with what they say, and depart from them courteously

¹¹And leave to Me the deniers—the people of luxury—and bear with them for a little while

¹²'For' We certainly have shackles, a 'raging' Fire

¹³choking food, and a painful punishment 'in store for them'

¹⁴on the Day the earth and mountains will shake 'violently', and mountains will be 'reduced to' dunes of shifting sand

¹⁵Indeed, We have sent to you a messenger as a witness over you, just as We sent a messenger to Pharaoh

¹⁶But Pharaoh disobeyed the messenger, so We seized him with a stern grip

¹⁷If you 'pagans' persist in disbelief, then how will you guard yourselves against 'the horrors of' a Day which will turn children's hair grey

¹⁸It will 'even' cause the sky to split apart. His promise 'of judgment' must be fulfilled

¹⁹Surely this is a reminder. So let whoever wills take the 'Right' Way to their Lord

²⁰Surely your Lord knows that you 'O Prophet' stand 'in prayer' for nearly two-thirds of the night, or 'sometimes' half of it, or

a third, as do some of those with you. Allah 'alone' keeps a 'precise' measure of the day and night. He knows that you 'believers' are unable to endure this, and has turned to you in mercy. So recite 'in prayer' whatever you can from the Quran. He knows that some of you will be sick, some will be travelling throughout the land seeking Allah's bounty, and some fighting in the cause of Allah. So recite whatever you can from it. And 'continue to' perform 'regular' prayers, pay alms-tax, and lend to Allah a good loan. Whatever good you send forth for yourselves, you will find it with Allah far better and more rewarding. And seek Allah's forgiveness. Surely Allah is All-Forgiving, Most Merciful

Al-Muddaththir

The Covered One • 56 verses

- ¹O you covered up 'in your clothes'
- ²Arise and warn 'all'
- ³Revere your Lord 'alone'
- ⁴Purify your garments
- ⁵'Continue to' shun idols
- ⁶Do not do a favour expecting more 'in return'
- ⁷And persevere for 'the sake of' your Lord
- ⁸'For' when the Trumpet will be sounded
- ⁹that will 'truly' be a difficult Day—
- ¹⁰far from easy for the disbelievers
- ¹¹And leave to me 'O Prophet' the one I created all by Myself
- ¹²and granted him abundant wealth
- ¹³and children always by his side
- ¹⁴and made life very easy for him

¹⁵Yet he is hungry for more

¹⁶But no! 'For' he has been truly stubborn with Our revelations

¹⁷I will make his fate unbearable

¹⁸for he contemplated and determined 'a degrading label for the Quran'

¹⁹May he be condemned! How evil was what he determined

²⁰May he be condemned even more! How evil was what he determined

²¹Then he re-contemplated 'in frustration'

²²then frowned and scowled

²³then turned his back 'on the truth' and acted arrogantly

²⁴saying, "This 'Quran' is nothing but magic from the ancients

²⁵This is no more than the word of a man."

²⁶Soon I will burn him in Hell

²⁷And what will make you realize what Hell is

²⁸It does not let anyone live or die

²⁹scorching the skin

³⁰It is overseen by nineteen 'keepers'

³¹We have appointed only 'stern' angels as wardens of the Fire. And We have made their number only as a test for the disbelievers, so that the People of the Book will be certain, and the believers will increase in faith, and neither the People of the Book nor the believers will have any doubts, and so that those 'hypocrites' with sickness in their hearts and the disbelievers will argue, "What does Allah mean by such a number?" In this way Allah leaves whoever He wills to stray and guides whoever He wills. And none knows the forces of your Lord except He. And this 'description of Hell' is only a reminder to humanity

³²But no! By the moon

³³and the night as it retreats

³⁴and the day as it breaks

³⁵Surely Hell is one of the mightiest catastrophes—

³⁶a warning to humankind

³⁷to whichever of you chooses to take the lead or lag behind

³⁸Every soul will be detained for what it has done

³⁹except the people of the right

⁴⁰who will be in Gardens, asking one another

⁴¹about the wicked 'who will then be asked'

⁴²“What has landed you in Hell?”

⁴³They will reply, “We were not of those who prayed

⁴⁴nor did we feed the poor

⁴⁵We used to indulge ‘in falsehood’ along with others

⁴⁶and deny the Day of Judgment

⁴⁷until the inevitable came to us.”

⁴⁸So the pleas of intercessors will be of no benefit to them

⁴⁹Now, what is the matter with them that they are turning away from the reminder

⁵⁰as if they were spooked zebras

⁵¹fleeing from a lion

⁵²In fact, each one of them wishes to be given a ‘personal’ letter ‘from Allah’ for all ‘to read’

⁵³But no! In fact, they do not fear the Hereafter

⁵⁴Enough! Surely this ‘Quran’ is a reminder

⁵⁵So let whoever wills be mindful of it

⁵⁶But they cannot do so unless Allah wills. He ‘alone’ is worthy to be feared and entitled to forgive

Al-Qiyāmah

The Resurrection • 40 verses

- ¹I do swear by the Day of Judgment
- ²And I do swear by the self-reproaching soul
- ³Do people think We cannot reassemble their bones
- ⁴Yes 'indeed'! We are 'most' capable of restoring 'even' their very fingertips
- ⁵Still people want to deny what is yet to come
- ⁶asking 'mockingly', "When is this Day of Judgment?"
- ⁷But when the sight is stunned
- ⁸and the moon is dimmed
- ⁹and the sun and the moon are brought together
- ¹⁰on that Day one will cry, "Where is the escape?"
- ¹¹But no! There will be no refuge
- ¹²On that Day all will end up before your Lord
- ¹³All will then be informed of what they have sent forth and left behind

- ¹⁴In fact, people will testify against their own souls
¹⁵despite the excuses they come up with
¹⁶Do not rush your tongue trying to memorize 'a revelation of' the Quran
¹⁷It is certainly upon Us to 'make you' memorize and recite it
¹⁸So once We have recited a revelation 'through Gabriel', follow its recitation 'closely'
¹⁹Then it is surely upon Us to make it clear 'to you'
²⁰But no! In fact, you love this fleeting world
²¹and neglect the Hereafter
²²On that Day 'some' faces will be bright
²³looking at their Lord
²⁴And 'other' faces will be gloomy
²⁵anticipating something devastating to befall them
²⁶But no! 'Beware of the day' when the soul reaches the collar bone 'as it leaves'
²⁷and it will be said, "Is there any healer 'who can save this life'?"
²⁸And the dying person realizes it is 'their' time to depart
²⁹and 'then' their feet are tied together 'in a shroud'

- ³⁰On that day they will be driven to your Lord 'alone'
³¹This denier neither believed nor prayed
³²but persisted in denial and turned away
³³then went to their own people, walking boastfully
³⁴Woe to you, and more woe
³⁵Again, woe to you, and even more woe
³⁶Do people think they will be left without purpose
³⁷Were they not 'once' a sperm-drop emitted
³⁸Then they became a clinging clot 'of blood', then He developed and perfected their form
³⁹producing from it both sexes, male and female
⁴⁰Is such 'a Creator' unable to bring the dead back to life

Al-Insān

Humanity • 31 verses

- ¹Is there not a period of time when each human is nothing yet worth mentioning
- ²For indeed, We alone created humans from a drop of mixed fluids, in order to test them, so We made them hear and see
- ³We already showed them the Way, whether they choose to be grateful or ungrateful
- ⁴Indeed, We have prepared for the disbelievers chains, shackles, and a blazing Fire
- ⁵Indeed, the virtuous will have a drink of pure wine—flavoured with camphor—
- ⁶from a spring where Allah's servants will drink, flowing at their will
- ⁷They are those who fulfil their vows and fear a Day of sweeping horror

⁸and give food—despite their desire for it—to the poor, the orphan, and the captive

⁹saying to themselves, “We feed you only for the sake of Allah, seeking neither reward nor thanks from you

¹⁰We fear from our Lord a horribly distressful Day.”

¹¹So Allah will deliver them from the horror of that Day, and grant them radiance and joy

¹²and reward them for their perseverance with a Garden ‘in Paradise’ and ‘garments of’ silk

¹³There they will be reclining on ‘canopied’ couches, never seeing scorching heat or bitter cold

¹⁴The Garden’s shade will be right above them, and its fruit will be made very easy to reach

¹⁵They will be waited on with silver vessels and cups of crystal—

¹⁶crystalline silver, filled precisely as desired

¹⁷And they will be given a drink ‘of pure wine’ flavoured with ginger

¹⁸from a spring there, called Salsabîl

¹⁹They will be waited on by eternal youths. If you saw them, you would think they were scattered pearls

²⁰And if you looked around, you would see 'indescribable' bliss and a vast kingdom

²¹The virtuous will be 'dressed' in garments of fine green silk and rich brocade, and adorned with bracelets of silver, and their Lord will give them a purifying drink

²²'And they will be told,' "All this is surely a reward for you. Your striving has been appreciated."

²³Indeed, it is We Who have revealed the Quran to you 'O Prophet' in stages

²⁴So be patient with your Lord's decree, and do not yield to any evildoer or 'staunch' disbeliever from among them

²⁵'Always' remember the Name of your Lord morning and evening

²⁶and prostrate before Him during part of the night, and glorify Him long at night

²⁷Surely those 'pagans' love this fleeting world, 'totally' neglecting a weighty Day ahead of them

²⁸It is We Who created them and perfected their 'physical' form. But if We will, We can easily replace them with others

²⁹Surely this is a reminder. So let whoever wills take the 'Right' Way to their Lord

³⁰But you cannot will 'to do so' unless Allah wills. Indeed, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise

³¹He admits whoever He wills into His mercy. As for the wrongdoers, He has prepared for them a painful punishment

Al-Mursalāt

Those Sent Forth • 50 verses

- ¹By those 'winds' sent forth successively
²and those blowing violently
³and those scattering 'rainclouds' widely
⁴And 'by' those 'angels' fully distinguishing 'truth from falsehood'
⁵and those delivering revelation
⁶ending excuses and giving warnings
⁷Surely, what you are promised will come to pass
⁸So when the stars are put out
⁹and the sky is torn apart
¹⁰and the mountains are blown away
¹¹and the messengers' time 'to testify' comes up—
¹²for which Day has all this been set
¹³For the Day of 'Final' Decision

¹⁴And what will make you realize what the Day of Decision is

¹⁵Woe on that Day to the deniers

¹⁶Did We not destroy earlier disbelievers

¹⁷And We will make the later disbelievers follow them

¹⁸This is how We deal with the wicked

¹⁹Woe on that Day to the deniers

²⁰Did We not create you from a humble fluid

²¹placing it in a secure place

²²until an appointed time

²³We 'perfectly' ordained 'its development'. How excellent are We in doing so

²⁴Woe on that Day to the deniers

²⁵Have We not made the earth a lodging

²⁶for the living and the dead

²⁷and placed upon it towering, firm mountains, and given you fresh water to drink

²⁸Woe on that Day to the deniers

²⁹'The disbelievers will be told,' "Proceed into that 'Fire' which you used to deny

- ³⁰Proceed into the shade 'of smoke' which rises in three columns
³¹providing neither coolness nor shelter from the flames
³²Indeed, it hurls sparks 'as big' as huge castles
³³and 'as dark' as black camels."
³⁴Woe on that Day to the deniers
³⁵On that Day they will not 'be in a position to' speak
³⁶nor will they be permitted to offer excuses
³⁷Woe on that Day to the deniers
³⁸'They will be told by Allah,' "This is the Day of 'Final' Decision: We have gathered you along with earlier disbelievers 'for punishment'
³⁹So if you have a scheme 'to save yourselves', then use it against Me."
⁴⁰Woe on that Day to the deniers
⁴¹Indeed, the righteous will be amid 'cool' shade and springs
⁴²and any fruit they desire
⁴³'They will be told,' "Eat and drink happily for what you used to do."
⁴⁴Surely this is how We reward the good-doers
⁴⁵'But' woe on that Day to the deniers

⁴⁶“Eat and enjoy yourselves for a little while, ‘for’ you are truly wicked.”

⁴⁷Woe on that Day to the deniers

⁴⁸When it is said to them, “Bow down ‘before Allah,” they do not bow

⁴⁹Woe on that Day to the deniers

⁵⁰So what message after this ‘Quran’ would they believe in

An-Naba'

The Momentous News • 40 verses

- ¹What are they asking one another about
- ²About the momentous news
- ³over which they disagree
- ⁴But no! They will come to know
- ⁵Again, no! They will come to know
- ⁶Have We not smoothed out the earth 'like a bed'
- ⁷and 'made' the mountains as 'its' pegs
- ⁸and created you in pairs
- ⁹and made your sleep for rest
- ¹⁰and made the night as a cover
- ¹¹and made the day for livelihood
- ¹²and built above you seven mighty 'heavens'
- ¹³and placed 'in them' a shining lamp
- ¹⁴and sent down from rainclouds pouring water

¹⁵producing by it grain and 'various' plants

¹⁶and dense orchards

¹⁷Indeed, the Day of 'Final' Decision is an appointed time—

¹⁸'it is' the Day the Trumpet will be blown, and you will 'all' come forth in crowds

¹⁹The sky will be 'split' open, becoming 'many' gates

²⁰and the mountains will be blown away, becoming 'like' a mirage

²¹Indeed, Hell is lying in ambush

²²as a home for the transgressors

²³where they will remain for 'endless' ages

²⁴There they will not taste any coolness or drink

²⁵except boiling water and 'oozing' pus—

²⁶a fitting reward

²⁷For they never expected any reckoning

²⁸and totally rejected Our signs

²⁹And We have everything recorded precisely

³⁰'So the deniers will be told,' "Taste 'the punishment', for all you will get from Us is more torment."

³¹Indeed, the righteous will have salvation—

³²Gardens, vineyards

³³and full-bosomed maidens of equal age

³⁴and full cups 'of pure wine'

³⁵never to hear any idle talk or lying therein—

³⁶a 'fitting' reward as a generous gift from your Lord

³⁷the Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything in between, the Most Compassionate. No one will dare speak to Him

³⁸on the Day the 'holy' spirit and the angels will stand in ranks. None will talk, except those granted permission by the Most Compassionate and whose words are true

³⁹That Day is the 'ultimate' truth. So let whoever wills take the path leading back to their Lord

⁴⁰Indeed, We have warned you of an imminent punishment—the Day every person will see 'the consequences of' what their hands have done, and the disbelievers will cry, "I wish I were dust."

An-Nāzi‘āt

Those who Pull Out • 46 verses

- ¹By those ‘angels’ stripping out ‘evil souls’ harshly
²and those pulling out ‘good souls’ gently
³and those gliding ‘through heavens’ swiftly
⁴and those taking the lead vigorously
⁵and those conducting affairs ‘obediently’
⁶‘Consider’ the Day ‘when’ the quaking Blast will come to
pass
⁷followed by a second Blast
⁸‘The deniers’ hearts on that Day will be trembling ‘in hor-
ror’
⁹with their eyes downcast
¹⁰‘But now’ they ask ‘mockingly’, “Will we really be restored
to our former state
¹¹even after we have been reduced to decayed bones?”
¹²Adding, “Then such a return would be a ‘total’ loss ‘for us’!”

- ¹³But indeed, it will take only one 'mighty' Blast
¹⁴and at once they will be above ground
¹⁵Has the story of Moses reached you 'O Prophet'
¹⁶His Lord called him in the sacred valley of Ṭuwa
¹⁷'commanding, '“Go to Pharaoh, for he has truly transgressed
'all bounds'
¹⁸And say, 'Would you 'be willing to' purify yourself
¹⁹and let me guide you to your Lord so that you will be in awe
'of Him'?"'
²⁰Then Moses showed him the great sign
²¹but he denied and disobeyed 'Allah'
²²then turned his back, striving 'against the truth'
²³Then he summoned 'his people' and called out
²⁴saying, “I am your lord, the most high!”
²⁵So Allah overtook him, making him an example in this life
and the next
²⁶Surely in this is a lesson for whoever stands in awe of 'Al-
lah'
²⁷Which is harder to create: you or the sky? He built it
²⁸raising it high and forming it flawlessly

- 29 He dimmed its night, and brought forth its daylight
30 As for the earth, He spread it out as well
31 bringing forth its water and pastures
32 and setting the mountains firmly 'upon it'—
33 all as 'a means of' sustenance for you and your animals
34 But, when the Supreme Disaster comes to pass—
35 the Day every person will remember all 'their' striving
36 and the Hellfire will be displayed for all to see—
37 then as for those who transgressed
38 and preferred the 'fleeting' life of this world
39 the Hellfire will certainly be 'their' home
40 And as for those who were in awe of standing before their
Lord and restrained themselves from 'evil' desires
41 Paradise will certainly be 'their' home
42 They ask you 'O Prophet' regarding the Hour, "When will it
be?"
43 But it is not for you to tell its time
44 That knowledge rests with your Lord 'alone'
45 Your duty is only to warn whoever is in awe of it

⁴⁶On the Day they see it, it will be as if they had stayed 'in the world' no more than one evening or its morning

‘Abasa

He Frowned • 42 verses

- ¹He frowned and turned ‘his attention’ away
²‘simply’ because the blind man came to him ‘interrupting’
³You never know ‘O Prophet’, perhaps he may be purified
⁴or he may be mindful, benefitting from the reminder
⁵As for the one who was indifferent
⁶you gave him your ‘undivided’ attention
⁷even though you are not to blame if he would not be purified
⁸But as for the one who came to you, eager ‘to learn’
⁹being in awe ‘of Allah’
¹⁰you were inattentive to him
¹¹But no! This ‘revelation’ is truly a reminder
¹²So let whoever wills be mindful of it
¹³It is ‘written’ on pages held in honour—
¹⁴highly esteemed, purified—

- ¹⁵by the hands of angel-scribes
¹⁶honourable and virtuous
¹⁷Condemned are 'disbelieving' humans! How ungrateful they are 'to Allah'
¹⁸From what substance did He create them
¹⁹He created them from a sperm-drop, and ordained their development
²⁰Then He makes the way easy for them
²¹then causes them to die and be buried
²²Then when He wills, He will resurrect them
²³But no! They have failed to comply with what He ordered
²⁴Let people then consider their food
²⁵how We pour down rain in abundance
²⁶and meticulously split the earth open 'for sprouts'
²⁷causing grain to grow in it
²⁸as well as grapes and greens
²⁹and olives and palm trees
³⁰and dense orchards
³¹and fruit and fodder—
³²all as 'a means of' sustenance for you and your animals

- ³³Then, when the Deafening Blast comes to pass—
³⁴on that Day every person will flee from their own siblings
³⁵and 'even' their mother and father
³⁶and 'even' their spouse and children
³⁷For then everyone will have enough concern of their own
³⁸On that Day 'some' faces will be bright
³⁹laughing and rejoicing
⁴⁰while 'other' faces will be dusty
⁴¹cast in gloom—
⁴²those are the disbelievers, the 'wicked' sinners

At-Takwīr

The Folding Up • 29 verses

- ¹When the sun is put out
- ²and when the stars fall down
- ³and when the mountains are blown away
- ⁴and when pregnant camels are left untended
- ⁵and when wild beasts are gathered together
- ⁶and when the seas are set on fire
- ⁷and when the souls 'and their bodies' are paired 'once more'
- ⁸and when baby girls, buried alive, are asked
- ⁹for what crime they were put to death
- ¹⁰and when the records 'of deeds' are laid open
- ¹¹and when the sky is stripped away
- ¹²and when the Hellfire is fiercely flared up
- ¹³and when Paradise is brought near—
- ¹⁴'on that Day' each soul will know what 'deeds' it has brought along

- ¹⁵I do swear by the receding stars
¹⁶which travel and hide
¹⁷and the night as it falls
¹⁸and the day as it breaks
¹⁹Indeed, this 'Quran' is the Word of 'Allah delivered by Gabriel,'
a noble messenger-angel
²⁰full of power, held in honour by the Lord of the Throne
²¹obeyed there 'in heaven', and trustworthy
²²And your fellow man is not insane
²³And he did see that 'angel' on the clear horizon
²⁴and he does not withhold 'what is revealed to him of' the
unseen
²⁵And this 'Quran' is not the word of an outcast devil
²⁶So what 'other' path would you take
²⁷Surely this 'Quran' is only a reminder to the whole world—
²⁸to whoever of you wills to take the Straight Way
²⁹But you cannot will 'to do so', except by the Will of Allah,
the Lord of all worlds

Al-Infiṭār

The Splitting Apart • 19 verses

- ¹When the sky splits open
²and when the stars fall away
³and when the seas burst forth
⁴and when the graves spill out
⁵‘then’ each soul will know what it has sent forth or left behind
⁶O humanity! What has emboldened you against your Lord,
the Most Generous
⁷Who created you, fashioned you, and perfected your design
⁸moulding you in whatever form He willed
⁹But no! In fact, you deny the ‘final’ Judgment
¹⁰while you are certainly observed by vigilant
¹¹honourable angels, recording ‘everything’
¹²They know whatever you do
¹³Indeed, the virtuous will be in bliss

¹⁴and the wicked will be in Hell

¹⁵burning in it on Judgment Day

¹⁶and they will have no escape from it

¹⁷What will make you realize what Judgment Day is

¹⁸Again, what will make you realize what Judgment Day is

¹⁹‘It is’ the Day no soul will be of ‘any’ benefit to another whatsoever, for all authority on that Day belongs to Allah ‘entirely’

Al-Muṭaffifīn

The Defrauders • 36 verses

- ¹Woe to the defrauders
²Those who take full measure 'when they buy' from people
³but give less when they measure or weigh for buyers
⁴Do such people not think that they will be resurrected
⁵for a tremendous Day—
⁶the Day 'all' people will stand before the Lord of all worlds
⁷But no! The wicked are certainly bound for Sijjīn 'in the depths of Hell'—
⁸and what will make you realize what Sijjīn is?—
⁹a fate 'already' sealed
¹⁰Woe on that Day to the deniers—
¹¹those who deny Judgment Day
¹²None would deny it except every evildoing transgressor
¹³Whenever Our revelations are recited to them, they say,
"Ancient fables!"

¹⁴But no! In fact, their hearts have been stained by all 'the evil' they used to commit

¹⁵Undoubtedly, they will be sealed off from their Lord on that Day

¹⁶Moreover, they will surely burn in Hell

¹⁷and then be told, "This is what you used to deny."

¹⁸But no! The virtuous are certainly bound for 'Illiyûn 'in elevated Gardens'—

¹⁹and what will make you realize what 'Illiyûn is?—

²⁰a fate 'already' sealed

²¹witnessed by those nearest 'to Allah'

²²Surely the virtuous will be in bliss

²³'seated' on 'canopied' couches, gazing around

²⁴You will recognize on their faces the glow of delight

²⁵They will be given a drink of sealed, pure wine

²⁶whose last sip will smell like musk. So let whoever aspires to this strive 'diligently'

²⁷And this drink's flavour will come from Tasnîm—

²⁸a spring from which those nearest 'to Allah' will drink

²⁹Indeed, the wicked used to laugh at the believers

³⁰wink to one another whenever they passed by

³¹and muse 'over these exploits' upon returning to their own people

³²And when they saw the faithful, they would say, "These 'people' are truly astray,"

³³even though they were not sent as keepers over the believers

³⁴But on that Day the believers will be laughing at the disbelievers

³⁵as they sit on 'canopied' couches, looking on

³⁶'The believers will be asked,' "Have the disbelievers 'not' been paid back for what they used to do?"

Al-Inshiqāq

The Splitting Open • 25 verses

- ¹When the sky bursts open
²obeying its Lord as it must
³and when the earth is flattened out
⁴and ejects 'all' its contents and becomes empty
⁵obeying its Lord as it must, 'surely you will all be judged'
⁶O humanity! Indeed, you are labouring restlessly towards
your Lord, and will 'eventually' meet the consequences
⁷As for those who are given their record in their right hand
⁸they will have an easy reckoning
⁹and will return to their people joyfully
¹⁰And as for those who are given their record 'in their left
hand' from behind their backs
¹¹they will cry for 'instant' destruction
¹²and will burn in the blazing Fire
¹³For they used to be prideful among their people

¹⁴thinking they would never return 'to Allah'

¹⁵Yes 'they would'! Surely their Lord has always been All-Seeing of them

¹⁶So, I do swear by the twilight

¹⁷And by the night and whatever it envelops

¹⁸And by the moon when it waxes full

¹⁹You will certainly pass from one state to another

²⁰So what is the matter with them that they do not believe

²¹and when the Quran is recited to them, they do not bow down 'in submission'

²²In fact, the disbelievers persist in denial

²³But Allah knows best whatever they hide

²⁴So give them good news of a painful punishment

²⁵But those who believe and do good will have a never-ending reward

Al-Burūj

The Constellations • 22 verses

- ¹By the sky full of constellations
²and the promised Day 'of Judgment'
³and the witness and what is witnessed
⁴Condemned are the makers of the ditch—
⁵the fire 'pit', filled with fuel—
⁶when they sat around it
⁷watching what they had 'ordered to be' done to the believers
⁸who they resented for no reason other than belief in Allah—
the Almighty, the Praiseworthy—
⁹'the One' to Whom belongs the kingdom of the heavens and
earth. And Allah is a Witness over all things
¹⁰Those who persecute the believing men and women and
then do not repent will certainly suffer the punishment of
Hell and the torment of burning

¹¹ Surely those who believe and do good will have Gardens under which rivers flow. That is the greatest triumph

¹² Indeed, the 'crushing' grip of your Lord is severe

¹³ 'For' He is certainly the One Who originates and resurrects 'all'

¹⁴ And He is the All-Forgiving, All-Loving—

¹⁵ Lord of the Throne, the All-Glorious

¹⁶ Doer of whatever He wills

¹⁷ Has the story of the 'destroyed' forces reached you 'O Prophet'—

¹⁸ 'the forces of' Pharaoh and Thamûd

¹⁹ Yet the disbelievers 'still' persist in denial

²⁰ But Allah encompasses them from all sides

²¹ In fact, this is a glorious Quran

²² 'recorded' in a Preserved Tablet

Aṭ-Ṭāriq

The Nightly Star • 17 verses

- ¹By the heaven and the nightly star
²And what will make you realize what the nightly star is
³‘It is’ the star of piercing brightness
⁴There is no soul without a vigilant angel ‘recording every-
thing’
⁵Let people then consider what they were created from
⁶‘They were’ created from a spurting fluid
⁷stemming from between the backbone and the ribcage
⁸Surely He is fully capable of bringing them back ‘to life’
⁹on the Day all secrets will be disclosed
¹⁰Then one will have neither power nor ‘any’ helper
¹¹By the sky with its recurring cycles
¹²and the earth with its sprouting plants
¹³Surely this ‘Quran’ is a decisive word

¹⁴and is not to be taken lightly

¹⁵They are certainly devising 'evil' plans

¹⁶but I too am planning

¹⁷So bear with the disbelievers 'O Prophet'. Let them be for
'just' a little while

Al-Aʿlā

The Most High • 19 verses

- ¹Glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High
²Who created and ‘perfectly’ fashioned ‘all’
³and Who ordained precisely and inspired accordingly
⁴and Who brings forth ‘green’ pasture
⁵then reduces it to withered chaff
⁶We will have you recite ‘the Quran, O Prophet,’ so you will
not forget ‘any of it’
⁷unless Allah wills otherwise. He surely knows what is open
and what is hidden
⁸We will facilitate for you the Way of Ease
⁹So ‘always’ remind ‘with the Quran’—‘even’ if the reminder
is beneficial ‘only to some’
¹⁰Those in awe ‘of Allah’ will be mindful ‘of it’
¹¹But it will be shunned by the most wretched
¹²who will burn in the greatest Fire

- ¹³where they will not 'be able to' live or die
- ¹⁴Successful indeed are those who purify themselves
- ¹⁵remember the Name of their Lord, and pray
- ¹⁶But you 'deniers only' prefer the life of this world
- ¹⁷even though the Hereafter is far better and more lasting
- ¹⁸This is certainly 'mentioned' in the earlier Scriptures—
- ¹⁹the Scriptures of Abraham and Moses

Al-Ghāshiyah

The Overwhelming Event • 26 verses

- ¹Has the news of the Overwhelming Event reached you 'O Prophet'
- ²On that Day 'some' faces will be downcast
- ³'totally' overburdened, exhausted
- ⁴burning in a scorching Fire
- ⁵left to drink from a scalding spring
- ⁶They will have no food except a foul, thorny shrub
- ⁷neither nourishing nor satisfying hunger
- ⁸On that Day 'other' faces will be glowing with bliss
- ⁹'fully' pleased with their striving
- ¹⁰in an elevated Garden
- ¹¹where no idle talk will be heard
- ¹²In it will be a running spring
- ¹³along with thrones raised high

¹⁴and cups set at hand

¹⁵and 'fine' cushions lined up

¹⁶and 'splendid' carpets spread out

¹⁷Do they not ever reflect on camels—how they were 'masterfully' created

¹⁸and the sky—how it was raised 'high'

¹⁹and the mountains—how they were firmly set up

²⁰and the earth—how it was levelled out

²¹So, 'continue to' remind 'all, O Prophet', for your duty is only to remind

²²You are not 'there' to compel them 'to believe'

²³But whoever turns away, persisting in disbelief

²⁴then Allah will inflict upon them the major punishment

²⁵Surely to Us is their return

²⁶then surely with Us is their reckoning

Al-Fajr

The Dawn • 30 verses

- ¹By the dawn
²and the ten nights
³and the even and the odd
⁴and the night when it passes
⁵Is all this 'not' a sufficient oath for those who have sense
⁶Did you not see how your Lord dealt with 'Ād—
⁷'the people' of Iram—with 'their' great stature
⁸unmatched in any other land
⁹and Thamūd who carved 'their homes into' the rocks in the
'Stone' Valley
¹⁰and the Pharaoh of mighty structures
¹¹They all transgressed throughout the land
¹²spreading much corruption there
¹³So your Lord unleashed on them a scourge of punishment

¹⁴For your Lord is truly vigilant

¹⁵Now, whenever a human being is tested by their Lord through His generosity and blessings, they boast, “My Lord has deservedly honoured me!”

¹⁶But when He tests them by limiting their provision, they protest, “My Lord has undeservedly humiliated me!”

¹⁷Absolutely not! In fact, you are not even gracious to the orphan

¹⁸nor do you urge one another to feed the poor

¹⁹And you devour others’ inheritance greedily

²⁰and love wealth fervently

²¹Enough! When the earth is entirely crushed over and over

²²and your Lord comes to judge with angels, rank upon rank

²³and Hell is brought forth on that Day—this is when every disbelieving person will remember their own sins. But what is the use of remembering then

²⁴They will cry, “I wish I had sent forth something good for my true life.”

²⁵On that Day He will punish them severely, like no other

²⁶and bind them tightly, like no other

²⁷Allah will say to the righteous, “O tranquil soul

²⁸Return to your Lord, well pleased 'with Him' and well pleasing 'to Him'

²⁹So join My servants

³⁰and enter My Paradise.”

Al-Balad

The City • 20 verses

- ¹I do swear by this city 'of Mecca'—
²even though you 'O Prophet' are subject to abuse in this city—
³and by every parent and 'their' child
⁴Indeed, We have created humankind in 'constant' struggle
⁵Do they think that no one has power over them
⁶boasting, "I have wasted enormous wealth!"
⁷Do they think that no one sees them
⁸Have We not given them two eyes
⁹a tongue, and two lips
¹⁰and shown them the two ways 'of right and wrong'
¹¹If only they had attempted the challenging path 'of goodness instead'
¹²And what will make you realize what 'attempting' the challenging path is

¹³It is to free a slave

¹⁴or to give food in times of famine

¹⁵to an orphaned relative

¹⁶or to a poor person in distress

¹⁷and—above all—to be one of those who have faith and urge each other to perseverance and urge each other to compassion

¹⁸These are the people of the right

¹⁹As for those who deny Our signs, they are the people of the left

²⁰The Fire will be sealed over them

Ash-Shams

The Sun • 15 verses

- ¹By the sun and its brightness
²and the moon as it follows it
³and the day as it unveils it
⁴and the night as it conceals it
⁵And by heaven and 'the One' Who built it
⁶and the earth and 'the One' Who spread it
⁷And by the soul and 'the One' Who fashioned it
⁸then with 'the knowledge of' right and wrong inspired it
⁹Successful indeed is the one who purifies their soul
¹⁰and doomed is the one who corrupts it
¹¹Thamûd rejected 'the truth' out of arrogance
¹²when the most wicked of them was roused 'to kill the she-camel'
¹³But the messenger of Allah warned them, "'Do not disturb'
Allah's camel and her 'turn to' drink!'"

¹⁴Still they defied him and slaughtered her. So their Lord crushed them for their crime, levelling all to the ground

¹⁵He has no fear of consequences

Al-Layl

The Night • 21 verses

- ¹By the night when it covers
²and the day when it shines
³And by 'the One' Who created male and female
⁴Surely the ends you strive for are diverse
⁵As for the one who is charitable, mindful 'of Allah'
⁶and 'firmly' believes in the finest reward
⁷We will facilitate for them the Way of Ease
⁸And as for the one who is stingy, indifferent 'to Allah'
⁹and 'staunchly' denies the finest reward
¹⁰We will facilitate for them the path of hardship
¹¹And their wealth will be of no benefit to them when they
tumble 'into Hell'
¹²It is certainly upon Us 'alone' to show 'the way to' guidance
¹³And surely to Us 'alone' belong this life and the next

- ¹⁴And so I have warned you of a raging Fire
¹⁵in which none will burn except the most wretched—
¹⁶who deny and turn away
¹⁷But the righteous will be spared from it—
¹⁸who donate 'some of' their wealth only to purify themselves
¹⁹not in return for someone's favours
²⁰but seeking the pleasure of their Lord, the Most High
²¹They will certainly be pleased

Aḍ-Ḍuḥā

The Morning Brightness • 11 verses

¹By the morning sunlight

²and the night when it falls still

³Your Lord 'O Prophet' has not abandoned you, nor has He become hateful 'of you'

⁴And the next life is certainly far better for you than this one

⁵And 'surely' your Lord will give so much to you that you will be pleased

⁶Did He not find you as an orphan then sheltered you

⁷Did He not find you unguided then guided you

⁸And did He not find you needy then satisfied your needs

⁹So do not oppress the orphan

¹⁰nor repulse the beggar

¹¹And proclaim the blessings of your Lord

Ash-Sharḥ

The Relief • 8 verses

- ¹Have We not uplifted your heart for you 'O Prophet'
²relieved you of the burden
³which weighed so heavily on your back
⁴and elevated your renown for you
⁵So, surely with hardship comes ease
⁶Surely with 'that' hardship comes 'more' ease
⁷So once you have fulfilled 'your duty', strive 'in devotion'
⁸turning to your Lord 'alone' with hope

At-Tīn

The Fig • 8 verses

¹By the fig and the olive 'of Jerusalem'

²and Mount Sinai

³and this secure city 'of Mecca'

⁴Indeed, We created humans in the best form

⁵But We will reduce them to the lowest of the low 'in Hell'

⁶except those who believe and do good—they will have a never-ending reward

⁷Now, what makes you deny the 'final' Judgment

⁸Is Allah not the most just of all judges

Al-‘Alaq

The Clot • 19 verses

- ¹Read, ‘O Prophet,’ in the Name of your Lord Who created—
²created humans from a clinging clot
³Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous
⁴Who taught by the pen—
⁵taught humanity what they knew not
⁶Most certainly, one exceeds all bounds
⁷once they think they are self-sufficient
⁸‘But’ surely to your Lord is the return ‘of all’
⁹Have you seen the man who prevents
¹⁰a servant ‘of Ours’ from praying
¹¹What if this ‘servant’ is ‘rightly’ guided
¹²or encourages righteousness
¹³What if that ‘man’ persists in denial and turns away
¹⁴Does he not know that Allah sees ‘all’

¹⁵But no! If he does not desist, We will certainly drag him by the forelock—

¹⁶a lying, sinful forelock

¹⁷So let him call his associates

¹⁸We will call the wardens of Hell

¹⁹Again, no! Never obey him 'O Prophet'! Rather, 'continue to' prostrate and draw near 'to Allah'

Al-Qadr

The Night of Glory • 5 verses

¹Indeed, 'it is' We 'Who' sent this 'Quran' down on the Night of Glory

²And what will make you realize what the Night of Glory is

³The Night of Glory is better than a thousand months

⁴That night the angels and the 'holy' spirit descend, by the permission of their Lord, for every 'decreed' matter

⁵It is all peace until the break of dawn

Al-Bayyinah

The Clear Proof • 8 verses

¹The disbelievers from the People of the Book and the polytheists were not going to desist 'from disbelief' until the clear proof came to them

²a messenger from Allah, reciting scrolls of 'utmost' purity

³containing upright commandments

⁴It was not until this clear proof came to the People of the Book that they became divided 'about his prophethood'—

⁵even though they were only commanded to worship Allah 'alone' with sincere devotion to Him in all uprightness, establish prayer, and pay alms-tax. That is the upright Way

⁶Indeed, those who disbelieve from the People of the Book and the polytheists will be in the Fire of Hell, to stay there forever. They are the worst of 'all' beings

⁷Indeed, those who believe and do good—they are the best of 'all' beings

⁸Their reward with their Lord will be Gardens of Eternity, under which rivers flow, to stay there for ever and ever. Allah is pleased with them and they are pleased with Him. This is 'only' for those in awe of their Lord

Az-Zalzalah

The Earthquake • 8 verses

- ¹When the earth is shaken 'in' its ultimate quaking
²and when the earth throws out 'all' its contents
³and humanity cries, "What is wrong with it?"—
⁴on that Day the earth will recount everything
⁵having been inspired by your Lord 'to do so'
⁶On that Day people will proceed in separate groups to be
shown 'the consequences of' their deeds
⁷So whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it
⁸And whoever does an atom's weight of evil will see it

Al-‘Ādiyāt

The Galloping Horses • 11 verses

- ¹ By the galloping, panting horses
²striking sparks of fire ‘with their hoofs’
³launching raids at dawn
⁴stirring up ‘clouds of’ dust
⁵and penetrating into the heart of enemy lines
⁶Surely humankind is ungrateful to their Lord—
⁷and they certainly attest to this—
⁸and they are truly extreme in their love of ‘worldly’ gains
⁹Do they not know that when the contents of the graves will
be spilled out
¹⁰and the secrets of the hearts will be laid bare—
¹¹surely their Lord is All-Aware of them on that Day

Al-Qāri‘ah

The Striking Calamity • 11 verses

¹The Striking Disaster

²What is the Striking Disaster

³And what will make you realize what the Striking Disaster
is

⁴‘It is’ the Day people will be like scattered moths

⁵and the mountains will be like carded wool

⁶So as for those whose scale is heavy ‘with good deeds’

⁷they will be in a life of bliss

⁸And as for those whose scale is light

⁹their home will be the abyss

¹⁰And what will make you realize what that is

¹¹‘It is’ a scorching Fire

At-Takāthur

The Rivalry for Worldly Gain • 8 verses

- ¹Competition for more 'gains' diverts you 'from Allah'
- ²until you end up in 'your' graves
- ³But no! You will soon come to know
- ⁴Again, no! You will soon come to know
- ⁵Indeed, if you were to know 'your fate' with certainty, 'you would have acted differently'
- ⁶'But' you will surely see the Hellfire
- ⁷Again, you will surely see it with the eye of certainty
- ⁸Then, on that Day, you will definitely be questioned about 'your worldly' pleasures

Al-ʿAṣr

The Time • 3 verses

¹By the ʿpassage ofʼ time

²Surely humanity is in ʿgraveʼ loss

³except those who have faith, do good, and urge each other to the truth, and urge each other to perseverance

Al-Humazah

The Backbiter • 9 verses

- ¹Woe to every backbiter, slanderer
- ²who amasses wealth 'greedily' and counts it 'repeatedly'
- ³thinking that their wealth will make them immortal
- ⁴Not at all! Such a person will certainly be tossed into the Crusher
- ⁵And what will make you realize what the Crusher is
- ⁶'It is' Allah's kindled Fire
- ⁷which rages over the hearts
- ⁸It will be sealed over them
- ⁹'tightly secured' with long braces

Al-Fil

The Elephant • 5 verses

- ¹Have you not seen 'O Prophet' how your Lord dealt with the
Army of the Elephant
²Did He not frustrate their scheme
³For He sent against them flocks of birds
⁴that pelted them with stones of baked clay
⁵leaving them like chewed up straw

Quraysh

Quraysh • 4 verses

¹‘At least’ for ‘the favour of’ making Quraysh habitually secure—

²secure in their trading caravan ‘to Yemen’ in the winter and
‘Syria’ in the summer—

³let them worship the Lord of this ‘Sacred’ House

⁴Who has fed them against hunger and made them secure
against fear

Al-Mā'ūn

The Common Necessities • 7 verses

- ¹Have you seen the one who denies the 'final' Judgment
²That is the one who repulses the orphan
³and does not encourage the feeding of the poor
⁴So woe to those 'hypocrites' who pray
⁵yet are unmindful of their prayers
⁶those who 'only' show off
⁷and refuse to give 'even the simplest' aid

Al-Kawthar

Abundance • 3 verses

¹Indeed, We have granted you 'O Prophet' abundant goodness

²So pray and sacrifice to your Lord 'alone'

³Only the one who hates you is truly cut off 'from any goodness'

Al-Kāfirūn

The Disbelievers • 6 verses

- ¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "O you disbelievers
²I do not worship what you worship
³nor do you worship what I worship
⁴I will never worship what you worship
⁵nor will you ever worship what I worship
⁶You have your way, and I have my Way."

An-Naşr

The Divine Support • 3 verses

¹When Allah's 'ultimate' help comes and the victory 'over Mecca is achieved'

²and you 'O Prophet' see the people embracing Allah's Way in crowds

³then glorify the praises of your Lord and seek His forgiveness, for certainly He is ever Accepting of Repentance

Al-Masad

The Palm Fibre • 5 verses

- ¹May the hands of Abu Lahab perish, and he 'himself' perish
²Neither his wealth nor 'worldly' gains will benefit him
³He will burn in a flaming Fire
⁴and 'so will' his wife, the carrier of 'thorny' kindling
⁵around her neck will be a rope of palm-fibre

Al-Ikhlāṣ

Sincerity of Faith • 4 verses

¹Say, ‘O Prophet,’ “He is Allah—One ‘and Indivisible’

²Allah—the Sustainer ‘needed by all’

³He has never had offspring, nor was He born

⁴And there is none comparable to Him.”

Al-Falaq

The Daybreak • 5 verses

- ¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "I seek refuge in the Lord of the daybreak
²from the evil of whatever He has created
³and from the evil of the night when it grows dark
⁴and from the evil of those 'witches casting spells by' blowing
onto knots
⁵and from the evil of an envier when they envy."

An-Nās

Humanity • 6 verses

- ¹Say, 'O Prophet,' "I seek refuge in the Lord of humankind
²the Master of humankind
³the God of humankind
⁴from the evil of the lurking whisperer—
⁵who whispers into the hearts of humankind—
⁶from among jinn and humankind."

Colophon

The Clear Quran: An Optimal English Translation

Translated by Dr. Mustafa Khattab

English translation © 2016 Dr. Mustafa Khattab / Dar-us-Salam Publications. All rights of the original translation are reserved. This typeset edition is generated solely for personal study and non-commercial reference.

Typeset with XeLaTeX using *Noto Serif* typeface
by Monotype • SIL Open Font Licence 1.1

Generated from druvx13/Quran-data
<https://github.com/druvx13/Quran-data>

A5 format • English text only • 114 Chapters • 6,236 Verses
